

THE STORY OF SALVATION

an abridged reading of the whole arc in order

The Story track

111 readings

Douay-Rheims (Challoner)

This track

The story told continuously: 111 readings, the 36 above plus 75 more, at 3,675 verses or 10.3 per cent of the Bible. Adds the connecting episodes, so that cause and consequence hold from Genesis 12 to Acts 28. Confined to the consensus narrative spine, and to it alone: at this tier the plan reads no prophet, no psalm, no gospel but St. Luke, and none of the narrative deuterocanon but 1 Machabees.

Extent. 111 readings, 118 chapters and 3675 verses of this edition.

What this plan does not read

This account belongs at the front and not in a footnote. An abridgement is defined by what it drops.

This plan is an abridgement, and the honest account of an abridgement is what it leaves out. All figures below are verse counts taken from the Douay-Rheims (Challoner) text indexed in this repository, whose 73 books hold 35,804 verses. Percentages computed on a 66-book canon run higher for every class named here, because the denominator is smaller; the commonly quoted figures of about 19.8 per cent for the prophets, 14.4 per cent for wisdom and poetry and 8.1 per cent for the epistles are of that kind.

At its fullest tier this plan reads 13,867 verses, 38.7 per cent of the Bible. The story tier reads 3,675 verses, 10.3 per cent. The landmarks tier reads 1,210 verses, 3.4 per cent.

The reduction does not come from cutting genealogies and law codes. Those are small: every genealogy and register dropped here comes to 297 verses, 0.8 per cent of the Bible, and the whole of Leviticus, Exodus 25-31 and 35-40, Numbers 1-9 and 26-30 and Deuteronomy 12-26 together come to 2,217 verses, 6.2 per cent. Seven per cent, between them. The reduction comes from dropping three whole classes of book that are not narrative, which come to 15,519 verses, 43.3 per cent of the Bible.

Not read at any tier:

The prophets, 5,875 verses, 16.4 per cent of the Bible (counting Lamentations, Baruch and Daniel among them). What survives is fifteen passages in thirteen readings, and the narrative chapters of Daniel: Isaias 7:1-17, 9:1-7, 11:1-10, 52:13-53:12, 54:5-14 and 55:1-11; Jeremias 31:31-40, 36 and 38:1-13; Baruch 3:9-15 with 3:32-4:4; Ezechiel 34, 36:16-28 and 37:1-14; Lamentations 3:19-33; Daniel 1-6, 13 and 14. Everything else is absent - the whole of Osee through Malachias, all but six passages of Isaias, all but three of Jeremias, Daniel's visions, and every oracle against the nations. A reader who finishes this plan has not read the prophets.

The wisdom and poetical books, 6,881 verses, 19.2 per cent. Job, Proverbs, Ecclesiastes, the Canticle of Canticles, Wisdom and Ecclesiasticus are not read at all. Of the 150 psalms, sixteen are read, each because a narrative moment demands it.

The epistles, 2,763 verses, 7.7 per cent. All twenty-one, and Hebrews with them. The plan follows the Church's expansion through the Acts and stops; it does not read what the apostles wrote to the churches they founded. That is the largest gap in its New Testament coverage, and no narrative plan can close it, because the epistles are not narrative.

The Apocalypse, but for 21:1-22:5, read as the close of the arc opened in Genesis 1.

Also not read, being narrative or historical but doubled, legal, or list: Leviticus entire; Exodus 25-31 and 35-40; Numbers 1-9 and 26-30 apart from chapter 27; Deuteronomy 12-26; Josue 12-22; Judges 17-21; 1 and 2 Paralipomenon entire, as a second telling of reigns already read in Samuel and Kings; Aggeus, Zacharias and Malachias, though they belong to the Return; and 2 Machabees but for chapters 6 and 7.

Genealogies and registers dropped: Genesis 5, 10, 22:20-24, 25:12-18 and 36; Exodus 6:14-30; Esdras 2; Nehemias 3 and 7. Genesis 11:10-32 and St. Matthew 1 are kept, because they are the two genealogies that carry the plot.

The consensus narrative spine within the twelve periods is 334 chapters. This plan reads 331 of them, holding back only Esdras 2, Nehemias 3 and Nehemias 7, and adds the material listed at the year tier. It touches 454 chapters in 31 of the 73 books.

The cost is stated here because every abridgement that concealed it has been attacked for concealing it. A reader who wants the Bible should read the Bible. What this offers is the story in order, at three depths, with the seams visible.

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PRIMEVAL HISTORY

From the creation to the scattering at Babel: the world God made, the fault that broke it, and the first covenant made with a remnant. Genesis 5 and 10, which are genealogies, are passed over; Genesis 11:10-32 is kept because it is the bridge to Abram.

1. Creation

Genesis 1:1-2:2

The first lesson of the Easter Vigil. The Vigil's own abridgement of salvation history governs this plan: every one of its lessons is read at some tier.

1 ¹ In the beginning God created heaven, and earth. ² And the earth was void and empty, and darkness was upon the face of the deep; and the spirit of God moved over the waters.

³ And God said: Be light made. And light was made. ⁴ And God saw the light that it was good; and he divided the light from the darkness. ⁵ And he called the light Day, and the darkness Night; and there was evening and morning one day.

⁶ And God said: Let there be a firmament made amidst the waters: and let it divide the waters from the waters. ⁷ And God made a firmament, and divided the waters that were under the firmament, from those that were above the firmament, and it was so. ⁸ And God called the firmament, Heaven; and the evening and morning were the second day.

⁹ God also said; Let the waters that are under the heaven, be gathered together into one place: and let the dry land appear. And it was so done. ¹⁰ And God called the dry land, Earth; and the gathering together of the waters, he called Seas. And God saw that it was good. ¹¹ And he said: let the earth bring forth green herb, and such as may seed, and the fruit tree yielding fruit after its kind, which may have seed in itself upon the earth. And it was so done. ¹² And the earth brought forth the green herb, and such as yieldeth seed according to its kind, and the tree that beareth fruit, having seed each one according to its kind. And God saw that it was good. ¹³ And the evening and the morning were the third day.

¹⁴ And God said: Let there be lights made in the firmament of heaven, to divide the day and the night, and let them be for signs, and for seasons, and for days and years: ¹⁵ To shine in the firmament of heaven, and to give light upon the earth, and it was so done. ¹⁶ And God made two great lights: a greater light to rule the day; and a lesser light to rule the night: and the stars. ¹⁷ And he set them in the firmament of heaven to shine upon the earth. ¹⁸ And to rule the day and the night, and to divide the light and the darkness. And God saw that it was good. ¹⁹ And the evening and morning were the fourth day.

²⁰ God also said: let the waters bring forth the creeping creature having life, and the fowl that may fly over the earth under the firmament of heaven. ²¹ And God created the great whales, and every living and moving creature, which the waters brought forth, according to their kinds, and every winged fowl according to its kind. And God saw that it was good. ²² And he blessed them, saying: Increase and multiply, and fill the waters of the sea: and let the birds be multiplied upon the earth. ²³ And the evening and morning were the fifth day.

²⁴ And God said: Let the earth bring forth the living creature in its kind, cattle and creeping things, and beasts of the earth,

according to their kinds. And it was so done. ²⁵ And God made the beasts of the earth according to their kinds, and cattle, and every thing that creepeth on the earth after its kind. And God saw that it was good.

²⁶ And he said: Let us make man to our image and likeness: and let him have dominion over the fishes of the sea, and the fowls of the air, and the beasts, and the whole earth, and every creeping creature that moveth upon the earth. ²⁷ And God created man to his own image: to the image of God he created him: male and female he created them. ²⁸ And God blessed them, saying: Increase and multiply, and fill the earth, and subdue it, and rule over the fishes of the sea, and the fowls of the air, and all living creatures that move upon the earth. ²⁹ And God said: Behold I have given you every herb bearing seed upon the earth, and all trees that have in themselves seed of their own kind, to be your meat: ³⁰ And to all beasts of the earth, and to every fowl of the air, and to all that move upon the earth, and wherein there is life, that they may have to feed upon. And it was so done. ³¹ And God saw all the things that he had made, and they were very good. And the evening and morning were the sixth day.

2 ¹ So the heavens and the earth were finished, and all the furniture of them. ² And on the seventh day God ended his work which he had made: and he rested on the seventh day from all his work which he had done.

3. The fall

Genesis 3:1-24

The protoevangelium at 3:15 is the seed of everything the plan afterwards follows.

3 ¹ Now the serpent was more subtle than any of the beasts of the earth which the Lord God had made. And he said to the woman: Why hath God commanded you, that you should not eat of every tree of paradise? ² And the woman answered him, saying: Of the fruit of the trees that are in paradise we do eat: ³ But of the fruit of the tree which is in the midst of paradise, God hath commanded us that we should not eat; and that we should not touch it, lest perhaps we die. ⁴ And the serpent said to the woman: No, you shall not die the death. ⁵ For God doth know that in what day soever you shall eat thereof, your eyes shall be opened: and you shall be as Gods, knowing good and evil.

⁶ And the woman saw that the tree was good to eat, and fair to the eyes, and delightful to behold: and she took of the fruit thereof, and did eat, and gave to her husband, who did eat. ⁷ And the eyes of them both were opened: and when they perceived themselves to be naked, they sewed together fig leaves, and made themselves aprons. ⁸ And when they heard the voice of the Lord God walking in paradise at the afternoon air, Adam and his wife hid themselves from the face of the Lord God, amidst the trees of paradise.

⁹ And the Lord God called Adam, and said to him: Where art thou? ¹⁰ And he said: I heard thy voice in paradise; and I was afraid, because I was naked, and I hid myself.

¹¹ And he said to him: And who hath told thee that thou wast naked, but that thou hast eaten of the tree whereof I commanded thee that thou shouldst not eat? ¹² And Adam said: The woman, whom thou gavest me to be my companion, gave me of the tree,

and I did eat. ¹³ And the Lord God said to the woman: Why hast thou done this? And she answered: The serpent deceived me, and I did eat.

¹⁴ And the Lord God said to the serpent: Because thou hast done this thing, thou art cursed among all cattle, and beasts of the earth: upon thy breast shalt thou go, and earth shalt thou eat all the days of thy life. ¹⁵ I will put enmities between thee and the woman, and thy seed and her seed: she shall crush thy head, and thou shalt lie in wait for her heel. ¹⁶ To the woman also he said: I will multiply thy sorrows, and thy conceptions: in sorrow shalt thou bring forth children, and thou shalt be under thy husband's power, and he shall have dominion over thee.

¹⁷ And to Adam he said: Because thou hast hearkened to the voice of thy wife, and hast eaten of the tree, whereof I commanded thee, that thou shouldst not eat, cursed is the earth in thy work: with labour and toil shalt thou eat thereof all the days of thy life. ¹⁸ Thorns and thistles shall it bring forth to thee, and thou shalt eat the herbs of the earth. ¹⁹ In the sweat of thy face shalt thou eat bread till thou return to the earth out of which thou wast taken: for dust thou art, and into dust thou shalt return. ²⁰ And Adam called the name of his wife Eve: because she was the mother of all the living. ²¹ And the Lord God made for Adam and his wife garments of skins, and clothed them.

²² And he said: Behold Adam is become as one of us, knowing good and evil: now therefore lest perhaps he put forth his hand and take also of the tree of life, and eat, and live for ever. ²³ And the Lord God sent him out of the paradise of pleasure, to till the earth from which he was taken. ²⁴ And he cast out Adam: and placed before the paradise of pleasure Cherubims, and a flaming sword, turning every way, to keep the way of the tree of life.

4. Cain and Abel

Genesis 4:1-16

4 ¹ And Adam knew Eve his wife; who conceived and brought forth Cain, saying: I have gotten a man through God. ² And again she brought forth his brother Abel. And Abel was a shepherd, and Cain a husbandman. ³ And it came to pass after many days, that Cain offered, of the fruits of the earth, gifts to the Lord. ⁴ Abel also offered of the firstlings of his flock, and of their fat: and the Lord had respect to Abel, and to his offerings. ⁵ But to Cain and his offerings he had no respect: and Cain was exceeding angry, and his countenance fell. ⁶ And the Lord said to him: Why art thou angry? and why is thy countenance fallen? ⁷ If thou do well, shalt thou not receive? but if ill, shall not sin forthwith be present at the door? but the lust thereof shall be under thee, and thou shalt have dominion over it. ⁸ And Cain said to Abel his brother: Let us go forth abroad. And when they were in the field, Cain rose up against his brother Abel, and slew him.

⁹ And the Lord said to Cain: Where is thy brother Abel? And he answered: I know not: am I my brother's keeper? ¹⁰ And he said to him: What hast thou done? the voice of thy brother's blood crieth to me from the earth. ¹¹ Now, therefore, cursed shalt thou be upon the earth, which hath opened her mouth and received the blood of thy brother at thy hand. ¹² When thou shalt till it, it shall not yield to thee its fruit: a fugitive and a vagabond shalt thou be upon the earth.

¹³ And Cain said to the Lord: My iniquity is greater than that I may deserve pardon. ¹⁴ Behold thou dost cast me out this day

from the face of the earth, and from thy face I shall be hid, and I shall be a vagabond and a fugitive on the earth: every one, therefore, that findeth me, shall kill me. ¹⁵ And the Lord said to him: No, it shall not so be: but whosoever shall kill Cain, shall be punished sevenfold. And the Lord set a mark upon Cain, that whosoever found him should not kill him.

¹⁶ And Cain went out from the face of the Lord, and dwelt as a fugitive on the earth at the east side of Eden.

7. The flood

Genesis 6:5-8:22

Read as one unit: the corruption, the ark, the deluge and its abating.

6 ⁵ And God seeing that the wickedness of men was great on the earth, and that all the thought of their heart was bent upon evil at all times, ⁶ It repented him that he had made man on the earth. And being touched inwardly with sorrow of heart, ⁷ He said: I will destroy man, whom I have created, from the face of the earth, from man even to beasts, from the creeping thing even to the fowls of the air, for it repenteth me that I have made them. ⁸ But Noe found grace before the Lord.

⁹ These are the generations of Noe: Noe was a just and perfect man in his generations, he walked with God. ¹⁰ And he begot three sons, Sem, Cham, and Japheth. ¹¹ And the earth was corrupted before God, and was filled with iniquity. ¹² And when God had seen that the earth was corrupted (for all flesh had corrupted its way upon the earth),

¹³ He said to Noe: The end of all flesh is come before me, the earth is filled with iniquity through them, and I will destroy them with the earth. ¹⁴ Make thee an ark of timber planks: thou shalt make little rooms in the ark, and thou shalt pitch it within and without. ¹⁵ And thus shalt thou make it. The length of the ark shall be three hundred cubits: the breadth of it fifty cubits, and the height of it thirty cubits. ¹⁶ Thou shalt make a window in the ark, and in a cubit shalt thou finish the top of it: and the door of the ark thou shalt set in the side: with lower, middle chambers, and third stories shalt thou make it. ¹⁷ Behold, I will bring the waters of a great flood upon the earth, to destroy all flesh, wherein is the breath of life under heaven. All things that are in the earth shall be consumed. ¹⁸ And I will establish my covenant with thee, and thou shalt enter into the ark, thou and thy sons, and thy wife, and the wives of thy sons with thee. ¹⁹ And of every living creature of all flesh, thou shalt bring two of a sort into the ark, that they may live with thee: of the male sex, and the female. ²⁰ Of fowls according to their kind, and of beasts in their kind, and of every thing that creepeth on the earth according to its kind: two of every sort shall go in with thee, that they may live. ²¹ Thou shalt take unto thee of all food that may be eaten, and thou shalt lay it up with thee: and it shall be food for thee and them. ²² And Noe did all things which God commanded him.

7 ¹ And the Lord said to him: Go in, thou and all thy house, into the ark: for thee I have seen just before me in this generation.

² Of all clean beasts take seven and seven, the male and the female. ³ But of the beasts that are unclean two and two, the male and the female. Of the fowls also of the air seven and seven, the male and the female: that seed may be saved upon the face

of the whole earth. ⁴ For yet a while, and after seven days, I will rain upon the earth forty days and forty nights: and I will destroy every substance that I have made, from the face of the earth.

⁵ And Noe did all things which the Lord had commanded him. ⁶ And he was six hundred years old, when the waters of the flood overflowed the earth. ⁷ And Noe went in and his sons, his wife and the wives of his sons with him into the ark, because of the waters of the flood. ⁸ And of beasts clean and unclean, and of fowls, and of every thing that moveth upon the earth, ⁹ Two and two went in to Noe into the ark, male and female, as the Lord had commanded Noe. ¹⁰ And after the seven days were passed, the waters of the flood overflowed the earth. ¹¹ In the six hundredth year of the life of Noe, in the second month, in the seventeenth day of the month, all the fountains of the great deep were broken up, and the floodgates of heaven were opened: ¹² And the rain fell upon the earth forty days and forty nights.

¹³ In the selfsame day Noe, and Sem, and Cham, and Japheth, his sons: his wife, and the three wives of his sons with them, went into the ark. ¹⁴ They and every beast according to its kind, and all the cattle in their kind, and every thing that moveth upon the earth, according to its kind, and every fowl according to its kind, all birds, and all that fly, ¹⁵ Went in to Noe into the ark, two and two of all flesh, wherein was the breath of life. ¹⁶ And they that went in, went in male and female of all flesh, as God had commanded him: and the Lord shut him in on the outside. ¹⁷ And the flood was forty days upon the earth: and the waters increased, and lifted up the ark on high from the earth. ¹⁸ For they overflowed exceedingly: and filled all on the face of the earth: and the ark was carried upon the waters. ¹⁹ And the waters prevailed beyond measure upon the earth: and all the high mountains under the whole heaven were covered. ²⁰ The water was fifteen cubits higher than the mountains which it covered. ²¹ And all flesh was destroyed that moved upon the earth, both of fowl and of cattle, and of beasts, and of all creeping things that creep upon the earth: and all men. ²² And all things wherein there is the breath of life on the earth, died. ²³ And he destroyed all the substance that was upon the earth, from man even to beast, and the creeping things and fowls of the air: and they were destroyed from the earth: and Noe only remained, and they that were with him in the ark. ²⁴ And the waters prevailed upon the earth a hundred and fifty days.

8 ¹ And God remembered Noe, and all the living creatures, and all the cattle which were with him in the ark, and brought a wind upon the earth, and the waters were abated: ² The fountains also of the deep, and the floodgates of heaven, were shut up, and the rain from heaven was restrained. ³ And the waters returned from off the earth going and coming: and they began to be abated after a hundred and fifty days. ⁴ And the ark rested in the seventh month, the seven and twentieth day of the month, upon the mountains of Armenia. ⁵ And the waters were going and decreasing until the tenth month: for in the tenth month, the first day of the month, the tops of the mountains appeared.

⁶ And after that forty days were passed, Noe opening the window of the ark, which he had made, sent forth a raven: ⁷ Which went forth and did not return, till the waters were dried up upon the earth. ⁸ He sent forth also a dove after him, to see if the

waters had now ceased upon the face of the earth. ⁹ But she not finding where her foot might rest, returned to him into the ark: for the waters were upon the whole earth: and he put forth his hand, and caught her, and brought her into the ark. ¹⁰ And having waited yet seven other days, he again sent forth the dove out of the ark. ¹¹ And she came to him in the evening carrying a bough of an olive tree, with green leaves, in her mouth. Noe therefore understood that the waters were ceased upon the earth. ¹² And he stayed yet other seven days: and he sent forth the dove, which returned not any more unto him.

¹³ Therefore in the six hundredth and first year, the first month, the first day of the month, the waters were lessened upon the earth, and Noe opening the covering of the ark, looked, and saw that the face of the earth was dried. ¹⁴ In the second month, the seven and twentieth day of the month, the earth was dried.

¹⁵ And God spoke to Noe, saying: ¹⁶ Go out of the ark, thou and thy wife, thy sons and the wives of thy sons with thee. ¹⁷ All living things that are with thee of all flesh, as well in fowls as in beasts, and all creeping things that creep upon the earth, bring out with thee, and go ye upon the earth: increase and multiply upon it. ¹⁸ So Noe went out, he and his sons: his wife, and the wives of his sons with him. ¹⁹ And all living things, and cattle, and creeping things that creep upon the earth, according to their kinds went out of the ark.

²⁰ And Noe built an altar unto the Lord: and taking of all cattle and fowls that were clean, offered holocausts upon the altar. ²¹ And the Lord smelled a sweet savour, and said: I will no more curse the earth for the sake of man: for the imagination and thought of man's heart are prone to evil from his youth: therefore I will no more destroy every living soul as I have done. ²² All the days of the earth, seedtime and harvest, cold and heat, summer and winter, night and day, shall not cease.

8. The covenant with Noe

Genesis 9:1-29

The first covenant of the plan; the bow set in the cloud.

9 ¹ And God blessed Noe and his sons. And he said to them: Increase, and multiply, and fill the earth. ² And let the fear and dread of you be upon all the beasts of the earth, and upon all the fowls of the air, and all that move upon the earth: all the fishes of the sea are delivered into your hand. ³ And every thing that moveth, and liveth shall be meat for you: even as the green herbs have I delivered them all to you: ⁴ Saving that flesh with blood you shall not eat. ⁵ For I will require the blood of your lives at the hand of every beast, and at the hand of man, at the hand of every man, and of his brother, will I require the life of man. ⁶ Whosoever shall shed man's blood, his blood shall be shed: for man was made to the image of God. ⁷ But increase you and multiply, and go upon the earth and fill it.

⁸ Thus also said God to Noe, and to his sons with him: ⁹ Behold I will establish my covenant with you, and with your seed after you: ¹⁰ And with every living soul that is with you, as well in all birds, as in cattle and beasts of the earth, that are come forth out of the ark, and in all the beasts of the earth. ¹¹ I will establish my covenant with you, and all flesh shall be no more destroyed with the waters of a flood, neither shall there be from henceforth a

flood to waste the earth. ¹² And God said: This is the sign of the covenant which I give between me and you, and to every living soul that is with you, for perpetual generations. ¹³ I will set my bow in the clouds, and it shall be the sign of a covenant between me and between the earth. ¹⁴ And when I shall cover the sky with clouds, my bow shall appear in the clouds: ¹⁵ And I will remember my covenant with you, and with every living soul that beareth flesh: and there shall no more be waters of a flood to destroy all flesh. ¹⁶ And the bow shall be in the clouds, and I shall see it, and shall remember the everlasting covenant, that was made between God and every living soul of all flesh which is upon the earth. ¹⁷ And God said to Noe: This shall be the sign of the covenant, which I have established, between me and all flesh upon the earth.

¹⁸ And the sons of Noe, who came out of the ark, were Sem, Cham, and Japheth: and Cham is the father of Chanaan. ¹⁹ These three are the sons of Noe: and from these was all mankind spread over the whole earth. ²⁰ And Noe a husbandman began to till the ground, and planted a vineyard. ²¹ And drinking of the wine was made drunk, and was uncovered in his tent. ²² Which when Cham the father of Chanaan had seen, to wit, that his father's nakedness was uncovered, he told it to his two brethren without. ²³ But Sem and Japheth put a cloak upon their shoulders, and going backward, covered the nakedness of their father: and their faces were turned away, and they saw not their father's nakedness. ²⁴ And Noe awaking from the wine, when he had learned what his younger son had done to him, ²⁵ He said: Cursed be Chanaan, a servant of servants shall he be unto his brethren. ²⁶ And he said: Blessed be the Lord God of Sem, be Chanaan his servant. ²⁷ May God enlarge Japheth, and may he dwell in the tents of Sem, and Chanaan be his servant.

²⁸ And Noe lived after the flood three hundred and fifty years. ²⁹ And all his days were in the whole nine hundred and fifty years: and he died.

9. Babel

Genesis 11:1-9

11 ¹ And the earth was of one tongue, and of the same speech. ² And when they removed from the east, they found a plain in the land of Sennaar, and dwelt in it. ³ And each one said to his neighbour: Come let us make brick, and bake them with fire. And they had brick instead of stones, and slime instead of mortar: ⁴ And they said: Come, let us make a city and a tower, the top whereof may reach to heaven; and let us make our name famous before we be scattered abroad into all lands.

⁵ And the Lord came down to see the city and the tower, which the children of Adam were building. ⁶ And he said: Behold, it is one people, and all have one tongue: and they have begun to do this, neither will they leave off from their designs, till they accomplish them in deed. ⁷ Come ye, therefore, let us go down, and there confound their tongue, that they may not understand one another's speech. ⁸ And so the Lord scattered them from that place into all lands, and they ceased to build the city. ⁹ And therefore the name thereof was called Babel, because there the language of the whole earth was confounded: and from thence the Lord scattered them abroad upon the face of all countries.

PATRIARCHS

Genesis 12-50, less chapter 36: the promise given to Abraham, carried through Isaac and Jacob, and preserved in Egypt through Joseph. The genealogy of Esau (36), the genealogy of Nachor (22:20-24) and the generations of Ismael (25:12-18) are passed over.

13. The call of Abram

Genesis 12:1-9

The promise on which the rest of the Old Testament depends.

12 ¹ And the Lord said to Abram: Go forth out of thy country, and from thy kindred, and out of thy father's house, and come into the land which I shall shew thee. ² And I will make of thee a great nation, and I will bless thee, and magnify thy name, and thou shalt be blessed. ³ I will bless them that bless thee, and curse them that curse thee, and IN THEE shall all the kindreds of the earth be blessed.

⁴ So Abram went out as the Lord had commanded him, and Lot went with him: Abram was seventy-five years old when he went forth from Haran. ⁵ And he took Sarai his wife, and Lot his brother's son, and all the substance which they had gathered, and the souls which they had gotten in Haran: and they went out to go into the land of Chanaan. And when they were come into it, ⁶ Abram passed through the country unto the place of Sichem, as far as the noble vale: now the Chanaanite was at that time in the land. ⁷ And the Lord appeared to Abram, and said to him: To thy seed will I give this land. And he built there an altar to the Lord, who had appeared to him. ⁸ And passing on from thence to a mountain, that was on the east side of Bethel, he there pitched his tent, having Bethel on the west, and Hai on the east: he built there also an altar to the Lord, and called upon his name. ⁹ And Abram went forward, going and proceeding on to the south.

17. The covenant of the divided victims

Genesis 15:1-21

"He believed God, and it was reputed to him unto justice."

15 ¹ Now when these things were done, the word of the Lord came to Abram by a vision, saying: Fear not, Abram, I am thy protector, and thy reward exceeding great.

² And Abram said: Lord God, what wilt thou give me? I shall go without children: and the son of the steward of my house is this Damascus Eliezer. ³ And Abram added: But to me thou hast not given seed: and lo my servant born in my house, shall be my heir. ⁴ And immediately the word of the Lord came to him, saying: He shall not be thy heir: but he that shall come out of thy bowels, him shalt thou have for thy heir. ⁵ And he brought him forth abroad, and said to him: Look up to heaven and number the stars if thou canst. And he said to him: So shall thy seed be. ⁶ Abram believed God, and it was reputed to him unto justice. ⁷ And he said to him: I am the Lord who brought thee out from Ur of the Chaldees, to give thee this land, and that thou mightest possess it. ⁸ But he said: Lord God, whereby may I know that I shall possess it? ⁹ And the Lord answered, and said: Take me a cow of three years old, and a she-goat of three years, and a ram of three years, a turtle also, and a pigeon. ¹⁰ And he took all these, and divided them in the midst, and laid

the two pieces of each one against the other: but the birds he divided not. ¹¹ And the fowls came down upon the carcasses, and Abram drove them away.

¹² And when the sun was setting, a deep sleep fell upon Abram, and a great and darksome horror seized upon him. ¹³ And it was said unto him: Know thou beforehand that thy seed shall be a stranger in a land not their own, and they shall bring them under bondage, and afflict them four hundred years. ¹⁴ But I will judge the nation which they shall serve, and after this they shall come out with great substance. ¹⁵ And thou shalt go to thy fathers in peace, and be buried in a good old age. ¹⁶ But in the fourth generation they shall return hither: for as yet the iniquities of the Amorrites are not at the full until this present time. ¹⁷ And when the sun was set, there arose a dark mist, and there appeared a smoking furnace, and a lamp of fire passing between those divisions. ¹⁸ That day God made a covenant with Abram, saying: To thy seed will I give this land, from the river to Egypt even to the great river Euphrates. ¹⁹ The Cineans, and Cenezites, the Cedmonites, ²⁰ And the Hethites, and the Pherezites, the Raphaim also, ²¹ And the Amorrites, and the Chanaanites, and the Gergesites, and the Jebusites.

20. The three at Mambre, and the plea for Sodom

Genesis 18:1-33

18 ¹ And the Lord appeared to him in the vale of Mambre as he was sitting at the door of his tent, in the very heat of the day. ² And when he had lifted up his eyes, there appeared to him three men standing near to him: and as soon as he saw them, he ran to meet them from the door of his tent, and adored down to the ground. ³ And he said: Lord, if I have found favour in thy sight, pass not away from thy servant. ⁴ But I will fetch a little water, and wash ye your feet, and rest ye under the tree. ⁵ And I will set a morsel of bread, and strengthen ye your heart, afterwards you shall pass on: for therefore are you come aside to your servant. And they said: Do as thou hast spoken. ⁶ Abraham made haste into the tent to Sara, and said to her: Make haste, temper together three measures of flour, and make cakes upon the hearth. ⁷ And he himself ran to the herd, and took from thence a calf, very tender and very good, and gave it to a young man, who made haste and boiled it. ⁸ He took also butter and milk, and the calf which he had boiled, and set before them: but he stood by them under the tree.

⁹ And when they had eaten, they said to him: Where is Sara thy wife? He answered: Lo she is in the tent. ¹⁰ And he said to him: I will return and come to thee at this time, life accompanying, and Sara, thy wife, shall have a son. Which when Sara heard, she laughed behind the door of the tent. ¹¹ Now they were both old, and far advanced in years, and it had ceased to be with Sara after the manner of women. ¹² And she laughed secretly, saying: After I am grown old, and my lord is an old man, shall I give myself to pleasure? ¹³ And the Lord said to Abraham: Why did Sara laugh, saying: Shall I, who am an old woman, bear a child indeed? ¹⁴ Is there any thing hard to God? According to appointment I will return to thee at this same time, life accompanying, and Sara shall have a son. ¹⁵ Sara denied, saying: I did not laugh: for she was afraid. But the Lord said: Nay; but thou didst laugh.

¹⁶ And when the men rose up from thence, they turned their eyes towards Sodom: and Abraham walked with them, bringing

them on the way. ¹⁷ And the Lord said: Can I hide from Abraham what I am about to do: ¹⁸ Seeing he shall become a great and mighty nation, and in him all the nations of the earth shall be blessed? ¹⁹ For I know that he will command his children, and his household after him, to keep the way of the Lord, and do judgment and justice: that for Abraham's sake, the Lord may bring to effect all the things he hath spoken unto him. ²⁰ And the Lord said: The cry of Sodom and Gomorrha is multiplied, and their sin is become exceedingly grievous. ²¹ I will go down and see whether they have done according to the cry that is come to me; or whether it be not so, that I may know. ²² And they turned themselves from thence, and went their way to Sodom: but Abraham as yet stood before the Lord. ²³ And drawing nigh, he said: Wilt thou destroy the just with the wicked? ²⁴ If there be fifty just men in the city, shall they perish withal? and wilt thou not spare that place for the sake of the fifty just, if they be therein? ²⁵ Far be it from thee to do this thing, and to slay the just with the wicked, and for the just to be in like case as the wicked; this is not beseeming thee: thou who judgest all the earth, wilt not make this judgment. ²⁶ And the Lord said to him: If I find in Sodom fifty just within the city, I will spare the whole place for their sake. ²⁷ And Abraham answered, and said: Seeing I have once begun, I will speak to my Lord, whereas I am dust and ashes. ²⁸ What if there be five less than fifty just persons? wilt thou for five and forty destroy the whole city: And he said: I will not destroy it, if I find five and forty. ²⁹ And again he said to him: But if forty be found there, what wilt thou do? He said: I will not destroy it for the sake of forty. ³⁰ Lord, saith he, be not angry, I beseech thee, if I speak: What if thirty shall be found there? He answered: I will not do it, if I find thirty there. ³¹ Seeing, saith he, I have once begun, I will speak to my Lord: What if twenty be found there? He said: I will not destroy it for the sake of twenty. ³² I beseech thee, saith he, be not angry, Lord, if I speak yet once more: What if ten shall be found there? And he said: I will not destroy it for the sake of ten. ³³ And the Lord departed, after he had left speaking to Abraham: and Abraham returned to his place.

23. The binding of Isaac

Genesis 22:1-18

The second lesson of the Easter Vigil, read to its Vigil terminus at verse 18; the genealogy of Nachor that follows is omitted.

22 ¹ After these things, God tempted Abraham, and said to him: Abraham, Abraham. And he answered: Here I am. ² He said to him: Take thy only begotten son Isaac, whom thou lovest, and go into the land of vision; and there thou shalt offer him for an holocaust upon one of the mountains which I will shew thee.

³ So Abraham rising up in the night, saddled his ass, and took with him two young men, and Isaac his son: and when he had cut wood for the holocaust, he went his way to the place which God had commanded him. ⁴ And on the third day, lifting up his eyes, he saw the place afar off. ⁵ And he said to his young men: Stay you here with the ass; I and the boy will go with speed as far as yonder, and after we have worshipped, will return to you. ⁶ And he took the wood for the holocaust, and laid it upon Isaac his son; and he himself carried in his hands fire and a sword. And as they two went on together, ⁷ Isaac said to his father: My father.

And he answered: What wilt thou, son? Behold, saith he, fire and wood: where is the victim for the holocaust? ⁸ And Abraham said: God will provide himself a victim for an holocaust, my son. So they went on together. ⁹ And they came to the place which God had shewn him, where he built an altar, and laid the wood in order upon it; and when he had bound Isaac his son, he laid him on the altar upon the pile of wood. ¹⁰ And he put forth his hand, and took the sword, to sacrifice his son.

¹¹ And behold, an angel of the Lord from heaven called to him, saying: Abraham, Abraham. And he answered: Here I am. ¹² And he said to him: Lay not thy hand upon the boy, neither do thou any thing to him: now I know that thou fearest God, and hast not spared thy only begotten son for my sake. ¹³ Abraham lifted up his eyes, and saw behind his back a ram, amongst the briers, sticking fast by the horns, which he took and offered for a holocaust instead of his son. ¹⁴ And he called the name of that place, The Lord seeth. Whereupon, even to this day, it is said: In the mountain the Lord will see.

¹⁵ And the angel of the Lord called to Abraham a second time from heaven, saying: ¹⁶ By my own self have I sworn, saith the Lord: because thou hast done this thing, and hast not spared thy only begotten son for my sake: ¹⁷ I will bless thee, and I will multiply thy seed as the stars of heaven, and as the sand that is by the sea shore; thy seed shall possess the gates of their enemies. ¹⁸ And in thy seed shall all the nations of the earth be blessed, because thou hast obeyed my voice.

29. The stolen blessing

Genesis 27:1-46

27 ¹ Now Isaac was old, and his eyes were dim, and he could not see: and he called Esau, his elder son, and said to him: My son? And he answered: Here I am. ² And his father said to him, Thou seest that I am old, and know not the day of my death. ³ Take thy arms, thy quiver, and bow, and go abroad; and when thou hast taken something by hunting, ⁴ Make me a savoury meat thereof, as thou knowest I like, and bring it that I may eat: and my soul may bless thee, before I die. ⁵ And when Rebecca had heard this, and he was gone into the field to fulfil his father's commandment, ⁶ She said to her son Jacob: I heard thy father talking with Esau, thy brother, and saying to him: ⁷ Bring me of thy hunting, and make me meats that I may eat, and bless thee in the sight of the Lord, before I die. ⁸ Now therefore, my son, follow my counsel: ⁹ And go thy way to the flock, bring me two kids of the best, that I may make of them meat for thy father, such as he gladly eateth. ¹⁰ Which when thou hast brought in, and he hath eaten, he may bless thee before he die. ¹¹ And he answered her: Thou knowest that Esau, my brother, is a hairy man, and I am smooth: ¹² If my father should feel me, and perceive it, I fear lest he will think I would have mocked him, and I shall bring upon me a curse instead of a blessing. ¹³ And his mother said to him: Upon me be this curse, my son: only hear thou my voice, and go, fetch me the things which I have said. ¹⁴ He went, and brought, and gave them to his mother. She dressed meats, such as she knew his father liked. ¹⁵ And she put on him very good garments of Esau, which she had at home with her: ¹⁶ And the little skins of the kids she put about his hands, and covered the bare of his neck. ¹⁷ And she gave him the savoury meat, and delivered him bread that she had baked.

¹⁸ Which when he had carried in, he said: My father? But he answered: I hear. Who art thou, my son? ¹⁹ And Jacob said: I am Esau, thy firstborn: I have done as thou didst command me: arise, sit and eat of my venison, that thy soul may bless me. ²⁰ And Isaac said to his son: How couldst thou find it so quickly, my son? He answered: It was the will of God, that what I sought came quickly in my way: ²¹ And Isaac said: Come hither, that I may feel thee, my son, and may prove whether thou be my son Esau, or no. ²² He came near to his father, and when he had felt him, Isaac said: The voice indeed is the voice of Jacob; but the hands, are the hands of Esau. ²³ And he knew him not, because his hairy hands made him like to the elder. Then blessing him, ²⁴ He said: Art thou my son Esau? He answered: I am. ²⁵ Then he said: Bring me the meats of thy hunting, my son, that my soul may bless thee. And when they were brought, and he had eaten, he offered him wine also, which after he had drunk, ²⁶ He said to him: Come near me, and give me a kiss, my son. ²⁷ He came near, and kissed him. And immediately as he smelled the fragrant smell of his garments, blessing him, he said: Behold, the smell of my son is as the smell of a plentiful field, which the Lord hath blessed. ²⁸ God give thee of the dew of heaven, and of the fatness of the earth, abundance of corn and wine. ²⁹ And let peoples serve thee, and tribes worship thee: be thou lord of thy brethren, and let thy mother's children bow down before thee. Cursed be he that curseth thee: and let him that blesseth thee be filled with blessings.

³⁰ Isaac had scarce ended his words, when, Jacob being now gone out abroad, Esau came, ³¹ And brought in to his father meats, made of what he had taken in hunting, saying: Arise, my father, and eat of thy son's venison; that thy soul may bless me. ³² And Isaac said to him: Why! who art thou? He answered: I am thy firstborn son, Esau. ³³ Isaac was struck with fear, and astonished exceedingly; and wondering beyond what can be believed, said: Who is he then that even now brought me venison that he had taken, and I ate of all before thou camest? and I have blessed him, and he shall be blessed. ³⁴ Esau having heard his father's words, roared out with a great cry; and, being in a consternation, said: Bless me also, my father. ³⁵ And he said: Thy brother came deceitfully and got thy blessing. ³⁶ But he said again: Rightly is his name called Jacob; for he hath supplanted me lo this second time: My birthright he took away before, and now this second time he hath stolen away my blessing. And again he said to his father: Hast thou not reserved me also a blessing? ³⁷ Isaac answered: I have appointed him thy lord, and have made all his brethren his servants: I have established him with corn and wine, and after this, what shall I do more for thee, my son? ³⁸ And Esau said to him: Hast thou only one blessing, father? I beseech thee bless me also. And when he wept with a loud cry, ³⁹ Isaac being moved, said to him: In the fat of the earth, and in the dew of heaven from above, ⁴⁰ Shall thy blessing be. Thou shalt live by the sword, and shalt serve thy brother: and the time shall come, when thou shalt shake off and loose his yoke from thy neck.

⁴¹ Esau therefore always hated Jacob, for the blessing where-with his father had blessed him; and he said in his heart: The days will come of the mourning for my father, and I will kill my brother Jacob. ⁴² These things were told to Rebecca: and she

sent and called Jacob, her son, and said to him: Behold Esau, thy brother, threateneth to kill thee. ⁴³ Now therefore, my son, hear my voice, arise and flee to Laban, my brother, to Haran: ⁴⁴ And thou shalt dwell with him a few days, till the wrath of thy brother be assuaged, ⁴⁵ And his indignation cease, and he forget the things thou hast done to him: afterwards I will send, and bring thee from thence hither. Why shall I be deprived of both my sons in one day? ⁴⁶ And Rebecca said to Isaac: I am weary of my life, because of the daughters of Heth: if Jacob take a wife of the stock of this land, I choose not to live.

31. Jacob's ladder at Bethel

Genesis 28:10-22

28 ¹⁰ But Jacob being departed from Bersabee, went on to Haran. ¹¹ And when he was come to a certain place, and would rest in it after sunset, he took of the stones that lay there, and putting under his head, slept in the same place. ¹² And he saw in his sleep a ladder standing upon the earth, and the top thereof touching heaven: the angels also of God ascending and descending by it. ¹³ And the Lord leaning upon the ladder saying to him: I am the Lord God of Abraham thy father, and the God of Isaac: The land, wherein thou sleepest, I will give to thee and to thy seed. ¹⁴ And thy seed shall be as the dust of the earth: thou shalt spread abroad to the west, and to the east, and to the north, and to the south: and IN THEE and thy seed, all the tribes of the earth SHALL BE BLESSED. ¹⁵ And I will be thy keeper whithersoever thou goest, and will bring thee back into this land: neither will I leave thee, till I shall have accomplished all that I have said.

¹⁶ And when Jacob awaked out of sleep, he said: Indeed the Lord is in this place, and I knew it not. ¹⁷ And trembling, he said: How terrible is this place? this is no other but the house of God, and the gate of heaven. ¹⁸ And Jacob arising in the morning, took the stone which he had laid under his head, and set it up for a title, pouring oil upon the top of it. ¹⁹ And he called the name of the city Bethel, which before was called Luza. ²⁰ And he made a vow, saying: If God shall be with me, and shall keep me in the way, by which I walk, and shall give me bread to eat, and raiment to put on, ²¹ And I shall return prosperously to my father's house: the Lord shall be my God: ²² And this stone, which I have set up for a title, shall be called the house of God: and of all things that thou shalt give to me, I will offer tithes to thee.

34. Jacob wrestles until daybreak

Genesis 32:1-32

The name Israel is given here.

32 ¹ Jacob also went on the journey he had begun: and the angels of God met him. ² And when he saw them, he said: These are the camps of God, and he called the name of that place Mahanaim, that is, Camps.

³ And he sent messengers before him to Esau, his brother, to the land of Seir, to the country of Edom: ⁴ And he commanded them, saying: Thus shall ye speak to my lord Esau: Thus saith thy brother Jacob: I have sojourned with Laban, and have been with him until this day: ⁵ I have oxen, and asses, and sheep, and menservants, and womenservants: and now I send a message to my lord, that I may find favour in thy sight. ⁶ And the messengers

returned to Jacob, saying: We came to Esau, thy brother, and behold he cometh with speed to meet thee with four hundred men. ⁷ Then Jacob was greatly afraid; and in his fear divided the people that was with him, and the flocks, and the sheep, and the oxen, and the camels, into two companies, ⁸ Saying: If Esau come to one company, and destroy it, the other company that is left, shall escape. ⁹ And Jacob said: O God of my father Abraham, and God of my father Isaac: O Lord who saidst to me, Return to thy land, and to the place of thy birth, and I will do well for thee. ¹⁰ I am not worthy of the least of all thy mercies, and of thy truth which thou hast fulfilled to thy servant. With my staff I passed over this Jordan; and now I return with two companies. ¹¹ Deliver me from the hand of my brother Esau, for I am greatly afraid of him; lest perhaps he come, and kill the mother with the children. ¹² Thou didst say, that thou wouldst do well by me, and multiply my seed like the sand of the sea, which cannot be numbered for multitude.

¹³ And when he had slept there that night, he set apart, of the things which he had, presents for his brother Esau, ¹⁴ Two hundred she-goats, twenty he-goats, two hundred ewes, and twenty rams, ¹⁵ Thirty milch camels with their colts, forty kine, and twenty bulls, twenty she-asses, and ten of their foals. ¹⁶ And he sent them by the hands of his servants, every drove by itself, and he said to his servants: Go before me, and let there be a space between drove and drove. ¹⁷ And he commanded the first, saying: If thou meet my brother Esau, and he ask thee: Whose art thou? or whither goest thou? or whose are these before thee? ¹⁸ Thou shalt answer: Thy servant Jacob's: he hath sent them as a present to my lord Esau; and he cometh after us. ¹⁹ In like manner he commanded the second, and the third, and all that followed the droves, saying: Speak ye the same words to Esau, when ye find him. ²⁰ And ye shall add: Thy servant Jacob himself also followeth after us; for he said: I will appease him with the presents that go before, and afterwards I will see him, perhaps he will be gracious to me. ²¹ So the presents went before him, but himself lodged that night in the camp. ²² And rising early, he took his two wives and his two handmaids, with his eleven sons, and passed over the ford of Jaboc. ²³ And when all things were brought over that belonged to him, ²⁴ He remained alone; and behold, a man wrestled with him till morning. ²⁵ And when he saw that he could not overcome him, he touched the sinew of his thigh, and forthwith it shrank. ²⁶ And he said to him: Let me go, for it is break of day. He answered: I will not let thee go, except thou bless me. ²⁷ And he said: What is thy name? He answered: Jacob. ²⁸ But he said: Thy name shall not be called Jacob, but Israel; for if thou hast been strong against God, how much more shalt thou prevail against men? ²⁹ Jacob asked him: Tell me by what name art thou called? He answered: Why dost thou ask my name? And he blessed him in the same place. ³⁰ And Jacob called the name of the place Phaniel, saying: I have seen God face to face, and my soul has been saved. ³¹ And immediately the sun rose upon him, after he was past Phaniel; but he halted on his foot. ³² Therefore the children of Israel, unto this day, eat not the sinew, that shrank in Jacob's thigh: because he touched the sinew of his thigh and it shrank.

37. Joseph sold by his brethren*Genesis 37:1-36*

37 ¹ And Jacob dwelt in the land of Chanaan, wherein his father sojourned. ² And these are his generations: Joseph, when he was sixteen years old, was feeding the flock with his brethren, being but a boy: and he was with the sons of Bala and of Zelpha his father's wives: and he accused his brethren to his father of a most wicked crime. ³ Now Israel loved Joseph above all his sons, because he had him in his old age: and he made him a coat of divers colours. ⁴ And his brethren seeing that he was loved by his father, more than all his sons, hated him, and could not speak peaceably to him.

⁵ Now it fell out also that he told his brethren a dream, that he had dreamed: which occasioned them to hate him the more. ⁶ And he said to them: Hear my dream which I dreamed. ⁷ I thought we were binding sheaves in the field: and my sheaf arose as it were, and stood, and your sheaves standing about bowed down before my sheaf. ⁸ His brethren answered: Shalt thou be our king? or shall we be subject to thy dominion? Therefore this matter of his dreams and words ministered nourishment to their envy and hatred. ⁹ He dreamed also another dream, which he told his brethren, saying: I saw in a dream, as it were the sun, and the moon, and eleven stars worshipping me. ¹⁰ And when he had told this to his father, and brethren, his father rebuked him and said: What meaneth this dream that thou hast dreamed? shall I and thy mother, and thy brethren worship thee upon the earth? ¹¹ His brethren therefore envied him: but his father considered the thing with himself.

¹² And when his brethren abode in Sechem, feeding their father's flocks, ¹³ Israel said to him: Thy brethren feed the sheep in Sichem: come, I will send thee to them. And when he answered: ¹⁴ I am ready: he said to him: Go, and see if all things be well with thy brethren, and the cattle: and bring me word again what is doing. So being sent from the vale of Hebron, he came to Sichem: ¹⁵ And a man found him there wandering in the field, and asked what he sought. ¹⁶ But he answered: I seek my brethren, tell me where they feed the flocks. ¹⁷ And the man said to him: They are departed from this place: for I heard them say: Let us go to Dothain. And Joseph went forward after his brethren, and found them in Dothain. ¹⁸ And when they saw him afar off, before he came nigh them, they thought to kill him: ¹⁹ And said one to another: Behold the dreamer cometh. ²⁰ Come, let us kill him, and cast him into some old pit: and we will say: Some evil beast hath devoured him: and then it shall appear what his dreams avail him: ²¹ And Ruben hearing this, endeavoured to deliver him out of their hands, and said: ²² Do not take away his life, nor shed his blood: but cast him into this pit, that is in the wilderness, and keep your hands harmless: now he said this, being desirous to deliver him out of their hands and to restore him to his father. ²³ And as soon as he came to his brethren, they forthwith stript him of his outside coat, that was of divers colours: ²⁴ And cast him into an old pit where there was not water. ²⁵ And sitting down to eat bread, they saw some Ismaelites on their way coming from Galaad, with their camels, carrying spices, and balm, and myrrh to Egypt. ²⁶ And Juda said to his brethren: What will it profit us to kill our brother, and conceal his blood? ²⁷ It is better that he be sold to the Ismaelites,

and that our hands be not defiled: for he is our brother and our flesh. His brethren agreed to his words. ²⁸ And when the Madianite merchants passed by, they drew him out of the pit, and sold him to the Ismaelites, for twenty pieces of silver: and they led him into Egypt.

²⁹ And Ruben returning to the pit, found not the boy: ³⁰ And rending his garments he went to his brethren, and said: The boy doth not appear, and whither shall I go? ³¹ And they took his coat, and dipped it in the blood of a kid, which they had killed: ³² Sending some to carry it to their father, and to say: This we have found: see whether it be thy son's coat, or not. ³³ And the father acknowledging it, said: It is my son's coat, an evil wild beast hath eaten him, a beast hath devoured Joseph. ³⁴ And tearing his garments, he put on sackcloth, mourning for his son a long time. ³⁵ And all his children being gathered together to comfort their father in his sorrow, he would not receive comfort, but said: I will go down to my son into hell, mourning. And whilst he continued weeping, ³⁶ The Madianites sold Joseph in Egypt to Putiphar, an eunuch of Pharaoh, captain of the soldiers.

43. Joseph makes himself known*Genesis 45:1-15*

45 ¹ Joseph could no longer refrain himself before many that stood by: whereupon he commanded that all should go out, and no stranger be present at their knowing one another. ² And he lifted up his voice with weeping, which the Egyptians, and all the house of Pharaoh heard. ³ And he said to his brethren: I am Joseph: Is my father yet living? His brethren could not answer him, being struck with exceeding great fear. ⁴ And he said mildly to them: Come nearer to me. And when they were come near him, he said: I am Joseph, your brother, whom you sold into Egypt. ⁵ Be not afraid, and let it not seem to you a hard case that you sold me into these countries: for God sent me before you into Egypt for your preservation. ⁶ For it is two years since the famine began to be upon the land, and five years more remain, wherein there can be neither ploughing nor reaping. ⁷ And God sent me before, that you may be preserved upon the earth, and may have food to live. ⁸ Not by your counsel was I sent hither, but by the will of God: who hath made me as it were a father to Pharaoh, and lord of his whole house, and governor in all the land of Egypt. ⁹ Make haste, and go ye up to my father, and say to him: Thus saith thy son Joseph: God hath made me lord of the whole land of Egypt; come down to me, linger not. ¹⁰ And thou shalt dwell in the land of Gessen: and thou shalt be near me, thou and thy sons, and thy sons' sons, thy sheep, and thy herds, and all things that thou hast. ¹¹ And there I will feed thee, (for there are yet five years of famine remaining) lest both thou perish, and thy house, and all things that thou hast. ¹² Behold, your eyes, and the eyes of my brother Benjamin, see that it is my mouth that speaketh to you. ¹³ You shall tell my father of all my glory, and all things that you have seen in Egypt: make haste and bring him to me. ¹⁴ And falling upon the neck of his brother Benjamin, he embraced him and wept: and Benjamin in like manner wept also on his neck. ¹⁵ And Joseph kissed all his brethren, and wept upon every one of them: after which they were emboldened to speak to him.

47. The blessing of Jacob*Genesis 49:1-32*

"The sceptre shall not be taken away from Juda" (49:10).

49 ¹ And Jacob called his sons, and said to them: Gather yourselves together, that I may tell you the things that shall befall you in the last days. ² Gather yourselves together, and hear, O ye sons of Jacob, hearken to Israel, your father: ³ Ruben, my firstborn, thou art my strength, and the beginning of my sorrow; excelling in gifts, greater in command. ⁴ Thou art poured out as water, grow thou not; because thou wentest up to thy father's bed, and didst defile his couch. ⁵ Simeon and Levi brethren: vessels of iniquity waging war. ⁶ Let not my soul go into their counsel, nor my glory be in their assembly: because in their fury they slew a man, and in their self-will they undermined a wall. ⁷ Cursed be their fury, because it was stubborn: and their wrath, because it was cruel: I will divide them in Jacob, and will scatter them in Israel. ⁸ Juda, thee shall thy brethren praise: thy hand shall be on the necks of thy enemies; the sons of thy father shall bow down to thee. ⁹ Juda is a lion's whelp: to the prey, my son, thou art gone up: resting thou hast couched as a lion, and as a lioness, who shall rouse him? ¹⁰ The sceptre shall not be taken away from Juda, nor a ruler from his thigh, till he come that is to be sent, and he shall be the expectation of nations. ¹¹ Tying his foal to the vineyard, and his ass, O my son, to the vine. He shall wash his robe in wine, and his garment in the blood of the grape. ¹² His eyes are more beautiful than wine, and his teeth whiter than milk. ¹³ Zabulon shall dwell on the seashore, and in the road of ships, reaching as far as Sidon. ¹⁴ Issachar shall be a strong ass, lying down between the borders. ¹⁵ He saw rest that it was good: and the land that it was excellent: and he bowed his shoulder to carry, and became a servant under tribute. ¹⁶ Dan shall judge his people like another tribe in Israel. ¹⁷ Let Dan be a snake in the way, a serpent in the path, that biteth the horse's heels, that his rider may fall backward. ¹⁸ I will look for thy salvation, O Lord. ¹⁹ Gad, being girded, shall fight before him: and he himself shall be girded backward. ²⁰ Aser, his bread shall be fat, and he shall yield dainties to kings. ²¹ Nephthali, a hart let loose, and giving words of beauty. ²² Joseph is a growing son, a growing son and comely to behold: the daughters run to and fro upon the wall; ²³ But they that held darts, provoked him, and quarrelled with him, and envied him. ²⁴ His bow rested upon the strong, and the bands of his arms and his hands were loosed, by the hands of the mighty one of Jacob: thence he came forth a pastor, the stone of Israel. ²⁵ The God of thy father shall be thy helper, and the Almighty shall bless thee with the blessings of heaven above, with the blessings of the deep that lieth beneath, with the blessings of the breasts and of the womb. ²⁶ The blessings of thy father are strengthened with the blessings of his fathers: until the desire of the everlasting hills should come: may they be upon the head of Joseph, and upon the crown of the Nazarite among his brethren. ²⁷ Benjamin a ravenous wolf, in the morning shall eat the prey, and in the evening shall divide the spoil.

²⁸ All these are the twelve tribes of Israel: these things their father spoke to them, and he blessed every one with their proper blessings. ²⁹ And he charged them, saying: I am now going to be gathered to my people: bury me with my fathers in the double cave, which is in the field of Ephron the Hethite, ³⁰ Over against

Mambre, in the land of Chanaan, which Abraham bought together with the field, of Ephron the Hethite, for a possession to bury in. ³¹ There they buried him, and Sara his wife: there was Isaac buried with Rebecca, his wife: there also Lia doth lie buried. ³² And when he had ended the commandments, wherewith he instructed his sons, he drew up his feet upon the bed, and died: and he was gathered to his people.

48. The death of Jacob and of Joseph*Genesis 50:1-25*

"You thought evil against me: but God turned it into good" (50:20) is the hinge of the whole patriarchal narrative.

50 ¹ And when Joseph saw this, he fell upon his father's face, weeping and kissing him. ² And he commanded his servants, the physicians, to embalm his father. ³ And while they were fulfilling his commands, there passed forty days: for this was the manner with bodies that were embalmed, and Egypt mourned for him seventy days. ⁴ And the time of the mourning being expired, Joseph spoke to the family of Pharaoh: If I have found favour in your sight, speak in the ears of Pharaoh: ⁵ For my father made me swear to him, saying: Behold I die; thou shalt bury me in my sepulchre which I have digged for myself in the land of Chanaan. So I will go up and bury my father, and return. ⁶ And Pharaoh said to him: Go up and bury thy father according as he made thee swear.

⁷ So he went up, and there went with him all the ancients of Pharaoh's house, and all the elders of the land of Egypt. ⁸ And the house of Joseph with his brethren, except their children, and their flocks and herds, which they left in the land of Gessen. ⁹ He had also in his train chariots and horsemen: and it was a great company. ¹⁰ And they came to the threshing floor of Atad, which is situated beyond the Jordan: where celebrating the exequies with a great and vehement lamentation, they spent full seven days. ¹¹ And when the inhabitants of Chanaan saw this, they said: This is a great mourning to the Egyptians. And therefore the name of that place was called, The mourning of Egypt. ¹² So the sons of Jacob did as he had commanded them. ¹³ And carrying him into the land of Chanaan, they buried him in the double cave, which Abraham had bought together with the field for a possession of a burying place, of Ephron, the Hethite, over against Mambre. ¹⁴ And Joseph returned into Egypt with his brethren, and all that were in his company, after he had buried his father.

¹⁵ Now he being dead, his brethren were afraid, and talked one with another: Lest perhaps he should remember the wrong he suffered, and requite us all the evil that we did to him. ¹⁶ And they sent a message to him, saying: Thy father commanded us before he died, ¹⁷ That we should say thus much to thee from him: I beseech thee to forget the wickedness of thy brethren, and the sin and malice they practised against thee: we also pray thee, to forgive the servants of the God of thy father this wickedness. And when Joseph heard this, he wept. ¹⁸ And his brethren came to him; and worshipping prostrate on the ground, they said: We are thy servants. ¹⁹ And he answered them: Fear not: can we resist the will of God? ²⁰ You thought evil against me: but God turned it into good, that he might exalt me, as at present you see, and might save many people. ²¹ Fear not: I will feed you and

your children. And he comforted them, and spoke gently and mildly.

²² And he dwelt in Egypt with all his father's house; and lived a hundred and ten years. And he saw the children of Ephraim to the third generation. The children also of Machir, the sons of Manasses, were born on Joseph's knees. ²³ After which he told his brethren: God will visit you after my death, and will make you go up out of this land, to the land which he swore to Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob. ²⁴ And he made them swear to him, saying: God will visit you, carry my bones with you out of this place: ²⁵ And he died, being a hundred and ten years old. And being embalmed, he was laid in a coffin in Egypt.

EGYPT AND EXODUS

Exodus 1-24 and 32-34: bondage, the passover, the sea, and the covenant at Sinai. The tabernacle specifications (25-31) and their execution (35-40) are passed over; they are description, not narrative, and the second is largely a repetition of the first.

49. Israel in bondage

Exodus 1:1-22

1 ¹ These are the names of the children of Israel, that went into Egypt with Jacob: they went in every man with his household: ² Ruben, Simeon, Levi, Juda, ³ Issachar, Zabulon, and Benjamin, ⁴ Dan, and Nephthali, Gad and Aser. ⁵ And all the souls that came out of Jacob's thigh, were seventy: but Joseph was in Egypt. ⁶ After he was dead, and all his brethren, and all that generation, ⁷ The children of Israel increased, and sprung up into multitudes, and growing exceedingly strong they filled the land.

⁸ In the mean time there arose a new king over Egypt, that knew not Joseph: ⁹ And he said to his people: Behold the people of the children of Israel are numerous and stronger than we. ¹⁰ Come let us wisely oppress them, lest they multiply: and if any war shall rise against us, join with our enemies, and having overcome us, depart out of the land. ¹¹ Therefore he set over them masters of the works, to afflict them with burdens: and they built for Pharaos cities of tabernacles, Phithom, and Ramesses. ¹² But the more they oppressed them, the more they were multiplied and increased. ¹³ And the Egyptians hated the children of Israel, and afflicted them and mocked them: ¹⁴ And they made their life bitter with hard works in clay and brick, and with all manner of service, wherewith they were overcharged in the works of the earth.

¹⁵ And the king of Egypt spoke to the midwives of the Hebrews: of whom one was called Sephora, the other Phua, ¹⁶ Commanding them: When you shall do the office of midwives to the Hebrew women, and the time of delivery is come: if it be a man child, kill it: if a woman, keep it alive. ¹⁷ But the midwives feared God, and did not do as the king of Egypt had commanded, but saved the men children. ¹⁸ And the king called for them and said: What is it that you meant to do, that you would save the men children? ¹⁹ They answered: The Hebrew women are not as the Egyptian women: for they themselves are skilful in the office of a midwife; and they are delivered before we come to them. ²⁰ Therefore God dealt well with the midwives: and the people multiplied and grew exceedingly strong. ²¹ And because the midwives feared God, he built them houses. ²² Pharaos there-

fore charged all his people, saying: Whatsoever shall be born of the male sex, ye shall cast into the river: whatsoever of the female, ye shall save alive.

50. The birth of Moses, and his flight

Exodus 2:1-25

2 ¹ After this there went a man of the house of Levi; and took a wife of his own kindred. ² And she conceived, and bore a son: and seeing him a goodly child, hid him three months. ³ And when she could hide him no longer, she took a basket made of bulrushes, and daubed it with slime and pitch: and put the little babe therein, and laid him in the sedges by the river's brink, ⁴ His sister standing afar off, and taking notice what would be done. ⁵ And behold the daughter of Pharaos came down to wash herself in the river: and her maids walked by the river's brink. And when she saw the basket in the sedges she sent one of her maids for it: and when it was brought, ⁶ She opened it, and seeing within it an infant crying, having compassion on it, she said: This is one of the babes of the Hebrews. ⁷ And the child's sister said to her: Shall I go, and call to thee a Hebrew woman, to nurse the babe? ⁸ She answered: Go. The maid went and called her mother. ⁹ And Pharaos daughter said to her: Take this child, and nurse him for me: I will give thee thy wages. The woman took and nursed the child: and when he was grown up, she delivered him to Pharaos daughter. ¹⁰ And she adopted him for a son, and called him Moses, saying: Because I took him out of the water.

¹¹ In those days, after Moses was grown up, he went out to his brethren: and saw their affliction, and an Egyptian striking one of the Hebrews, his brethren. ¹² And when he had looked about this way and that way, and saw no one there, he slew the Egyptian and hid him in the sand. ¹³ And going out the next day, he saw two Hebrews quarrelling: and he said to him that did the wrong: Why strikest thou thy neighbour? ¹⁴ But he answered: Who hath appointed thee prince and judge over us? wilt thou kill me, as thou didst yesterday kill the Egyptian? Moses feared, and said: How is this come to be known? ¹⁵ And Pharaos heard of this word, and sought to kill Moses: but he fled from his sight, and abode in the land of Madian, and he sat down by a well.

¹⁶ And the priest of Madian had seven daughters, who came to draw water: and when the troughs were filled, desired to water their father's flocks. ¹⁷ And the shepherds came and drove them away: and Moses arose, and defending the maids, watered their sheep. ¹⁸ And when they returned to Raguel their father, he said to them: Why are ye come sooner than usual? ¹⁹ They answered: A man of Egypt delivered us from the hands of the shepherds: and he drew water also with us, and gave the sheep to drink. ²⁰ But he said: Where is he? why have you let the man go? call him that he may eat bread. ²¹ And Moses swore that he would dwell with him. And he took Sephora his daughter to wife: ²² And she bore him a son, whom he called Gersam, saying: I have been a stranger in a foreign country. And she bore another, whom he called Eliezer, saying: For the God of my father, my helper, hath delivered me out of the hand of Pharaos.

²³ Now after a long time the king of Egypt died: and the children of Israel groaning, cried out because of the works: and their cry went up unto God from the works. ²⁴ And he heard their groaning, and remembered the covenant which he made with

Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob. ²⁵ And the Lord looked upon the children of Israel, and he knew them.

51. The burning bush

Exodus 3:1-4:17

"I AM WHO AM." The divine name is given here.

3 ¹ Now Moses fed the sheep of Jethro, his father in law, the priest of Midian: and he drove the flock to the inner parts of the desert, and came to the mountain of God, Horeb. ² And the Lord appeared to him in a flame of fire out of the midst of a bush: and he saw that the bush was on fire, and was not burnt. ³ And Moses said: I will go, and see this great sight, why the bush is not burnt. ⁴ And when the Lord saw that he went forward to see, he called to him out of the midst of the bush. and said: Moses, Moses. And he answered: Here I am. ⁵ And he said: Come not nigh hither, put off the shoes from thy feet; for the place, whereon thou standest, is holy ground. ⁶ And he said: I am the God of thy father, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob. Moses hid his face: for he durst not look at God.

⁷ And the Lord said to him: I have seen the affliction of my people in Egypt, and I have heard their cry because of the rigour of them that are over the works; ⁸ And knowing their sorrow, I am come down to deliver them out of the hands of the Egyptians, and to bring them out of that land into a good and spacious land, into a land that floweth with milk and honey, to the places of the Chanaanite, and Hethite, and Amorrite, and Pherezite, and Hevite, and Jebusite. ⁹ For the cry of the children of Israel is come unto me: and I have seen their affliction, wherewith they are oppressed by the Egyptians. ¹⁰ But come, and I will send thee to Pharaoh, that thou mayst bring forth my people, the children of Israel, out of Egypt.

¹¹ And Moses said to God: Who am I that I should go to Pharaoh, and should bring forth the children of Israel out of Egypt? ¹² And he said to him: I will be with thee; and this thou shalt have for a sign that I have sent thee: When thou shalt have brought my people out of Egypt, thou shalt offer sacrifice to God upon this mountain. ¹³ Moses said to God: Lo, I shall go to the children of Israel, and say to them: The God of your fathers hath sent me to you. If they shall say to me: What is his name? What shall I say to them? ¹⁴ God said to Moses: I AM WHO AM. He said: Thus shalt thou say to the children of Israel: HE WHO IS, hath sent me to you. ¹⁵ And God said again to Moses: Thus shalt thou say to the children of Israel: The Lord God of your fathers the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob hath sent me to you; this is my name for ever, and this is my memorial unto all generations. ¹⁶ Go and gather together the ancients of Israel, and thou shalt say to them: The Lord God of your fathers, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob, hath appeared to me, saying: Visiting I have visited you; and I have seen all that hath befallen you in Egypt. ¹⁷ And I have said the word to bring you forth out of the affliction of Egypt, into the land of the Chanaanite, and Hethite, and Amorrite, and Pherezite, and Hevite, and Jebusite, to a land that floweth with milk and honey. ¹⁸ And they shall hear thy voice; and thou shalt go in, thou and the ancients of Israel, to the king of Egypt, and thou shalt say to him: The Lord God of the Hebrews hath

called us; we will go three days' journey into the wilderness, to sacrifice unto the Lord our God. ¹⁹ But I know that the king of Egypt will not let you go, but by a mighty hand. ²⁰ For I will stretch forth my hand, and will strike Egypt with all my wonders which I will do in the midst of them: after these he will let you go. ²¹ And I will give favour to this people, in the sight of the Egyptians: and when you go forth, you shall not depart empty: ²² But every woman shall ask of her neighbour, and of her that is in her house, vessels of silver and of gold, and raiment: and you shall put them on your sons and daughters, and shall spoil Egypt.

4 ¹ Moses answered, and said: They will not believe me, nor hear my voice, but they will say: The Lord hath not appeared to thee. ² Then he said to him: What is that thou holdest in thy hand? He answered: A rod. ³ And the Lord said: Cast it down upon the ground. He cast it down, and it was turned into a serpent, so that Moses fled from it. ⁴ And the Lord said: Put out thy hand, and take it by the tail. He put forth his hand, and took hold of it, and it was turned into a rod. ⁵ That they may believe, saith he, that the Lord God of their fathers, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob, hath appeared to thee. ⁶ And the Lord said again: Put thy hand into thy bosom. And when he had put it into his bosom, he brought it forth leprous as snow. ⁷ And he said: Put back thy hand into thy bosom. He put it back, and brought it out again, and it was like the other flesh. ⁸ If they will not believe thee, saith he, nor hear the voice of the former sign, they will believe the word of the latter sign. ⁹ But if they will not even believe these two signs, nor hear thy voice: take of the river water, and pour it out upon the dry land, and whatsoever thou drawest out of the river, shall be turned into blood.

¹⁰ Moses said: I beseech thee, Lord, I am not eloquent from yesterday and the day before; and since thou hast spoken to thy servant, I have more impediment and slowness of tongue. ¹¹ The Lord said to him: Who made man's mouth? or who made the dumb and the deaf, the seeing and the blind? did not I? ¹² Go therefore, and I will be in thy mouth; and I will teach thee what thou shalt speak. ¹³ But he said: I beseech thee, Lord, send whom thou wilt send. ¹⁴ The Lord being angry at Moses, said: Aaron the Levite is thy brother, I know that he is eloquent: behold he cometh forth to meet thee, and seeing thee, shall be glad at heart. ¹⁵ Speak to him, and put my words in his mouth: and I will be in thy mouth, and in his mouth, and will shew you what you must do. ¹⁶ He shall speak in thy stead to the people, and shall be thy mouth: but thou shalt be to him in those things that pertain to God. ¹⁷ And take this rod in thy hand, wherewith thou shalt do the signs.

58. The passover, and the going out

Exodus 12:1-42

12 ¹ And the Lord said to Moses and Aaron in the land of Egypt: ² This month shall be to you the beginning of months; it shall be the first in the months of the year. ³ Speak ye to the whole assembly of the children of Israel, and say to them: On the tenth day of this month let every man take a lamb by their families and houses. ⁴ But if the number be less than may suffice to eat the lamb, he shall take unto him his neighbour that joineth to his house, according to the number of souls which may be enough

to eat the lamb. ⁵ And it shall be a lamb without blemish, a male, of one year; according to which rite also you shall take a kid. ⁶ And you shall keep it until the fourteenth day of this month; and the whole multitude of the children of Israel shall sacrifice it in the evening. ⁷ And they shall take of the blood thereof, and put it upon both the side posts, and on the upper door posts of the houses, wherein they shall eat it. ⁸ And they shall eat the flesh that night roasted at the fire, and unleavened bread with wild lettuce. ⁹ You shall not eat thereof any thing raw, nor boiled in water, but only roasted at the fire; you shall eat the head with the feet and entrails thereof. ¹⁰ Neither shall there remain any thing of it until morning. If there be any thing left, you shall burn it with fire. ¹¹ And thus you shall eat it: you shall gird your reins, and you shall have shoes on your feet, holding staves in your hands, and you shall eat in haste; for it is the Phase (that is the Passage) of the Lord. ¹² And I will pass through the land of Egypt that night, and will kill every firstborn in the land of Egypt, both man and beast: and against all the gods of Egypt I will execute judgments; I am the Lord. ¹³ And the blood shall be unto you for a sign in the houses where you shall be; and I shall see the blood, and shall pass over you; and the plague shall not be upon you to destroy you, when I shall strike the land of Egypt. ¹⁴ And this day shall be for a memorial to you; and you shall keep it a feast to the Lord in your generations, with an everlasting observance. ¹⁵ Seven days shall you eat unleavened bread: in the first day there shall be no leaven in your houses; whosoever shall eat any thing leavened, from the first day until the seventh day, that soul shall perish out of Israel. ¹⁶ The first day shall be holy and solemn, and the seventh day shall be kept with the like solemnity: you shall do no work in them, except those things that belong to eating. ¹⁷ And you shall observe the feast of the unleavened bread: for in this same day I will bring forth your army out of the land of Egypt, and you shall keep this day in your generations by a perpetual observance. ¹⁸ The first month, the fourteenth day of the month, in the evening, you shall eat unleavened bread, until the one and twentieth day of the same month, in the evening. ¹⁹ Seven days there shall not be found any leaven in your houses: he that shall eat leavened bread, his soul shall perish out of the assembly of Israel, whether he be a stranger or born in the land. ²⁰ You shall not eat any thing leavened: in all your habitations you shall eat unleavened bread.

²¹ And Moses called all the ancients of the children of Israel, and said to them: Go take a lamb by your families, and sacrifice the Phase. ²² And dip a bunch of hyssop in the blood that is at the door, and sprinkle the transom of the door therewith, and both the door cheeks: let none of you go out of the door of his house till morning. ²³ For the Lord will pass through striking the Egyptians: and when he shall see the blood on the transom, and on both the posts, he will pass over the door of the house, and not suffer the destroyer to come into your houses and to hurt you. ²⁴ Thou shalt keep this thing as a law for thee and thy children for ever. ²⁵ And when you have entered into the land which the Lord will give you, as he hath promised, you shall observe these ceremonies. ²⁶ And when your children shall say to you: What is the meaning of this service? ²⁷ You shall say to them: It is the victim of the passage of the Lord, when he

passed over the houses of the children of Israel in Egypt, striking the Egyptians, and saving our houses. And the people bowing themselves, adored. ²⁸ And the children of Israel going forth, did as the Lord had commanded Moses and Aaron.

²⁹ And it came to pass at midnight, the Lord slew every first-born in the land of Egypt, from the firstborn of Pharaoh, who sat on his throne, unto the firstborn of the captive woman that was in the prison, and all the firstborn of cattle. ³⁰ And Pharaoh arose in the night, and all his servants, and all Egypt: and there arose a great cry in Egypt; for there was not a house wherein there lay not one dead. ³¹ And Pharaoh calling Moses and Aaron, in the night, said: Arise and go forth from among my people, you and the children of Israel: go, sacrifice to the Lord as you say. ³² Your sheep and herds take along with you, as you demanded, and departing bless me. ³³ And the Egyptians pressed the people to go forth out of the land speedily, saying: We shall all die. ³⁴ The people therefore took dough before it was leavened; and tying it in their cloaks, put it on their shoulders. ³⁵ And the children of Israel did as Moses had commanded: and they asked of the Egyptians vessels of silver and gold, and very much raiment. ³⁶ And the Lord gave favour to the people in the sight of the Egyptians, so that they lent unto them: and they stripped the Egyptians.

³⁷ And the children of Israel set forward from Ramesse to Socoth, being about six hundred thousand men on foot, beside children. ³⁸ And a mixed multitude, without number, went up also with them, sheep and herds, and beasts of divers kinds, exceeding many. ³⁹ And they baked the meal, which a little before they had brought out of Egypt in dough: and they made hearth cakes unleavened: for it could not be leavened, the Egyptians pressing them to depart, and not suffering them to make any stay; neither did they think of preparing any meat. ⁴⁰ And the abode of the children of Israel that they made in Egypt, was four hundred and thirty years. ⁴¹ Which being expired, the same day all the army of the Lord went forth out of the land of Egypt. ⁴² This is the observable night of the Lord, when he brought them forth out of the land of Egypt: this night all the children of Israel must observe in their generations.

61. The crossing of the sea

Exodus 14:15-15:1

The third lesson of the Easter Vigil, whose range this reading reproduces exactly, ending as the Vigil does at the opening of the canticle.

14 ¹⁵ And the Lord said to Moses: Why criest thou to me? Speak to the children of Israel to go forward. ¹⁶ But lift thou up thy rod, and stretch forth thy hand over the sea, and divide it: that the children of Israel may go through the midst of the sea on dry ground. ¹⁷ And I will harden the heart of the Egyptians to pursue you: and I will be glorified in Pharaoh, and in all his host, and in his chariots and in his horsemen. ¹⁸ And the Egyptians shall know that I am the Lord, when I shall be glorified in Pharaoh, and in his chariots, and in his horsemen. ¹⁹ And the angel of God, who went before the camp of Israel, removing, went behind them: and together with him the pillar of the cloud, leaving the forefront, ²⁰ Stood behind, between the Egyptians' camp and the

camp of Israel: and it was a dark cloud, and enlightening the night, so that they could not come at one another all the night.

²¹ And when Moses had stretched forth his hand over the sea, the Lord took it away by a strong and burning wind blowing all the night, and turned it into dry ground: and the water was divided. ²² And the children of Israel went in through the midst of the sea dried up; for the water was as a wall on their right hand and on their left. ²³ And the Egyptians pursuing went in after them, and all Pharaoh's horses, his chariots and horsemen, through the midst of the sea. ²⁴ And now the morning watch was come, and behold the Lord looking upon the Egyptian army through the pillar of fire and of the cloud, slew their host. ²⁵ And overthrew the wheels of the chariots, and they were carried into the deep. And the Egyptians said: Let us flee from Israel; for the Lord fighteth for them against us.

²⁶ And the Lord said to Moses: Stretch forth thy hand over the sea, that the waters may come again upon the Egyptians, upon their chariots and horsemen. ²⁷ And when Moses had stretched forth his hand towards the sea, it returned at the first break of day to the former place: and as the Egyptians were fleeing away, the waters came upon them, and the Lord shut them up in the middle of the waves. ²⁸ And the waters returned, and covered the chariots and the horsemen of all the army of Pharaoh, who had come into the sea after them, neither did there so much as one of them remain. ²⁹ But the children of Israel marched through the midst of the sea upon dry land, and the waters were to them as a wall on the right hand and on the left: ³⁰ And the Lord delivered Israel in that day out of the hands of the Egyptians. ³¹ And they saw the Egyptians dead upon the sea shore, and the mighty hand that the Lord had used against them: and the people feared the Lord, and they believed the Lord, and Moses his servant.

15 ¹ Then Moses and the children of Israel sung this canticle to the Lord, and said: Let us sing to the Lord: for he is gloriously magnified, the horse and the rider he hath thrown into the sea.

63. The manna and the quails

Exodus 16:1-36

16 ¹ And they set forward from Elim, and all the multitude of the children of Israel came into the desert of Sin, which is between Elim and Sinai: the fifteenth day of the second month, after they came out of the land of Egypt. ² And all the congregation of the children of Israel murmured against Moses and Aaron in the wilderness. ³ And the children of Israel said to them: Would to God we had died by the hand of the Lord in the land of Egypt, when we sat over the fleshpots, and ate bread to the full: Why have you brought us into this desert, that you might destroy all the multitude with famine?

⁴ And the Lord said to Moses: Behold I will rain bread from heaven for you; let the people go forth, and gather what is sufficient for every day: that I may prove them whether they will walk in my law, or not. ⁵ But the sixth day let them provide for to bring in: and let it be double to that they were wont to gather every day. ⁶ And Moses and Aaron said to the children of Israel In the evening you shall know that the Lord hath brought you forth out of the land of Egypt: ⁷ And in the morning you shall see the glory of the Lord: for he hath heard your murmuring against the Lord: but as for us, what are we, that you mutter against us?

⁸ And Moses said: In the evening the Lord will give you flesh to eat, and in the morning bread to the full: for he hath heard your murmurings, with which you have murmured against him, for what are we? your murmuring is not against us, but against the Lord. ⁹ Moses also said to Aaron: Say to the whole congregation of the children of Israel: Come before the Lord; for he hath heard your murmuring. ¹⁰ And when Aaron spoke to all the assembly of the children of Israel, they looked towards the wilderness; and behold the glory of the Lord appeared in a cloud. ¹¹ And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying: ¹² I have heard the murmuring of the children of Israel, say to them: In the evening you shall eat flesh, and in the morning you shall have your fill of bread; and you shall know that I am the Lord your God.

¹³ So it came to pass in the evening, that quails coming up, covered the camp: and in the morning a dew lay round about the camp. ¹⁴ And when it had covered the face of the earth, it appeared in the wilderness small, and as it were beaten with a pestle, like unto the hoar frost on the ground. ¹⁵ And when the children of Israel saw it, they said one to another: Manhu! which signifieth: What is this! for they knew not what it was. And Moses said to them: This is the bread which the Lord hath given you to eat. ¹⁶ This is the word that the Lord hath commanded: Let every one gather of it as much as is enough to eat; a gomor for every man, according to the number of your souls that dwell in a tent, so shall you take of it. ¹⁷ And the children of Israel did so: and they gathered, one more, another less. ¹⁸ And they measured by the measure of a gomor: neither had he more that had gathered more; nor did he find less that had provided less: but every one had gathered, according to what they were able to eat. ¹⁹ And Moses said to them: Let no man leave thereof till the morning. ²⁰ And they hearkened not to him, but some of them left until the morning, and it began to be full of worms, and it putrified, and Moses was angry with them. ²¹ Now every one of them gathered in the morning, as much as might suffice to eat: and after the sun grew hot, it melted. ²² But on the sixth day they gathered twice as much, that is, two gomors every man: and all the rulers of the multitude came, and told Moses. ²³ And he said to them: This is what the Lord hath spoken: To morrow is the rest of the sabbath sanctified to the Lord. Whatsoever work is to be done, do it; and the meats that are to be dressed, dress them; and whatsoever shall remain, lay it up until the morning. ²⁴ And they did so as Moses had commanded, and it did not putrify, neither was there worm found in it. ²⁵ And Moses said: Eat it to day, because it is the sabbath of the Lord: to day it shall not be found in the field. ²⁶ Gather it six days; but on the seventh day is the sabbath of the Lord, therefore it shall not be found. ²⁷ And the seventh day came; and some of the people going forth to gather, found none. ²⁸ And the Lord said to Moses: How long will you refuse to keep my commandments, and my law? ²⁹ See that the Lord hath given you the sabbath, and for this reason on the sixth day he giveth you a double provision: let each man stay at home, and let none go forth out of his place the seventh day. ³⁰ And the people kept the sabbath on the seventh day. ³¹ And the house of Israel called the name thereof Manna: and it was like coriander seed, white, and the taste thereof like to flour with honey. ³² And Moses said: This is the word which the Lord hath commanded: Fill a gomor of it, and let it be kept unto generations

to come hereafter; that they may know the bread, wherewith I fed you in the wilderness when you were brought forth out of the land of Egypt.³³ And Moses said to Aaron: Take a vessel, and put manna into it, as much as a gomor can hold; and lay it up before the Lord, to keep unto your generations.³⁴ As the Lord commanded Moses. And Aaron put it in the tabernacle to be kept.³⁵ And the children of Israel ate manna forty years, till they came to a habitable land: with this meat were they fed, until they reached the borders of the land of Chanaan.³⁶ Now a gomor is the tenth part of an ephi.

66. Israel at the mountain

Exodus 19:1-25

19 ¹ In the third month of the departure of Israel out of the land of Egypt, on this day they came into the wilderness of Sinai: ² For departing out of Raphidim, and coming to the desert of Sinai, they camped in the same place, and there Israel pitched their tents over against the mountain. ³ And Moses went up to God; and the Lord called unto him from the mountain, and said: Thus shalt thou say to the house of Jacob, and tell the children of Israel: ⁴ You have seen what I have done to the Egyptians, how I have carried you upon the wings of eagles, and have taken you to myself. ⁵ If therefore you will hear my voice, and keep my covenant, you shall be my peculiar possession above all people: for all the earth is mine. ⁶ And you shall be to me a priestly kingdom, and a holy nation. These are the words thou shalt speak to the children of Israel.

⁷ Moses came; and calling together the elders of the people, he declared all the words which the Lord had commanded. ⁸ And all the people answered together: All that the Lord hath spoken, we will do. And when Moses had related the people's words to the Lord,

⁹ The Lord said to him: Lo, now will I come to thee in the darkness of a cloud, that the people may hear me speaking to thee, and may believe thee for ever. And Moses told the words of the people to the Lord. ¹⁰ And he said to him: Go to the people, and sanctify them to day, and to morrow, and let them wash their garments. ¹¹ And let them be ready against the third day; for on the third day the Lord will come down in the sight of all the people, upon Mount Sinai. ¹² And thou shalt appoint certain limits to the people round about, and thou shalt say to them: Take heed ye go not up into the mount, and that ye touch not the borders thereof: every one that toucheth the mount, dying he shall die. ¹³ No hands shall touch him, but he shall be stoned to death, or he shall be shot through with arrows: whether it be beast, or man, he shall not live. When the trumpet shall begin to sound, then let them go up into the mount.

¹⁴ And Moses came down from the mount to the people, and sanctified them. And when they had washed their garments, ¹⁵ He said to them: Be ready against the third day, and come not near your wives.

¹⁶ And now the third day was come, and the morning appeared: and behold thunders began to be heard, and lightning to flash, and a very thick cloud to cover the mount, and the noise of the trumpet sounded exceeding loud; and the people that was in the camp, feared. ¹⁷ And when Moses had brought them forth to meet God, from the place of the camp, they stood at the bottom of the mount. ¹⁸ And all Mount Sinai was on a smoke: because

the Lord was come down upon it in fire, and the smoke arose from it as out of a furnace: and all the mount was terrible. ¹⁹ And the sound of the trumpet grew by degrees louder and louder, and was drawn out to a greater length: Moses spoke, and God answered him. ²⁰ And the Lord came down upon Mount Sinai, in the very top of the mount, and he called Moses unto the top thereof. And when he was gone up thither, ²¹ He said unto him: Go down, and charge the people; lest they should have a mind to pass the limits to see the Lord, and a very great multitude of them should perish. ²² The priests also that come to the Lord, let them be sanctified, lest he strike them. ²³ And Moses said to the Lord: The people cannot come up to Mount Sinai: for thou didst charge, and command, saying: Set limits about the mount, and sanctify it. ²⁴ And the Lord said to him: Go, get thee down; and thou shalt come up, thou and Aaron with thee: but let not the priests and the people pass the limits, nor come up to the Lord, lest he kill them. ²⁵ And Moses went down to the people and told them all.

67. The Decalogue

Exodus 20:1-21

Kept at the highest tier although it is law and not narrative: the covenant it states is the standard against which every later collapse in this plan is measured.

20 ¹ And the Lord spoke all these words: ² I am the Lord thy God, who brought thee out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of bondage. ³ Thou shalt not have strange gods before me. ⁴ Thou shalt not make to thyself a graven thing, nor the likeness of any thing that is in heaven above, or in the earth beneath, nor of those things that are in the waters under the earth. ⁵ Thou shalt not adore them, nor serve them: I am the Lord thy God, mighty, jealous, visiting the iniquity of the fathers upon the children, unto the third and fourth generation of them that hate me: ⁶ And shewing mercy unto thousands to them that love me, and keep my commandments. ⁷ Thou shalt not take the name of the Lord thy God in vain: for the Lord will not hold him guiltless that shall take the name of the Lord his God in vain. ⁸ Remember that thou keep holy the sabbath day. ⁹ Six days shalt thou labour, and shalt do all thy works. ¹⁰ But on the seventh day is the sabbath of the Lord thy God: thou shalt do no work on it, thou nor thy son, nor thy daughter, nor thy manservant, nor thy maidservant, nor thy beast, nor the stranger that is within thy gates. ¹¹ For in six days the Lord made heaven and earth, and the sea, and all things that are in them, and rested on the seventh day: therefore the Lord blessed the seventh day, and sanctified it.

¹² Honour thy father and thy mother, that thou mayst be longlived upon the land which the Lord thy God will give thee. ¹³ Thou shalt not kill. ¹⁴ Thou shalt not commit adultery. ¹⁵ Thou shalt not steal. ¹⁶ Thou shalt not bear false witness against thy neighbour. ¹⁷ Thou shalt not covet thy neighbour's house; neither shalt thou desire his wife, nor his servant, nor his handmaid, nor his ox, nor his ass, nor any thing that is his.

¹⁸ And all the people saw the voices and the flames, and the sound of the trumpet, and the mount smoking; and being terrified and struck with fear, they stood afar off, ¹⁹ Saying to Moses: Speak thou to us, and we will hear: let not the Lord speak to us, lest we die. ²⁰ And Moses said to the people: Fear not; for God is

come to prove you, and that the dread of him might be in you, and you should not sin. ²¹ And the people stood afar off. But Moses went to the dark cloud wherein God was.

69. The blood of the covenant

Exodus 24:1-18

Exodus 25-31, the tabernacle specifications, are omitted here.

24 ¹ And he said to Moses: Come up to the Lord, thou, and Aaron, Nadab and Abiu, and seventy of the ancients of Israel, and you shall adore afar off. ² And Moses alone shall come up to the Lord, but they shall not come nigh; neither shall the people come up with him.

³ So Moses came and told the people all the words of the Lord, and all the judgments: and all the people answered with one voice: We will do all the words of the Lord, which he hath spoken. ⁴ And Moses wrote all the words of the Lord: and rising in the morning, he built an altar at the foot of the mount, and twelve titles according to the twelve tribes of Israel. ⁵ And he sent young men of the children of Israel, and they offered holocausts, and sacrificed pacific victims of calves to the Lord. ⁶ Then Moses took half of the blood, and put it into bowls; and the rest he poured upon the altar. ⁷ And taking the book of the covenant, he read it in the hearing of the people: and they said: All things that the Lord hath spoken, we will do, we will be obedient. ⁸ And he took the blood and sprinkled it upon the people, and he said: This is the blood of the covenant, which the Lord hath made with you concerning all these words.

⁹ Then Moses and Aaron, Nadab and Abiu, and seventy of the ancients of Israel went up: ¹⁰ And they saw the God of Israel: and under his feet as it were a work of sapphire stone, and as the heaven, when clear. ¹¹ Neither did he lay his hand upon those of the children of Israel, that retired afar off, and they saw God, and they did eat and drink.

¹² And the Lord said to Moses: Come up to me into the mount, and be there; and I will give thee tables of stone, and the law, and the commandments which I have written; that thou mayest teach them. ¹³ Moses rose up, and his minister Josue: and Moses going up into the mount of God, ¹⁴ Said to the ancients: Wait ye here till we return to you. You have Aaron and Hur with you: if any question shall arise, you shall refer it to them. ¹⁵ And when Moses was gone up, a cloud covered the mount. ¹⁶ And the glory of the Lord dwelt upon Sinai, covering it with a cloud six days: and the seventh day he called him out of the midst of the cloud. ¹⁷ And the sight of the glory of the Lord, was like a burning fire upon the top of the mount, in the eyes of the children of Israel. ¹⁸ And Moses entering into the midst of the cloud, went up into the mountain: And he was there forty days and forty nights.

70. The golden calf

Exodus 32:1-35

32 ¹ And the people seeing that Moses delayed to come down from the mount, gathering together against Aaron, said: Arise, make us gods, that may go before us: For as to this Moses, the man that brought us out of the land of Egypt, we know not what has befallen him. ² And Aaron said to them: Take the golden earrings from the ears of your wives, and your sons and daughters, and bring them to me. ³ And the people did what he had

commanded, bringing the earrings to Aaron. ⁴ And when he had received them, he fashioned them by founders' work, and made of them a molten calf. And they said: These are thy gods, O Israel, that have brought thee out of the land of Egypt. ⁵ And when Aaron saw this, he built an altar before it, and made proclamation by a crier's voice, saying To morrow is the solemnity of the Lord. ⁶ And rising in the morning, they offered holocausts, and peace victims, and the people sat down to eat and drink, and they rose up to play.

⁷ And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying: Go, get thee down: thy people, which thou hast brought out of the land of Egypt, hath sinned. ⁸ They have quickly strayed from the way which thou didst shew them: and they have made to themselves a molten calf, and have adored it, and sacrificing victims to it, have said: These are thy gods, O Israel, that have brought thee out of the land of Egypt. ⁹ And again the Lord said to Moses: I see that this people is stiffnecked: ¹⁰ Let me alone, that my wrath may be kindled against them, and that I may destroy them, and I will make of thee a great nation. ¹¹ But Moses besought the Lord his God, saying: Why, O Lord, is thy indignation enkindled against thy people, whom thou hast brought out of the land of Egypt, with great power, and with a mighty hand? ¹² Let not the Egyptians say, I beseech thee: He craftily brought them out, that he might kill them in the mountains, and destroy them from the earth: let thy anger cease, and be appeased upon the wickedness of thy people. ¹³ Remember Abraham, Isaac, and Israel, thy servants, to whom thou sworeest by thy own self, saying: I will multiply your seed as the stars of heaven: and this whole land that I have spoken of, I will give to your seed, and you shall possess it for ever: ¹⁴ And the Lord was appeased from doing the evil which he had spoken against his people.

¹⁵ And Moses returned from the mount, carrying the two tables of the testimony in his hand, written on both sides, ¹⁶ And made by the work of God; the writing also of God was graven in the tables. ¹⁷ And Josue hearing the noise of the people shouting, said to Moses: The noise of battle is heard in the camp. ¹⁸ But he answered: It is not the cry of men encouraging to fight, nor the shout of men compelling to flee: but I hear the voice of singers. ¹⁹ And when he came nigh to the camp, he saw the calf, and the dances: and being very angry, he threw the tables out of his hand, and broke them at the foot of the mount: ²⁰ And laying hold of the calf which they had made, he burnt it, and beat it to powder, which he strewed into water, and gave thereof to the children of Israel to drink.

²¹ And he said to Aaron: What has this people done to thee, that thou shouldst bring upon them a most heinous sin? ²² And he answered him: Let not my lord be offended; for thou knowest this people, that they are prone to evil. ²³ They said to me: make us gods, that may go before us; for as to this Moses, who brought us forth out of the land of Egypt, we know not what is befallen him. ²⁴ And I said to them: Which of you hath any gold? and they took and brought it to me; and I cast it into the fire, and this calf came out.

²⁵ And when Moses saw that the people were naked, (for Aaron had stripped them by occasion of the shame of the filth, and had set them naked among their enemies) ²⁶ Then standing in the gate of the camp, he said: If any man be on the Lord's

side, let him join with me. And all the sons of Levi gathered themselves together unto him: ²⁷ And he said to them: Thus saith the Lord God of Israel: Put every man his sword upon his thigh: go, and return from gate to gate through the midst of the camp, and let every man kill his brother, and friend, and neighbour. ²⁸ And the sons of Levi did according to the words of Moses, and there were slain that day about three and twenty thousand men. ²⁹ And Moses said: You have consecrated your hands this day to the Lord, every man in his son and in his brother, that a blessing may be given to you.

³⁰ And when the next day was come, Moses spoke to the people: You have sinned a very great sin: I will go up to the Lord, if by any means I may be able to entreat him for your crime. ³¹ And returning to the Lord, he said: I beseech thee: this people hath sinned a heinous sin, and they have made to themselves gods of gold: either forgive them this trespass, ³² Or if thou do not, strike me out of the book that thou hast written. ³³ And the Lord answered him: He that hath sinned against me, him will I strike out of my book: ³⁴ But go thou, and lead this people whither I have told thee: my angel shall go before thee. And I in the day of revenge will visit this sin also of theirs. ³⁵ The Lord therefore struck the people for the guilt, on occasion of the calf which Aaron had made.

72. The covenant renewed; the shining face

Exodus 34:1-35

Exodus 35-40, the making of the tabernacle, are omitted; they repeat chapters 25-31 in the past tense.

34 ¹ And after this he said: Hew thee two tables of stone like unto the former, and I will write upon them the words, which were in the tables, which thou brokest. ² Be ready in the morning, that thou mayst forthwith go up into Mount Sinai, and thou shalt stand with me upon the top of the mount. ³ Let no man go up with thee, and let not any man be seen throughout all the mount; neither let the oxen nor the sheep feed over against it.

⁴ Then he cut out two tables of stone, such as had been before; and rising very early he went up into the Mount Sinai, as the Lord had commanded him, carrying with him the tables. ⁵ And when the Lord was come down in a cloud, Moses stood with him, calling upon the name of the Lord. ⁶ And when he passed before him, he said: O the Lord, the Lord God, merciful and gracious, patient and of much compassion, and true, ⁷ Who keepest mercy unto thousands: who takest away iniquity, and wickedness, and sin, and no man of himself is innocent before thee. Who renderest the iniquity of the fathers to the children, and to the grandchildren unto the third and fourth generation. ⁸ And Moses making haste, bowed down prostrate unto the earth, and adoring, ⁹ Said: If I have found grace in thy sight, O Lord, I beseech thee that thou wilt go with us, (for it is a stiffnecked people) and take away our iniquities and sin, and possess us.

¹⁰ The Lord answered: I will make a covenant in the sight of all, I will do signs such as were never seen upon the earth, nor in any nations; that this people, in the midst of whom thou art, may see the terrible work of the Lord which I will do. ¹¹ Observe all things which this day I command thee: I myself will drive out before thy face the Amorrite, and the Chanaanite, and the Hethite, and the Pherezite, and the Hevite, and the Jebusite. ¹² Beware

thou never join in friendship with the inhabitants of that land, which may be thy ruin: ¹³ But destroy their altars, break their statues and cut down their groves: ¹⁴ Adore not any strange god. The Lord his name is jealous, he is a jealous God. ¹⁵ Make no covenant with the men of those countries; lest, when they have committed fornication with their gods, and have adored their idols, some one call thee to eat of the things sacrificed. ¹⁶ Neither shalt thou take of their daughters a wife for thy son, lest after they themselves have committed fornication, they make thy sons also to commit fornication with their gods. ¹⁷ Thou shalt not make to thyself any molten gods.

¹⁸ Thou shalt keep the feast of the unleavened bread. Seven days shalt thou eat unleavened bread, as I commanded thee in the time of the month of the new corn: for in the month of the spring time thou camest out from Egypt. ¹⁹ All of the male kind that openeth the womb, shall be mine. Of all beasts; both of oxen and of sheep, it shall be mine. ²⁰ The firstling of an ass thou shalt redeem with a sheep: but if thou wilt not give a price for it, it shall be slain. The firstborn of thy sons thou shalt redeem: neither shalt thou appear before me empty.

²¹ Six days shalt thou work, the seventh day thou shalt cease to plough and to reap.

²² Thou shalt keep the feast of weeks with the firstfruits of the corn of thy wheat harvest, and the feast when the time of the year returneth that all things are laid in. ²³ Three times in the year all thy males shall appear in the sight of the almighty Lord the God of Israel. ²⁴ For when I shall have taken away the nations from thy face, and shall have enlarged thy borders, no man shall lie in wait against thy land when thou shalt go up, and appear in the sight of the Lord thy God thrice in a year. ²⁵ Thou shalt not offer the blood of my sacrifice upon leaven; neither shall there remain in the morning any thing of the victim of the solemnity of the Phase. ²⁶ The first of the fruits of thy ground thou shalt offer in the house of the Lord thy God. Thou shalt not boil a kid in the milk of his dam. ²⁷ And the Lord said to Moses: Write thee these words, by which I have made a covenant both with thee and with Israel.

²⁸ And he was there with the Lord forty days and forty nights: he neither ate bread nor drank water, and he wrote upon the tables the ten words of the covenant.

²⁹ And when Moses came down from the Mount Sinai, he held the two tables of the testimony, and he knew not that his face was horned from the conversation of the Lord. ³⁰ And Aaron and the children of Israel seeing the face of Moses horned, were afraid to come near. ³¹ And being called by him, they returned, both Aaron and the rulers of the congregation. And after that he spoke to them, ³² And all the children of Israel came to him: and he gave them in commandment all that he had heard of the Lord on Mount Sinai. ³³ And having done speaking, he put a veil upon his face. ³⁴ But when he went in to the Lord, and spoke with him, he took it away until he came forth, and then he spoke to the children of Israel all things that had been commanded him. ³⁵ And they saw that the face of Moses when he came out was horned, but he covered his face again, if at any time he spoke to them.

THE WILDERNESS

Numbers 10-14, 16-17, 20-25, 27 and 31-33, with Deuteronomy 1-11 and 29-34. The Deuteronomic law code (12-26) is passed over, as is Leviticus entire and Numbers 1-9 and 26-30 apart from chapter 27: censuses, offerings and cultic ordinance.

74. The quails, and the seventy elders

Numbers 11:1-34

11 ¹ In the mean time there arose a murmuring of the people against the Lord, as it were repining at their fatigue. And when the Lord heard it he was angry. And the fire of the Lord being kindled against them, devoured them that were at the uttermost part of the camp. ² And when the people cried to Moses, Moses prayed to the Lord, and the fire was swallowed up. ³ And he called the name of that place, The burning: for that the fire of the Lord had been kindled against them.

⁴ For a mixt multitude of people, that came up with them, burned with desire, sitting and weeping, the children of Israel also being joined with them, and said: Who shall give us flesh to eat? ⁵ We remember the fish that we ate in Egypt free cost: the cucumbers come into our mind, and the melons, and the leeks, and the onions, and the garlic. ⁶ Our soul is dry, our eyes behold nothing else but manna. ⁷ Now the manna was like coriander seed, of the colour of bdellium. ⁸ And the people went about, and gathering it, ground it in a mill, or beat it in a mortar, and boiled it in a pot, and made cakes thereof of the taste of bread tempered with oil. ⁹ And when the dew fell in the night upon the camp, the manna also fell with it.

¹⁰ Now Moses heard the people weeping by their families, every one at the door of his tent. And the wrath of the Lord was exceedingly enkindled: to Moses also the thing seemed insupportable. ¹¹ And he said to the Lord: Why hast thou afflicted thy servant? Wherefore do I not find favour before thee? And why hast thou laid the weight of all this people upon me? ¹² Have I conceived all this multitude, or begotten them, that thou shouldst say to me: Carry them in thy bosom as the nurse is wont to carry the little infant, and bear them into the land, for which thou hast sworn to their fathers? ¹³ Whence should I have flesh to give to so great a multitude? They weep against me, saying: Give us flesh that we may eat. ¹⁴ I am not able alone to bear all this people, because it is too heavy for me. ¹⁵ But if it seem unto thee otherwise, I beseech thee to kill me, and let me find grace in thy eyes, that I be not afflicted with so great evils.

¹⁶ And the Lord said to Moses: Gather unto me seventy men of the ancients of Israel, whom thou knowest to be ancients and masters of the people: and thou shalt bring them to the door of the tabernacle of the covenant, and shalt make them stand there with thee, ¹⁷ That I may come down and speak with thee: and I will take of thy spirit, and will give to them, that they may bear with thee the burden of the people, and thou mayest not be burthened alone. ¹⁸ And thou shalt say to the people: Be ye sanctified: to morrow you shall eat flesh: for I have heard you say: Who will give us flesh to eat? It was well with us in Egypt. That the Lord may give you flesh, and you may eat: ¹⁹ Not for one day, nor two, nor five, nor ten, nor twenty. ²⁰ But even for a month of days, till it come out at your nostrils, and become loathsome to you, because you have cast off the Lord,

who is in the midst of you, and have wept before him, saying: Why came we out of Egypt? ²¹ And Moses said: There are six hundred thousand footmen of this people, and sayest thou: I will give them flesh to eat a whole month? ²² Shall then a multitude of sheep and oxen be killed, that it may suffice for their food? or shall the fishes of the sea be gathered together to fill them? ²³ And the Lord answered him: Is the hand of the Lord unable? Thou shalt presently see whether my word shall come to pass or no.

²⁴ Moses therefore came, and told the people the words of the Lord, and assembled seventy men of the ancients of Israel, and made them to stand about the tabernacle. ²⁵ And the Lord came down in a cloud, and spoke to him, taking away of the spirit that was in Moses, and giving to the seventy men. And when the spirit had rested on them they prophesied, nor did they cease afterwards. ²⁶ Now there remained in the camp two of the men, of whom one was called Eldad, and the other Medad, upon whom the spirit rested; for they also had been enrolled, but were not gone forth to the tabernacle. ²⁷ And when they prophesied in the camp, there ran a young man, and told Moses, saying: Eldad and Medad prophesy in the camp. ²⁸ Forthwith Josue the son of Nun, the minister of Moses, and chosen out of many, said: My lord Moses forbid them. ²⁹ But he said: Why hast thou emulation for me? O that all the people might prophesy, and that the Lord would give them his spirit! ³⁰ And Moses returned, with the ancients of Israel, into the camp. ³¹ And a wind going out from the Lord, taking quails up beyond the sea brought them, and cast them into the camp for the space of one day's journey, on every side of the camp round about, and they flew in the air two cubits high above the ground. ³² The people therefore rising up all that day, and night, and the next day, gathered together of quails, he that did least, ten cores: and they dried them round about the camp. ³³ As yet the flesh was between their teeth, neither had that kind of meat failed: when behold the wrath of the Lord being provoked against the people, struck them with an exceeding great plague. ³⁴ And that place was called, The graves of lust: for there they buried the people that had lusted. And departing from the graves of lust, they came unto Haseroth, and abode there.

76. The spies, and the refusal of the land

Numbers 13:1-14:45

The forty years in the desert begin here; every later reading in this period is its consequence.

13 ¹ And the people marched from Haseroth, and pitched their tents in the desert of Pharan. ² And there the Lord spoke to Moses, saying. ³ Send men to view the land of Chanaan, which I will give to the children of Israel, one of every tribe, of the rulers. ⁴ Moses did what the Lord had commanded, sending from the desert of Pharan, principal men, whose names are these: ⁵ Of the tribe of Ruben, Sammua the son of Zechur. ⁶ Of the tribe of Simeon, Saphat the son of Huri. ⁷ Of the tribe of Juda, Caleb the son of Jephone. ⁸ Of the tribe of Issachar, Igal the son of Joseph. ⁹ Of the tribe of Ephraim, Osee the son of Nun. ¹⁰ Of the tribe of Benjamin, Phalti the son of Raphu. ¹¹ Of the tribe of Zabulon, Geddiel the son of Sodi. ¹² Of the tribe of Joseph, of the sceptre of Manasses, Gaddi the son of Susi. ¹³ Of the tribe of

Dan, Ammiel the son of Gemalli. ¹⁴ Of the tribe of Aser, Sthur the son of Michael. ¹⁵ Of the tribe of Nephtali, Nahabi the son of Vapsi. ¹⁶ Of the tribe of Gad, Guel the son of Machi. ¹⁷ These are the names of the men, whom Moses sent to view the land: and he called Osee the son of Nun, Josue. ¹⁸ And Moses sent them to view the land of Chanaan, and said to them: Go you up by the south side. And when you shall come to the mountains, ¹⁹ View the land, of what sort it is, and the people that are the inhabitants thereof, whether they be strong or weak: few in number or many: ²⁰ The land itself, whether it be good or bad: what manner of cities, walled or without walls:

²¹ The ground, fat or barren, woody or without trees. Be of good courage, and bring us of the fruits of the land. Now it was the time when the firstripe grapes are fit to be eaten. ²² And when they were gone up, they viewed the land from the desert of Sin, unto Rohob as you enter into Emath. ²³ And they went up at the south side, and came to Hebron, where were Achiman and Sisai and Tholmai the sons of Enac. For Hebron was built seven years before Tanis the city of Egypt. ²⁴ And going forward as far as the torrent of the cluster of grapes, they cut off a branch with its cluster of grapes, which two men carried upon a lever. They took also of the pomegranates and of the figs of that place: ²⁵ Which was called Nehelescol, that is to say, the torrent of the cluster of grapes, because from thence the children of Israel had carried a cluster of grapes. ²⁶ And they that went to spy out the land returned after forty days, having gone round all the country, ²⁷ And came to Moses and Aaron and to all the assembly of the children of Israel to the desert of Pharan, which is in Cades. And speaking to them and to all the multitude, they shewed them the fruits of the land: ²⁸ And they related and said: We came into the land to which thou sentest us, which in very deed floweth with milk and honey as may be known by these fruits: ²⁹ But it hath very strong inhabitants, and the cities are great and walled. We saw there the race of Enac. ³⁰ Amalec dwelleth in the south, the Hethite and the Jebusite and the Amorrhite in the mountains: but the Chanaanite abideth by the sea and near the streams of the Jordan. ³¹ In the mean time Caleb, to still the murmuring of the people that rose against Moses, said: Let us go up and possess the land, for we shall be able to conquer it. ³² But the others, that had been with him, said: No, we are not able to go up to this people, because they are stronger than we. ³³ And they spoke ill of the land, which they had viewed, before the children of Israel, saying: The land which we have viewed, devoureth its inhabitants: the people, that we beheld are of a tall stature. ³⁴ There we saw certain monsters of the sons of Enac, of the giant kind: in comparison of whom, we seemed like locusts.

14 ¹ Therefore the whole multitude crying wept that night. ² And all the children of Israel murmured against Moses and Aaron, saying: ³ Would God that we had died in Egypt: and would God we may die in this vast wilderness, and that the Lord may not bring us into this land, lest we fall by the sword, and our wives and children be led away captives. Is it not better to return into Egypt? ⁴ And they said one to another: Let us appoint a captain, and let us return into Egypt.

⁵ And when Moses and Aaron heard this, they fell down flat upon the ground before the multitude of the children of Israel.

⁶ But Josue the son of Nun, and Caleb the son of Jephone, who themselves also had viewed the land, rent their garments, ⁷ And said to all the multitude of the children of Israel: The land which we have gone round is very good: ⁸ If the Lord be favourable, he will bring us into it, and give us a land flowing with milk and honey. ⁹ Be not rebellious against the Lord: and fear ye not the people of this land, for we are able to eat them up as bread. All aid is gone from them: the Lord is with us, fear ye not. ¹⁰ And when all the multitude cried out, and would have stoned them, the glory of the Lord appeared over the tabernacle of the covenant to all the children of Israel.

¹¹ And the Lord said to Moses: How long will this people detract me? how long will they not believe me for all the signs that I have wrought before them? ¹² I will strike them therefore with pestilence, and will consume them: but thee I will make a ruler over a great nation, and a mightier than this is.

¹³ And Moses said to the Lord: That the Egyptians, from the midst of whom thou hast brought forth this people, ¹⁴ And the inhabitants of this land, (who have heard that thou, O Lord, art among this people, and art seen face to face, and thy cloud protecteth them, and thou goest before them in a pillar of a cloud by day, and in a pillar of fire by night,) ¹⁵ May hear that thou hast killed so great a multitude as it were one man and may say: ¹⁶ He could not bring the people into the land for which he had sworn, therefore did he kill them in the wilderness. ¹⁷ Let then the strength of the Lord be magnified, as thou hast sworn, saying: ¹⁸ The Lord is patient and full of mercy, by taking away iniquity and wickedness, and leaving no man clear, who visiteth the sins of the fathers upon the children unto the third and fourth generation. ¹⁹ Forgive, I beseech thee, the sins of this people, according to the greatness of thy mercy, as thou hast been merciful to them from their going out of Egypt unto this place.

²⁰ And the Lord said: I have forgiven according to thy word. ²¹ As I live: and the whole earth shall be filled with the glory of the Lord. ²² But yet all the men that have seen my majesty, and the signs that I have done in Egypt, and in the wilderness, and have tempted me now ten times, and have not obeyed my voice, ²³ Shall not see the land for which I swore to their fathers, neither shall any one of them that hath detracted me behold it. ²⁴ My servant Caleb, who being full of another spirit hath followed me, I will bring into this land which he hath gone round: and his seed shall possess it. ²⁵ For the Amalecite and the Chanaanite dwell in the valleys. To morrow remove the camp, and return into the wilderness by the way of the Red Sea. ²⁶ And the Lord spoke to Moses and Aaron, saying: ²⁷ How long doth this wicked multitude murmur against me? I have heard the murmurings of the children of Israel. ²⁸ Say therefore to them: As I live, saith the Lord: According as you have spoken in my hearing, so will I do to you. ²⁹ In the wilderness shall your carcasses lie. All you that were numbered from twenty years old and upward, and have murmured against me, ³⁰ Shall not enter into the land, over which I lifted up my hand to make you dwell therein, except Caleb the son of Jephone, and Josue the son of Nun. ³¹ But your children, of whom you said, that they should be a prey to the enemies, will I bring in: that they may see the land which you have despised. ³² Your carcasses shall

lie in the wilderness. ³³ Your children shall wander in the desert forty years, and shall bear your fornication, until the carcasses of their fathers be consumed in the desert. ³⁴ According to the number of the forty days, wherein you viewed the land: a year shall be counted for a day. And forty years you shall receive your iniquities, and shall know my revenge: ³⁵ For as I have spoken, so will I do to all this wicked multitude, that hath risen up together against me: in this wilderness shall it faint away and die.

³⁶ Therefore all the men, whom Moses had sent to view the land, and who at their return had made the whole multitude to murmur against him, speaking ill of the land that it was naught, ³⁷ Died and were struck in the sight of the Lord. ³⁸ But Josue the son of Nun, and Caleb the son of Jephone lived, of all them that had gone to view the land. ³⁹ And Moses spoke all these words to all the children of Israel, and the people mourned exceedingly. ⁴⁰ And behold rising up very early in the morning, they went up to the top of the mountain, and said: We are ready to go up to the place, of which the Lord hath spoken: for we have sinned. ⁴¹ And Moses said to them: Why transgress you the word of the Lord, which shall not succeed prosperously with you? ⁴² Go not up, for the Lord is not with you: lest you fall before your enemies. ⁴³ The Amalecite and the Chanaanite are before you, and by their sword you shall fall, because you would not consent to the Lord, neither will the Lord be with you. ⁴⁴ But they being blinded went up to the top of the mountain. But the ark of the testament of the Lord and Moses departed not from the camp. ⁴⁵ And the Amalecite came down, and the Chanaanite that dwelt in the mountain: and smiting and slaying them pursued them as far as Horma.

77. The rebellion of Core

Numbers 16:1-50

16 ¹ And behold Core the son of Isaar, the son of Caath, the son of Levi, and Dathan and Abiron the sons of Eliab, and Hon the son of Pheleth of the children of Ruben, ² Rose up against Moses, and with them two hundred and fifty others of the children of Israel, leading men of the synagogue, and who in the time of assembly were called by name. ³ And when they had stood up against Moses and Aaron, they said: Let it be enough for you, that all the multitude consisteth of holy ones, and the Lord is among them: Why lift you up yourselves above the people of the Lord? ⁴ When Moses heard this, he fell flat on his face: ⁵ And speaking to Core and all the multitude, he said: In the morning the Lord will make known who belong to him, and the holy he will join to himself: and whom he shall choose, they shall approach to him. ⁶ Do this therefore: Take every man of you your censers, thou Core, and all thy company. ⁷ And putting fire in them to morrow, put incense upon it before the Lord: and whomsoever he shall choose, the same shall be holy: you take too much upon you, ye sons of Levi. ⁸ And he said again to Core: Hear ye sons of Levi. ⁹ Is it a small thing unto you, that the God of Israel hath spared you from all the people, and joined you to himself, that you should serve him in the service of the tabernacle, and should stand before the congregation of the people, and should minister to him? ¹⁰ Did he therefore make thee and all thy brethren the sons of Levi to approach unto him, that you should challenge to yourselves the priesthood also,

¹¹ And that all thy company should stand against the Lord? for what is Aaron that you murmur against him?

¹² Then Moses sent to call Dathan and Abiron the sons of Eliab. But they answered: We will not come. ¹³ Is it a small matter to thee, that thou hast brought us out of a land that flowed with milk and honey, to kill us in the desert, except thou rule also like a lord over us? ¹⁴ Thou hast brought us indeed into a land that floweth with rivers of milk and honey, and hast given us possessions of fields and vineyards; wilt thou also pull out our eyes? We will not come. ¹⁵ Moses therefore being very angry, said to the Lord: Respect not their sacrifices: thou knowest that I have not taken of them so much as a young ass at any time, nor have injured any of them. ¹⁶ And he said to Core: Do thou and thy congregation stand apart before the Lord to morrow, and Aaron apart. ¹⁷ Take every one of you censers, and put incense upon them, offering to the Lord two hundred and fifty censers: let Aaron also hold his censer. ¹⁸ When they had done this, Moses and Aaron standing, ¹⁹ And had drawn up all the multitude against them to the door of the tabernacle, the glory of the Lord appeared to them all. ²⁰ And the Lord speaking to Moses and Aaron, said: ²¹ Separate yourselves from among this congregation, that I may presently destroy them. ²² They fell flat on their face, and said: O most mighty, the God of the spirits of all flesh, for one man's sin shall thy wrath rage against all?

²³ And the Lord said to Moses: ²⁴ Command the whole people to separate themselves from the tents of Core and Dathan and Abiron. ²⁵ And Moses arose, and went to Dathan and Abiron: and the ancients of Israel following him, ²⁶ He said to the multitude: Depart from the tents of these wicked men, and touch nothing of theirs, lest you be involved in their sins. ²⁷ And when they were departed from their tents round about, Dathan and Abiron coming out stood in the entry of their pavilions with their wives and children, and all the people. ²⁸ And Moses said: By this you shall know that the Lord hath sent me to do all things that you see, and that I have not forged them of my own head: ²⁹ If these men die the common death of men, and if they be visited with a plague, wherewith others also are wont to be visited, the Lord did not send me. ³⁰ But if the Lord do a new thing, and the earth opening her mouth swallow them down, and all things that belong to them, and they go down alive into hell, you shall know that they have blasphemed the Lord.

³¹ And immediately as he had made an end of speaking, the earth broke asunder under their feet: ³² And opening her mouth, devoured them with their tents and all their substance. ³³ And they went down alive into hell, the ground closing upon them, and they perished from among the people. ³⁴ But all Israel, that was standing round about, fled at the cry of them that were perishing: saying: Lest perhaps the earth swallow us up also. ³⁵ And a fire coming out from the Lord, destroyed the two hundred and fifty men that offered the incense.

³⁶ And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying: ³⁷ Command Eleazar the son of Aaron the priest to take up the censers that lie in the burning, and to scatter the fire of one side and the other: because they are sanctified ³⁸ In the deaths of the sinners: and let him beat them into plates, and fasten them to the altar, because incense hath been offered in them to the Lord, and they are sanctified, that the children of Israel may see them for a sign and

a memorial. ³⁹ Then Eleazar the priest took the brazen censers, wherein they had offered, whom the burning fire had devoured, and beat them into plates, fastening them to the altar: ⁴⁰ That the children of Israel might have for the time to come wherewith they should be admonished, that no stranger or any one that is not of the seed of Aaron should come near to offer incense to the Lord, lest he should suffer as Core suffered, and all his congregation, according as the Lord spoke to Moses.

⁴¹ The following day all the multitude of the children of Israel murmured against Moses and Aaron, saying: You have killed the people of the Lord. ⁴² And when there arose a sedition, and the tumult increased, ⁴³ Moses and Aaron fled to the tabernacle of the covenant. And when they were gone into it, the cloud covered it, and the glory of the Lord appeared. ⁴⁴ And the Lord said to Moses: ⁴⁵ Get you out from the midst of this multitude, this moment will I destroy them. And as they were lying on the ground,

⁴⁶ Moses said to Aaron: Take the censer, and putting fire in it from the altar, put incense upon it, and go quickly to the people to pray for them: for already wrath is gone out from the Lord, and the plague rageth. ⁴⁷ When Aaron had done this, and had run to the midst of the multitude which the burning fire was now destroying, he offered the incense: ⁴⁸ And standing between the dead and the living, he prayed for the people, and the plague ceased. ⁴⁹ And the number of them that were slain was fourteen thousand and seven hundred men, besides them that had perished in the sedition of Core. ⁵⁰ And Aaron returned to Moses to the door of the tabernacle of the covenant after the destruction was over.

79. Meriba; the death of Aaron

Numbers 20:1-30

20 ¹ And the children of Israel, and all the multitude came into the desert of Sin, in the first month: and the people abode in Cades. And Mary died there, and was buried in the same place. ² And the people wanting water, came together against Moses and Aaron: ³ And making a sedition, they said: Would God we had perished among our brethren before the Lord. ⁴ Why have you brought out the church of the Lord into the wilderness, that both we and our cattle should die? ⁵ Why have you made us come up out of Egypt, and have brought us into this wretched place which cannot be sowed, nor bringeth forth figs, nor vines, nor pomegranates, neither is there any water to drink? ⁶ And Moses and Aaron leaving the multitude, went into the tabernacle of the covenant, and fell flat upon the ground, and cried to the Lord, and said. O Lord God, hear the cry of this people, and open to them thy treasure, a fountain of living water, that being satisfied, they may cease to murmur. And the glory of the Lord appeared over them. ⁷ And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying: ⁸ Take the rod, and assemble the people together, thou and Aaron thy brother, and speak to the rock before them, and it shall yield waters. And when thou hast brought forth water out of the rock, all the multitude and their cattle shall drink. ⁹ Moses therefore took the rod, which was before the Lord, as he had commanded him, ¹⁰ And having gathered together the multitude before the rock, he said to them: Hear, ye rebellious and incredulous: Can we bring you forth water out of this rock? ¹¹ And when Moses had lifted up his hand, and struck the rock twice with the rod, there

came forth water in great abundance, so that the people and their cattle drank,

¹² And the Lord said to Moses and Aaron: Because you have not believed me, to sanctify me before the children of Israel, you shall not bring these people into the land, which I will give them. ¹³ This is the Water of contradiction, where the children of Israel strove with words against the Lord, and he was sanctified in them.

¹⁴ In the mean time Moses sent messengers from Cades to the king of Edom, to say: Thus saith thy brother Israel: Thou knowest all the labour that hath come upon us: ¹⁵ In what manner our fathers went down into Egypt, and there we dwelt a long time, and the Egyptians afflicted us and our fathers. ¹⁶ And how we cried to the Lord, and he heard us, and sent an angel, who hath brought us out of Egypt. Lo, we are now in the city of Cades, which is in the uttermost of thy borders, ¹⁷ And we beseech thee that we may have leave to pass through thy country. We will not go through the fields, nor through the vineyards, we will not drink the waters of thy wells, but we will go by the common highway, neither turning aside to the right hand, nor to the left, till we are past thy borders. ¹⁸ And Edom answered them: Thou shalt not pass by me: if thou dost I will come out armed against thee. ¹⁹ And the children of Israel said: We will go by the beaten way: and if we and our cattle drink of thy waters, we will give thee what is just: there shall be no difficulty in the price, only let us pass speedily. ²⁰ But he answered: Thou shalt not pass. And immediately he came forth to meet them with an infinite multitude, and a strong hand, ²¹ Neither would he condescend to their desire to grant them passage through his borders. Wherefore Israel turned another way from him.

²² And when they had removed the camp from Cades, they came to mount Hor, which is in the borders of the land of Edom: ²³ Where the Lord spoke to Moses: ²⁴ Let Aaron, saith he, go to his people: for he shall not go into the land which I have given the children of Israel, because he was incredulous to my words, at the waters of contradiction. ²⁵ Take Aaron and his son with him, and bring them up into mount Hor: ²⁶ And when thou hast stripped the father of his vesture, thou shalt vest therewith Eleazar his son: Aaron shall be gathered to his people, and die there. ²⁷ Moses did as the Lord had commanded: and they went up into mount Hor before all the multitude. ²⁸ And when he had stripped Aaron of his vestments, he vested Eleazar his son with them. ²⁹ And Aaron being dead in the top of the mountain, he came down with Eleazar. ³⁰ And all the multitude seeing that Aaron was dead, mourned for him thirty days throughout all their families.

80. The brazen serpent

Numbers 21:1-35

Read again in St. John 3:14, which this plan also reads.

21 ¹ And when king Arad the Chanaanite, who dwelt towards the south, had heard this, to wit, that Israel was come by the way of the spies, he fought against them, and overcoming them carried off their spoils. ² But Israel binding himself by vow to the Lord, said: If thou wilt deliver this people into my hand, I will utterly destroy their cities. ³ And the Lord heard the prayers of Israel, and delivered up the Chanaanite, and they cut them

off and destroyed their cities: and they called the name of that place Horma, that is to say, Anathema.

⁴ And they marched from mount Hor, by the way that leadeth to the Red Sea, to compass the land of Edom. And the people began to be weary of their journey and labour: ⁵ And speaking against God and Moses, they said: Why didst thou bring us out of Egypt, to die in the wilderness? There is no bread, nor have we any waters: our soul now loatheth this very light food. ⁶ Wherefore the Lord sent among the people fiery serpents, which bit them and killed many of them. ⁷ Upon which they came to Moses, and said; We have sinned, because we have spoken against the Lord and thee: pray that he may take away these serpents from us. And Moses prayed for the people. ⁸ And the Lord said to him: Make a brazen serpent, and set it up for a sign: whosoever being struck shall look on it, shall live. ⁹ Moses therefore made a brazen serpent, and set it up for a sign: which when they that were bitten looked upon, they were healed.

¹⁰ And the children of Israel setting forwards camped in Oboth. ¹¹ And departing thence they pitched their tents in Jeabarim, in the wilderness, that faceth Moab toward the east. ¹² And removing from thence, they came to the torrent Zared: ¹³ Which they left and encamped over against Arnon, which is in the desert and standeth out on the borders of the Amorrite. For Arnon is the border of Moab, dividing the Moabites and the Amorrites. ¹⁴ Wherefore it is said in the book of the wars of the Lord: As he did in the Red Sea, so will he do in the streams of Arnon. ¹⁵ The rocks of the torrents were bowed down that they might rest in Ar, and lie down in the borders of the Moabites. ¹⁶ When they went from that place, the well appeared whereof the Lord said to Moses: Gather the people together, and I will give them water.

¹⁷ Then Israel sung this song: Let the well spring up. They sung thereto: ¹⁸ The well, which the princes dug, and the chiefs of the people prepared by the direction of the lawgiver, and with their staves. And they marched from the wilderness to Mathana. ¹⁹ From Mathana unto Nahaliel: from Nahaliel unto Bamoth. ²⁰ From Bamoth, is a valley in the country of Moab, to the top of Phasga, which looked towards the desert. ²¹ And Israel sent messengers to Sehon king of the Amorrites, saying: ²² I beseech thee that I may have leave to pass through thy land: we will not go aside into the fields or the vineyards, we will not drink waters of the wells, we will go the king's highway, till we be past thy borders. ²³ And he would not grant that Israel should pass by his borders: but rather gathering an army, went forth to meet them in the desert, and came to Jasa and fought against them. ²⁴ And he was slain by them with the edge of the sword, and they possessed his land from the Arnon unto the Jeboc, and to the confines of the children of Ammon: for the borders of the Ammonites, were kept with a strong garrison. ²⁵ So Israel took all his cities, and dwelt in the cities of the Amorrite, to wit, in Hesebon, and in the villages thereof. ²⁶ Hesebon was the city of Sehon the king of the Amorrites, who fought against the king of Moab: and took all the land, that had been of his dominion, as far as the Arnon. ²⁷ Therefore it is said in the proverb: Come into Hesebon, let the city of Sehon be built and set up: ²⁸ A fire is gone out of Hesebon, a flame from the city of Sehon, and hath consumed Ar of the Moabites, and the inhabitants of the high places of the Arnon. ²⁹ Woe to thee Moab: thou art undone,

O people of Chamos. He hath given his sons to flight, and his daughters into captivity to Sehon the king of the Amorrites. ³⁰ Their yoke is perished from Hesebon unto Dibon, they came weary to Nophe, and unto Medaba.

³¹ So Israel dwelt in the land of the Amorrite. ³² And Moses sent some to take a view of Jazer: and they took the villages of it, and conquered the inhabitants. ³³ And they turned themselves, and went up by the way of Basan, and Og the king of Basan came against them with all his people, to fight in Edrai. ³⁴ And the Lord said to Moses: Fear him not, for I have delivered him and all his people, and his country into thy hand: and thou shalt do to him as thou didst to Sehon the king of the Amorrites, the inhabitant of Hesebon. ³⁵ So they slew him also with his sons, and all his people, not letting any one escape, and they possessed his land.

88. The Decalogue rehearsed

Deuteronomy 5:1-33

The second of the two statements of the Decalogue this plan reads.

⁵ ¹ And Moses called all Israel, and said to them: Hear, O Israel, the ceremonies and judgments, which I speak in your ears this day: learn them, and fulfil them in work. ² The Lord our God made a covenant with us in Horeb. ³ He made not the covenant with our fathers, but with us, who are now present and living. ⁴ He spoke to us face to face in the mount out of the midst of fire. ⁵ I was the mediator and stood between the Lord and you at that time, to shew you his words, for you feared the fire, and went not up into the mountain, and he said:

⁶ I am the Lord thy God, who brought thee out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of bondage. ⁷ Thou shalt not have strange gods in my sight. ⁸ Thou shalt not make to thy self a graven thing, nor the likeness of any things, that are in heaven above, or that are in the earth beneath, or that abide in the waters under the earth. ⁹ Thou shalt not adore them, and thou shalt not serve them. For I am the Lord thy God, a jealous God, visiting the iniquity of the fathers upon their children unto the third and fourth generation, to them that hate me, ¹⁰ And shewing mercy unto many thousands, to them that love me, and keep my commandments. ¹¹ Thou shalt not take the name of the Lord thy God in vain: for he shall not be unpunished that taketh his name upon a vain thing. ¹² Observe the day of the sabbath, to sanctify it, as the Lord thy God hath commanded thee. ¹³ Six days shalt thou labour, and shalt do all thy works. ¹⁴ The seventh is the day of the sabbath, that is, the rest of the Lord thy God. Thou shalt not do any work therein, thou nor thy son nor thy daughter, nor thy manservant nor thy maidservant, nor thy ox, nor thy ass, nor any of thy beasts, nor the stranger that is within thy gates: that thy manservant and thy maidservant may rest, even as thyself. ¹⁵ Remember that thou also didst serve in Egypt, and the Lord thy God brought thee out from thence with a strong hand, and a stretched out arm. Therefore hath he commanded thee that thou shouldst observe the sabbath day.

¹⁶ Honour thy father and mother, as the Lord thy God hath commanded thee, that thou mayst live a long time, and it may be well with thee in the land, which the Lord thy God will give thee. ¹⁷ Thou shalt not kill. ¹⁸ Neither shalt thou commit adul-

tery. ¹⁹ And thou shalt not steal. ²⁰ Neither shalt thou bear false witness against thy neighbour. ²¹ Thou shalt not covet thy neighbour's wife: nor his house, nor his field, nor his manservant, nor his maidservant, nor his ox, nor his ass, nor any thing that is his.

²² These words the Lord spoke to all the multitude of you in the mountain, out of the midst of the fire and the cloud, and the darkness, with a loud voice, adding nothing more: and he wrote them in two tables of stone, which he delivered unto me. ²³ But you, after you heard the voice out of the midst of the darkness, and saw the mountain burn, came to me, all the princes of the tribes and the elders, and you said: ²⁴ Behold the Lord our God hath shewn us his majesty and his greatness, we have heard his voice out of the midst of the fire, and have proved this day that God speaking with man, man hath lived. ²⁵ Why shall we die therefore, and why shall this exceeding great fire consume us: for if we hear the voice of the Lord our God any more, we shall die. ²⁶ What is all flesh, that it should hear the voice of the living God, who speaketh out of the midst of the fire, as we have heard, and be able to live? ²⁷ Approach thou rather: and hear all things that the Lord our God shall say to thee, and thou shalt speak to us, and we will hear and will do them. ²⁸ And when the Lord had heard this, he said to me: I have heard the voice of the words of this people, which they spoke to thee: they have spoken all things well. ²⁹ Who shall give them to have such a mind, to fear me, and to keep all my commandments at all times, that it may be well with them and with their children for ever? ³⁰ Go and say to them: Return into your tents. ³¹ But stand thou here with me, and I will speak to thee all my commandments, and ceremonies and judgments: which thou shalt teach them, that they may do them in the land, which I will give them for a possession. ³² Keep therefore and do the things which the Lord God hath commanded you: you shall not go aside neither to the right hand, nor to the left. ³³ But you shall walk in the way that the Lord your God hath commanded, that you may live, and it may be well with you, and your days may be long in the land of your possession.

89. "Hear, O Israel"

Deuteronomy 6:1-25

The Shema, and the first commandment as Christ cites it. Deuteronomy 12-26, the law code, is omitted after chapter 11.

6 ¹ These are the precepts, and ceremonies, and judgments, which the Lord your God commanded that I should teach you, and that you should do them in the land into which you pass over to possess it: ² That thou mayst fear the Lord thy God, and keep all his commandments and precepts, which I command thee, and thy sons, and thy grandsons, all the days of thy life, that thy days may be prolonged. ³ Hear, O Israel, and observe to do the things which the Lord hath commanded thee, that it may be well with thee, and thou mayst be greatly multiplied, as the Lord the God of thy fathers hath promised thee a land flowing with milk and honey.

⁴ Hear, O Israel, the Lord our God is one Lord. ⁵ Thou shalt love the Lord thy God with thy whole heart, and with thy whole soul, and with thy whole strength. ⁶ And these words which I command thee this day, shall be in thy heart: ⁷ And thou shalt tell

them to thy children, and thou shalt meditate upon them sitting in thy house, and walking on thy journey, sleeping and rising. ⁸ And thou shalt bind them as a sign on thy hand, and they shall be and shall move between thy eyes. ⁹ And thou shalt write them in the entry, and on the doors of thy house. ¹⁰ And when the Lord thy God shall have brought thee into the land, for which he swore to thy fathers Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob: and shall have given thee great and goodly cities, which thou didst not build, ¹¹ Houses full of riches, which thou didst not set up, cisterns which thou didst not dig, vineyards and oliveyards, which thou didst not plant, ¹² And thou shalt have eaten and be full: ¹³ Take heed diligently lest thou forget the Lord, who brought thee out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of bondage. Thou shalt fear the Lord thy God, and shalt serve him only, and thou shalt swear by his name. ¹⁴ You shall not go after the strange gods of all the nations, that are round about you: ¹⁵ Because the Lord thy God is a jealous God in the midst of thee: lest at any time the wrath of the Lord thy God be kindled against thee, and take thee away from the face of the earth. ¹⁶ Thou shalt not tempt the Lord thy God, as thou temptedst him in the place of temptation. ¹⁷ Keep the precepts of the Lord thy God, and the testimonies and ceremonies which he hath commanded thee. ¹⁸ And do that which is pleasing and good in the sight of the Lord, that it may be well with thee: and going in thou mayst possess the goodly land, concerning which the Lord swore to thy fathers, ¹⁹ That he would destroy all thy enemies before thee, as he hath spoken. ²⁰ And when thy son shall ask thee to morrow, saying: What mean these testimonies, and ceremonies and judgments, which the Lord our God hath commanded us? ²¹ Thou shalt say to him: We were bondmen of Pharaoh in Egypt, and the Lord brought us out of Egypt with a strong hand. ²² And he wrought signs and wonders great and very grievous in Egypt against Pharaoh, and all his house, in our sight, ²³ And he brought us out from thence, that he might bring us in and give us the land, concerning which he swore to our fathers. ²⁴ And the Lord commanded that we should do all these ordinances, and should fear the Lord our God, that it might be well with us all the days of our life, as it is at this day. ²⁵ And he will be merciful to us, if we keep and do all his precepts before the Lord our God, as he hath commanded us.

97. The canticle of Moses

Deuteronomy 32:1-52

32 ¹ Hear, O ye heavens, the things I speak, let the earth give ear to the words of my mouth. ² Let my doctrine gather as the rain, let my speech distil as the dew, as a shower upon the herb, and as drops upon the grass. ³ Because I will invoke the name of the Lord: give ye magnificence to our God. ⁴ The works of God are perfect, and all his ways are judgments: God is faithful and without any iniquity, he is just and right. ⁵ They have sinned against him, and are none of his children in their filth: they are a wicked and perverse generation. ⁶ Is this the return thou makest to the Lord, O foolish and senseless people? Is not he thy father, that hath possessed thee, and made thee, and created thee? ⁷ Remember the days of old, think upon every generation: ask thy father, and he will declare to thee: thy elders and they will tell thee. ⁸ When the Most High divided the nations: when he separated the sons of Adam, he appointed the bounds of

people according to the number of the children of Israel. ⁹ But the Lord's portion is his people: Jacob the lot of his inheritance. ¹⁰ He found him in a desert land, in a place of horror, and of vast wilderness: he led him about, and taught him: and he kept him as the apple of his eye. ¹¹ As the eagle enticing her young to fly, and hovering over them, he spread his wings, and hath taken him and carried him on his shoulders. ¹² The Lord alone was his leader: and there was no strange god with him. ¹³ He set him upon high land: that he might eat the fruits of the fields, that he might suck honey out of the rock, and oil out of the hardest stone, ¹⁴ Butter of the herd, and milk of the sheep with the fat of lambs, and of the rams of the breed of Basan: and goats with the marrow of wheat, and might drink the purest blood of the grape. ¹⁵ The beloved grew fat, and kicked: he grew fat, and thick and gross, he forsook God who made him, and departed from God his saviour. ¹⁶ They provoked him by strange gods, and stirred him up to anger, with their abominations. ¹⁷ They sacrificed to devils and not to God: to gods whom they knew not: that were newly come up, whom their fathers worshipped not. ¹⁸ Thou hast forsaken the God that begot thee, and hast forgotten the Lord that created thee. ¹⁹ The Lord saw, and was moved to wrath: because his own sons and daughters provoked him. ²⁰ And he said: I will hide my face from them, and will consider what their last end shall be: for it is a perverse generation, and unfaithful children. ²¹ They have provoked me with that which was no god, and have angered me with their vanities: and I will provoke them with that which is no people, and will vex them with a foolish nation. ²² A fire is kindled in my wrath, and shall burn even to the lowest hell: and shall devour the earth with her increase, and shall burn the foundations of the mountains. ²³ I will heap evils upon them, and will spend my arrows among them. ²⁴ They shall be consumed with famine, and birds shall devour them with a most bitter bite: I will send the teeth of beasts upon them, with the fury of creatures that trail upon the ground, and of serpents. ²⁵ Without, the sword shall lay them waste, and terror within, both the young man and the virgin, the sucking child with the man in years. ²⁶ I said: Where are they? I will make the memory of them to cease from among men. ²⁷ But for the wrath of the enemies I have deferred it: lest perhaps their enemies might be proud, and should say: Our mighty hand, and not the Lord, hath done all these things. ²⁸ They are a nation without counsel, and without wisdom. ²⁹ O that they would be wise and would understand, and would provide for their last end. ³⁰ How should one pursue after a thousand, and two chase ten thousand? Was it not, because their God had sold them, and the Lord had shut them up? ³¹ For our God is not as their gods: our enemies themselves are judges. ³² Their vines are of the vineyard of Sodom, and of the suburbs of Gomorrha: their grapes are grapes of gall, and their clusters most bitter. ³³ Their wine is the gall of dragons, and the venom of asps, which is incurable. ³⁴ Are not these things stored up with me, and sealed up in my treasures? ³⁵ Revenge is mine, and I will repay them in due time, that their foot may slide: the day of destruction is at hand, and the time makes haste to come. ³⁶ The Lord will judge his people, and will have mercy on his servants: he shall see that their hand is weakened, and that they who were shut up have also failed, and they that remained are consumed. ³⁷ And he shall say: Where are their gods, in whom

they trusted? ³⁸ Of whose victims they ate the fat, and drank the wine of their drink offerings: let them arise and help you, and protect you in your distress. ³⁹ See ye that I alone am, and there is no other God besides me: I will kill and I will make to live: I will strike, and I will heal, and there is none that can deliver out of my hand. ⁴⁰ I will lift up my hand to heaven, and I will say: I live for ever. ⁴¹ If I shall whet my sword as the lightning, and my hand take hold on judgment: I will render vengeance to my enemies, and repay them that hate me. ⁴² I will make my arrows drunk with blood, and my sword shall devour flesh, of the blood of the slain and of the captivity, of the bare head of the enemies. ⁴³ Praise his people, ye nations, for he will revenge the blood of his servants: and will render vengeance to their enemies, and he will be merciful to the land of his people.

⁴⁴ So Moses came and spoke all the words of this canticle in the ears of the people, and Josue the son of Nun. ⁴⁵ And he ended all these words, speaking to all Israel. ⁴⁶ And he said to them: Set your hearts on all the words, which I testify to you this day: which you shall command your children to observe and to do, and to fulfil all that is written in this law: ⁴⁷ For they are not commanded you in vain, but that every one should live in them, and that doing them you may continue a long time in the land whither you are going over the Jordan to possess it. ⁴⁸ And the Lord spoke to Moses the same day, saying: ⁴⁹ Go up into this mountain Abarim, (that is to say, of passages,) unto mount Nebo, which is in the land of Moab over against Jericho: and see the land of Chanaan, which I will deliver to the children of Israel to possess, and die thou in the mountain. ⁵⁰ When thou art gone up into it thou shalt be gathered to thy people, as Aaron thy brother died in mount Hor, and was gathered to his people: ⁵¹ Because you trespassed against me in the midst of the children of Israel, at the waters of contradiction, in Cades of the desert of Sin: and you did not sanctify me among the children of Israel. ⁵² Thou shalt see the land before thee, which I will give to the children of Israel, but thou shalt not enter into it.

99. The death of Moses

Deuteronomy 34:1-12

34 ¹ Then Moses went up from the plains of Moab upon mount Nebo, to the top of Phasga over against Jericho: and the Lord shewed him all the land of Galaad as far as Dan. ² And all Nephthali, and the land of Ephraim and Manasses, and all the land of Juda unto the furthestmost sea, ³ And the south part, and the breadth of the plain of Jericho the city of palm trees as far as Segor. ⁴ And the Lord said to him: This is the land, for which I swore to Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, saying: I will give it to thy seed. Thou hast seen it with thy eyes, and shalt not pass over to it.

⁵ And Moses the servant of the Lord died there, in the land of Moab, by the commandment of the Lord: ⁶ And he buried him in the valley of the land of Moab over against Phogor: and no man hath known of his sepulchre until this present day. ⁷ Moses was a hundred and twenty years old when he died: his eye was not dim, neither were his teeth moved. ⁸ And the children of Israel mourned for him in the plains of Moab thirty days: and the days of their mourning in which they mourned Moses were ended. ⁹ And Josue the son of Nun was filled with the spirit of wisdom, because Moses had laid his hands upon him. And the

children of Israel obeyed him, and did as the Lord commanded Moses. ¹⁰ And there arose no more a prophet in Israel like unto Moses, whom the Lord knew face to face, ¹¹ In all the signs and wonders, which he sent by him, to do in the land of Egypt to Pharaoh, and to all his servants, and to his whole land, ¹² And all the mighty hand, and great miracles, which Moses did before all Israel.

CONQUEST AND JUDGES

Josue 1-11 and 23-24, Judges 1-16, and Ruth. The allotment of the tribal territories (Josue 12-22) is passed over as a survey document, and Judges 17-21, the appendix, is left aside as outside the line of the story.

102. The commission of Josue

Joshua 1:1-18

1 ¹ Now it came to pass after the death of Moses, the servant of the Lord, that the Lord spoke to Josue, the son of Nun, the minister of Moses, and said to him: ² Moses my servant is dead: arise, and pass over this Jordan, thou and thy people with thee, into the land which I will give to the children of Israel. ³ I will deliver to you every place that the sole of your foot shall tread upon, as I have said to Moses. ⁴ From the desert, and from Libanus unto the great river Euphrates, all the land of the Hethites, unto the great sea toward the going down of the sun, shall be your border. ⁵ No man shall be able to resist you all the days of thy life: as I have been with Moses, so will I be with thee: I will not leave thee, nor forsake thee. ⁶ Take courage, and be strong: for thou shalt divide by lot to this people the land for which I swore to their fathers, that I would deliver it to them. ⁷ Take courage therefore, and be very valiant: that thou mayst observe and do all the law, which Moses my servant hath commanded thee: turn not from it to the right hand or to the left, that thou mayst understand all things which thou dost. ⁸ Let not the book of this law depart from thy mouth: but thou shalt meditate on it day and night, that thou mayst observe and do all things that are written in it: then shalt thou direct thy way, and understand it. ⁹ Behold I command thee, take courage, and be strong. Fear not, and be not dismayed: because the Lord thy God is with thee in all things whatsoever thou shalt go to.

¹⁰ And Josue commanded the princes of the people, saying: Pass through the midst of the camp, and command the people, and say: ¹¹ Prepare your victuals: for after the third day you shall pass over the Jordan, and shall go in to possess the land, which the Lord your God will give you.

¹² And he said to the Rubenites, and the Gadites, and the half tribe of Manasses: ¹³ Remember the word, which Moses the servant of the Lord commanded you, saying: The Lord your God hath given you rest, and all this land. ¹⁴ Your wives, and children; and cattle, shall remain in the land which Moses gave you on this side of the Jordan: but pass you over armed before your brethren all of you that are strong of hand, and fight for them, ¹⁵ Until the Lord give rest to your brethren, as he hath given you, and they also possess the land which the Lord your God will give them: and so you shall return into the land of your possession, and you shall dwell in it, which Moses the servant

of the Lord gave you beyond the Jordan, toward the rising of the sun.

¹⁶ And they made answer to Josue, and said: All that thou hast commanded us, we will do: and whither soever thou shalt send us, we will go. ¹⁷ As we obeyed Moses in all things, so will we obey thee also: only be the Lord thy God with thee, as he was with Moses. ¹⁸ He that shall gainsay thy mouth, and not obey all thy words, that thou shalt command him, let him die: only take thou courage, and do manfully.

104. The crossing of the Jordan

Joshua 3:1-17

3 ¹ And Josue rose before daylight, and removed the camp: and they departed from Setim, and came to the Jordan: he, and all the children of Israel, and they abode there for three days. ² After which, the heralds went through the midst of the camp, ³ And began to proclaim: When you shall see the ark of the covenant of the Lord your God, and the priests of the race of Levi carrying it, rise you up also, and follow them as they go before: ⁴ And let there be between you and the ark the space of two thousand cubits: that you may see it afar off, and know which way you must go: for you have not gone this way before: and take care you come not near the ark. ⁵ And Josue said to the people: Be ye sanctified: for tomorrow the Lord will do wonders among you. ⁶ And he said to the priests: Take up the ark of the covenant, and go before the people. And they obeyed his commands, and took it up, and walked before them.

⁷ And the Lord said to Josue: This day will I begin to exalt thee before Israel: that they may know that as I was with Moses, so I am with thee also. ⁸ And do thou command the priests, that carry the ark of the covenant, and say to them: When you shall have entered into part of the water of the Jordan, stand in it.

⁹ And Josue said to the children of Israel: Come hither, and hear the word of the Lord your God. ¹⁰ And again he said: By this you shall know, that the Lord, the living God, is in the midst of you, and that he shall destroy, before your sight, the Chanaanite and the Hethite, the Hevite and the Pherezite, the Gergesite also, and the Jebusite, and the Amorrhite. ¹¹ Behold, the ark of the covenant of the Lord of all the earth shall go before you into the Jordan. ¹² Prepare ye twelve men of the tribes of Israel, one of every tribe. ¹³ And when the priests, that carry the ark of the Lord the God of the whole earth, shall set the soles of their feet in the waters of the Jordan, the waters that are beneath shall run down and go off: and those that come from above, shall stand together upon a heap.

¹⁴ So the people went out of their tents, to pass over the Jordan: and the priests that carried the ark of the covenant, went on before them. ¹⁵ And as soon as they came into the Jordan, and their feet were dipped in part of the water, (now the Jordan, it being harvest time, had filled the banks of its channel,) ¹⁶ The waters that came down from above stood in one place, and swelling up like a mountain, were seen afar off, from the city that is called Adom, to the place of Sarthan: but those that were beneath, ran down into the sea of the wilderness, (which now is called the Dead Sea) until they wholly failed. ¹⁷ And the people marched over against Jericho: and the priests that carried the ark of the covenant of the Lord, stood girded upon the dry ground in

the midst of the Jordan, and all the people passed over, through the channel that was dried up.

106. The fall of Jericho

Joshua 6:1-27

6 ¹ Now Jericho was close shut up and fenced, for fear of the children of Israel, and no man durst go out or come in. ² And the Lord said to Josue: Behold I have given into thy hands Jericho, and the king thereof, and all the valiant men. ³ Go round about the city all ye fighting men once a day: so shall ye do for six days. ⁴ And on the seventh day the priests shall take the seven trumpets, which are used in the jubilee, and shall go before the ark of the covenant: and you shall go about the city seven times, and the priests shall sound the trumpets. ⁵ And when the voice of the trumpet shall give a longer and broken tune, and shall sound in your ears, all the people shall shout together with a very great shout, and the walls of the city shall fall to the ground, and they shall enter in every one at the place against which they shall stand.

⁶ Then Josue, the son of Nun, called the priests, and said to them: Take the ark of the covenant: and let seven other priests take the seven trumpets of the jubilee, and march before the ark of the Lord. ⁷ And he said to the people: Go, and compass the city, armed, marching before the ark of the Lord.

⁸ And when Josue had ended his words, and the seven priests blew the seven trumpets before the ark of the covenant of the Lord, ⁹ And all the armed men went before, the rest of the common people followed the ark, and the sound of the trumpets was heard on all sides. ¹⁰ But Josue had commanded the people, saying: You shall not shout, nor shall your voice be heard, nor any word go out of your mouth: until the day come wherein I shall say to you: Cry, and shout. ¹¹ So the ark of the Lord went about the city once a day, and returning into the camp, abode there. ¹² And Josue rising before day, the priests took the ark of the Lord, ¹³ And seven of them seven trumpets, which are used in the jubilee: and they went before the ark of the Lord, walking and sounding the trumpets: and the armed men went before them, and the rest of the common people followed the ark, and they blew the trumpets. ¹⁴ And they went round about the city the second day once, and returned into the camp. So they did six days. ¹⁵ But the seventh day, rising up early, they went about the city, as it was ordered, seven times. ¹⁶ And when in the seventh going about the priests sounded with the trumpets, Josue said to all Israel: Shout: for the Lord hath delivered the city to you: ¹⁷ And let this city be an anathema, and all things that are in it, to the Lord. Let only Rahab, the harlot, live, with all that are with her in the house: for she hid the messengers whom we sent. ¹⁸ But beware ye lest you touch ought of those things that are forbidden, and you be guilty of transgression, and all the camp of Israel be under sin, and be troubled. ¹⁹ But whatsoever gold or silver there shall be, or vessels of brass and iron, let it be consecrated to the Lord, laid up in his treasures. ²⁰ So all the people making a shout, and the trumpets sounding, when the voice and the sound thundered in the ears of the multitude, the walls forthwith fell down: and every man went up by the place that was over against him: and they took the city, ²¹ And killed all that were in it, man and woman, young and old. The oxen also, and the sheep, and the asses, they slew with the edge

of the sword. ²² But Josue said to the two men that had been sent for spies: Go into the harlot's house, and bring her out, and all things that are hers, as you assured her by oath. ²³ And the young men went in, and brought out Rahab, and her parents, her brethren also, and all her goods, and her kindred, and made them to stay without the camp. ²⁴ But they burned the city, and all things that were therein; except the gold and silver, and vessels of brass and iron, which they consecrated unto the treasury of the Lord. ²⁵ But Josue saved Rahab the harlot, and her father's house, and all she had, and they dwelt in the midst of Israel until this present day: because she hid the messengers whom he had sent to spy out Jericho. At that time, Josue made an imprecation, saying:

²⁶ Cursed be the man before the Lord, that shall raise up and build the city of Jericho. In his firstborn may he lay the foundation thereof, and in the last of his children set up its gates. ²⁷ And the Lord was with Josue, and his name was noised throughout all the land.

112. The covenant at Sichem

Joshua 24:1-33

24 ¹ And Josue gathered together all the tribes of Israel in Sichem, and called for the ancients, and the princes and the judges, and the masters: and they stood in the sight of the Lord: ² And he spoke thus to the people: Thus saith the Lord the God of Israel: Your fathers dwelt of old on the other side of the river, Thare the father of Abraham, and Nachor: and they served strange gods. ³ And I took your father Abraham from the borders of Mesopotamia: and brought him into the land of Chanaan: and I multiplied his seed, ⁴ And gave him Isaac: and to him again I gave Jacob and Esau. And I gave to Esau mount Seir for his possession: but Jacob and his children went down into Egypt. ⁵ And I sent Moses and Aaron, and I struck Egypt with many signs and wonders. ⁶ And I brought you and your fathers out of Egypt, and you came to the sea: and the Egyptians pursued your fathers with chariots and horsemen, as far as the Red Sea. ⁷ And the children of Israel cried to the Lord: and he put darkness between you and the Egyptians, and brought the sea upon them, and covered them. Your eyes saw all that I did in Egypt, and you dwelt in the wilderness a long time. ⁸ And I brought you into the land of the Amorrite, who dwelt beyond the Jordan. And when they fought against you, I delivered them into your hands, and you possessed their land, and slew them. ⁹ And Balac son of Sephor king of Moab arose and fought against Israel. And he sent and called for Balaam son of Beor, to curse you: ¹⁰ And I would not hear him, but on the contrary I blessed you by him, and I delivered you out of his hand. ¹¹ And you passed over the Jordan, and you came to Jericho. And the men of that city fought against you, the Amorrite, and the Pherezite, and the Chanaanite, and the Hethite, and the Gergesite, and the Hevite, and the Jebusite: and I delivered them into your hands. ¹² And I sent before you hornets: and I drove them out from their places, the two kings of the Amorrites, not with thy sword nor with thy bow, ¹³ And I gave you a land, in which you had not laboured, and cities to dwell in which you built not, vineyards and oliveyards, which you planted not.

¹⁴ Now therefore fear the Lord, and serve him with a perfect and most sincere heart: and put away the gods which your fa-

thers served in Mesopotamia and in Egypt, and serve the Lord.¹⁵ But if it seem evil to you to serve the Lord, you have your choice: choose this day that which pleaseth you, whom you would rather serve, whether the gods which your fathers served in Mesopotamia, or the gods of the Amorrites, in whose land you dwell: but as for me and my house we will serve the Lord.¹⁶ And the people answered, and said, God forbid we should leave the Lord, and serve strange gods.¹⁷ The Lord our God he brought us and our fathers out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of bondage: and did very great signs in our sight, and preserved us in all the way by which we journeyed, and among all the people through whom we passed.¹⁸ And he hath cast out all the nations, the Amorrite the inhabitant of the land into which we are come. Therefore we will serve the Lord, for he is our God.¹⁹ And Josue said to the people: You will not be able to serve the Lord: for he is a holy God, and mighty and jealous, and will not forgive your wickedness and sins.²⁰ If you leave the Lord, and serve strange gods, he will turn, and will afflict you, and will destroy you after all the good he hath done you.²¹ And the people said to Josue: No, it shall not be so as thou sayest, but we will serve the Lord.²² And Josue said to the people, You are witnesses, that you yourselves have chosen you the Lord to serve him. And they answered: We are witnesses.²³ Now therefore, said he, put away strange gods from among you, and incline your hearts to the Lord the God of Israel.²⁴ And the people said to Josue: We will serve the Lord our God, and we will be obedient to his commandments.²⁵ Josue therefore on that day made a covenant, and set before the people commandments and judgments in Sichem.²⁶ And he wrote all these things in the volume of the law of the Lord: and he took a great stone, and set it under the oak that was in the sanctuary of the Lord.²⁷ And he said to all the people: Behold this stone shall be a testimony unto you, that it hath heard all the words of the Lord, which he hath spoken to you: lest perhaps hereafter you will deny it, and lie to the Lord your God.²⁸ And he sent the people away every one to their own possession,

²⁹ And after these things Josue the son of Nun the servant of the Lord died, being a hundred and ten years old:³⁰ And they buried him in the border of his possession in Thamnathare, which is situate in mount Ephraim, on the north side of mount Gaas.³¹ And Israel served the Lord all the days of Josue, and of the ancients that lived a long time after Josue, and that had known all the works of the Lord which he had done in Israel.³² And the bones of Joseph which the children of Israel had taken out of Egypt, they buried in Sichem, in that part of the field which Jacob had bought of the sons of Hemor the father of Sichem, for a hundred young ewes, and it was in the possession of the sons of Joseph.³³ Eleazar also the son of Aaron died: and they buried him in Gabaath that belongeth to Phinees his son, which was given him in mount Ephraim.

114. The pattern of the judges

Judges 2:1-23

The interpretative key to the whole book: they forsook the Lord, he delivered them up, they cried, he raised a judge.

2 ¹ And an angel of the Lord went up from Galgal to the place of weepers, and said: I made you go out of Egypt, and have

brought you into the land for which I swore to your fathers: and I promised that I would not make void my covenant with you for ever:² On condition that you should not make a league with the inhabitants of this land, but should throw down their altars: and you would not hear my voice: why have you done this?³ Wherefore I would not destroy them from before your face; that you may have enemies, and their gods may be your ruin.⁴ And when the angel of the Lord spoke these words to all the children of Israel: they lifted up their voice, and wept.⁵ And the name of that place was called, The place of weepers, or of tears: and there they offered sacrifices to the Lord.⁶ And Josue sent away the people, and the children of Israel went every one to his own possession to hold it:⁷ And they served the Lord all his days, and the days of the ancients, that lived a long time after him, and who knew all the works of the Lord, which he had done for Israel.⁸ And Josue, the son of Nun, the servant of the Lord, died, being a hundred and ten years old;⁹ And they buried him in the borders of his possession in Thamnathare, in Mount Ephraim, on the north side of Mount Gaas.¹⁰ And all that generation was gathered to their fathers: and there arose others that knew not the Lord and the works which he had done for Israel.¹¹ And the children of Israel did evil in the sight of the Lord, and they served Baalim,¹² And they left the Lord, the God of their fathers, who had brought them out of the land of Egypt: and they followed strange gods, and the gods of the people that dwelt round about them, and they adored them: and they provoked the Lord to anger,¹³ Forsaking him, and serving Baal and Astaroth.¹⁴ And the Lord being angry against Israel, delivered them into the hands of plunderers: who took them and sold them to their enemies, that dwelt round about: neither could they stand against their enemies:¹⁵ But whithersoever they meant to go, the hand of the Lord was upon them, as he had said, and as he had sworn to them: and they were greatly distressed.¹⁶ And the Lord raised up judges, to deliver them from the hands of those that oppressed them: but they would not hearken to them,¹⁷ Committing fornication with strange gods, and adoring them. They quickly forsook the way, in which their fathers had walked: and hearing the commandments of the Lord, they did all things contrary.¹⁸ And when the Lord raised them up judges, in their days, he was moved to mercy, and heard the groanings of the afflicted, and delivered them from the slaughter of the oppressors.¹⁹ But after the judge was dead, they returned, and did much worse things than their fathers had done, following strange gods, serving them, and adoring them. They left not their own inventions, and the stubborn way, by which they were accustomed to walk.²⁰ And the wrath of the Lord was kindled against Israel, and he said: Behold this nation hath made void my covenant, which I had made with their fathers, and hath despised to hearken to my voice:²¹ I also will not destroy the nations which Josue left when he died:²² That through them I may try Israel, whether they will keep the way of the Lord, and walk in it, as their fathers kept it, or not.²³ The Lord therefore left all these nations, and would not quickly destroy them, neither did he deliver them into the hands of Josue.

118. The call of Gedeon*Judges 6:1-40*

6 ¹ And the children of Israel again did evil in the sight of the Lord: and he delivered them into the hand of Madian seven years, ² And they were grievously oppressed by them. And they made themselves dens and caves in the mountains, and strong holds to resist. ³ And when Israel had sown, Madian and Amalec, and the rest of the eastern nations, came up: ⁴ And pitching their tents among them, wasted all things as they were in the blade, even to the entrance of Gaza: and they left nothing at all in Israel for sustenance of life, nor sheep, nor oxen, nor asses. ⁵ For they and all their flocks came with their tents, and like locusts filled all places, an innumerable multitude of men, and of camels, wasting whatsoever they touched. ⁶ And Israel was humbled exceedingly in the sight of Madian.

⁷ And he cried to the Lord, desiring help against the Madianites. ⁸ And he sent unto them a prophet, and he spoke: Thus saith the Lord, the God of Israel: I made you to come up out of Egypt, and brought you out of the house of bondage, ⁹ And delivered you out of the hands of the Egyptians, and of all the enemies that afflicted you: and I cast them out at your coming in, and gave you their land. ¹⁰ And I said: I am the Lord your God, fear not the gods of the Amorrites, in whose land you dwell. And you would not hear my voice.

¹¹ And an angel of the Lord came, and sat under an oak that was in Ephra, and belonged to Joas, the father of the family of Ezri. And when Gedeon, his son, was threshing and cleansing wheat by the winepress, to flee from Madian, ¹² The angel of the Lord appeared to him, and said: The Lord is with thee, O most valiant of men. ¹³ And Gedeon said to him: I beseech thee, my lord, if the Lord be with us, why have these evils fallen upon us? Where are his miracles, which our fathers have told us of, saying: The Lord brought us out of Egypt but now the Lord hath forsaken us, and delivered us into the hand of Madian. ¹⁴ And the Lord looked upon him, and said: Go, in this thy strength, and thou shalt deliver Israel out of the hand of Madian: know that I have sent thee. ¹⁵ He answered, and said: I beseech thee, my lord wherewith shall I deliver Israel? Behold, my family is the meanest in Manasses, and I am the least in my father's house. ¹⁶ And the Lord said to him: I will be with thee: and thou shalt cut off Madian as one man. ¹⁷ And he said: If I have found grace before thee, give me a sign that it is thou that speakest to me: ¹⁸ And depart not hence, till I return to thee, and bring a sacrifice, and offer it to thee. And he answered: I will wait thy coming.

¹⁹ So Gedeon went in, and boiled a kid, and made unleavened loaves of a measure of flour: and putting the flesh in a basket, and the broth of the flesh into a pot, he carried all under the oak, and presented to him. ²⁰ And the angel of the Lord said to him: Take the flesh and the unleavened loaves, and lay them upon that rock, and pour out the broth thereon. And when he had done so,

²¹ The angel of the Lord put forth the tip of the rod, which he held in his hand, and touched the flesh and the unleavened loaves: and there arose a fire from the rock, and consumed the flesh and the unleavened loaves: and the angel of the Lord vanished out of his sight. ²² And Gedeon seeing that it was the angel of the Lord, said: Alas, my Lord God: for I have seen the angel of

the Lord face to face. ²³ And the Lord said to him: Peace be with thee: fear not, thou shalt not die. ²⁴ And Gedeon built there an altar to the Lord, and called it the Lord's peace, until this present day. And when he was yet in Ephra, which is of the family of Ezri,

²⁵ That night the Lord said to him: Take a bullock of thy father's, and another bullock of seven years, and thou shalt destroy the altar of Baal, which is thy father's: and cut down the grove that is about the altar: ²⁶ And thou shalt build an altar to the Lord thy God, in the top of this rock, whereupon thou didst lay the sacrifice before: and thou shalt take the second bullock, and shalt offer a holocaust upon a pile of the wood, which thou shalt cut down out of the grove. ²⁷ Then Gedeon, taking ten men of his servants, did as the Lord had commanded him. But fearing his father's house, and the men of that city, he would not do it by day, but did all by night.

²⁸ And when the men of that town were risen in the morning, they saw the altar of Baal destroyed, and the grove cut down, and the second bullock laid upon the altar, which then was built. ²⁹ And they said one to another: Who hath done this? And when they inquired for the author of the fact, it was said: Gedeon, the son of Joas, did all this. ³⁰ And they said to Joas: Bring out thy son hither, that he may die: because he hath destroyed the altar of Baal, and hath cut down his grove. ³¹ He answered them: Are you the avengers of Baal, that you fight for him? he that is his adversary, let him die before to-morrow light appear: if he be a god, let him revenge himself on him that hath cast down his altar. ³² From that day Gedeon was called Jerobaal, because Joas had said: Let Baal revenge himself on him that hath cast down his altar.

³³ Now all Madian, and Amalec, and the eastern people, were gathered together, and passing over the Jordan, camped in the valley of Jezrael. ³⁴ But the spirit of the Lord came upon Gedeon, and he sounded the trumpet, and called together the house of Abiezer, to follow him. ³⁵ And he sent messengers into all Manasses, and they also followed him: and other messengers into Aser and Zabulon, and Nephthali, and they came to meet him.

³⁶ And Gedeon said to God: If thou wilt save Israel by my hand, as thou hast said, ³⁷ I will put this fleece of wool on the floor: if there be dew on the fleece only, and it be dry on all the ground beside, I shall know that by my hand, as thou hast said, thou wilt deliver Israel. ³⁸ And it was so. And rising before day, wringing the fleece, he filled a vessel with the dew. ³⁹ And he said again to God: Let not thy wrath be kindled against me, if I try once more, seeking a sign in the fleece. I pray that the fleece only may be dry, and all the ground wet with dew. ⁴⁰ And God did that night as he had requested: and it was dry on the fleece only, and there was dew on all the ground.

119. Gedeon and the three hundred*Judges 7:1-25*

7 ¹ Then Jerobaal, who is the same as Gedeon, rising up early, and all the people with him, came to the fountain that is called Harad. Now the camp of Madian was in the valley, on the north side of the high hill. ² And the Lord said to Gedeon: The people that are with thee are many, and Madian shall not be delivered into their hands: lest Israel should glory against me, and say: I was delivered by my own strength. ³ Speak to the people, and

proclaim in the hearing of all: Whosoever is fearful and timorous, let him return. So two and twenty thousand men went away from Mount Galaad and returned home, and only ten thousand remained. ⁴ And the Lord said to Gedeon: The people are still too many, bring them to the waters, and there I will try them: and of whom I shall say to thee, This shall go with thee, let him go: whom I shall forbid to go, let him return. ⁵ And when the people were come down to the waters, the Lord said to Gedeon: They that shall lap the water with their tongues, as dogs are wont to lap, thou shalt set apart by themselves: but they that shall drink bowing down their knees, shall be on the other side. ⁶ And the number of them that had lapped water; casting it with the hand to their mouth, was three hundred men: and all the rest of the multitude had drunk kneeling. ⁷ And the Lord said to Gedeon: By the three hundred men, that lapped water, I will save you, and deliver Madian into thy hand: but let all the rest of the people return to their place. ⁸ So taking victuals and trumpets according to their number, he ordered all the rest of the multitude to depart to their tents: and he with the three hundred gave himself to the battle. Now the camp of Madia was beneath him in the valley. ⁹ The same night the Lord said to him: Arise, and go down into the camp: because I have delivered them into thy hand. ¹⁰ But if thou be afraid to go alone, let Phara, thy servant, go down with thee. ¹¹ And when thou shalt hear what they are saying, then shall thy hands be strengthened, and thou shalt go down more secure to the enemies' camp. And he went down with Phara his servant, into part of the camp, where was the watch of men in arms. ¹² But Madian and Amalec, and all the eastern people, lay scattered in the valley, as a multitude of locusts: their camels also were innumerable, as the sand that lieth on the sea shore. ¹³ And when Gedeon was come, one told his neighbour a dream: and in this manner related what he had seen: I dreamt a dream, and it seemed to me as if a hearth cake of barley bread rolled and came down into the camp of Madian: and when it was come to a tent, it struck it, and beat it down flat to the ground. ¹⁴ He to whom he spoke, answered: This is nothing else but the sword of Gedeon, the son of Joas, a man of Israel. For the Lord hath delivered Madian, and all their camp into his hand.

¹⁵ And when Gedeon had heard the dream, and the interpretation thereof, he adored: and returned to the camp of Israel, and said: Arise, for the Lord hath delivered the camp of Madian into our hands.

¹⁶ And he divided the three hundred men into three parts, and gave them trumpets in their hands, and empty pitchers, and lamps within the pitchers. ¹⁷ And he said to them: What you shall see me do, do you the same: I will go into one part of the camp, and do you as I shall do. ¹⁸ When the trumpet shall sound in my hand, do you also blow the trumpets on every side of the camp, and shout together to the Lord and to Gedeon.

¹⁹ And Gedeon, and the three hundred men that were with him, went into part of the camp, at the beginning of the midnight watch, and the watchmen being alarmed, they began to sound their trumpets, and to clap the pitchers one against another. ²⁰ And when they sounded their trumpets in three places round about the camp, and had broken their pitchers, they held their lamps in their left hands, and with their right hands the trumpets which they blew, and they cried out: The sword of the Lord and

of Gedeon: ²¹ Standing every man in his place round about the enemies' camp. So all the camp was troubled, and crying out and howling, they fled away: ²² And the three hundred men nevertheless persisted sounding the trumpets. And the Lord sent the sword into all the camp, and they killed one another, ²³ Fleeing as far as Bethsetta, and the border of Abelmahula, in Tebbath. But the men of Israel, shouting from Nephthali, and Aser, and from all Manasses, pursued after Madian. ²⁴ And Gedeon sent messengers into all Mount Ephraim, saying: Come down to meet Madian, and take the waters before them to Bethbera and the Jordan. And all Ephraim shouted, and took the waters before them and the Jordan as far as Bethbera. ²⁵ And having taken two men of Madian, Oreb and Zeb: Oreb they slew in the rock of Oreb, and Zeb in the winepress of Zeb. And they pursued Madian, carrying the heads of Oreb and Zeb to Gedeon, beyond the waters of the Jordan.

125. Samson and Dalila

Judges 16:1-31

Judges 17-21, the appendix of Michas and the outrage at Gabaa, is omitted.

16 ¹ He went also into Gaza, and saw there a woman, a harlot, and went in unto her. ² And when the Philistines had heard this, and it was noised about among them, that Samson was come into the city, they surrounded him, setting guards at the gate of the city, and watching there all the night in silence, that in the morning they might kill him as he went out. ³ But Samson slept till midnight, and then rising, he took both the doors of the gate, with the posts thereof and the bolt, and laying them on his shoulders, carried them up to the top of the hill, which looketh towards Hebron.

⁴ After this he loved a woman, who dwelt in the valley of Sorec, and she was called Dalila. ⁵ And the princes of the Philistines came to her, and said: Deceive him, and learn of him wherein his great strength lieth, and how we may be able to overcome him, to bind and afflict him: which if thou shalt do, we will give thee every one of us eleven hundred pieces of silver.

⁶ And Dalila said to Samson: Tell me, I beseech thee, wherein thy greatest strength lieth, and what it is, wherewith if thou wert bound, thou couldst not break loose. ⁷ And Samson answered her: If I shall be bound with seven cords, made of sinews not yet dry, but still moist, I shall be weak like other men. ⁸ And the princes of the Philistines brought unto her seven cords, such as he spoke of, with which she bound him; ⁹ Men lying privately in wait with her, and in the chamber, expecting the event of the thing, and she cried out to him: The Philistines are upon thee, Samson. And he broke the bands, as a man would break a thread of tow twined with spittle, when it smelleth the fire: so it was not known wherein his strength lay. ¹⁰ And Dalila said to him: Behold thou hast mocked me, and hast told me a false thing: but now at least tell me wherewith thou mayest be bound. ¹¹ And he answered her: If I shall be bound with new ropes, that were never in work, I shall be weak and like other men. ¹² Dalila bound him again with these, and cried out: The Philistines are upon thee, Samson, there being an ambush prepared for him in the chamber. But he broke the bands like threads of webs. ¹³ And Dalila said to him again: How long dost thou deceive me,

and tell me lies? Shew me wherewith thou mayest be bound. And Samson answered her: If thou plattest the seven locks of my head with a lace, and tying them round about a nail, fastenest it in the ground, I shall be weak. ¹⁴ And when Dalila had done this, she said to him: The Philistines are upon thee, Samson. And awaking out of his sleep, he drew out the nail with the hairs and the lace.

¹⁵ And Dalila said to him: How dost thou say thou lovest me, when thy mind is not with me? Thou hast told me lies these three times, and wouldst not tell me wherein thy greatest strength lieth. ¹⁶ And when she pressed him much, and continually hung upon him for many days, giving him no time to rest, his soul fainted away, and was wearied even unto death. ¹⁷ Then opening the truth of the thing, he said to her: The razor hath never come upon my head, for I am a Nazarite, that is to say, consecrated to God from my mother's womb: If my head be shaven, my strength shall depart from me, and I shall become weak, and shall be like other men.

¹⁸ Then seeing that he had discovered to her all his mind, she sent to the princes of the Philistines, saying: Come up this once more, for now he hath opened his heart to me. And they went up, taking with them the money which they had promised. ¹⁹ But she made him sleep upon her knees, and lay his head in her bosom. And she called a barber and shaved his seven locks, and began to drive him away, and thrust him from her: for immediately his strength departed from him. ²⁰ And she said: The Philistines are upon thee, Samson. And awaking from sleep, he said in his mind: I will go out as I did before, and shake myself, not knowing that the Lord was departed from him.

²¹ Then the Philistines seized upon him, and forthwith pulled out his eyes, and led him bound in chains to Gaza, and shutting him up in prison made him grind. ²² And now his hair began to grow again, ²³ And the princes of the Philistines assembled together, to offer great sacrifices to Dagon their god, and to make merry, saying: Our god hath delivered our enemy Samson into our hands. ²⁴ And the people also seeing this, praised their god, and said the same: Our god hath delivered our adversary into our hands, him that destroyed our country, and killed very many. ²⁵ And rejoicing in their feasts, when they had now taken their good cheer, they commanded that Samson should be called, and should play before them. And being brought out of prison, he played before them; and they made him stand between two pillars. ²⁶ And he said to the lad that guided his steps: Suffer me to touch the pillars which support the whole house, and let me lean upon them, and rest a little. ²⁷ Now the house was full of men and women, and all the princes of the Philistines were there. Moreover about three thousand persons of both sexes, from the roof and the higher part of the house, were beholding Samson's play. ²⁸ But he called upon the Lord, saying: O Lord God remember me, and restore to me now my former strength, O my God, that I may revenge myself on my enemies, and for the loss of my two eyes I may take one revenge. ²⁹ And laying hold on both the pillars on which the house rested, and holding the one with his right hand, and the other with his left, ³⁰ He said: Let me die with the Philistines. And when he had strongly shook the pillars, the house fell upon all the princes, and the rest of the multitude, that was there: and he killed many more at his

death, than he had killed before in his life. ³¹ And his brethren and all his kindred, going down took his body, and buried it between Saraa and Esthaol, in the buryingplace of his father Manue: and he judged Israel twenty years.

126. "Thy people shall be my people"

Ruth 1:1-22

1 ¹ In the days of one of the judges, when the judges ruled, there came a famine in the land. And a certain man of Bethlehem Juda, went to sojourn in the land of Moab with his wife and his two sons. ² He was named Elimelech, and his wife Noemi: and his two sons, the one Mahalon, and the other Chelion, Ephrathites of Bethlehem Juda. And entering into the country of Moab, they abode there. ³ And Elimelech the husband of Noemi died: and she remained with her sons. ⁴ And they took wives of the women of Moab, of which one was called Orpha, and the other Ruth. And they dwelt there ten years, ⁵ And they both died, to wit, Mahalon and Chelion: and the woman was left alone, having lost both her sons and her husband. ⁶ And she arose to go from the land of Moab to her own country, with both her daughters in law: for she had heard that the Lord had looked upon his people, and had given them food. ⁷ Wherefore she went forth out of the place of her sojournment, with both her daughters in law: and being now in the way to return into the land of Juda, ⁸ She said to them: Go ye home to your mothers, the Lord deal mercifully with you, as you have dealt with the dead and with me. ⁹ May he grant you to find rest in the houses of the husbands whom you shall take. And she kissed them. And they lifted up their voice, and began to weep, ¹⁰ And to say: We will go on with thee to thy people. ¹¹ But she answered them: Return, my daughters: why come ye with me? have I any more sons in my womb, that you may hope for husbands of me? ¹² Return again, my daughters, and go your ways: for I am now spent with age, and not fit for wedlock. Although I might conceive this night, and bear children, ¹³ If you would wait till they were grown up, and come to man's estate, you would be old women before you marry. Do not so, my daughters, I beseech you: for I am grieved the more for your distress, and the hand of the Lord is gone out against me. ¹⁴ And they lifted up their voice, and began to weep again: Orpha kissed her mother in law, and returned: Ruth stuck close to her mother in law. ¹⁵ And Noemi said to her: Behold thy kinswoman is returned to her people, and to her gods, go thou with her. ¹⁶ She answered: Be not against me, to desire that I should leave thee and depart: for whithersoever thou shalt go, I will go: and where thou shalt dwell, I also will dwell. Thy people shall be my people, and thy God my God. ¹⁷ The land that shall receive thee dying, in the same will I die: and there will I be buried. The Lord do so and so to me, and add more also, if aught but death part me and thee. ¹⁸ Then Noemi seeing that Ruth was steadfastly determined to go with her, would not be against it, nor persuade her any more to return to her friends:

¹⁹ So they went together, and came to Bethlehem. And when they were come into the city, the report was quickly spread among all: and the women said: This is that Noemi. ²⁰ But she said to them: Call me not Noemi (that is, beautiful,) but call me Mara (that is, bitter), for the Almighty hath quite filled me with bitterness. ²¹ I went out full and the Lord hath brought me back empty. Why then do you call me Noemi, whom the Lord hath

humbled, and the Almighty hath afflicted? ²² So Noemi came with Ruth, the Moabitess, her daughter in law, from the land of her sojournment: and returned into Bethlehem, in the beginning of the barley harvest.

129. Booz redeems Ruth

Ruth 4:1-22

The book ends in a genealogy, and it is the one genealogy no abridgement can cut: Phares, Booz, Obed, Isai, David.

4 ¹ Then Booz went up to the gate, and sat there. And when he had seen the kinsman going by, of whom he had spoken before, he said to him, calling him by his name: Turn aside for a little while, and sit down here. He turned aside, and sat down. ² And Booz, taking ten men of the ancients of the city, said to them: Sit ye down here. ³ They sat down, and he spoke to the kinsman: Noemi, who is returned from the country of Moab will sell a parcel of land that belonged to our brother Elimelech. ⁴ I would have thee to understand this, and would tell thee before all that sit here, and before the ancients of my people. If thou wilt take possession of it by the right of kindred: buy it, and possess it: but if it please thee not, tell me so, that I may know what I have to do. For there is no near kinsman besides thee, who art first, and me, who am second. But he answered: I will buy the field. ⁵ And Booz said to him: When thou shalt buy the field at the woman's hand, thou must take also Ruth, the Moabitess, who was the wife of the deceased: to raise up the name of thy kinsman in his inheritance.

⁶ He answered: I yield up my right of next akin: for I must not cut off the posterity of my own family. Do thou make use of my privilege, which I profess I do willingly forego. ⁷ Now this in former times was the manner in Israel between kinsmen, that if at any time one yielded his right to another: that the grant might be sure, the man put off his shoe and gave it to his neighbour; this was a testimony of cession of right in Israel. ⁸ So Booz said to his kinsman: Put off thy shoe. And immediately he took it off from his foot.

⁹ And he said to the ancients, and to all the people: You are witnesses this day, that I have bought all that was Elimelech's, and Chelion's, and Mahalon's, of the hand of Noemi: ¹⁰ And have taken to wife Ruth, the Moabitess, the wife of Mahalon, to raise up the name of the deceased in his inheritance lest his name be cut off, from among his family and his brethren and his people. You, I say, are witnesses of this thing. ¹¹ Then all the people that were in the gate, and the ancients, answered: We are witnesses: The Lord make this woman who cometh into thy house, like Rachel, and Lia, who built up the house of Israel: that she may be an example of virtue in Ephrata, and may have a famous name in Bethlehem: ¹² And that the house may be, as the house of Phares, whom Tamar bore unto Juda, of the seed which the Lord shall give thee of this young woman.

¹³ Booz therefore took Ruth, and married her: and went in unto her, and the Lord gave her to conceive, and to bear a son. ¹⁴ And the women said to Noemi: Blessed be the Lord, who hath not suffered thy family to want a successor: that his name should be preserved in Israel. ¹⁵ And thou shouldst have one to comfort thy soul, and cherish thy old age. For he is born of thy daughter in law: who loveth thee: and is much better to thee, than if thou

hadst seven sons. ¹⁶ And Noemi taking the child, laid it in her bosom, and she carried it, and was a nurse unto it. ¹⁷ And the women, her neighbours, congratulating with her, and saying, There is a son born to Noemi, called his name Obed: he is the father of Isai, the father of David.

¹⁸ These are the generations of Phares: Phares begot Esron, ¹⁹ Esron begot Aram, Aram begot Aminadab, ²⁰ Aminadab begot Nahasson, Nahasson begot Salmon, ²¹ Salmon begot Booz, Booz begot Obed, ²² Obed begot Isai, Isai begot David.

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1 and 2 Samuel entire. The Douay-Rheims prints these as the First and Second Books of Kings; this plan uses the modern names, so that Douay 3 and 4 Kings appear in the next period as 1 and 2 Kings. 1 and 2 Paralipomenon (Chronicles) are passed over as a second telling of the same reigns.

131. Anna, and the birth of Samuel

1 Samuel 1:1-28

Douay-Rheims title: the First Book of Samuel, otherwise called the First Book of Kings.

1 ¹ There was a man of Ramathaimsophim, of Mount Ephraim, and his name was Elcana, the son of Jeroham, the son of Eliu, the son of Thohu, the son of Suph, an Ephraimite: ² And he had two wives, the name of one was Anna, and the name of the other Phenenna. Phenenna had children: but Anna had no children. ³ And this man went up out of his city upon the appointed days, to adore and to offer sacrifice to the Lord of hosts in Silo. And the two sons of Heli, Ophni and Phinees, were there priests of the Lord. ⁴ Now the day came, and Elcana offered sacrifice, and gave to Phenenna, his wife, and to all her sons and daughters, portions: ⁵ But to Anna he gave one portion with sorrow, because he loved Anna. And the Lord had shut up her womb. ⁶ Her rival also afflicted her, and troubled her exceedingly, insomuch that she upbraided her, that the Lord had shut up her womb: ⁷ And thus she did every year, when the time returned, that they went up to the temple of the Lord: and thus she provoked her: but Anna wept, and did not eat. ⁸ Then Elcana, her husband, said to her: Anna, why weepest thou? and why dost thou not eat? and why dost thou afflict thy heart? Am not I better to thee than ten children?

⁹ So Anna arose after she had eaten and drunk in Silo: And Heli, the priest, sitting upon a stool before the door of the temple of the Lord; ¹⁰ As Anna had her heart full of grief, she prayed to the Lord, shedding many tears, ¹¹ And she made a vow, saying: O Lord of hosts, if thou wilt look down on the affliction of thy servant, and wilt be mindful of me, and not forget thy handmaid, and wilt give to thy servant a manchild: I will give him to the Lord all the days of his life, and no razor shall come upon his head. ¹² And it came to pass, as she multiplied prayers before the Lord, that Heli observed her mouth. ¹³ Now Anna spoke in her heart, and only her lips moved, but her voice was not heard at all. Heli therefore thought her to be drunk, ¹⁴ And said to her: How long wilt thou be drunk? digest a little the wine, of which thou hast taken too much. ¹⁵ Anna answering, said: Not so, my lord: for I am an exceeding unhappy woman, and have drunk neither wine nor any strong drink, but I have poured out

my soul before the Lord. ¹⁶ Count not thy handmaid for one of the daughters of Belial: for out of the abundance of my sorrow and grief have I spoken till now. ¹⁷ Then Heli said to her: Go in peace: and the God of Israel grant thee thy petition, which thou hast asked of him. ¹⁸ And she said: Would to God thy handmaid may find grace in thy eyes. So the woman went on her way, and ate, and her countenance was no more changed.

¹⁹ And they rose in the morning, and worshipped before the Lord: and they returned, and came into their house at Ramatha. And Elcana knew Anna his wife: And the Lord remembered her. ²⁰ And it came to pass when the time was come about, Anna conceived and bore a son, and called his name Samuel: because she had asked him of the Lord. ²¹ And Elcana, her husband, went up, and all his house, to offer to the Lord the solemn sacrifice, and his vow. ²² But Anna went not up: for she said to her husband: I will not go till the child be weaned, and till I may carry him, that he may appear before the Lord, and may abide always there. ²³ And Elcana, her husband, said to her: Do what seemeth good to thee, and stay till thou wean him: and I pray that the Lord may fulfil his word. So the woman staid at home, and gave her son suck, till she weaned him.

²⁴ And after she had weaned him, she carried him with her, with three calves, and three bushels of flour, and a bottle of wine, and she brought him to the house of the Lord in Silo. Now the child was as yet very young: ²⁵ And they immolated a calf, and offered the child to Heli. ²⁶ And Anna said: I beseech thee, my lord, as thy soul liveth, my lord: I am that woman, who stood before thee here praying to the Lord. ²⁷ For this child did I pray, and the Lord hath granted me my petition, which I asked of him. ²⁸ Therefore I also have lent him to the Lord all the days of his life, he shall be lent to the Lord. And they adored the Lord there. And Anna prayed, and said:

133. The call of Samuel

1 Samuel 3:1-21

³ ¹ Now the child Samuel ministered to the Lord before Heli, and the word of the Lord was precious in those days, there was no manifest vision. ² And it came to pass one day when Heli lay in his place, and his eyes were grown dim, that he could not see: ³ Before the lamp of God went out, Samuel slept in the temple of the Lord, where the ark of God was. ⁴ And the Lord called Samuel. And he answered: Here am I. ⁵ And he ran to Heli, and said: Here am I: for thou didst call me. He said: I did not call: go back and sleep. And he went and slept. ⁶ And the Lord called Samuel again. And Samuel arose and went to Heli, and said: Here am I: for thou calledst me. He answered: I did not call thee, my son: return and sleep. ⁷ Now Samuel did not yet know the Lord, neither had the word of the Lord been revealed to him. ⁸ And the Lord called Samuel again the third time. And he arose up and went to Heli, ⁹ And said: Here am I: for thou didst call me. Then Heli understood that the Lord called the child, and he said to Samuel: Go, and sleep: and if he shall call thee any more, thou shalt say: Speak, Lord, for thy servant heareth. So Samuel went, and slept in his place. ¹⁰ And the Lord came, and stood, and he called, as he had called the other times, Samuel, Samuel. And Samuel said: Speak, Lord, for thy servant heareth.

¹¹ And the Lord said to Samuel: Behold I do a thing in Israel: and whosoever shall hear it, both his ears shall tingle. ¹² In that

day I will raise up against Heli all the things I have spoken concerning his house: I will begin, and I will make an end. ¹³ For I have foretold unto him, that I will judge his house for ever, for iniquity, because he knew that his sons did wickedly, and did not chastise them. ¹⁴ Therefore have I sworn to the house of Heli, that the iniquity of his house shall not be expiated with victims nor offerings for ever.

¹⁵ And Samuel slept till morning, and opened the doors of the house of the Lord. And Samuel feared to tell the vision to Heli. ¹⁶ Then Heli called Samuel, and said: Samuel, my son. And he answered: Here am I. ¹⁷ And he asked him: What is the word that the Lord hath spoken to thee? I beseech thee hide it not from me. May God do so and so to thee, and add so and so, if thou hide from me one word of all that were said to thee. ¹⁸ So Samuel told him all the words, and did not hide them from him. And he answered: It is the Lord: let him do what is good in his sight.

¹⁹ And Samuel grew, and the Lord was with him, and not one of his words fell to the ground. ²⁰ And all Israel, from Dan to Bersabee, knew that Samuel was a faithful prophet of the Lord. ²¹ And the Lord again appeared in Silo, for the Lord revealed himself to Samuel in Silo, according to the word of the Lord. And the word of Samuel came to pass to all Israel.

137. "Give us a king"

1 Samuel 8:1-22

The kingdom is granted as a concession; every later reading in this period is coloured by that.

⁸ ¹ And it came to pass, when Samuel was old, that he appointed his sons to be judges over Israel. ² Now the name of his firstborn son was Joel: and the name of the second was Abia, judges in Bersabee. ³ And his sons walked not in his ways: but they turned aside after lucre, and took bribes, and perverted judgment.

⁴ Then all the ancients of Israel being assembled came to Samuel to Ramatha. ⁵ And they said to him: Behold thou art old, and thy sons walk not in thy ways: make us a king, to judge us, as all nations have. ⁶ And the word was displeasing in the eyes of Samuel, that they should say: Give us a king to judge us. And Samuel prayed to the Lord. ⁷ And the Lord said to Samuel: Hearken to the voice of the people in all that they say to thee. For they have not rejected thee, but me, that I should not reign over them. ⁸ According to all their works, they have done from the day that I brought them out of Egypt until this day: as they have forsaken me, and served strange gods, so do they also unto thee. ⁹ Now, therefore, hearken to their voice: but yet testify to them, and foretell them the right of the king, that shall reign over them.

¹⁰ Then Samuel told all the words of the Lord to the people that had desired a king of him, ¹¹ And said: This will be the right of the king that shall reign over you: He will take your sons, and put them in his chariots, and will make them his horsemen, and his running footmen, to run before his chariots, ¹² And he will appoint of them to be his tribunes, and his centurions, and to plough his fields, and to reap his corn, and to make him arms and chariots. ¹³ Your daughters also he will take to make him ointments, and to be his cooks, and bakers. ¹⁴ And he will take your fields, and your vineyards, and your best oliveyards, and

give them to his servants. ¹⁵ Moreover he will take the tenth of your corn, and of the revenues of your vineyards, to give to his eunuchs and servants. ¹⁶ Your servants also, and handmaids, and your goodliest young men, and your asses, he will take away, and put them to his work. ¹⁷ Your flocks also he will tithe, and you shall be his servants. ¹⁸ And you shall cry out in that day from the face of the king, whom you have chosen to yourselves: and the Lord will not hear you in that day, because you desired unto yourselves a king.

¹⁹ But the people would not hear the voice of Samuel, and they said, Nay: but there shall be a king over us, ²⁰ And we also will be like all nations: and our king shall judge us, and go out before us, and fight our battles for us. ²¹ And Samuel heard all the words of the people, and rehearsed them in the ears of the Lord. ²² And the Lord said to Samuel: Harken to their voice, and make them a king. And Samuel said to the men of Israel: Let every man go to his city.

142. Saul rejected

1 Samuel 15:1-35

"Obedience is better than sacrifices" (15:22).

15 ¹ And Samuel said to Saul: The Lord sent me to anoint thee king over his people Israel: now therefore hearken thou unto the voice of the Lord: ² Thus saith the Lord of hosts: I have reckoned up all that Amalec hath done to Israel: how he opposed them in the way when they came up out of Egypt. ³ Now therefore go, and smite Amalec, and utterly destroy all that he hath: spare him not, nor covet anything that is his: but slay both man and woman, child and suckling, ox and sheep, camel and ass. ⁴ So Saul commanded the people, and numbered them as lambs: two hundred thousand footmen, and ten thousand of the men of Juda. ⁵ And when Saul was come to the city of Amalec, he laid ambushes in the torrent. ⁶ And Saul said to the Cinite: Go, depart, and get ye down from Amalec: lest I destroy thee with him. For thou hast shewn kindness to all the children of Israel, when they came up out of Egypt. And the Cinite departed from the midst of Amalec. ⁷ And Saul smote Amalec from Hevila, until thou comest to Sur, which is over against Egypt. ⁸ And he took Agag, the king of Amalec, alive: but all the common people he slew with the edge of the sword. ⁹ And Saul and the people spared Agag, and the best of the flocks of sheep, and of the herds, and the garments and the rams, and all that was beautiful, and would not destroy them: but every thing that was vile, and good for nothing, that they destroyed.

¹⁰ And the word of the Lord came to Samuel, saying: ¹¹ It repenteth me that I have made Saul king: for he hath forsaken me, and hath not executed my commandments. And Samuel was grieved, and he cried unto the Lord all night. ¹² And when Samuel rose early, to go to Saul in the morning, it was told Samuel that Saul was come to Carmel, and had erected for himself a triumphant arch, and returning had passed on, and gone down to Galgal. And Samuel came to Saul, and Saul was offering a holocaust to the Lord, out of the choicest of the spoils, which he had brought from Amalec. ¹³ And when Samuel was come to Saul, Saul said to him: Blessed be thou of the Lord, I have fulfilled the word of the Lord. ¹⁴ And Samuel said: What meaneth then this bleating of the flocks, which soundeth in my ears, and the

lowing of the herds, which I hear? ¹⁵ And Saul said: They have brought them from Amalec: for the people spared the best of the sheep and of the herds, that they might be sacrificed to the Lord thy God, but the rest we have slain. ¹⁶ And Samuel said to Saul: Suffer me, and I will tell thee what the Lord hath said to me this night. And he said to him: Speak. ¹⁷ And Samuel said: When thou wast a little one in thy own eyes, wast thou not made the head of the tribes of Israel? And the Lord anointed thee to be king over Israel. ¹⁸ And the Lord sent thee on the way, and said: Go, and kill the sinners of Amalec, and thou shalt fight against them until thou hast utterly destroyed them. ¹⁹ Why then didst thou not hearken to the voice of the Lord: but hast turned to the prey, and hast done evil in the eyes of the Lord? ²⁰ And Saul said to Samuel: Yea, I have hearkened to the voice of the Lord, and have walked in the way by which the Lord sent me, and have brought Agag, the king of Amalec, and Amalec I have slain. ²¹ But the people took of the spoils, sheep and oxen, as the firstfruits of those things that were slain, to offer sacrifice to the Lord their God in Galgal. ²² And Samuel said: Doth the Lord desire holocausts and victims, and not rather that the voice of the Lord should be obeyed? For obedience is better than sacrifices: and to hearken rather than to offer the fat of rams. ²³ Because it is like the sin of witchcraft, to rebel: and like the crime of idolatry, to refuse to obey. Forasmuch, therefore, as thou hast rejected the word of the Lord, the Lord hath also rejected thee from being king.

²⁴ And Saul said to Samuel: I have sinned, because I have transgressed the commandment of the Lord, and thy words, fearing the people, and obeying their voice. ²⁵ But now bear, I beseech thee, my sin, and return with me, that I may adore the Lord. ²⁶ And Samuel said to Saul: I will not return with thee, because thou hast rejected the word of the Lord, and the Lord hath rejected thee from being king over Israel. ²⁷ And Samuel turned about to go away: but he laid hold upon the skirt of his mantle, and it rent. ²⁸ And Samuel said to him: The Lord hath rent the kingdom of Israel from thee this day, and hath given it to thy neighbour who is better than thee. ²⁹ But the triumph in Israel will not spare, and will not be moved to repentance: for he is not a man that he should repent. ³⁰ Then he said: I have sinned: yet honour me now before the ancients of my people, and before Israel, and return with me, that I may adore the Lord thy God. ³¹ So Samuel turned again after Saul: and Saul adored the Lord. ³² And Samuel said: Bring hither to me Agag, the king of Amalec. And Agag was presented to him very fat, and trembling. And Agag said: Doth bitter death separate in this manner? ³³ And Samuel said: As thy sword hath made women childless, so shall thy mother be childless among women. And Samuel hewed him in pieces before the Lord in Galgal.

³⁴ And Samuel departed to Ramatha: but Saul went up to his house in Gabaa. ³⁵ And Samuel saw Saul no more till the day of his death: nevertheless, Samuel mourned for Saul, because the Lord repented that he had made him king over Israel.

143. David anointed

1 Samuel 16:1-23

16 ¹ And the Lord said to Samuel: How long wilt thou mourn for Saul, whom I have rejected from reigning over Israel? fill thy horn with oil, and come, that I may send thee to Isai, the

Bethlehemite: for I have provided me a king among his sons. ² And Samuel said: How shall I go? for Saul will hear of it, and he will kill me. And the Lord said: Thou shalt take with thee a calf of the herd, and thou shalt say: I am come to sacrifice to the Lord. ³ And thou shalt call Isai to the sacrifice, and I will shew thee what thou art to do, and thou shalt anoint him whom I shall shew to thee. ⁴ Then Samuel did as the Lord had said to him. And he came to Bethlehem, and the ancients of the city wondered, and meeting him, they said: Is thy coming hither peaceable? ⁵ And he said: It is peaceable: I am come to offer sacrifice to the Lord, be ye sanctified, and come with me to the sacrifice. And he sanctified Isai and his sons, and called them to the sacrifice. ⁶ And when they were come in, he saw Eliab, and said: Is the Lord's anointed before him? ⁷ And the Lord said to Samuel: Look not on his countenance, nor on the height of his stature: because I have rejected him, nor do I judge according to the look of man: for man seeth those things that appear, but the Lord beholdeth the heart. ⁸ And Isai called Abinadab, and brought him before Samuel. And he said: Neither hath the Lord chosen this, ⁹ And Isai brought Samma, and he said of him: Neither hath the Lord chosen this. ¹⁰ Isai therefore brought his seven sons before Samuel: and Samuel said to Isai: The Lord hath not chosen any one of these. ¹¹ And Samuel said to Isai: Are here all thy sons? He answered: There remaineth yet a young one, who keepeth the sheep. And Samuel said to Isai: Send, and fetch him: for we will not sit down till he come hither. ¹² He sent therefore and brought him. Now he was ruddy and beautiful to behold, and of a comely face. And the Lord said: Arise, and anoint him, for this is he. ¹³ Then Samuel took the horn of oil, and anointed him in the midst of his brethren: and the Spirit of the Lord came upon David from that day forward: and Samuel rose up, and went to Ramatha. ¹⁴ But the Spirit of the Lord departed from Saul, and an evil spirit from the Lord troubled him. ¹⁵ And the servants of Saul said to him: Behold now an evil spirit from God troubleth thee. ¹⁶ Let our lord give orders, and thy servants who are before thee, will seek out a man skilful in playing on the harp, that when the evil spirit from the Lord is upon thee, he may play with his hand, and thou mayst bear it more easily. ¹⁷ And Saul said to his servants: Provide me then some man that can play well, and bring him to me. ¹⁸ And one of the servants answering, said: Behold I have seen a son of Isai, the Bethlehemite, a skilful player, and one of great strength, and a man fit for war, and prudent in his words, and a comely person: and the Lord is with him.

¹⁹ Then Saul sent messengers to Isai, saying: Send me David, thy son, who is in the pastures. ²⁰ And Isai took an ass laden with bread, and a bottle of wine, and a kid of the flock, and sent them by the hand of David, his son, to Saul. ²¹ And David came to Saul, and stood before him: and he loved him exceedingly, and made him his armourbearer. ²² And Saul sent to Isai, saying: Let David stand before me: for he hath found favour in my sight. ²³ So whensoever the evil spirit from the Lord was upon Saul, David took his harp, and played with his hand, and Saul was refreshed, and was better, for the evil spirit departed from him.

144. David and Goliath

1 Samuel 17:1-58

17 ¹ Now the Philistines gathering together their troops to battle, assembled at Socho of Juda: and camped between Socho and Azeca, in the borders of Dommim. ² And Saul and the children of Israel being gathered together, came to the valley of Terebinth, and they set the army in array to fight against the Philistines. ³ And the Philistines stood on a mountain on the one side, and Israel stood on a mountain on the other side: and there was a valley between them. ⁴ And there went out a man baseborn from the camp of the Philistines, named Goliath, of Geth, whose height was six cubits and a span: ⁵ And he had a helmet of brass upon his head, and he was clothed with a coat of mail with scales, and the weight of his coat of mail was five thousand sicles of brass: ⁶ And he had greaves of brass on his legs, and a buckler of brass covered his shoulders. ⁷ And the staff of his spear was like a weaver's beam, and the head of his spear weighed six hundred sicles of iron: and his armourbearer went before him. ⁸ And standing, he cried out to the bands of Israel, and said to them: Why are you come out prepared to fight? am not I a Philistine, and you the servants of Saul? Choose out a man of you, and let him come down and fight hand to hand. ⁹ If he be able to fight with me, and kill me, we will be servants to you: but if I prevail against him, and kill him, you shall be servants, and shall serve us. ¹⁰ And the Philistine said: I have defied the bands of Israel this day: give me a man, and let him fight with me hand to hand. ¹¹ And Saul and all the Israelites hearing these words of the Philistine, were dismayed, and greatly afraid. ¹² Now David was the son of that Ephrathite, of Bethlehem Juda, before mentioned, whose name was Isai, who had eight sons, and was an old man in the days of Saul, and of great age among men. ¹³ And his three eldest sons followed Saul to the battle: and the names of his three sons that went to the battle, were Eliab, the firstborn, and the second, Abinadab, and the third Samma: ¹⁴ But David was the youngest. So the three eldest having followed Saul, ¹⁵ David went, and returned from Saul, to feed his father's flock at Bethlehem. ¹⁶ Now the Philistine came out morning and evening, and presented himself forty days. ¹⁷ And Isai said to David, his son: Take for thy brethren an ephi of frumenty, and these ten loaves, and run to the camp to thy brethren, ¹⁸ And carry these ten little cheeses to the tribune: and go see thy brethren, if they are well: and learn with whom they are placed. ¹⁹ But Saul, and they, and all the children of Israel, were in the valley of Terebinth, fighting against the Philistines.

²⁰ David, therefore, arose in the morning, and gave the charge of the flock to the keeper: and went away loaded, as Isai had commanded him. And he came to the place of Magala, and to the army, which was going out to fight, and shouted for the battle. ²¹ For Israel had put themselves in array, and the Philistines who stood against them were prepared. ²² And David leaving the vessels which he had brought, under the care of the keeper of the baggage, ran to the place of the battle, and asked if all things went well with his brethren. ²³ And as he talked with them, that baseborn man, whose name was Goliath, the Philistine, of Geth, shewed himself coming up from the camp of the Philistines: and he spoke according to the same words, and David heard them, ²⁴ And all the Israelites, when they saw the man, fled from his

face, fearing him exceedingly. ²⁵ And some one of Israel said: Have you seen this man that is come up, for he is come up to defy Israel. And the man that shall slay him, the king will enrich with great riches, and will give him his daughter, and will make his father's house free from tribute in Israel. ²⁶ And David spoke to the men that stood by him, saying: What shall be given to the man that shall kill this Philistine, and shall take away the reproach from Israel? for who is this uncircumcised Philistine, that he should defy the armies of the living God? ²⁷ And the people answered him the same words, saying: These things shall be given to the man that shall slay him.

²⁸ Now when Eliab his eldest brother heard this, when he was speaking with others, he was angry with David, and said: Why camest thou hither? and why didst thou leave those few sheep in the desert? I know thy pride, and the wickedness of thy heart: that thou art come down to see the battle. ²⁹ And David said: What have I done? is there not cause to speak? ³⁰ And he turned a little aside from him to another: and said the same word. And the people answered him as before. ³¹ And the words which David spoke were heard, and were rehearsed before Saul. ³² And when he was brought to Saul, he said to him. Let not any man's heart be dismayed in him: I thy servant will go, and will fight against the Philistine. ³³ And Saul said to David: Thou art not able to withstand this Philistine, nor to fight against him: for thou art but a boy, but he is a warrior from his youth. ³⁴ And David said to Saul: Thy servant kept his father's sheep, and there came a lion, or a bear, and took a ram out of the midst of the flock: ³⁵ And I pursued after them, and struck them, and delivered it out of their mouth: and they rose up against me, and I caught them by the throat, and I strangled, and killed them. ³⁶ For I thy servant have killed both a lion and a bear: and this uncircumcised Philistine shall be also as one of them. I will go now, and take away the reproach of the people: for who is this uncircumcised Philistine, who hath dared to curse the army of the living God? ³⁷ And David said: The Lord who delivered me out of the paw of the lion, and out of the paw of the bear, he will deliver me out of the hand of this Philistine. And Saul said to David: Go, and the Lord be with thee.

³⁸ And Saul clothed David with his garments, and put a helmet of brass upon his head, and armed him with a coat of mail. ³⁹ And David having girded his sword upon his armour, began to try if he could walk in armour: for he was not accustomed to it. And David said to Saul: I cannot go thus, for I am not used to it. And he laid them off,

⁴⁰ And he took his staff, which he had always in his hands: and chose him five smooth stones out of the brook, and put them into the shepherd's scrip, which he had with him, and he took a sling in his hand, and went forth against the Philistine. ⁴¹ And the Philistine came on, and drew nigh against David, and his armourbearer went before him. ⁴² And when the Philistine looked, and beheld David, he despised him. For he was a young man, ruddy, and of a comely countenance. ⁴³ And the Philistine said to David: Am I a dog, that thou comest to me with a staff? And the Philistine cursed David by his gods. ⁴⁴ And he said to David: Come to me, and I will give thy flesh to the birds of the air, and to the beasts of the earth. ⁴⁵ And David said to the Philistine: Thou comest to me with a sword, and with a spear, and with a

shield: but I come to thee in the name of the Lord of hosts, the God of the armies of Israel, which thou hast defied. ⁴⁶ This day, and the Lord will deliver thee into my hand, and I will slay thee, and take away thy head from thee: and I will give the carcasses of the army of the Philistines this day to the birds of the air, and to the beasts of the earth: that all the earth may know that there is a God in Israel. ⁴⁷ And all this assembly shall know that the Lord saveth not with sword and spear: for it is his battle, and he will deliver you into our hands.

⁴⁸ And when the Philistine arose, and was coming, and drew nigh to meet David, David made haste, and ran to the fight to meet the Philistine. ⁴⁹ And he put his hand into his scrip, and took a stone, and cast it with the sling, and fetching it about, struck the Philistine in the forehead: and the stone was fixed in his forehead, and he fell on his face upon the earth. ⁵⁰ And David prevailed over the Philistine, with a sling and a stone, and he struck, and slew the Philistine. And as David had no sword in his hand, ⁵¹ He ran, and stood over the Philistine, and took his sword, and drew it out of the sheath, and slew him, and cut off his head. And the Philistines seeing that their champion was dead, fled away. ⁵² And the men of Israel and Juda rising up shouted, and pursued after the Philistines till they came to the valley and to the gates of Accaron, and there fell many wounded of the Philistines in the way of Saraim, and as far as Geth, and as far as Accaron. ⁵³ And the children of Israel returning, after they had pursued the Philistines, fell upon their camp. ⁵⁴ And David taking the head of the Philistine, brought it to Jerusalem: but his armour he put in his tent. ⁵⁵ Now at the time that Saul saw David going out against the Philistines, he said to Abner, the captain of the army: Of what family is this young man descended, Abner? And Abner said: As thy soul liveth, O king, I know not. ⁵⁶ And the king said: Inquire thou, whose son this young man is. ⁵⁷ And when David was returned, after the Philistine was slain, Abner took him, and brought him in before Saul, with the head of the Philistine in his hand. ⁵⁸ And Saul said to him: Young man, of what family art thou? And David said: I am the son of thy servant Isai the Bethlehemite.

153. The death of Saul on Gelboe

1 Samuel 31:1-13

31 ¹ And the Philistines fought against Israel, and the men of Israel fled from before the Philistines, and fell down slain in mount Gelboe. ² And the Philistines fell upon Saul, and upon his sons, and they slew Jonathan, and Abinadab, and Melchisua, the sons of Saul. ³ And the whole weight of the battle was turned upon Saul: and the archers overtook him, and he was grievously wounded by the archers. ⁴ Then Saul said to his armourbearer: Draw thy sword, and kill me: lest these uncircumcised come, and slay me, and mock at me. And his armourbearer would not: for he was struck with exceeding great fear. Then Saul took his sword, and fell upon it. ⁵ And when his armourbearer saw this, to wit, that Saul was dead, he also fell upon his sword and died with him. ⁶ So Saul died, and his three sons, and his armourbearer, and all his men that same day together.

⁷ And the men of Israel, that were beyond the valley, and beyond the Jordan, seeing that the Israelites were fled, and that Saul was dead, and his sons, forsook their cities, and fled: and the Philistines came and dwelt there. ⁸ And on the morrow the

Philistines came to strip the slain, and they found Saul and his three sons lying in mount Gelboe. ⁹ And they cut off Saul's head, and stripped him of his armour, and sent into the land of the Philistines round about, to publish it in the temples of their idols and among their people. ¹⁰ And they put his armour in the temple of Astaroth, but his body they hung on the wall of Bethsan. ¹¹ Now when the inhabitants of Jabes Galaad had heard all that the Philistines had done to Saul, ¹² All the most valiant men arose, and walked all the night, and took the body of Saul, and the bodies of his sons, from the wall of Bethsan: and they came to Jabes Galaad, and burnt them there. ¹³ And they took their bones, and buried them in the wood of Jabes: and fasted seven days.

156. King over all Israel; Jerusalem taken

2 Samuel 5:1-25

⁵ ¹ Then all the tribes of Israel came to David in Hebron, saying: Behold we are thy bone and thy flesh. ² Moreover yesterday also and the day before, when Saul was king over us, thou wast he that did lead out and bring in Israel: and the Lord said to thee: Thou shalt feed my people Israel, and thou shalt be prince over Israel. ³ The ancients also of Israel came to the king of Hebron, and king David made a league with them in Hebron before the Lord: and they anointed David to be king over Israel.

⁴ David was thirty years old when he began to reign, and he reigned forty years. ⁵ In Hebron he reigned over Juda seven years and six months: and in Jerusalem he reigned three and thirty years over all Israel and Juda.

⁶ And the king and all the men that were with him went to Jerusalem to the Jebusites the inhabitants of the land: and they said to David: Thou shalt not come in hither unless thou take away the blind and the lame that say: David shall not come in hither. ⁷ But David took the castle of Sion, the same is the city of David. ⁸ For David had offered that day a reward to whosoever should strike the Jebusites and get up to the gutters of the tops of the houses, and take away the blind and the lame that hated the soul of David: therefore it is said in the proverb: The blind and the lame shall not come into the temple. ⁹ And David dwelt in the castle, and called it, The city of David: and built round about from Mello and inwards. ¹⁰ And he went on prospering and growing up, and the Lord God of hosts was with him. ¹¹ And Hiram the king of Tyre sent messengers to David, and cedar trees, and carpenters, and masons for walls: and they built a house for David. ¹² And David knew that the Lord had confirmed him king over Israel, and that he had exalted his kingdom over his people Israel.

¹³ And David took more concubines and wives of Jerusalem, after he was come from Hebron: and there were born to David other sons also and daughters: ¹⁴ And these are the names of them, that were born to him in Jerusalem, Samua, and Sobab, and Nathan, and Solomon, ¹⁵ And Jebahar, and Elisua, and Nepheg, ¹⁶ And Japhia, and Elisama, and Elioda, and Eliphaeth.

¹⁷ And the Philistines heard that they had anointed David to be king over Israel: and they all came to seek David: and when David heard of it, he went down to a strong hold. ¹⁸ And the Philistines coming spread themselves in the valley of Raphaim. ¹⁹ And David consulted the Lord, saying: Shall I go up to the Philistines? and wilt thou deliver them into my hand? And the

Lord said to David: Go up, for I will surely deliver the Philistines into thy hand. ²⁰ And David came to Baal Pharisim: and defeated them there, and he said, The Lord hath divided my enemies before me, as waters are divided. Therefore the name of the place was called Baal Pharisim. ²¹ And they left there their idols: which David and his men took away.

²² And the Philistines came up again and spread themselves into the valley of Raphaim. ²³ And David consulted the Lord: Shall I go up against the Philistines, and wilt thou deliver them into my hands? He answered: Go not up against them but fetch a compass behind them, and thou shalt come upon them over against the pear trees. ²⁴ And when thou shalt hear the sound of one going in the tops of the pear trees, then shalt thou join battle: for then will the Lord go out before thy face to strike the army of the Philistines. ²⁵ And David did as the Lord had commanded him, and he smote the Philistines from Gabaa until thou come to Gezer.

158. "Thy house shall be faithful for ever"

2 Samuel 7:1-29

The Davidic covenant. The angel's words at the Annunciation, read later in this plan, are its direct answer.

⁷ ¹ And it came to pass when the king sat in his house, and the Lord had given him rest on every side from all his enemies, ² He said to Nathan the prophet: Dost thou see that I dwell in a house of cedar, and the ark of God is lodged within skins? ³ And Nathan said to the king: Go, do all that is in thy heart: because the Lord is with thee.

⁴ But it came to pass that night, that the word of the Lord came to Nathan, saying: ⁵ Go, and say to my servant David: Thus saith the Lord: Shalt thou build me a house to dwell in? ⁶ Whereas I have not dwelt in a house from the day that I brought the children of Israel out of the land of Egypt even to this day: but have walked in a tabernacle, and in a tent. ⁷ In all the places that I have gone through with all the children of Israel, did ever I speak a word to any one of the tribes of Israel, whom I commanded to feed my people Israel, saying: Why have you not built me a house of cedar? ⁸ And now thus shalt thou speak to my servant David: Thus saith the Lord of hosts: I took thee out of the pastures from following the sheep to be ruler over my people Israel: ⁹ And I have been with thee wheresoever thou hast walked, and have slain all thy enemies from before thy face: and I have made thee a great man, like unto the name of the great ones that are on the earth. ¹⁰ And I will appoint a place for my people Israel, and I will plant them, and they shall dwell therein, and shall be disturbed no more: neither shall the children of iniquity afflict them any more as they did before, ¹¹ From the day that I appointed judges over my people Israel: and I will give thee rest from all thy enemies. And the Lord foretelleth to thee, that the Lord will make thee a house. ¹² And when thy days shall be fulfilled, and thou shalt sleep with thy fathers, I will raise up thy seed after thee, which shall proceed out of thy bowels, and I will establish his kingdom. ¹³ He shall build a house to my name, and I will establish the throne of his kingdom for ever. ¹⁴ I will be to him a father, and he shall be to me a son: and if he commit any iniquity, I will correct him with the rod of men, and with the stripes of the children of men. ¹⁵ But my mercy I will not

take away from him, as I took it from Saul, whom I removed from before my face. ¹⁶ And thy house shall be faithful, and thy kingdom for ever before thy face, and thy throne shall be firm for ever. ¹⁷ According to all these words and according to all this vision so did Nathan speak to David.

¹⁸ And David went in, and sat before the Lord, and said: Who am I, O Lord God, and what is my house, that thou hast brought me thus far? ¹⁹ But yet this hath seemed little in thy sight, O Lord God, unless thou didst also speak of the house of thy servant for a long time to come: for this is the law of Adam, O Lord God: ²⁰ And what can David say more unto thee? for thou knowest thy servant, O Lord God: ²¹ For thy word's sake, and according to thy own heart thou has done all these great things, so that thou wouldst make it known to thy servant. ²² Therefore thou art magnified, O Lord God, because there is none like to thee, neither is there any God besides thee, in all the things that we have heard with our ears. ²³ And what nation is there upon earth, as thy people Israel, whom God went to redeem for a people to himself, and to make him a name, and to do for them great and terrible things, upon the earth, before the face of thy people, whom thou redeemedst to thyself out of Egypt, from the nations and their gods. ²⁴ For thou hast confirmed to thyself thy people Israel to be an everlasting people: and thou, O Lord God, art become their God. ²⁵ And now, O Lord God, raise up for ever the word that thou hast spoken, concerning thy servant and concerning his house: and do as thou hast spoken, ²⁶ That thy name may be magnified for ever, and it may be said: The Lord of hosts is God over Israel. And the house of thy servant David shall be established before the Lord. ²⁷ Because thou, O Lord of hosts, God of Israel, hast revealed to the ear of thy servant, saying: I will build thee a house: therefore hath thy servant found in his heart to pray this prayer to thee. ²⁸ And now, O Lord God, thou art God, and thy words shall be true: for thou hast spoken to thy servant these good things. ²⁹ And now begin, and bless the house of thy servant, that it may endure for ever before thee: because thou, O Lord God, hast spoken it, and with thy blessing let the house of thy servant be blessed for ever.

160. David and Bethsabee

2 Samuel 11:1-27

11 ¹ And it came to pass at the return of the year, at the time when kings go forth to war, that David sent Joab and his servants with him, and all Israel, and they spoiled the children of Ammon, and besieged Rabba: but David remained in Jerusalem. ² In the mean time it happened that David arose from his bed after noon, and walked upon the roof of the king's house: And he saw from the roof of his house a woman washing herself, over against him: and the woman was very beautiful. ³ And the king sent, and inquired who the woman was. And it was told him, that she was Bethsabee the daughter of Eliam, the wife of Urias the Hethite. ⁴ And David sent messengers, and took her, and she came in to him, and he slept with her: and presently she was purified from her uncleanness: ⁵ And she returned to her house having conceived. And she sent and told David, and said: I have conceived.

⁶ And David sent to Joab, saying: Send me Urias the Hethite. And Joab sent Urias to David. ⁷ And Urias came to David. And David asked how Joab did, and the people, and how the war was

carried on. ⁸ And David said to Urias: Go into thy house, and wash thy feet. And Urias went out from the king's house, and there went out after him a mess of meat from the king. ⁹ But Urias slept before the gate of the king's house, with the other servants of his lord, and went not down to his own house. ¹⁰ And it was told David by some that said: Urias went not to his house. And David said to Urias: Didst thou not come from thy journey? why didst thou not go down to thy house? ¹¹ And Urias said to David: The ark of God and Israel and Juda dwell in tents, and my lord Joab and the servants of my lord abide upon the face of the earth: and shall I go into my house, to eat and to drink, and to sleep with my wife? By thy welfare and by the welfare of thy soul I will not do this thing. ¹² Then David said to Urias: Tarry here to day, and to morrow I will send thee away. Urias tarried in Jerusalem that day and the next. ¹³ And David called him to eat and to drink before him, and he made him drunk: and he went out in the evening, and slept on his couch with the servants of his lord, and went not down into his house. ¹⁴ And when the morning was come, David wrote a letter to Joab: and sent it by the hand of Urias, ¹⁵ Writing in the letter: Set ye Urias in the front of the battle, where the fight is strongest: and leave ye him, that he may be wounded and die. ¹⁶ Wherefore as Joab was besieging the city, he put Urias in the place where he knew the bravest men were. ¹⁷ And the men coming out of the city, fought against Joab, and there fell some of the people of the servants of David, and Urias the Hethite was killed also. ¹⁸ Then Joab sent, and told David all things concerning the battle. ¹⁹ And he charged the messenger, saying: When thou hast told all the words of the battle to the king, ²⁰ If thou see him to be angry, and he shall say: Why did you approach so near to the wall to fight? knew you not that many darts are thrown from above off the wall? ²¹ Who killed Abimelech the son of Jerobaal? did not a woman cast a piece of a millstone upon him from the wall and slew him in Thebes? Why did you go near the wall? Thou shalt say: Thy servant Urias the Hethite is also slain.

²² So the messenger departed, and came and told David all that Joab had commanded him. ²³ And the messenger said to David: The men prevailed against us, and they came out to us into the field: and we vigorously charged and pursued them even to the gate of the city. ²⁴ And the archers shot their arrows at thy servants from off the wall above: and some of the king's servants are slain, and thy servant Urias the Hethite is also dead. ²⁵ And David said to the messenger: Thus shalt thou say to Joab: Let not this thing discourage thee: for various is the event of war: and sometimes one, sometimes another is consumed by the sword: encourage thy warriors against the city, and exhort them that thou mayest overthrow it.

²⁶ And the wife of Urias heard that Urias her husband was dead, and she mourned for him. ²⁷ And the mourning being over, David sent and brought her into his house, and she became his wife, and she bore him a son: and this thing which David had done, was displeasing to the Lord.

161. Nathan's parable

2 Samuel 12:1-31

12 ¹ And the Lord sent Nathan to David: and when he was come to him, he said to him: There were two men in one city, the one rich, and the other poor. ² The rich man had exceeding many

sheep and oxen. ³ But the poor man had nothing at all but one little ewe lamb, which he had bought and nourished up, and which had grown up in his house together with his children, eating of his bread, and drinking of his cup, and sleeping in his bosom: and it was unto him as a daughter. ⁴ And when a certain stranger was come to the rich man, he spared to take of his own sheep and oxen, to make a feast for that stranger, who was come to him, but took the poor man's ewe, and dressed it for the man that was come to him. ⁵ And David's anger being exceedingly kindled against that man, he said to Nathan: As the Lord liveth, the man that hath done this is a child of death. ⁶ He shall restore the ewe fourfold, because he did this thing, and had no pity.

⁷ And Nathan said to David: Thou art the man. Thus saith the Lord the God of Israel: I anointed thee king over Israel, and I delivered thee from the hand of Saul, ⁸ And gave thee thy master's house and thy master's wives into thy bosom, and gave thee the house of Israel and Juda: and if these things be little, I shall add far greater things unto thee. ⁹ Why therefore hast thou despised the word of the Lord, to do evil in my sight? Thou hast killed Urias the Hethite with the sword, and hast taken his wife to be thy wife, and hast slain him with the sword of the children of Ammon. ¹⁰ Therefore the sword shall never depart from thy house, because thou hast despised me, and hast taken the wife of Urias the Hethite to be thy wife. ¹¹ Thus saith the Lord: Behold, I will raise up evil against thee out of thy own house, and I will take thy wives before thy eyes and give them to thy neighbour, and he shall lie with thy wives in the sight of this sun. ¹² For thou didst it secretly: but I will do this thing in the sight of all Israel, and in the sight of the sun. ¹³ And David said to Nathan: I have sinned against the Lord. And Nathan said to David: The Lord also hath taken away thy sin: thou shalt not die. ¹⁴ Nevertheless, because thou hast given occasion to the enemies of the Lord to blaspheme, for this thing, the child that is born to thee, shall surely die. ¹⁵ And Nathan returned to his house. The Lord also struck the child which the wife of Urias had borne to David, and his life was despaired of. ¹⁶ And David besought the Lord for the child: and David kept a fast, and going in by himself lay upon the ground. ¹⁷ And the ancients of his house came, to make him rise from the ground: but he would not, neither did he eat meat with them. ¹⁸ And it came to pass on the seventh day that the child died: and the servants of David feared to tell him, that the child was dead. For they said: Behold when the child was yet alive, we spoke to him, and he would not hearken to our voice: how much more will he afflict himself if we tell him that the child is dead? ¹⁹ But when David saw his servants whispering, he understood that the child was dead: and he said to his servants: Is the child dead? They answered him He is dead. ²⁰ Then David arose from the ground, and washed and anointed himself: and when he had changed his apparel, he went into the house of the Lord: and worshipped, and then he came into his own house, and he called for bread, and ate. ²¹ And his servants said to him: What thing is this that thou hast done? thou didst fast and weep for the child, while it was alive, but when the child was dead, thou didst rise up, and eat bread. ²² And he said: While the child was yet alive, I fasted and wept for him: for I said: Who knoweth whether the Lord may not give him to me, and the child may live? ²³ But now that he

is dead, why should I fast? Shall I be able to bring him back any more? I shall go to him rather: but he shall not return to me.

²⁴ And David comforted Bethsabee his wife, and went in unto her, and slept with her: and she bore a son, and he called his name Solomon, and the Lord loved him. ²⁵ And he sent by the hand of Nathan the prophet, and called his name, Amiable to the Lord, because the Lord loved him.

²⁶ And Joab fought against Rabbath of the children of Ammon, and laid close siege to the royal city. ²⁷ And Joab sent messengers to David, saying: I have fought against Rabbath, and the city of waters is about to be taken. ²⁸ Now therefore gather thou the rest of the people together, and besiege the city and take it: lest when the city shall be wasted by me, the victory be ascribed to my name. ²⁹ Then David gathered all the people together, and went out against Rabbath: and after fighting, he took it. ³⁰ And he took the crown of their king from his head, the weight of which was a talent of gold, set with most precious stones, and it was put upon David's head, and the spoils of the city which were very great he carried away. ³¹ And bringing forth the people thereof he sawed them, and drove over them chariots armed with iron: and divided them with knives, and made them pass through brickkilns: so did he to all the cities of the children of Ammon: and David returned, with all the army to Jerusalem.

164. The revolt of Absalom

2 Samuel 15:1-37

15 ¹ Now after these things Absalom made himself chariots, and horsemen, and fifty men to run before him. ² And Absalom rising up early stood by the entrance of the gate, and when any man had business to come to the king's judgment, Absalom called him to him, and said: Of what city art thou? He answered, and said: Thy servant is of such tribe of Israel. ³ And Absalom answered him: Thy words seem to me good and just. But there is no man appointed by the king to hear thee. And Absalom said: ⁴ O that they would make me judge over the land, that all that have business might come to me, that I might do them justice. ⁵ Moreover when any man came to him to salute him, he put forth his hand, and took him, and kissed him. ⁶ And this he did to all Israel that came for judgment, to be heard by the king, and he enticed the hearts of the men of Israel.

⁷ And after forty years, Absalom said to king David: Let me go, and pay my vows which I have vowed to the Lord in Hebron. ⁸ For thy servant made a vow, when he was in Gessur of Syria, saying: If the Lord shall bring me again into Jerusalem, I will offer sacrifice to the Lord. ⁹ And king David said to him: Go in peace. And he arose, and went to Hebron.

¹⁰ And Absalom sent spies into all the tribes of Israel, saying: As soon as you shall hear the sound of the trumpet, say ye: Absalom reigneth in Hebron. ¹¹ Now there went with Absalom two hundred men out of Jerusalem that were called, going with simplicity of heart, and knowing nothing of the design. ¹² Absalom also sent for Achitophel the Gilonite, David's counsellor, from his city Gilo. And while he was offering sacrifices, there was a strong conspiracy, and the people running together increased with Absalom. ¹³ And there came a messenger to David, saying: All Israel with their whole heart followeth Absalom. ¹⁴ And David said to his servants, that were with him in Jerusalem: Arise and let us flee: for we shall not escape else from the face

of Absalom: make haste to go out, lest he come and overtake us, and bring ruin upon us, and smite the city with the edge of the sword. ¹⁵ And the king's servants said to him: Whatsoever our lord the king shall command, we thy servants will willingly execute. ¹⁶ And the king went forth, and all his household on foot: and the king left ten women his concubines to keep the house: ¹⁷ And the king going forth and all Israel on foot, stood afar off from the house: ¹⁸ And all his servants walked by him, and the bands of the Cerethi, and the Phelethi, and all the Gethites, valiant warriors, six hundred men who had followed him from Geth on foot, went before the king.

¹⁹ And the king said to Ethai the Gethite: Why comest thou with us: return and dwell with the king, for thou art a stranger, and art come out of thy own place. ²⁰ Yesterday thou camest, and to day shalt thou be forced to go forth with us? but I shall go whither I am going: return thou, and take back thy brethren with thee, and the Lord will shew thee mercy, and truth, because thou hast shewn grace and fidelity. ²¹ And Ethai answered the king, saying: As the Lord liveth, and as my lord the king liveth: in what place soever thou shalt be, my lord, O king, either in death, or in life, there will thy servant be. ²² And David said to Ethai: Come, and pass over. And Ethai the Gethite passed, and all the men that were with him, and the rest of the people. ²³ And they all wept with a loud voice, and all the people passed over: the king also himself went over the brook Cedron, and all the people marched towards the way that looketh to the desert. ²⁴ And Sadoc the priest also came, and all the Levites with him carrying the ark of the covenant of God, and they set down the ark of God: and Abiathar went up, till all the people that was come out of the city had done passing. ²⁵ And the king said to Sadoc: Carry back the ark of God into the city: if I shall find grace in the sight of the Lord, he will bring me again, and he will shew me it, and his tabernacle. ²⁶ But if he shall say to me: Thou pleasest me not: I am ready, let him do that which is good before him. ²⁷ And the king said to Sadoc the priest: O seer, return into the city in peace: and let Achimaas thy son, and Jonathan the son of Abiathar, your two sons, be with you. ²⁸ Behold I will lie hid in the plains of the wilderness, till there come word from you to certify me. ²⁹ So Sadoc and Abiathar carried back the ark of God into Jerusalem: and they tarried there. ³⁰ But David went up by the ascent of mount Olivet, going up and weeping, walking barefoot, and with his head covered, and all the people that were with them, went up with their heads covered weeping.

³¹ And it was told David that Achitophel also was in the conspiracy with Absalom, and David said: Infatuate, O Lord, I beseech thee, the counsel of Achitophel.

³² And when David was come to the top of the mountain, where he was about to adore the Lord, behold Chusai the Arachite, came to meet him with his garment rent and his head covered with earth. ³³ And David said to him: If thou come with me, thou wilt be a burden to me: ³⁴ But if thou return into the city, and wilt say to Absalom: I am thy servant, O king: as I have been thy father's servant, so I will be thy servant: thou shalt defeat the counsel of Achitophel. ³⁵ And thou hast with thee Sadoc, and Abiathar the priests: and what thing soever thou shalt hear out of the king's house, thou shalt tell it to Sadoc and Abiathar the priests. ³⁶ And there are with them their two sons

Achimaas; the son of Sadoc, and Jonathan the son of Abiathar: and you shall send by them to me every thing that you shall hear. ³⁷ Then Chusai the friend of David went into the city, and Absalom came into Jerusalem.

166. The death of Absalom

2 Samuel 18:1-33

18 ¹ And David, having reviewed his people, appointed over them captains of thousands and of hundreds, ² And sent forth a third part of the people under the hand of Joab, and a third part under the hand of Abisai the son of Sarvia Joab's brother, and a third part under the hand of Ethai, who was of Geth: and the king said to the people: I also will go forth with you. ³ And the people answered: Thou shalt not go forth: for if we flee away, they will not much mind us: or if half of us should fall, they will not greatly care: for thou alone art accounted for ten thousand: it is better therefore that thou shouldst be in the city to succour us. ⁴ And the king said to them: What seemeth good to you, that will I do. And the king stood by the gate: and all the people went forth by their troops, by hundreds and by thousands. ⁵ And the king commanded Joab, and Abisai, and Ethai, saying: Save me the boy Absalom. And all the people heard the king giving charge to all the princes concerning Absalom.

⁶ So the people went out into the field against Israel, and the battle was fought in the forest of Ephraim. ⁷ And the people of Israel were defeated there by David's army, and a great slaughter was made that day of twenty thousand men. ⁸ And the battle there was scattered over the face of all the country, and there were many more of the people whom the forest consumed, than whom the sword devoured that day.

⁹ And it happened that Absalom met the servants of David, riding on a mule: and as the mule went under a thick and large oak, his head stuck in the oak: and while he hung between the heaven and the earth, the mule on which he rode passed on. ¹⁰ And one saw this and told Joab, saying: I saw Absalom hanging upon an oak. ¹¹ And Joab said to the man that told him: If thou sawest him, why didst thou not stab him to the ground, and I would have given thee ten sicles of silver, and a belt? ¹² And he said to Joab: If thou wouldst have paid down in my hands a thousand pieces of silver, I would not lay my hands upon the king's son for in our hearing the king charged thee, and Abisai, and Ethai, saying: Save me the boy Absalom. ¹³ Yea and if I should have acted boldly against my own life, this could not have been hid from the king, and wouldst thou have stood by me? ¹⁴ And Joab said: Not as thou wilt, but I will set upon him in thy sight. So he took three lances in his hand, and thrust them into the heart of Absalom: and whilst he yet panted for life, sticking on the oak, ¹⁵ Ten young men, armourbearers of Joab, ran up, and striking him slew him. ¹⁶ And Joab sounded the trumpet, and kept back the people from pursuing after Israel in their flight, being willing to spare the multitude. ¹⁷ And they took Absalom, and cast him into a great pit in the forest, and they laid an exceeding great heap of stones upon him: but all Israel fled to their own dwellings.

¹⁸ Now Absalom had reared up for himself, in his lifetime, a pillar, which is in the king's valley: for he said: I have no son, and this shall be the monument of my name. And he called the

pillar by his own name, and it is called the hand of Absalom, to this day.

¹⁹ And Achimaas the son of Sadoc said: I will run and tell the king, that the Lord hath done judgment for him from the hand of his enemies. ²⁰ And Joab said to him: Thou shalt not be the messenger this day, but shalt bear tidings another day: this day I will not have thee bear tidings, because the king's son is dead. ²¹ And Joab said to Chusai: Go, and tell the king what thou hast seen. Chusai bowed down to Joab, and ran. ²² Then Achimaas the son of Sadoc said to Joab again: Why might not I also run after Chusai? And Joab said to him: Why wilt thou run, my son? thou wilt not be the bearer of good tidings. ²³ He answered: But what if I run? And he said to him: Run. Then Achimaas running by a nearer way passed Chusai. ²⁴ And David sat between the two gates: and the watchman that was on the top of the gate upon the wall, lifting up his eyes, saw a man running alone. ²⁵ And crying out he told the king: and the king said: If he be alone, there are good tidings in his mouth. And as he was coming apace, and drawing nearer, ²⁶ The watchman saw another man running, and crying aloud from above, he said: I see another man running alone. And the king said: He also is a good messenger. ²⁷ And the watchman said: The running of the foremost seemeth to me like the running of Achimaas the son of Sadoc. And the king said: He is a good man: and cometh with good news. ²⁸ And Achimaas crying out, said to the king: God save thee, O king. And falling down before the king with his face to the ground, he said: Blessed be the Lord thy God, who hath shut up the men that have lifted up their hands against the lord my king. ²⁹ And the king said: Is the young man Absalom safe? And Achimaas said: I saw a great tumult, O king, when thy servant Joab sent me thy servant: I know nothing else. ³⁰ And the king said to him: Pass, and stand here. ³¹ And when he had passed, and stood still, Chusai appeared and coming up he said: I bring good tidings, my lord, the king, for the Lord hath judged for thee this day from the hand of all that have risen up against thee. ³² And the king said to Chusai: Is the young man Absalom safe? And Chusai answering him, said: Let the enemies of my lord, the king, and all that rise against him unto evil, be as the young man is.

³³ The king therefore being much moved, went up to the high chamber over the gate, and wept. And as he went he spoke in this manner: My son Absalom, Absalom my son: would to God that I might die for thee, Absalom my son, my son Absalom.

THE DIVIDED MONARCHY

1 Kings entire and 2 Kings 1-17 - in the Douay-Rheims, the Third Book of Kings and the Fourth as far as the fall of Samaria. The period runs from Solomon to the deportation of the northern tribes. Isaias 7, 9 and 11 are read here, at the reign of Achaz to whom the first of them was spoken.

173. *The gift of wisdom, and the two mothers*

1 Kings 3:1-28

3 ¹ And the kingdom was established in the hand of Solomon, and he made affinity with Pharaoh, the king of Egypt: for he took his daughter, and brought her into the city of David: until he had made an end of building his own house, and the house of

the Lord, and the wall of Jerusalem round about. ² But yet the people sacrificed in the high places: for there was no temple built to the name of the Lord until that day. ³ And Solomon loved the Lord, walking in the precepts of David, his father; only he sacrificed in the high places, and burnt incense. ⁴ He went therefore to Gabaon, to sacrifice there: for that was the great high place: a thousand victims for holocausts, did Solomon offer upon that altar, in Gabaon. ⁵ And the Lord appeared to Solomon in a dream by night, saying: Ask what thou wilt that I should give thee. ⁶ And Solomon said: Thou hast shewed great mercy to thy servant David, my father, even as he walked before thee in truth, and justice, and an upright heart with thee: and thou hast kept thy great mercy for him, and hast given him a son to sit on his throne, as it is this day. ⁷ And now, O Lord God, thou hast made thy servant king instead of David, my father: and I am but a child, and know not how to go out and come in; ⁸ And thy servant is in the midst of the people which thou hast chosen, an immense people, which cannot be numbered nor counted for multitude. ⁹ Give therefore to thy servant an understanding heart, to judge thy people, and discern between good and evil. For who shall be able to judge this people, thy people, which is so numerous? ¹⁰ And the word was pleasing to the Lord, that Solomon had asked such a thing. ¹¹ And the Lord said to Solomon: Because thou hast asked this thing, and hast not asked for thyself long life nor riches, nor the lives of thy enemies, but hast asked for thyself wisdom to discern judgment; ¹² Behold I have done for thee according to thy words, and have given thee a wise and understanding heart, in so much that there hath been no one like thee before thee, nor shall arise after thee. ¹³ Yea, and the things also which thou didst not ask, I have given thee; to wit, riches and glory: so that no one hath been like thee among the kings in all days heretofore. ¹⁴ And if thou wilt walk in my ways, and keep my precepts and my commandments, as thy father walked, I will lengthen thy days. ¹⁵ And Solomon awaked, and perceived that it was a dream: and when he was come to Jerusalem, he stood before the ark of the covenant of the Lord, and offered holocausts, and sacrificed victims of peace offerings, and made a great feast for all his servants.

¹⁶ Then there came two women that were harlots, to the king, and stood before him. ¹⁷ And one of them said: I beseech thee, my lord, I and this woman dwelt in one house, and I was delivered of a child with her in the chamber. ¹⁸ And the third day after I was delivered, she also was delivered; and we were together, and no other person with us in the house; only we two. ¹⁹ And this woman's child died in the night: for in her sleep she overlaid him. ²⁰ And rising in the dead time of the night, she took my child from my side, while I, thy handmaid, was asleep, and laid it in her bosom: and laid her dead child in my bosom. ²¹ And when I arose in the morning, to give my child suck, behold it was dead: but considering him more diligently, when it was clear day, I found that it was not mine which I bore. ²² And the other woman answered: It is not so as thou sayest, but thy child is dead, and mine is alive. On the contrary, she said; Thou liest: for my child liveth, and thy child is dead. And in this manner they strove before the king. ²³ Then said the king: The one saith, My child is alive, and thy child is dead. And the other answereth: Nay; but thy child is dead, and mine liveth. ²⁴ The king therefore

said: Bring me a sword. And when they had brought a sword before the king, ²⁵ Divide, said he, the living child in two, and give half to the one and half to the other. ²⁶ But the woman, whose child was alive, said to the king; (for her bowels were moved upon her child) I beseech thee, my lord, give her the child alive, and do not kill it. But the other said: Let it be neither mine nor thine; but divide it. ²⁷ The king answered, and said: Give the living child to this woman, and let it not be killed; for she is the mother thereof. ²⁸ And all Israel heard the judgment which the king had judged, and they feared the king, seeing that the wisdom of God was in him to do judgment.

179. Solomon's wives, and the sentence

1 Kings 11:1-43

11 ¹ And king Solomon loved many strange women, besides the daughter of Pharaoh, and women of Moab, and of Ammon, and of Edom, and of Sidon, and of the Hethites: ² Of the nations concerning which the Lord said to the children of Israel: You shall not go in unto them, neither shall any of them come into yours: for they will most certainly turn away your hearts to follow their gods. And to these was Solomon joined with a most ardent love. ³ And he had seven hundred wives as queens, and three hundred concubines: and the women turned away his heart. ⁴ And when he was now old, his heart was turned away by women to follow strange gods: and his heart was not perfect with the Lord his God, as was the heart of David, his father. ⁵ But Solomon worshipped Astarthe, the goddess of the Sidonians, and Moloch, the idol of the Ammonites. ⁶ And Solomon did that which was not pleasing before the Lord, and did not fully follow the Lord, as David, his father. ⁷ Then Solomon built a temple for Chamos, the idol of Moab, on the hill that is over against Jerusalem, and for Moloch, the idol of the children of Ammon. ⁸ And he did in this manner for all his wives that were strangers, who burnt incense, and offered sacrifice to their gods. ⁹ And the Lord was angry with Solomon, because his mind was turned away from the Lord, the God of Israel, who had appeared to him twice; ¹⁰ And had commanded him concerning this thing, that he should not follow strange gods: but he kept not the things which the Lord commanded him. ¹¹ The Lord therefore said to Solomon: Because thou hast done this, and hast not kept my covenant, and my precepts, which I have commanded thee, I will divide and rend thy kingdom, and will give it to thy servant. ¹² Nevertheless, in thy days I will not do it, for David thy father's sake: but I will rend it out of the hand of thy son. ¹³ Neither will I take away the whole kingdom; but I will give one tribe to thy son, for the sake of David, my servant, and Jerusalem, which I have chosen.

¹⁴ And the Lord raised up an adversary to Solomon, Adad, the Edomite, of the king's seed, in Edom. ¹⁵ For when David was in Edom, and Joab, the general of the army, was gone up to bury them that were slain, and had killed every male in Edom, ¹⁶ (For Joab remained there six months with all Israel, till he had slain every male in Edom,) ¹⁷ Then Adad fled, he and certain Edomites of his father's servants, with him, to go into Egypt: and Adad was then a little boy. ¹⁸ And they arose out of Madian, and came into Pharan, and they took men with them from Pharan, and went into Egypt, to Pharaoh, the king of Egypt: who gave him a house, and appointed him victuals, and assigned him land.

¹⁹ And Adad found great favour before Pharaoh, insomuch that he gave him to wife the own sister of his wife, Taphnes, the queen. ²⁰ And the sister of Taphnes bore him his son, Genubath; and Taphnes brought him up in the house of Pharaoh: and Genubath dwelt with Pharaoh among his children. ²¹ And when Adad heard in Egypt that David slept with his fathers, and that Joab, the general of the army, was dead, he said to Pharaoh: Let me depart, that I may go to my own country. ²² And Pharaoh said to him: Why, what is wanting to thee with me, that thou seekest to go to thy own country? But he answered: Nothing; yet I beseech thee to let me go.

²³ God also raised up against him an adversary, Razon, the son of Eliada, who had fled from his master, Adarezer, the king of Soba. ²⁴ And he gathered men against him, and he became a captain of robbers, when David slew them of Soba: and they went to Damascus, and dwelt there, and they made him king in Damascus. ²⁵ And he was an adversary to Israel all the days of Solomon: and this is the evil of Adad, and his hatred against Israel; and he reigned in Syria.

²⁶ Jeroboam also, the son of Nabat, an Ephrathite, of Sareda, a servant of Solomon, whose mother was named Sarua, a widow woman, lifted up his hand against the king. ²⁷ And this is the cause of his rebellion against him; for Solomon built Mello, and filled up the breach of the city of David, his father. ²⁸ And Jeroboam was a valiant and mighty man: and Solomon seeing him a young man ingenious and industrious, made him chief over the tributes of all the house of Joseph. ²⁹ So it came to pass at that time, that Jeroboam went out of Jerusalem, and the prophet Ahias, the Silonite, clad with a new garment, found him in the way: and they two were alone in the field. ³⁰ And Ahias taking his new garment, wherewith he was clad, divided it into twelve parts: ³¹ And he said to Jeroboam: Take to thee ten pieces: for thus saith the Lord, the God of Israel: Behold, I will rend the kingdom out of the hand of Solomon, and will give thee ten tribes. ³² But one tribe shall remain to him for the sake of my servant, David, and Jerusalem, the city which I have chosen out of all the tribes of Israel: ³³ Because he hath forsaken me, and hath adored Astarthe, the goddess of the Sidonians, and Chamos, the god of Moab, and Moloch, the god of the children of Ammon: and hath not walked in my ways, to do justice before me, and to keep my precepts, and judgments, as did David, his father. ³⁴ Yet I will not take away all the kingdom out of his hand, but I will make him prince all the days of his life, for David my servant's sake, whom I chose, who kept my commandments, and my precepts. ³⁵ But I will take away the kingdom out of his son's hand, and will give thee ten tribes: ³⁶ And to his son I will give one tribe, that there may remain a lamp for my servant, David, before me always in Jerusalem, the city which I have chosen, that my name might be there. ³⁷ And I will take thee, and thou shalt reign over all that thy soul desireth, and thou shalt be king over Israel. ³⁸ If then thou wilt hearken to all that I shall command thee, and wilt walk in my ways, and do what is right before me, keeping my commandments and my precepts, as David, my servant, did: I will be with thee, and will build thee up a faithful house, as I built a house for David, and I will deliver Israel to thee: ³⁹ And I will for this afflict the seed of David, but yet not for ever. ⁴⁰ Solomon, therefore, sought to kill Jeroboam:

but he arose, and fled into Egypt, to Sesac, the king of Egypt, and was in Egypt till the death of Solomon.

⁴¹ And the rest of the words of Solomon, and all that he did and his wisdom: behold they are all written in the book of the words of the days of Solomon. ⁴² And the days that Solomon reigned in Jerusalem, over all Israel, were forty years. ⁴³ And Solomon slept with his fathers, and was buried in the city of David, his father; and Roboam, his son, reigned in his stead.

180. The kingdom torn in two

1 Kings 12:1-33

12 ¹ And Roboam went to Sichem: for thither were all Israel come together to make him king. ² But Jeroboam, the son of Nabat, who was yet in Egypt, a fugitive from the face of king Solomon, hearing of his death, returned out of Egypt. ³ And they sent and called him: and Jeroboam came, and all the multitude of Israel, and they spoke to Roboam, saying: ⁴ Thy father laid a grievous yoke upon us: now, therefore, do thou take off a little of the grievous service of thy father, and of his most heavy yoke, which he put upon us, and we will serve thee. ⁵ And he said to them: Go till the third day, and come to me again. And when the people was gone,

⁶ King Roboam took counsel with the old men, that stood before Solomon, his father, while he yet lived, and he said: What counsel do you give me, that I may answer this people? ⁷ They said to him: If thou wilt yield to this people to day, and condescend to them, and grant their petition, and wilt speak gentle words to them, they will be thy servants always. ⁸ But he left the counsel of the old men, which they had given him, and consulted with the young men that had been brought up with him, and stood before him. ⁹ And he said to them: What counsel do you give me, that I may answer this people, who have said to me: Make the yoke, which thy father put upon us, lighter? ¹⁰ And the young men that had been brought up with him, said: Thus shalt thou speak to this people, who have spoken to thee, saying: Thy father made our yoke heavy, do thou ease us. Thou shalt say to them: My little finger is thicker than the back of my father. ¹¹ And now my father put a heavy yoke upon you, but I will add to your yoke: my father beat you with whips, but I will beat you with scorpions.

¹² So Jeroboam, and all the people, came to Roboam the third day, as the king had appointed, saying: Come to me again the third day. ¹³ And the king answered the people roughly, leaving the counsel of the old men, which they had given him, ¹⁴ And he spoke to them according to the counsel of the young men, saying: My father made your yoke heavy, but I will add to your yoke: My father beat you with whips, but I will beat you with scorpions. ¹⁵ And the king condescended not to the people: for the Lord was turned away from him, to make good his word, which he had spoken in the hand of Ahias, the Silonite, to Jeroboam, the son of Nabat. ¹⁶ Then the people, seeing that the king would not hearken to them, answered him, saying: What portion have we in David? or what inheritance in the son of Isai? Go home to thy dwellings, O Israel: now, David, look to thy own house. So Israel departed to their dwellings. ¹⁷ But as for all the children of Israel that dwelt in the cities of Juda, Roboam reigned over them. ¹⁸ Then king Roboam sent Aduram, who was over the tribute: and all Israel stoned him, and he died. Wherefore king

Roboam made haste to get him up into his chariot, and he fled to Jerusalem: ¹⁹ And Israel revolted from the house of David, unto this day. ²⁰ And it came to pass when all Israel heard that Jeroboam was come again, that they gathered an assembly, and sent and called him, and made him king over all Israel, and there was none that followed the house of David but the tribe of Juda only.

²¹ And Roboam came to Jerusalem, and gathered together all the house of Juda, and the tribe of Benjamin, a hundred fourscore thousand chosen men for war, to fight against the house of Israel, and to bring the kingdom again under Roboam, the son of Solomon. ²² But the word of the Lord came to Semeias, the man of God, saying: ²³ Speak to Roboam, the son of Solomon, the king of Juda, and to all the house of Juda, and Benjamin, and the rest of the people, saying: ²⁴ Thus saith the Lord: You shall not go up, nor fight against your brethren, the children of Israel: let every man return to his house, for this thing is from me. They hearkened to the word of the Lord, and returned from their journey, as the Lord had commanded them.

²⁵ And Jeroboam built Sichem in mount Ephraim, and dwelt there, and going out from thence, he built Phanael. ²⁶ And Jeroboam said in his heart: Now shall the kingdom return to the house of David, ²⁷ If this people go up to offer sacrifices in the house of the Lord at Jerusalem: and the heart of this people will turn to their lord Roboam, the king of Juda, and they will kill me, and return to him. ²⁸ And finding out a device, he made two golden calves, and said to them: Go ye up no more to Jerusalem: Behold thy gods, O Israel, who brought thee out of the land of Egypt. ²⁹ And he set the one in Bethel, and the other in Dan: ³⁰ And this thing became an occasion of sin: for the people went to adore the calf as far as Dan. ³¹ And he made temples in the high places, and priests of the lowest of the people, who were not of the sons of Levi. ³² And he appointed a feast in the eighth month, on the fifteenth day of the month, after the manner of the feast that was celebrated in Juda. And going up to the altar, he did in like manner in Bethel, to sacrifice to the calves, which he had made: and he placed in Bethel priests of the high places, which he had made. ³³ And he went up to the altar, which he had built in Bethel, on the fifteenth day of the eighth month, which he had devised of his own heart: and he ordained a feast to the children of Israel, and went up on the altar to burn incense.

183. Elias, the drought, and the widow of Sarephta

1 Kings 17:1-24

17 ¹ And Elias the Thesbite, of the inhabitants of Galaad, said to Achab: As the Lord liveth, the God of Israel, in whose sight I stand, there shall not be dew nor rain these years, but according to the words of my mouth. ² And the word of the Lord came to him, saying: ³ Get thee hence, and go towards the east, and hide thyself by the torrent of Carith, which is over against the Jordan; ⁴ And there thou shalt drink of the torrent: and I have commanded the ravens to feed thee there. ⁵ So he went, and did according to the word of the Lord: and going, he dwelt by the torrent Carith, which is over against the Jordan. ⁶ And the ravens brought him bread and flesh in the morning, and bread and flesh in the evening; and he drank of the torrent. ⁷ But after some time the torrent was dried up: for it had not rained upon the earth.

⁸ Then the word of the Lord came to him, saying: ⁹ Arise, and go to Sarephta of the Sidonians, and dwell there: for I have commanded a widow woman there to feed thee. ¹⁰ He arose, and went to Sarephta. And when he was come to the gate of the city, he saw the widow woman gathering sticks, and he called her, and said to her: Give me a little water in a vessel, that I may drink. ¹¹ And when she was going to fetch it, he called after her, saying: Bring me also, I beseech thee, a morsel of bread in thy hand. ¹² And she answered: As the Lord thy God liveth, I have no bread, but only a handful of meal in a pot, and a little oil in a cruise: behold I am gathering two sticks, that I may go in and dress it, for me and my son, that we may eat it and die. ¹³ And Elias said to her: Fear not; but go, and do as thou hast said but first make for me of the same meal a little hearth cake, and bring it to me, and after make for thyself and thy son. ¹⁴ For thus saith the Lord, the God of Israel: The pot of meal shall not waste, nor the cruise of oil be diminished, until the day wherein the Lord will give rain upon the face of the earth. ¹⁵ She went, and did according to the word of Elias: and he ate, and she, and her house: and from that day ¹⁶ The pot of meal wasted not, and the cruise of oil was not diminished according to the word of the Lord, which he spoke in the hand of Elias.

¹⁷ And it came to pass after this, that the son of the woman, the mistress of the house, fell sick, and the sickness was very grievous, so that there was no breath left in him. ¹⁸ And she said to Elias: What have I to do with thee, thou man of God? art thou come to me, that my iniquities should be remembered, and that thou shouldst kill my son? ¹⁹ And Elias said to her: Give me thy son. And he took him out of her bosom, and carried him into the upper chamber where he abode, and laid him upon his own bed. ²⁰ And he cried to the Lord, and said: O Lord, my God, hast thou afflicted also the widow, with whom I am after a sort maintained, so as to kill her son? ²¹ And he stretched, and measured himself upon the child three times, and cried to the Lord, and said: O Lord, my God, let the soul of this child, I beseech thee, return into his body. ²² And the Lord heard the voice of Elias: and the soul of the child returned into him, and he revived. ²³ And Elias took the child, and brought him down from the upper chamber to the house below, and delivered him to his mother, and said to her: Behold thy son liveth.

²⁴ And the woman said to Elias: Now by this I know that thou art a man of God, and the word of the Lord in thy mouth is true.

184. *Elias on Carmel*

1 Kings 18:1-46

18 ¹ After many days, the word of the Lord came to Elias, in the third year, saying: Go, and shew thyself to Achab, that I may give rain upon the face of the earth. ² And Elias went to shew himself to Achab, and there was a grievous famine in Samaria. ³ And Achab called Abdias the governor of his house: now Abdias feared the Lord very much. ⁴ For when Jezabel killed the prophets of the Lord, he took a hundred prophets, and hid them by fifty and fifty in caves, and fed them with bread and water. ⁵ And Achab said to Abdias: Go into the land unto all fountains of waters, and into all valleys, to see if we can find grass, and save the horses and mules, that the beasts may not utterly perish. ⁶ And they divided the countries between them, that they might go round about them: Achab went one way, and

Abdias another way by himself. ⁷ And as Abdias was in the way, Elias met him: and he knew him, and fell on his face, and said: Art thou my lord Elias? ⁸ And he answered: I am. Go, and tell thy master: Elias is here. ⁹ And he said: What have I sinned, that thou wouldst deliver me, thy servant, into the hand of Achab, that he should kill me? ¹⁰ As the Lord thy God liveth, there is no nation or kingdom, whither my lord hath not sent to seek thee: and when all answered: He is not here: he took an oath of every kingdom and nation, because thou wast not found. ¹¹ And now thou sayest to me: Go and tell thy master: Elias is here. ¹² And when I am gone from thee, the Spirit of the Lord will carry thee into a place that I know not: and I shall go in and tell Achab; and he, not finding thee, will kill me: but thy servant feareth the Lord from his infancy. ¹³ Hath it not been told thee, my lord, what I did when Jezabel killed the prophets of the Lord; how I hid a hundred men of the prophets of the Lord, by fifty and fifty in caves, and fed them with bread and water? ¹⁴ And now thou sayest: Go and tell thy master: Elias is here: that he may kill me. ¹⁵ And Elias said: As the Lord of hosts liveth, before whose face I stand, this day I will shew myself unto him. ¹⁶ Abdias therefore went to meet Achab, and told him: and Achab came to meet Elias.

¹⁷ And when he had seen him, he said: Art thou he that troublest Israel? ¹⁸ And he said: I have not troubled Israel, but thou and thy father's house, who have forsaken the commandments of the Lord, and have followed Baalim. ¹⁹ Nevertheless send now, and gather unto me all Israel, unto Mount Carmel, and the prophets of Baal four hundred and fifty, and the prophets of the groves four hundred, who eat at Jezabel's table. ²⁰ Achab sent to all the children of Israel, and gathered together the prophets unto mount Carmel. ²¹ And Elias coming to all the people, said: How long do you halt between two sides? If the Lord be God, follow him: but if Baal, then follow him. And the people did not answer him a word. ²² And Elias said again to the people: I only remain a prophet of the Lord: but the prophets of Baal are four hundred and fifty men. ²³ Let two bullocks be given us, and let them choose one bullock for themselves, and cut it in pieces, and lay it upon wood, but put no fire under: and I will dress the other bullock, and lay it on wood, and put no fire under it. ²⁴ Call ye on the names of your gods, and I will call on the name of my Lord: and the God that shall answer by fire, let him be God. And all the people answering, said: A very good proposal. ²⁵ Then Elias said to the prophets of Baal: Choose you one bullock and dress it first, because you are many: and call on the names of your gods; but put no fire under. ²⁶ And they took the bullock, which he gave them, and dressed it: and they called on the name of Baal from morning even until noon, saying: O Baal, hear us. But there was no voice, nor any that answered: and they leaped over the altar that they had made. ²⁷ And when it was now noon, Elias jested at them, saying: Cry with a louder voice: for he is a god; and perhaps he is talking, or is in an inn, or on a journey; or perhaps he is asleep, and must be awaked. ²⁸ So they cried with a loud voice, and cut themselves after their manner with knives and lancets, till they were all covered with blood. ²⁹ And after midday was past, and while they were prophesying, the time was come of offering sacrifice, and there was no voice heard, nor did any one answer, nor regard them as they prayed. ³⁰ Elias

said to all the people: Come ye unto me. And the people coming near unto him, he repaired the altar of the Lord, that was broken down: ³¹ And he took twelve stones, according to the number of the tribes of the sons of Jacob to whom the word of the Lord came, saying: Israel shall be thy name. ³² And he built with the stones an altar to the name of the Lord: and he made a trench for water, of the breadth of two furrows, round about the altar. ³³ And he laid the wood in order, and cut the bullock in pieces, and laid it upon the wood. ³⁴ And he said: Fill four buckets with water, and pour it upon the burnt offering, and upon the wood. And again he said: Do the same the second time. And when they had done it the second time, he said: Do the same also the third time. And they did so the third time. ³⁵ And the water run round about the altar, and the trench was filled with water. ³⁶ And when it was now time to offer the holocaust, Elias, the prophet, came near and said: O Lord God of Abraham, and Isaac, and Israel, shew this day that thou art the God of Israel, and I thy servant, and that according to thy commandment I have done all these things. ³⁷ Hear me, O Lord, hear me: that this people may learn that thou art the Lord God, and that thou hast turned their heart again. ³⁸ Then the fire of the Lord fell, and consumed the holocaust, and the wood, and the stones, and the dust, and licked up the water that was in the trench. ³⁹ And when all the people saw this, they fell on their faces, and they said: The Lord, he is God; the Lord, he is God. ⁴⁰ And Elias said to them: Take the prophets of Baal, and let not one of them escape. And when they had taken them, Elias brought them down to the torrent Cison, and killed them there.

⁴¹ And Elias said to Achab: Go up, eat and drink: for there is a sound of abundance of rain. ⁴² Achab went up to eat and drink: and Elias went up to the top of Carmel, and casting himself down upon the earth, put his face between his knees, ⁴³ And he said to his servant: Go up, and look towards the sea. And he went up, and looked, and said: There is nothing. And again he said to him: Return seven times. ⁴⁴ And at the seventh time: Behold a little cloud arose out of the sea like a man's foot. And he said: Go up, and say to Achab: Prepare thy chariot, and go down, lest the rain prevent thee. ⁴⁵ And while he turned himself this way and that way, behold the heavens grew dark, with clouds and wind, and there fell a great rain. And Achab getting up, went away to Jezrahel: ⁴⁶ And the hand of the Lord was upon Elias, and he girded up his loins, and ran before Achab, till he came to Jezrahel.

185. The whistling of a gentle air

1 Kings 19:1-21

Horeb again, and the call of Eliseus.

19 ¹ And Achab told Jezabel all that Elias had done, and how he had slain all the prophets with the sword. ² And Jezabel sent a messenger to Elias, saying: Such and such things may the gods do to me, and add still more, if by this hour to morrow I make not thy life as the life of one of them. ³ Then Elias was afraid, and rising up, he went whithersoever he had a mind: and he came to Bersabee of Juda, and left his servant there, ⁴ And he went forward, one day's journey into the desert. And when he was there, and sat under a juniper tree, he requested for his soul that he might die, and said: It is enough for me, Lord; take

away my soul: for I am no better than my fathers. ⁵ And he cast himself down, and slept in the shadow of the juniper tree: and behold an angel of the Lord touched him, and said to him: Arise and eat. ⁶ He looked, and behold there was at his head a hearth cake, and a vessel of water: and he ate and drank, and he fell asleep again. ⁷ And the angel of the Lord came again the second time, and touched him, and said to him: Arise, eat: for thou hast yet a great way to go. ⁸ And he arose, and ate and drank, and walked in the strength of that food forty days and forty nights, unto the mount of God, Horeb. ⁹ And when he was come thither, he abode in a cave: and behold the word of the Lord came unto him, and he said to him: What dost thou here, Elias? ¹⁰ And he answered: With zeal have I been zealous for the Lord God of hosts: for the children of Israel have forsaken thy covenant: they have thrown down thy altars, they have slain thy prophets with the sword, and I alone am left, and they seek my life to take it away. ¹¹ And he said to him: Go forth, and stand upon the mount before the Lord: and behold the Lord passeth, and a great and strong wind before the Lord, overthrowing the mountains, and breaking the rocks in pieces: but the Lord is not in the wind. And after the wind, an earthquake: but the Lord is not in the earthquake. ¹² And after the earthquake, a fire: but the Lord is not in the fire. And after the fire, a whistling of a gentle air. ¹³ And when Elias heard it, he covered his face with his mantle, and coming forth, stood in the entering in of the cave, and behold a voice unto him, saying: What dost thou here, Elias? And he answered: ¹⁴ With zeal have I been zealous for the Lord God of hosts: because the children of Israel have forsaken thy covenant: they have destroyed thy altars, they have slain thy prophets with the sword; and I alone am left, and they seek my life to take it away. ¹⁵ And the Lord said to him: Go, and return on thy way, through the desert, to Damascus: and when thou art come thither, thou shalt anoint Hazael to be king over Syria; ¹⁶ And thou shalt anoint Jehu, the son of Namsi, to be king over Israel: and Eliseus, the son of Saphat, of Abelmeula, thou shalt anoint to be prophet in thy room. ¹⁷ And it shall come to pass, that whosoever shall escape the sword of Hazael, shall be slain by Jehu: and whosoever shall escape the sword of Jehu, shall be slain by Eliseus. ¹⁸ And I will leave me seven thousand men in Israel, whose knees have not been bowed before Baal, and every mouth that hath not worshipped him, kissing the hands.

¹⁹ And Elias departing from thence, found Eliseus, the son of Saphat, ploughing with twelve yoke of oxen: and he was one of them that were ploughing with, twelve yoke of oxen: and when Elias came up to him, he cast his mantle upon him. ²⁰ And he forthwith left the oxen, and ran after Elias, and said: Let me, I pray thee, kiss my father and my mother, and then I will follow thee. And he said to him: Go, and return back: for that which was my part, I have done to thee. ²¹ And returning back from him, he took a yoke of oxen, and killed them, and boiled the flesh with the plough of the oxen, and gave to the people, and they ate: and rising up, he went away, and followed Elias, and ministered to him.

187. Naboth's vineyard

1 Kings 21:1-29

21 ¹ And after these things, Naboth the Jezrahelite, who was in Jezrahel, had at that time a vineyard, near the palace of Achab,

king of Samaria. ² And Achab spoke to Naboth, saying: Give me thy vineyard, that I may make me a garden of herbs, because it is nigh, and adjoining to my house; and I will give thee for it a better vineyard: or if thou think it more convenient for thee, I will give thee the worth of it in money. ³ Naboth answered him: The Lord be merciful to me, and not let me give thee the inheritance of my fathers. ⁴ And Achab came into his house angry and fretting, because of the word that Naboth, the Jezrahelite, had spoken to him, saying: I will not give thee the inheritance of my fathers. And casting himself upon his bed, he turned away his face to the wall, and would eat no bread. ⁵ And Jezabel, his wife, went in to him, and said to him: What is the matter that thy soul is so grieved? and why eatest thou no bread? ⁶ And he answered her: I spoke to Naboth, the Jezrahelite, and said to him: Give me thy vineyard, and take money for it: or if it please thee, I will give thee a better vineyard for it. And he said: I will not give thee my vineyard. ⁷ Then Jezabel, his wife, said to him. Thou art of great authority indeed, and governest well the kingdom of Israel. Arise, and eat bread, and be of good cheer; I will give thee the vineyard of Naboth, the Jezrahelite. ⁸ So she wrote letters in Achab's name, and sealed them with his ring, and sent them to the ancients, and the chief men that were in his city, and that dwelt with Naboth. ⁹ And this was the tenor of the letters: Proclaim a fast, and make Naboth sit among the chief of the people; ¹⁰ And suborn two men, sons of Belial, against him, and let them bear false witness; that he hath blasphemed God and the king: and then carry him out, and stone him, and so let him die. ¹¹ And the men of his city, the ancients and nobles, that dwelt with him in the city, did as Jezabel had commanded them, and as it was written in the letters which she had sent to them; ¹² They proclaimed a fast, and made Naboth sit among the chief of the people. ¹³ And bringing two men, sons of the devil, they made them sit against him: and they, like men of the devil, bore witness against him before the people: saying: Naboth hath blasphemed God and the king. Wherefore they brought him forth without the city, and stoned him to death. ¹⁴ And they sent to Jezabel, saying: Naboth is stoned, and is dead.

¹⁵ And it came to pass, when Jezabel heard that Naboth was stoned, and dead, that she said to Achab: Arise, and take possession of the vineyard of Naboth, the Jezrahelite, who would not agree with thee, and give it thee for money: for Naboth is not alive, but dead. ¹⁶ And when Achab heard this, to wit, that Naboth was dead, he arose, and went down into the vineyard of Naboth, the Jezrahelite, to take possession of it.

¹⁷ And the word of the Lord came to Elias, the Thesbite, saying: ¹⁸ Arise, and go down to meet Achab, king of Israel, who is in Samaria: behold he is going down to the vineyard of Naboth, to take possession of it: ¹⁹ And thou shalt speak to him, saying: Thus saith the Lord: Thou hast slain: moreover also thou hast taken possession. And after these words thou shalt add: Thus saith the Lord: In this place, wherein the dogs have licked the blood of Naboth, they shall lick thy blood also. ²⁰ And Achab said to Elias: Hast thou found me thy enemy? He said: I have found thee because thou art sold, to do evil in the sight of the Lord. ²¹ Behold I will bring evil upon thee, and I will cut down thy posterity, and I will kill of Achab him that pisseth against the wall, and him that is shut up, and the last in Israel. ²² And

I will make thy house like the house of Jeroboam the son of Nabat, and like the house of Baasa the son of Ahias: for what thou hast done to provoke me to anger, and for making Israel to sin. ²³ And of Jezabel also, the Lord spoke, saying: The dogs shall eat Jezabel in the field of Jezrahel. ²⁴ If Achab die in the city, the dogs shall eat him: but if he die in the field, the birds of the air shall eat him.

²⁵ Now, there was not such another as Achab, who was sold to do evil in the sight of the Lord: for his wife, Jezabel, set him on, ²⁶ And he became abominable, insomuch that he followed the idols which the Amorrites had made, whom the Lord destroyed before the face of the children of Israel. ²⁷ And when Achab had heard these words, he rent his garments, and put haircloth upon his flesh, and fasted, and slept in sackcloth, and walked with his head cast down. ²⁸ And the word of the Lord came to Elias, the Thesbite, saying: ²⁹ Hast thou not seen Achab humbled before me? therefore, because he hath humbled himself, for my sake, I will not bring the evil in his days, but in his son's days will I bring the evil upon his house.

190. *Elias taken up; the mantle of Eliseus*

2 Kings 2:1-25

2 ¹ And it came to pass, when the Lord would take up Elias, into heaven, by a whirlwind, that Elias and Eliseus were going from Galgal. ² And Elias said to Eliseus: Stay thou here, because the Lord hath sent me as far as Bethel. And Eliseus said to him: As the Lord liveth, and as thy soul liveth, I will not leave thee. And when they were come down to Bethel, ³ The sons of the prophets, that were at Bethel, came forth to Eliseus, and said to him: Dost thou know that, this day, the Lord will take away thy master from thee? And he answered: I also know it: hold your peace. ⁴ And Elias said to Eliseus: Stay here, because the Lord hath sent me to Jericho. And he said: As the Lord liveth, and as thy soul liveth, I will not leave thee. And when they were come to Jericho, ⁵ The sons of the prophets, that were at Jericho, came to Eliseus, and said to him: Dost thou know that, this day, the Lord will take away thy master from thee? And he said: I also know it: hold your peace. ⁶ And Elias said to him: Stay here, because the Lord hath sent me as far as the Jordan. And he said: as the Lord liveth, and as thy soul liveth, I will not leave thee. And they two went on together. ⁷ And fifty men, of the sons of the prophets, followed them, and stood in sight, at a distance: but they two stood by the Jordan. ⁸ And Elias took his mantle, and folded it together, and struck the waters, and they were divided hither and thither, and they both passed over on dry ground. ⁹ And when they were gone over, Elias said to Eliseus: Ask what thou wilt have me to do for thee, before I be taken away from thee. And Eliseus said: I beseech thee, that in me may be thy double spirit. ¹⁰ And he answered: Thou hast asked a hard thing; nevertheless, if thou see me when I am taken from thee, thou shalt have what thou hast asked: but if thou see me not, thou shalt not have it. ¹¹ And as they went on, walking and talking together, behold, a fiery chariot and fiery horses parted them both asunder: and Elias went up by a whirlwind into heaven. ¹² And Eliseus saw him, and cried: My father, my father, the chariot of Israel, and the driver thereof. And he saw him no more: and he took hold of his own garments, and rent them in two pieces.

¹³ And he took up the mantle of Elias, that fell from him: and going back, he stood on the bank of the Jordan; ¹⁴ And he struck the waters with the mantle of Elias, that had fallen from him, and they were not divided. And he said: Where is now the God of Elias? And he struck the waters, and they were divided hither and thither, and Eliseus passed over. ¹⁵ And the sons of the prophets, at Jericho, who were over against him, seeing it, said: The spirit of Elias hath rested upon Eliseus. And coming to meet him, they worshipped him, falling to the ground. ¹⁶ And they said to him: Behold, there are with thy servants, fifty strong men, that can go, and seek thy master, lest, perhaps, the spirit of the Lord, hath taken him up and cast him upon some mountain, or into some valley. And he said: Do not send. ¹⁷ But they pressed him, till he consented, and said: Send. And they sent fifty men: and they sought three days, but found him not. ¹⁸ And they came back to him: for he abode at Jericho, and he said to them: Did I not say to you? Do not send.

¹⁹ And the men of the city, said to Eliseus: Behold the situation of this city is very good, as thou, my lord, seest: but the waters are very bad, and the ground barren. ²⁰ And he said: Bring me a new vessel, and put salt into it. And when they had brought it, ²¹ He went out to the spring of the waters, and cast the salt into it, and said: Thus saith the Lord: I have healed these waters, and there shall be no more in them death or barrenness. ²² And the waters were healed unto this day, according to the word of Eliseus, which he spoke.

²³ And he went up from thence to Bethel: and as he was going up by the way, little boys came out of the city and mocked him, saying: Go up, thou bald head, go up, thou bald head. ²⁴ And looking back, he saw them, and cursed them in the name of the Lord: and there came forth two bears out of the forest, and tore of them, two and forty boys. ²⁵ And from thence he went to mount Carmel, and from thence he returned to Samaria.

203. The fall of Samaria

2 Kings 17:1-41

The chapter states why the northern kingdom ended, and is the plan's explanation of everything that follows it.

17 ¹ In the twelfth year of Achaz king of Juda, Osee the son of Ela reigned in Samaria, over Israel, nine years. ² And he did evil before the Lord: but not as the kings of Israel that had been before him. ³ Against him came up Salmanasar, king of the Assyrians; and Osee became his servant, and paid him tribute. ⁴ And when the king of the Assyrians found that Osee, endeavouring to rebel, had sent messengers to Sua, the king of Egypt, that he might not pay tribute to the king of the Assyrians, as he had done every year, he besieged him, bound him, and cast him into prison. ⁵ And he went through all the land: and going up to Samaria, he besieged it three years. ⁶ And in the ninth year of Osee, the king of the Assyrians took Samaria, and carried Israel away to Assyria: and he placed them in Hala, and Habor, by the river of Gozan, in the cities of the Medes.

⁷ For so it was that the children of Israel had sinned against the Lord, their God, who brought them out of the land of Egypt, from under the hand of Pharaoh, king of Egypt; and they worshipped strange gods. ⁸ And they walked according to the way of the nations which the Lord had destroyed in the sight of the children

of Israel, and of the kings of Israel: because they had done in like manner. ⁹ And the children of Israel offended the Lord, their God, with things that were not right: and built them high places in all their cities, from the tower of the watchmen to the fenced city. ¹⁰ And they made them statues and groves on every high hill, and under every shady tree: ¹¹ And they burnt incense there upon altars, after the manner of the nations which the Lord had removed from their face: and they did wicked things, provoking the Lord. ¹² And they worshipped abominations, concerning which the Lord had commanded them that they should not do this thing. ¹³ And the Lord testified to them in Israel, and in Juda, by the hand of all the prophets and seers, saying: Return from your wicked ways, and keep my precepts, and ceremonies, according to all the law which I commanded your fathers: and as I have sent to you in the hand of my servants the prophets. ¹⁴ And they hearkened not, but hardened their necks like to the neck of their fathers, who would not obey the Lord, their God. ¹⁵ And they rejected his ordinances, and the covenant that he made with their fathers, and the testimonies which he testified against them: and they followed vanities, and acted vainly: and they followed the nations that were round about them, concerning which the Lord had commanded them that they should not do as they did. ¹⁶ And they forsook all the precepts of the Lord, their God: and made to themselves two molten calves, and groves, and adored all the host of heaven: and they served Baal, ¹⁷ And consecrated their sons, and their daughters, through fire: and they gave themselves to divinations, and soothsayings: and they delivered themselves up to do evil before the Lord, to provoke him. ¹⁸ And the Lord was very angry with Israel, and removed them from his sight, and there remained only the tribe of Juda. ¹⁹ But neither did Juda itself keep the commandments of the Lord, their God: but they walked in the errors of Israel, which they had wrought. ²⁰ And the Lord cast off all the seed of Israel, and afflicted them, and delivered them into the hand of spoilers, till he cast them away from his face: ²¹ Even from that time, when Israel was rent from the house of David, and made Jeroboam, son of Nabat, their king: for Jeroboam separated Israel from the Lord, and made them commit a great sin. ²² And the children of Israel walked in all the sins of Jeroboam, which he had done: and they departed not from them, ²³ Till the Lord removed Israel from his face, as he had spoken in the hand of all his servants, the prophets: and Israel was carried away out of their land to Assyria, unto this day.

²⁴ And the king of the Assyrians brought people from Babylon, and from Cutha, and from Avah, and from Emath, and from Sepharvaim: and placed them in the cities of Samaria instead of the children of Israel: and they possessed Samaria, and dwelt in the cities thereof. ²⁵ And when they began to dwell there, they feared not the Lord: and the Lord sent lions among them, which killed them. ²⁶ And it was told the king of the Assyrians, and it was said: The nations which thou hast removed, and made to dwell in the cities of Samaria, know not the ordinances of the God of the land: and the Lord hath sent lions among them: and behold they kill them, because they know not the manner of the God of the land. ²⁷ And the king of the Assyrians commanded, saying: Carry thither one of the priests whom you brought from thence captive, and let him go, and dwell with them: and let

him teach them the ordinances of the God of the land. ²⁸ So one of the priests, who had been carried away captive from Samaria, came and dwelt in Bethel, and taught them how they should worship the Lord. ²⁹ And every nation made gods of their own and put them in the temples of the high places, which the Samaritans had made, every nation in their cities where they dwelt. ³⁰ For the men of Babylon made Sochothbenoth: and the Cuthites made Nergel: and the men of Emath made Asima. ³¹ And the Hevites made Nebahaz, and Tharthac. And they that were of Sepharvaim burnt their children in fire, to Adramelech and Anamelech, the gods of Sepharvaim. ³² And nevertheless they worshipped the Lord. And they made to themselves, of the lowest of the people, priests of the high places, and they placed them in the temples of the high places. ³³ And when they worshipped the Lord, they served also their own gods, according to the custom of the nations out of which they were brought to Samaria: ³⁴ Unto this day they follow the old manner: they fear not the Lord, neither do they keep his ceremonies, and judgments, and law, and the commandment, which the Lord commanded the children of Jacob, whom he surnamed Israel: ³⁵ With whom he made a covenant, and charged them, saying: You shall not fear strange gods, nor shall you adore them, nor worship them, nor sacrifice to them. ³⁶ But the Lord, your God, who brought you out of the land of Egypt, with great power, and a stretched out arm, him shall you fear, and him shall you adore, and to him shall you sacrifice. ³⁷ And the ceremonies, and judgments, and law, and the commandment, which he wrote for you, you shall observe to do them always: and you shall not fear strange gods. ³⁸ And the covenant that he made with you, you shall not forget: neither shall ye worship strange gods, ³⁹ But fear the Lord, your God, and he shall deliver you out of the hand of all your enemies. ⁴⁰ But they did not hearken to them, but did according to their old custom. ⁴¹ So these nations feared the Lord, but nevertheless served also their idols: their children also, and grandchildren, as their fathers did, so do they unto this day.

EXILE

2 Kings 18-25: Juda alone, from Ezechias to the burning of the temple, with the prophetic and deuterocanonical material the exile requires. Ezechias and Josias stand here rather than in the Divided Kingdom because their reigns are the last reprieve before the deportation, and the book treats them so.

204. Ezechias reforms; Sennacherib invades

2 Kings 18:1-37

18 ¹ In the third year of Osee, the son of Ela, king of Israel, reigned Ezechias, the son of Achaz, king of Juda. ² He was five and twenty years old when he began to reign: and he reigned nine and twenty years in Jerusalem: the name of his mother was Abi, the daughter of Zacharias. ³ And he did that which was good before the Lord, according to all that David, his father, had done. ⁴ He destroyed the high places, and broke the statues in pieces, and cut down the groves, and broke the brazen serpent, which Moses had made: for till that time the children of Israel burnt incense to it: and he called its name Nohestan. ⁵ He trusted in the Lord, the God of Israel: so that after him there was none like him among all the kings of Juda, nor any of them that were before

him: ⁶ And he stuck to the Lord, and departed not from his steps, but kept his commandments, which the Lord commanded Moses. ⁷ Wherefore the Lord also was with him, and in all things, to which he went forth, he behaved himself wisely. And he rebelled against the king of the Assyrians, and served him not. ⁸ He smote the Philistines as far as Gaza, and all their borders, from the tower of the watchmen to the fenced city.

⁹ In the fourth year of king Ezechias, which was the seventh year of Osee, the son of Ela, king of Israel, Salmanasar, king of the Assyrians, came up to Samaria, and besieged it, ¹⁰ And took it. For after three years, in the sixth year of Ezechias, that is, in the ninth year of Osee, king of Israel, Samaria was taken: ¹¹ And the king of the Assyrians carried away Israel into Assyria, and placed them in Hala, and in Habor, by the rivers of Gozan, in the cities of the Medes. ¹² Because they hearkened not to the voice of the Lord, their God, but transgressed his covenant: all that Moses, the servant of the Lord, commanded, they would not hear, nor do.

¹³ In the fourteenth year of king Ezechias, Sennacherib, king of the Assyrians, came up against the fenced cities of Juda, and took them. ¹⁴ Then Ezechias, king of Juda, sent messengers to the king of the Assyrians, to Lachis, saying: I have offended, depart from me: and all that thou shalt put upon me, I will bear. And the king of the Assyrians put a tax upon Ezechias, king of Juda, of three hundred talents of silver, and thirty talents of gold. ¹⁵ And Ezechias gave all the silver that was found in the house of the Lord, and in the king's treasures. ¹⁶ At that time Ezechias broke the doors of the temple of the Lord, and the plates of gold which he had fastened on them, and gave them to the king of the Assyrians.

¹⁷ And the king of the Assyrians sent Tharthan, and Rabsaris, and Rabsaces, from Lachis, to king Ezechias, with a strong army, to Jerusalem: and they went up and came to Jerusalem, and they stood by the conduit of the upper pool, which is in the way of the fuller's field. ¹⁸ And they called for the king: and there went out to them Eliacim, the son of Helcias, who was over the house, and Sobna, the scribe, and Joahe, the son of Asaph, the recorder. ¹⁹ And Rabsaces said to them: Speak to Ezechias: Thus saith the great king, the king of the Assyrians: What is this confidence, wherein thou trustest? ²⁰ Perhaps thou hast taken counsel, to prepare thyself for battle. On whom dost thou trust, that thou darest to rebel? ²¹ Dost thou trust in Egypt a staff of a broken reed, upon which if a man lean, it will break and go into his hand, and pierce it? so is Pharaon, king of Egypt, to all that trust in him. ²² But if you say to me: We trust in the Lord, our God: is it not he, whose high places and altars Ezechias hath taken away: and hath commanded Juda and Jerusalem: You shall worship before this altar in Jerusalem? ²³ Now therefore come over to my master, the king of the Assyrians, and I will give you two thousand horses, and see whether you be able to have riders for them. ²⁴ And how can you stand against one lord of the least of my master's servants? Dost thou trust in Egypt for chariots and for horsemen? ²⁵ Is it without the will of the Lord that I am come up to this place to destroy it? The Lord said to me: Go up to this land, and destroy it. ²⁶ Then Eliacim, the son of Helcias, and Sobna, and Joahe, said to Rabsaces: We pray thee, speak to us, thy servants, in Syriac: for we understand that tongue:

and speak not to us in the Jews' language, in the hearing of the people that are upon the wall. ²⁷ And Rabsaces answered them, saying: Hath my master sent me to thy master, and to thee, to speak these words, and not rather to the men that sit upon the wall, that they may eat their own dung, and drink their urine with you? ²⁸ Then Rabsaces stood, and cried out with a loud voice in the Jews' language, and said: Hear the word of the great king, the king of the Assyrians. ²⁹ Thus saith the king: Let not Ezechias deceive you: for he shall not be able to deliver you out of my hand. ³⁰ Neither let him make you trust in the Lord, saying: The Lord will surely deliver us, and this city shall not be given into the hand of the king of the Assyrians. ³¹ Do not hearken to Ezechias. For thus saith the king of the Assyrians: Do with me that which is for your advantage, and come out to me: and every man of you shall eat of his own vineyard, and of his own fig tree: and you shall drink water of your own cisterns, ³² Till I come, and take you away, to a land, like to your own land, a fruitful land, and plentiful in wine, a land of bread and vineyards, a land of olives, and oil, and honey, and you shall live, and not die. Hearken not to Ezechias, who deceiveth you, saying: The Lord will deliver us. ³³ Have any of the gods of the nations delivered their land from the hand of the king of Assyria? ³⁴ Where is the god of Emath, and of Arphad? where is the god of Sepharvaim, of Ana, and of Ava? have they delivered Samaria out of my hand? ³⁵ Who are they among all the gods of the nations that have delivered their country out of my hand, that the Lord may deliver Jerusalem out of my hand? ³⁶ But the people held their peace, and answered him not a word: for they had received commandment from the king that they should not answer him. ³⁷ And Eliacim, the son of Helcias, who was over the house, and Sobna, the scribe, and Joahe, the son of Asaph, the recorder, came to Ezechias, with their garments rent, and told him the words of Rabsaces.

205. The angel of the Lord before Jerusalem

2 Kings 19:1-37

19 ¹ And when king Ezechias heard these words, he rent his garments, and covered himself with sackcloth, and went into the house of the Lord. ² And he sent Eliacim, who was over the house, and Sobna, the scribe, and the ancients of the priests, covered with sackcloths, to Isaias, the prophet, the son of Amos. ³ And they said to him: Thus saith Ezechias: This day is a day of tribulation, and of rebuke, and of blasphemy: the children are come to the birth, and the woman in travail hath not strength. ⁴ It may be the Lord, thy God, will hear all the words of Rabsaces, whom the king of the Assyrians, his master, hath sent to reproach the living God, and to reprove with words, which the Lord, thy God, hath heard: and do thou offer prayer for the remnants that are found. ⁵ So the servants of king Ezechias came to Isaias. ⁶ And Isaias said to them: Thus shall you say to your master: Thus saith the Lord: Be not afraid for the words which thou hast heard, with which the servants of the king of the Assyrians have blasphemed me. ⁷ Behold I will send a spirit upon him, and he shall hear a message, and shall return into his own country, and I will make him fall by the sword in his own country.

⁸ And Rabsaces returned, and found the king of the Assyrians besieging Lobna: for he had heard that he was departed from Lachis. ⁹ And when he heard of Tharaca, king of Ethiopia: Be-

hold, he is come out to fight with thee: and was going against him, he sent messengers to Ezechias, saying: ¹⁰ Thus shall you say to Ezechias, king of Juda: Let not thy God deceive thee, in whom thou trustest: and do not say: Jerusalem shall not be delivered into the hands of the king of the Assyrians. ¹¹ Behold, thou hast heard what the kings of the Assyrians have done to all countries, how they have laid them waste: and canst thou alone be delivered? ¹² Have the gods of the nations delivered any of them, whom my fathers have destroyed, to wit, Gozan, and Haran, and Reseph, and the children of Eden, that were in The-lassar? ¹³ Where is the king of Emath, and the king of Arphad, and the king of the city of Sepharvaim, and of Ana, and of Ava?

¹⁴ And when Ezechias had received the letter of the hand of the messengers, and had read it, he went up to the house of the Lord, and spread it before the Lord, ¹⁵ And he prayed in his sight, saying: O Lord God of Israel, who sittest upon the cherubims, thou alone art the God of all the kings of the earth: thou madest heaven and earth: ¹⁶ Incline thy ear, and hear: open, O Lord, thy eyes and see: and hear all the words of Sennacherib, who hath sent to upbraid unto us the living God. ¹⁷ Of a truth, O Lord, the kings of the Assyrians have destroyed nations, and the lands of them all. ¹⁸ And they have cast their gods into the fire: for they were not gods, but the work of men's hands, of wood and stone, and they destroyed them. ¹⁹ Now therefore, O Lord our God, save us from his hand, that all the kingdoms of the earth may know that thou art the Lord, the only God.

²⁰ And Isaias, the son of Amos, sent to Ezechias, saying: Thus saith the Lord, the God of Israel: I have heard the prayer thou hast made to me concerning Sennacherib, king of the Assyrians. ²¹ This is the word that the Lord hath spoken of him: The virgin, the daughter of Sion, hath despised thee, and laughed thee to scorn: the daughter of Jerusalem hath wagged her head behind thy back. ²² Whom hast thou reproached, and whom hast thou blasphemed? against whom hast thou exalted thy voice, and lifted up thy eyes on high? against the holy one of Israel. ²³ By the hand of thy servants thou hast reproached the Lord, and hast said: With the multitude of my chariots I have gone up to the height of the mountains, to the top of Libanus, and have cut down its tall cedars, and its choice fir trees. And I have entered into the furthest parts thereof, and the forest of its Carmel. ²⁴ I have cut down, and I have drunk strange waters, and have dried up with the soles of my feet all the shut up waters. ²⁵ Hast thou not heard what I have done from the beginning? from the days of old I have formed it, and now I have brought it to effect: that fenced cities of fighting men should be turned to heaps of ruins: ²⁶ And the inhabitants of them were weak of hand, they trembled and were confounded, they became like the grass of the field, and the green herb on the tops of houses, which withered before it came to maturity. ²⁷ Thy dwelling, and thy going out, and thy coming in, and thy way I knew before, and thy rage against me. ²⁸ Thou hast been mad against me, and thy pride hath come up to my ears: therefore I will put a ring in thy nose, and a bit between thy lips, and I will turn thee back by the way by which thou camest. ²⁹ And to thee, O Ezechias, this shall be a sign: Eat this year what thou shalt find: and in the second year, such things as spring of themselves: but in the third year sow and reap: plant vineyards, and eat the fruit of them. ³⁰ And whatsoever shall be

left of the house of Juda, shall take root downward, and bear fruit upward. ³¹ For out of Jerusalem shall go forth a remnant, and that which shall be saved out of mount Sion: the zeal of the Lord of hosts shall do this. ³² Wherefore thus saith the Lord concerning the king of the Assyrians: He shall not come into this city, nor shoot an arrow into it, nor come before it with shield, nor cast a trench about it. ³³ By the way that he came he shall return: and into this city he shall not come, saith the Lord. ³⁴ And I will protect this city, and will save it for my own sake, and for David, my servant's sake.

³⁵ And it came to pass that night, that an angel of the Lord came, and slew in the camp of the Assyrians a hundred and eighty-five thousand. And when he arose early in the morning, he saw all the bodies of the dead. ³⁶ And Sennacherib, king of the Assyrians, departing, went away, and he returned and abode in Ninive. ³⁷ And as he was worshipping in the temple of Nes-roch, his god, Adramelech and Sarasar, his sons, slew him with the sword, and they fled into the land of the Armenians, and Asarhaddon, his son, reigned in his stead.

207. The book of the law found

2 Kings 22:1-20

22 ¹ Josias was eight years old when he began to reign: he reigned one and thirty years in Jerusalem: the name of his mother was Idida, the daughter of Hadaia, of Besecath. ² And he did that which was right in the sight of the Lord, and walked in all the ways of David, his father: he turned not aside to the right hand, or to the left.

³ And in the eighteenth year of king Josias, the king sent Saphan, the son of Assia, the son of Messulam, the scribe of the temple of the Lord, saying to him: ⁴ Go to Helcias, the high priest, that the money may be put together which is brought into the temple of the Lord, which the doorkeepers of the temple have gathered of the people. ⁵ And let it be given to the workmen by the overseers of the house of the Lord: and let them distribute it to those that work in the temple of the Lord, to repair the temple: ⁶ That is, to carpenters and masons, and to such as mend breaches: and that timber may be bought, and stones out of the quarries, to repair the temple of the Lord. ⁷ But let there be no reckoning made with them of the money which they receive, but let them have it in their power, and in their trust.

⁸ And Helcias, the high priest, said to Saphan, the scribe: I have found the book of the law in the house of the Lord: and Helcias gave the book to Saphan, and he read it. ⁹ And Saphan, the scribe, came to the king, and brought him word again concerning that which he had commanded, and said: Thy servants have gathered together the money that was found in the house of the Lord: and they have given it to be distributed to the workmen, by the overseers of the works of the temple of the Lord. ¹⁰ And Saphan, the scribe, told the king, saying: Helcias, the priest, hath delivered to me a book. And when Saphan had read it before the king,

¹¹ And the king had heard the words of the law of the Lord, he rent his garments. ¹² And he commanded Helcias, the priest, and Ahicam, the son of Saphan, and Achobor, the son of Micha, and Saphan, the scribe, and Asaia, the king's servant, saying: ¹³ Go and consult the Lord for me, and for the people, and for all Juda, concerning the words of this book which is found: for

the great wrath of the Lord is kindled against us, because our fathers have not hearkened to the words of this book, to do all that is written for us. ¹⁴ So Helcias, the priest, and Ahicam, and Achobor, and Saphan, and Asaia, went to Holda, the prophetess, the wife of Sellum, the son of Thecua, the son of Araas, keeper of the wardrobe, who dwelt in Jerusalem, in the Second: and they spoke to her. ¹⁵ And she said to them: Thus saith the Lord, the God of Israel: Tell the man that sent you to me: ¹⁶ Thus saith the Lord: Behold, I will bring evils upon this place, and upon the inhabitants thereof, all the words of the law which the king of Juda hath read: ¹⁷ Because they have forsaken me, and have sacrificed to strange gods, provoking me by all the works of their hands: therefore my indignation shall be kindled against this place, and shall not be quenched. ¹⁸ But to the king of Juda, who sent you to consult the Lord, thus shall you say: Thus saith the Lord, the God of Israel: for as much as thou hast heard the words of the book, ¹⁹ And thy heart hath been moved to fear, and thou hast humbled thyself before the Lord, hearing the words against this place, and the inhabitants thereof, to wit, that they should become a wonder and a curse: and thou hast rent thy garments, and wept before me; I also have heard thee; saith the Lord. ²⁰ Therefore I will gather thee to thy fathers, and thou shalt be gathered to thy sepulchre in peace; that thy eyes may not see all the evils which I will bring upon this place.

208. The reform and the death of Josias

2 Kings 23:1-37

23 ¹ And they brought the king word again what she had said. And he sent: and all the ancients of Juda and Jerusalem were assembled to him. ² And the king went up to the temple of the Lord, and all the men of Juda, and all the inhabitants of Jerusalem with him, the priests, and the prophets, and all the people, both little and great: and in the hearing of them all he read all the words of the book of the covenant, which was found in the house of the Lord. ³ And the king stood upon the step: and he made a covenant with the Lord, to walk after the Lord, and to keep his commandments, and his testimonies, and his ceremonies, with all their heart, and with all their soul, and to perform the words of this covenant, which were written in that book: and the people agreed to the covenant.

⁴ And the king commanded Helcias, the high priest, and the priests of the second order, and the doorkeepers, to cast out of the temple of the Lord all the vessels that had been made for Baal, and for the grove, and for all the host of heaven: and he burnt them without Jerusalem, in the valley of Cedron, and he carried the ashes of them to Bethel. ⁵ And he destroyed the soothsayers, whom the kings of Juda had appointed to sacrifice in the high places in the cities of Juda, and round about Jerusalem: them also that burnt incense to Baal, and to the sun, and to the moon, and to the twelve signs, and to all the host of heaven. ⁶ And he caused the grove to be carried out from the house of the Lord, without Jerusalem, to the valley of Cedron, and he burnt it there, and reduced it to dust, and cast the dust upon the graves of the common people. ⁷ He destroyed also the pavilions of the effeminate, which were in the house of the Lord, for which the women wove as it were little dwellings for the grove. ⁸ And he gathered together all the priests out of the cities of Juda: and he defiled the high places, where the priests offered sacrifice,

from Gabaa to Bersabee: and he broke down the altars of the gates that were in the entering in of the gate of Josue, governor of the city, which was on the left hand of the gate of the city. ⁹ However, the priests of the high places came not up to the altar of the Lord, in Jerusalem: but only ate of the unleavened bread among their brethren. ¹⁰ And he defiled Topheth, which is in the valley of the son of Ennom: that no man should consecrate there his son, or his daughter, through fire, to Moloch. ¹¹ And he took away the horses which the kings of Juda had given to the sun, at the entering in of the temple of the Lord, near the chamber of Nathanmelech the eunuch, who was in Pharurim: and he burnt the chariots of the sun with fire. ¹² And the altars that were upon the top of the upper chamber of Achaz, which the kings of Juda had made, and the altars which Manasses had made in the two courts of the temple of the Lord, the king broke down: and he ran from thence, and cast the ashes of them into the torrent Cedron. ¹³ The high places also that were at Jerusalem, on the right side of the Mount of Offence, which Solomon, king of Israel, had built to Astaroth, the idol of the Sidonians, and to Chamos, the scandal of Moab, and to Melchom, the abomination of the children of Ammon, the king defiled. ¹⁴ And he broke in pieces the statues, and cut down the groves: and he filled their places with the bones of dead men.

¹⁵ Moreover, the altar also that was at Bethel, and the high place, which Jeroboam, the son of Nabat, who made Israel to sin, had made: both the altar, and the high place, he broke down and burnt, and reduced to powder, and burnt the grove. ¹⁶ And as Josias turned himself, he saw there the sepulchres that were in the mount: and he sent and took the bones out of the sepulchres, and burnt them upon the altar, and defiled it according to the word of the Lord, which the man of God spoke, who had foretold these things. ¹⁷ And he said: What is that monument which I see? And the men of that city answered: It is the sepulchre of the man of God, who came from Juda, and foretold these things which thou hast done upon the altar of Bethel. ¹⁸ And he said: Let him alone, let no man move his bones. So his bones were left untouched with the bones of the prophet, that came out of Samaria. ¹⁹ Moreover all the temples of the high places which were in the cities of Samaria, which the kings of Israel had made to provoke the Lord, Josias took away: and he did to them according to all the acts that he had done in Bethel. ²⁰ And he slew all the priests of the high places, that were there, upon the altars; and he burnt men's bones upon them: and returned to Jerusalem.

²¹ And he commanded all the people, saying: Keep the Phase to the Lord your God, according as it is written in the book of this covenant. ²² Now there was no such a Phase kept from the days of the judges, who judged Israel, nor in all the days of the kings of Israel, and of the kings of Juda, ²³ As was this Phase, that was kept to the Lord in Jerusalem, in the eighteenth year of king Josias.

²⁴ Moreover the diviners by spirits, and soothsayers, and the figures of idols, and the uncleannesses, and the abominations, that had been in the land of Juda and Jerusalem, Josias took away: that he might perform the words of the law, that were written in the book, which Helcias the priest had found in the temple of the Lord. ²⁵ There was no king before him like unto

him, that returned to the Lord with all his heart, and with all his soul, and with all his strength, according to all the law of Moses: neither after him did there arise any like unto him. ²⁶ But yet the Lord turned not away from the wrath of his great indignation, wherewith his anger was kindled against Juda: because of the provocations, wherewith Manasses had provoked him. ²⁷ And the Lord said: I will remove Juda also from before my face, as I have removed Israel: and I will cast off this city Jerusalem, which I chose, and the house, of which I said: My name shall be there. ²⁸ Now the rest of the acts of Josias, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Juda? ²⁹ In his days Pharaon Nechao, king of Egypt, went up against the king of Assyria to the river Euphrates: and king Josias went to meet him: and was slain at Mageddo, when he had seen him. ³⁰ And his servants carried him dead from Mageddo: and they brought him to Jerusalem, and buried him in his own sepulchre. And the people of the land took Joachaz, the son of Josias: and they anointed him, and made him king in his father's stead.

³¹ Joachaz was three and twenty years old when he began to reign, and he reigned three months in Jerusalem: the name of his mother was Amital, the daughter of Jeremias, of Lobna. ³² And he did evil before the Lord, according to all that his fathers had done. ³³ And Pharaon Nechao bound him at Rebla, which is in the land of Emath, that he should not reign in Jerusalem: and he set a fine upon the land, of a hundred talents of silver, and a talent of gold. ³⁴ And Pharaon Nechao made Eliacim, the son of Josias, king in the room of Josias his father: and turned his name to Joakim. And he took Joachaz away and carried him into Egypt, and he died there. ³⁵ And Joakim gave the silver and the gold to Pharaon, after he had taxed the land for every man, to contribute according to the commandment of Pharaon: and he exacted both the silver and the gold of the people of the land, of every man according to his ability: to give to Pharaon Nechao. ³⁶ Joakim was five and twenty years old when he began to reign: and he reigned eleven years in Jerusalem: the name of his mother was Zebida, the daughter of Phadaia, of Ruma. ³⁷ And he did evil before the Lord according to all that his fathers had done.

209. The first deportation

2 Kings 24:1-20

24 ¹ In his days Nabuchodonosor, king of Babylon came up, and Joakim became his servant three years: then again he rebelled against him. ² And the Lord sent against him the rovers of the Chaldees, and the rovers of Syria, and the rovers of Moab, and the rovers of the children of Ammon: and he sent them against Juda, to destroy it, according to the word of the Lord, which he had spoken by his servants, the prophets. ³ And this came by the word of the Lord against Juda, to remove them from before him for all the sins of Manasses which he did; ⁴ And for the innocent blood that he shed, filling Jerusalem with innocent blood: and therefore the Lord would not be appeased. ⁵ But the rest of the acts of Joakim, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Juda? And Joakim slept with his fathers: ⁶ And Joachin, his son, reigned in his stead. ⁷ And the king of Egypt came not again any more out of his own country: for the king of Babylon had taken all that

had belonged to the king of Egypt, from the river of Egypt, unto the river Euphrates.

⁸ Joachin was eighteen years old when he began to reign, and he reigned three months in Jerusalem: the name of his mother was Nohesta, the daughter of Elnathan, of Jerusalem. ⁹ And he did evil before the Lord, according to all that his father had done. ¹⁰ At that time the servants of Nabuchodonosor, king of Babylon, came up against Jerusalem, and the city was surrounded with their forts. ¹¹ And Nabuchodonosor, king of Babylon, came to the city, with his servants, to assault it. ¹² And Joachin, king of Juda, went out to the king of Babylon, he, and his mother, and his servants, and his nobles, and his eunuchs: and the king of Babylon received him in the eighth year of his reign. ¹³ And he brought out from thence all the treasures of the house of the Lord, and the treasures of the king's house: and he cut in pieces all the vessels of gold which Solomon, king of Israel, had made in the temple of the Lord, according to the word of the Lord. ¹⁴ And he carried away all Jerusalem, and all the princes, and all the valiant men of the army, to the number of ten thousand, into captivity: and every artificer and smith: and none were left, but the poor sort of the people of the land. ¹⁵ And he carried away Joachin into Babylon, and the king's mother, and the king's wives, and his eunuchs: and the judges of the land he carried into captivity, from Jerusalem, into Babylon. ¹⁶ And all the strong men, seven thousand, and the artificers, and the smiths, a thousand, all that were valiant men, and fit for war: and the king of Babylon led them captives into Babylon. ¹⁷ And he appointed Matthanias, his uncle, in his stead: and called his name Sedecias. ¹⁸ Sedecias was one and twenty years old when he began to reign, and he reigned eleven years in Jerusalem: the name of his mother was Amital, the daughter of Jeremias, of Lobna. ¹⁹ And he did evil before the Lord, according to all that Joakim had done. ²⁰ For the Lord was angry against Jerusalem and against Juda, till he cast them out from his face: and Sedecias revolted from the king of Babylon.

210. The fall of Jerusalem

2 Kings 25:1-30

The temple is burned. The lowest point of the plan, and the ground of everything the prophets afterwards say.

25 ¹ And it came to pass in the ninth year of his reign, in the tenth month, the tenth day of the month, that Nabuchodonosor, king of Babylon, came, he and all his army, against Jerusalem: and they surrounded it: and raised works round about it. ² And the city was shut up and besieged till the eleventh year of king Sedecias, ³ The ninth day of the month: and a famine prevailed in the city, and there was no bread for the people of the land. ⁴ And a breach was made into the city: and all the men of war fled in the night between the two walls by the king's garden (now the Chaldees besieged the city round about), and Sedecias fled by the way that leadeth to the plains of the wilderness. ⁵ And the army of the Chaldees pursued after the king, and overtook him in the plains of Jericho: and all the warriors that were with him were scattered, and left him: ⁶ So they took the king, and brought him to the king of Babylon, to Reblatha, and he gave judgment upon him. ⁷ And he slew the sons of Sedecias before

his face, and he put out his eyes, and bound him with chains, and brought him to Babylon.

⁸ In the fifth month, the seventh day of the month, the same is the nineteenth year of the king of Babylon, came Nabuzardan, commander of the army, a servant of the king of Babylon, into Jerusalem. ⁹ And he burnt the house of the Lord, and the king's house, and the houses of Jerusalem, and every house he burnt with fire. ¹⁰ And all the army of the Chaldees, which was with the commander of the troops, broke down the walls of Jerusalem round about. ¹¹ And Nabuzardan, the commander of the army, carried away the rest of the people, that remained in the city, and the fugitives, that had gone over to the king of Babylon, and the remnant of the common people. ¹² But of the poor of the land he left some dressers of vines and husbandmen. ¹³ And the pillars of brass that were in the temple of the Lord, and the bases, and the sea of brass, which was in the house of the Lord, the Chaldees broke in pieces, and carried all the brass of them to Babylon. ¹⁴ They took away also the pots of brass, and the mazers, and the forks, and the cups, and the mortars, and all the vessels of brass, with which they ministered. ¹⁵ Moreover also the censers, and the bowls, such as were of gold in gold: and such as were of silver in silver, the general of the army took away. ¹⁶ That is, two pillars, one sea, and the bases which Solomon had made in the temple of the Lord: the brass of all these vessels was without weight. ¹⁷ One pillar was eighteen cubits high: and the chapter of brass, which was upon it, was three cubits high: and the network, and the pomegranates that were upon the chapter of the pillar, were all of brass: and the second pillar had the like adorning.

¹⁸ And the general of the army took Seraias, the chief priest, and Sophonias, the second priest, and three doorkeepers: ¹⁹ And out of the city one eunuch, who was captain over the men of war: and five men of them who had stood before the king, whom he found in the city, and Sopher, the captain of the army, who exercised the young soldiers of the people of the land: and three-score men of the common people, who were found in the city: ²⁰ These Nabuzardan, the general of the army, took away, and carried them to the king of Babylon, to Reblatha. ²¹ And the king of Babylon smote them, and slew them at Reblatha, in the land of Emath: so Juda was carried away out of their land.

²² But over the people that remained in the land of Juda, which Nabuchodonosor, king of Babylon, had left, he gave the government to Godolias, the son of Ahicam, the son of Saphan. ²³ And when all the captains of the soldiers had heard this, they and the men that were with them, to wit, that the king of Babylon had made Godolias governor they came to Godolias to Maspha, Ismael, the son of Nathanias, and Johanan, the son of Caree, and Saraia, the son of Thanehumeth, the Netophathite, and Jezonias, the son of Maachathi, they and their men. ²⁴ And Godolias swore to them and to their men, saying: Be not afraid to serve the Chaldees: stay in the land, and serve the king of Babylon, and it shall be well with you. ²⁵ But it came to pass in the seventh month, that Ismael, the son of Nathanias, the son of Elisama, of the seed royal came, and ten men with him, and smote Godolias; so that he died: and also the Jews and the Chaldees that were with him in Maspha. ²⁶ And all the people, both little and great, and the captains of the soldiers, rising up, went to Egypt, fearing

the Chaldees. ²⁷ And it came to pass in the seven and thirtieth year of the captivity of Joachin, king of Juda, in the twelfth month, the seven and twentieth day of the month: Evilmerodach, king of Babylon, in the year that he began to reign, lifted up the head of Joachin, king of Juda, out of prison. ²⁸ And he spoke kindly to him: and he set his throne above the throne of the kings that were with him in Babylon. ²⁹ And he changed his garments which he had in prison, and he ate bread always before him, all the days of his life. ³⁰ And he appointed him a continual allowance, which was also given him by the king, day by day, all the days of his life.

RETURN AND RESTORATION

Esdras (Ezra) and Nehemias entire but for their registers, with Esther and Judith. The Douay-Rheims prints the first two as the First and Second Books of Esdras. Esdras 2, Nehemias 3 and Nehemias 7 are lists of names and are passed over on the same rule that omits Genesis 5, 10 and 36.

235. The decree of Cyrus

Ezra 1:1-11

Douay-Rheims title: the First Book of Esdras. Esdras 2, the register of those who returned, is omitted.

1 ¹ In the first year of Cyrus king of the Persians, that the word of the Lord by the mouth of Jeremias might be fulfilled, the Lord stirred up the spirit of Cyrus king of the Persians: and he made a proclamation throughout all his kingdom, and in writing also, saying: ² Thus saith Cyrus king of the Persians: The Lord the God of heaven hath given to me all the kingdoms of the earth, and he hath charged me to build him a house in Jerusalem, which is in Judea. ³ Who is there among you of all his people? His God be with him. Let him go up to Jerusalem, which is in Judea, and build the house of the Lord the God of Israel: he is the God that is in Jerusalem. ⁴ And let all the rest in all places wheresoever they dwell, help him every man from his place, with silver and gold, and goods, and cattle, besides that which they offer freely to the temple of God, which is in Jerusalem.

⁵ Then rose up the chief of the fathers of Juda and Benjamin, and the priests, and Levites, and every one whose spirit God had raised up, to go up to build the temple of the Lord, which was in Jerusalem. ⁶ And all they that were round about, helped their hands with vessels of silver, and gold, with goods, and with beasts, and with furniture, besides what they had offered on their own accord. ⁷ And king Cyrus brought forth the vessels of the temple of the Lord, which Nabuchodonosor had taken from Jerusalem, and had put them in the temple of his god. ⁸ Now Cyrus king of Persia brought them forth by the hand of Mithridates the son of Gazabar, and numbered them to Sassabasar the prince of Juda. ⁹ And this is the number of them: thirty bowls of gold, a thousand bowls of silver, nine and twenty knives, thirty cups of gold, ¹⁰ Silver cups of a second sort, four hundred and ten: other vessels a thousand. ¹¹ All the vessels of gold and silver, five thousand four hundred: all these Sassabasar brought with them that came up from the captivity of Babylon to Jerusalem.

236. The altar, and the foundation laid

Ezra 3:1-13

3 ¹ And now the seventh month was come, and the children of Israel were in their cities: and the people gathered themselves together as one man to Jerusalem. ² And Josue the son of Josedec rose up, and his brethren the priests, and Zorobabel the son of Salathiel, and his brethren, and they built the altar of the God of Israel that they might offer holocausts upon it, as it is written in the law of Moses the man of God. ³ And they set the altar of God upon its bases, while the people of the lands round about put them in fear, and they offered upon it a holocaust to the Lord morning and evening. ⁴ And they kept the feast of tabernacles, as it is written, and offered the holocaust every day orderly according to the commandment, the duty of the day in its day. ⁵ And afterwards the continual holocaust, both on the new moons, and on all the solemnities of the Lord, that were consecrated, and on all in which a freewill offering was made to the Lord. ⁶ From the first day of the seventh month they began to offer holocausts to the Lord: but the temple of God was not yet founded. ⁷ And they gave money to hewers of stones and to masons: and meat and drink, and oil to the Sidonians and Tyrians, to bring cedar trees from Libanus to the sea of Joppe, according to the orders which Cyrus king of the Persians had given them.

⁸ And in the second year of their coming to the temple of God in Jerusalem, the second month, Zorobabel the son of Salathiel, and Josue the son of Josedec, and the rest of their brethren the priests, and the Levites, and all that were come from the captivity to Jerusalem began, and they appointed Levites from twenty years old and upward, to hasten forward the work of the Lord. ⁹ Then Josue and his sons and his brethren, Cedmihel, and his sons, and the children of Juda, as one man, stood to hasten them that did the work in the temple of God: the sons of Henadad, and their sons, and their brethren the Levites. ¹⁰ And when the masons laid the foundations of the temple of the Lord, the priests stood in their ornaments with trumpets: and the Levites the sons of Asaph with cymbals, to praise God by the hands of David king of Israel. ¹¹ And they sung together hymns, and praise to the Lord: because he is good, for his mercy endureth for ever towards Israel. And all the people shouted with a great shout, praising the Lord, because the foundations of the temple of the Lord were laid. ¹² But many of the priests and the Levites, and the chief of the fathers and the ancients that had seen the former temple; when they had the foundation of this temple before their eyes, wept with a loud voice: and many shouting for joy, lifted up their voice. ¹³ So that one could not distinguish the voice of the shout of joy, from the noise of the weeping of the people: for one with another the people shouted with a loud shout, and the voice was heard afar off.

238. The temple finished and dedicated

Ezra 5:1-6:22

5 ¹ Now Aggeus the prophet, and Zacharias the son of Addo, prophesied to the Jews that were in Judea and Jerusalem, in the name of the God of Israel. ² Then rose up Zorobabel the son of Salathiel, and Josue the son of Josedec, and began to build the

temple of God in Jerusalem, and with them were the prophets of God helping them.

³ And at the same time came to them Thathanai, who was governor beyond the river, and Stharbazanai, and their counsellors: and said thus to them: Who hath given you counsel to build this house, and to repair the walls thereof? ⁴ In answer to which we gave them the names of the men who were the promoters of that building. ⁵ But the eye of their God was upon the ancients of the Jews, and they could not hinder them. And it was agreed that the matter should be referred to Darius, and then they should give satisfaction concerning that accusation.

⁶ The copy of the letter that Thathanai governor of the country beyond the river, and Stharbazanai, and his counsellors the Arphasachites, who dwelt beyond the river, sent to Darius the king. ⁷ The letter which they sent him, was written thus: To Darius the king all peace. ⁸ Be it known to the king, that we went to the province of Judea, to the house of the great God, which they are building with unpolished stones, and timber is laid in the walls: and this work is carried on diligently and advanceth in their hands. ⁹ And we asked those ancients, and said to them thus: Who hath given you authority to build this house, and to repair these walls? ¹⁰ We asked also of them their names, that we might give thee notice: and we have written the names of the men that are the chief among them. ¹¹ And they answered us in these words, saying: We are the servants of the God of heaven and earth, and we are building a temple that was built these many years ago, and which a great king of Israel built and set up. ¹² But after that our fathers had provoked the God of heaven to wrath, he delivered them into the hands of Nabuchodonosor the king of Babylon the Chaldean: and he destroyed this house, and carried away the people to Babylon. ¹³ But in the first year of Cyrus the king of Babylon, king Cyrus set forth a decree, that this house of God should be built. ¹⁴ And the vessels also of gold and silver of the temple of God, which Nabuchodonosor had taken out of the temple, that was in Jerusalem, and had brought them to the temple of Babylon, king Cyrus brought out of the temple of Babylon, and they were delivered to one Sassabasar, whom also he appointed governor, ¹⁵ And said to him: Take these vessels, and go, and put them in the temple that is in Jerusalem, and let the house of God be built in its place. ¹⁶ Then came this same Sassabasar, and laid the foundations of the temple of God in Jerusalem, and from that time until now it is in building, and is not yet finished. ¹⁷ Now therefore if it seem good to the king, let him search in the king's library, which is in Babylon, whether it hath been decreed by Cyrus the king, that the house of God in Jerusalem should be built, and let the king send his pleasure to us concerning this matter.

⁶ ¹ Then king Darius gave orders, and they searched in the library of the books that were laid up in Babylon, ² And there was found in Ecbatana, which is a castle in the province of Media, a book in which this record was written. ³ In the first year of Cyrus the king: Cyrus the king decreed, that the house of God should be built, which is in Jerusalem, in the place where they may offer sacrifices, and that they lay the foundations that may support the height of threescore cubits, and the breadth of threescore cubits, ⁴ Three rows of unpolished stones, and so rows of new timber: and the charges shall be given out of the

king's house. ⁵ And also let the golden and silver vessels of the temple of God, which Nabuchodonosor took out of the temple of Jerusalem, and brought to Babylon, be restored, and carried back to the temple of Jerusalem to their place, which also were placed in the temple of God. ⁶ Now therefore Thathanai, governor of the country beyond the river, Stharbazanai, and your counsellors the Apharsachites, who are beyond the river, depart far from them, ⁷ And let that temple of God be built by the governor of the Jews, and by their ancients, that they may build that house of God in its place. ⁸ I also have commanded what must be done by those ancients of the Jews, that the house of God may be built, to wit, that of the king's chest, that is, of the tribute that is paid out of the country beyond the river, the charges be diligently given to those men, lest the work be hindered. ⁹ And if it shall be necessary, let calves also, and lambs, and kids, for holocausts to the God of heaven, wheat, salt, wine, and oil, according to the custom of the priests that are in Jerusalem, be given them day by day, that there be no complaint in any thing. ¹⁰ And let them offer oblations to the God of heaven, and pray for the life of the king, and of his children. ¹¹ And I have made a decree: That if any whosoever, shall alter this commandment, a beam be taken from his house, and set up, and he be nailed upon it, and his house be confiscated. ¹² And may the God, that hath caused his name to dwell there, destroy all kingdoms, and the people that shall put out their hand to resist, and to destroy the house of God, that is in Jerusalem. I Darius have made the decree, which I will have diligently complied with.

¹³ So then Thathanai, governor of the country beyond the river, and Stharbazanai, and his counsellors diligently executed what Darius the king had commanded. ¹⁴ And the ancients of the Jews built, and prospered according to the prophecy of Aggeus the prophet, and of Zacharias the son of Addo: and they built and finished, by the commandment of the God of Israel, and by the commandment of Cyrus, and Darius, and Artaxerxes kings of the Persians. ¹⁵ And they were finishing this house of God, until the third day of the month of Adar, which was in the sixth year of the reign of king Darius.

¹⁶ And the children of Israel, the priests and the Levites, and the rest of the children of the captivity kept the dedication of the house of God with joy. ¹⁷ And they offered at the dedication of the house of God, a hundred calves, two hundred rams, four hundred lambs, and for a sin offering for all Israel twelve he goats, according to the number of the tribes of Israel. ¹⁸ And they set the priests in their divisions, and the Levites in their courses over the works of God in Jerusalem, as it is written in the book of Moses. ¹⁹ And the children of Israel of the captivity kept the phase, on the fourteenth day of the first month. ²⁰ For all the priests and the Levites were purified as one man: all were clean to kill the phase for all the children of the captivity, and for their brethren the priests, and themselves. ²¹ And the children of Israel that were returned from captivity, and all that had separated themselves from the filthiness of the nations of the earth to them, to seek the Lord the God of Israel, did eat. ²² And they kept the feast of unleavened bread seven days with joy, for the Lord had made them joyful, and had turned the heart of the king of Assyria to them, that he should help their hands in the work of the house of the Lord the God of Israel.

241. Nehemias hears of the ruined walls*Nehemiah 1:1-11*

Douay-Rheims title: the Book of Nehemias, which is called the Second of Esdras.

1 ¹ The words of Nehemias the son of Helchias. And it came to pass in the month of Casleu, in the twentieth year, as I was in the castle of Susa, ² That Hanani one of my brethren came, he and some men of Juda; and I asked them concerning the Jews, that remained and were left of the captivity, and concerning Jerusalem. ³ And they said to me: They that have remained, and are left of the captivity there in the province, are in great affliction, and reproach: and the wall of Jerusalem is broken down, and the gates thereof are burnt with fire.

⁴ And when I had heard these words, I sat down, and wept, and mourned for many days: and I fasted, and prayed before the face of the God of heaven. ⁵ And I said: I beseech thee, O Lord God of heaven, strong, great, and terrible, who keepest covenant and mercy with those that love thee, and keep thy commandments: ⁶ Let thy ears be attentive, and thy eyes open, to hear the prayer of thy servant, which I pray before thee now, night and day, for the children of Israel thy servants: and I confess the sins of the children of Israel, by which they have sinned against thee: I and my father's house have sinned. ⁷ We have been seduced by vanity, and have not kept thy commandments, and ceremonies and judgments, which thou hast commanded thy servant Moses. ⁸ Remember the word that thou commandedst to Moses thy servant, saying: If you shall transgress, I will scatter you abroad among the nations: ⁹ But if you return to me, and keep my commandments, and do them, though you should be led away to the uttermost parts of the world, I will gather you from thence, and bring you back to the place which I have chosen for my name to dwell there. ¹⁰ And these are thy servants, and thy people: whom thou hast redeemed by thy great strength, and by thy mighty hand. ¹¹ I beseech thee, O Lord, let thy ear be attentive to the prayer of thy servant, and to the prayer of thy servants who desire to fear thy name: and direct thy servant this day, and give him mercy before this man. For I was the king's cupbearer.

242. The night ride, and the king's leave*Nehemiah 2:1-20*

Nehemias 3, the register of the builders, is omitted.

2 ¹ And it came to pass in the month of Nisan, in the twentieth year of Artaxerxes the king: that wine was before him, and I took up the wine, and gave it to the king: and I was as one languishing away before his face. ² And the king said to me: Why is thy countenance sad, seeing thou dost not appear to be sick? this is not without cause, but some evil, I know not what, is in thy heart. And I was seized with an exceeding great fear: ³ And I said to the king: O king, live for ever: why should not my countenance be sorrowful, seeing the city of the place of the sepulchres of my fathers is desolate, and the gates thereof are burnt with fire? ⁴ Then the king said to me: For what dost thou make request? And I prayed to the God of heaven, ⁵ And I said to the king: If it seem good to the king, and if thy servant hath found favour in thy sight, that thou wouldst send me into Judea to the city of the sepulchre of my father, and I will build

it. ⁶ And the king said to me, and the queen that sat by him: For how long shall thy journey be, and when wilt thou return? And it pleased the king, and he sent me: and I fixed him a time. ⁷ And I said to the king: If it seem good to the king, let him give me letters to the governors of the country beyond the river, that they convey me over, till I come into Judea: ⁸ And a letter to Asaph the keeper of the king's forest, to give me timber that I may cover the gates of the tower of the house, and the walls of the city, and the house that I shall enter into. And the king gave me according to the good hand of my God with me.

⁹ And I came to the governors of the country beyond the river, and gave them the king's letters. And the king had sent with me captains of soldiers, and horsemen. ¹⁰ And Sanaballat the Horonite, and Tobias the servant, the Ammonite, heard it, and it grieved them exceedingly, that a man was come, who sought the prosperity of the children of Israel. ¹¹ And I came to Jerusalem, and was there three days. ¹² And I arose in the night, I and some few men with me, and I told not any man what God had put in my heart to do in Jerusalem, and there was no beast with me, but the beast that I rode upon. ¹³ And I went out by night by the gate of the valley, and before the dragon fountain, and to the dung gate, and I viewed the wall of Jerusalem which was broken down, and the gates thereof which were consumed with fire. ¹⁴ And I passed to the gate of the fountain, and to the king's aqueduct, and there was no place for the beast on which I rode to pass. ¹⁵ And I went up in the night by the torrent, and viewed the wall, and going back I came to the gate of the valley, and returned. ¹⁶ But the magistrates knew not whither I went, or what I did: neither had I as yet told any thing to the Jews, or to the priests, or to the nobles, or to the magistrates, or to the rest that did the work.

¹⁷ Then I said to them: You know the affliction wherein we are, because Jerusalem is desolate, and the gates thereof are consumed with fire: come, and let us build up the walls of Jerusalem, and let us be no longer a reproach. ¹⁸ And I shewed them how the hand of my God was good with me, and the king's words, which he had spoken to me, and I said: Let us rise up, and build. And their hands were strengthened in good. ¹⁹ But Sanaballat the Horonite, and Tobias the servant, the Ammonite, and Gossem the Arabian heard of it, and they scoffed at us, and despised us, and said: What is this thing that you do? are you going to rebel against the king? ²⁰ And I answered them, and said to them: The God of heaven he helpeth us, and we are his servants: let us rise up and build: but you have no part, nor justice, nor remembrance in Jerusalem.

245. Esdras reads the law*Nehemiah 8:1-18*

"The joy of the Lord is our strength." The people hear the law they had lost, and the restored community is constituted around it.

8 ¹ And the seventh month came: and the children of Israel were in their cities. And all the people were gathered together as one man to the street which is before the water gate, and they spoke to Esdras the scribe, to bring the book of the law of Moses, which the Lord had commanded to Israel. ² Then Esdras the priest brought the law before the multitude of men and women,

and all those that could understand, in the first day of the seventh month. ³ And he read it plainly in the street that was before the water gate, from the morning until midday, before the men, and the women, and all those that could understand: and the ears of all the people were attentive to the book. ⁴ And Esdras the scribe stood upon a step of wood, which he had made to speak upon, and there stood by him Mathathias, and Semeia, and Ania, and Uria, and Helcia, and Maasia, on his right hand: and on the left, Phadaia, Misael, and Melchia, and Hasum, and Hasbadana, Zacharia and Mosollam. ⁵ And Esdras opened the book before all the people: for he was above all the people: and when he had opened it, all the people stood. ⁶ And Esdras blessed the Lord the great God: and all the people answered, Amen, amen: lifting up their hands: and they bowed down, and adored God with their faces to the ground. ⁷ Now Josue, and Bani, and Serebia, Jamin, Accub, Sephtai, Odia, Maasia, Celtia, Azarias, Jozabed, Hanan, Phalaia, the Levites, made silence among the people to hear the law: and the people stood in their place. ⁸ And they read in the book of the law of God distinctly and plainly to be understood: and they understood when it was read.

⁹ And Nehemias (he is Athersatha) and Esdras the priest and scribe, and the Levites who interpreted to all the people, said: This is a holy day to the Lord our God: do not mourn, nor weep: for all the people wept, when they heard the words of the law. ¹⁰ And he said to them: Go, eat fat meats, and drink sweet wine, and send portions to them that have not prepared for themselves: because it is the holy day of the Lord, and be not sad: for the joy of the Lord is our strength. ¹¹ And the Levites stilled all the people, saying: Hold your peace, for the day is holy, and be not sorrowful. ¹² So all the people went to eat and drink, and to send portions, and to make great mirth: because they understood the words that he had taught them.

¹³ And on the second day the chiefs of the families of all the people, the priests, and the Levites were gathered together to Esdras the scribe, that he should interpret to them the words of the law. ¹⁴ And they found written in the law, that the Lord had commanded by the hand of Moses, that the children of Israel should dwell in tabernacles, on the feast, in the seventh month: ¹⁵ And that they should proclaim and publish the word in all their cities, and in Jerusalem, saying: Go forth to the mount, and fetch branches of olive, and branches of beautiful wood, branches of myrtle, and branches of palm, and branches of thick trees, to make tabernacles, as it is written.

¹⁶ And the people went forth, and brought. And they made themselves tabernacles every man on the top of his house, and in their courts, and in the courts of the house of God, and in the street of the water gate, and in the street of the gate of Ephraim. ¹⁷ And all the assembly of them that were returned from the captivity, made tabernacles, and dwelt in tabernacles: for since the days of Josue the son of Nun the children of Israel had not done so, until that day: and there was exceeding great joy. ¹⁸ And he read in the book of the law of God day by day, from the first day till the last, and they kept the solemnity seven days, and in the eighth day a solemn assembly according to the manner.

246. The great confession

Nehemiah 9:1-38

The whole of salvation history to this point, recited by the people themselves - the nearest thing in scripture to this plan's own table of contents.

9 ¹ And in the four and twentieth day of the month the children of Israel came together with fasting and with sackcloth, and earth upon them. ² And the seed of the children of Israel separated themselves from every stranger: and they stood, and confessed their sins, and the iniquities of their fathers. ³ And they rose up to stand: and they read in the book of the law of the Lord their God, four times in the day, and four times they confessed, and adored the Lord their God. ⁴ And there stood up upon the step of the Levites, Josue, and Bani, and Cedmihel, Sabania, Bonni, Sarebias, Bani, and Chanani: and they cried with a loud voice to the Lord their God. ⁵ And the Levites Josue and Cedmihel, Bonni, Hasebnia, Serebia, Oduia, Sebnia, and Phathahia, said: Arise, bless the Lord your God from eternity to eternity: and blessed be the high name of thy glory with all blessing and praise. ⁶ Thou thyself, O Lord alone, thou hast made heaven, and the heaven of heavens, and all the host thereof: the earth and all things that are in it: the seas and all that are therein: and thou givest life to all these things, and the host of heaven adoreth thee. ⁷ Thou O Lord God, art he who chocest Abram, and broughtest him forth out of the fire of the Chaldeans, and gavest him the name of Abraham. ⁸ And thou didst find his heart faithful before thee: and thou madest a covenant with him, to give him the land of the Chanaanite, of the Hethite, and of the Amorrite, and of the Pherezite, and of the Jebusite, and of the Gergezite, to give it to his seed: and thou hast fulfilled thy words, because thou art just. ⁹ And thou sawest the affliction of our fathers in Egypt: and thou didst hear their cry by the Red Sea. ¹⁰ And thou shewedst signs and wonders upon Pharaoh, and upon all his servants, and upon the people of his land: for thou knewest that they dealt proudly against them: and thou madest thyself a name, as it is at this day. ¹¹ And thou didst divide the sea before them, and they passed through the midst of the sea on dry land: but their persecutors thou threwest into the depth, as a stone into mighty waters. ¹² And in a pillar of a cloud thou wast their leader by day, and in a pillar of fire by night, that they might see the way by which they went. ¹³ Thou camest down also to mount Sinai, and didst speak with them from heaven, and thou gavest them right judgments, and the law of truth, ceremonies, and good precepts. ¹⁴ Thou madest known to them thy holy sabbath, and didst prescribe to them commandments, and ceremonies, and the law by the hand of Moses thy servant. ¹⁵ And thou gavest them bread from heaven in their hunger, and broughtest forth water for them out of the rock in their thirst, and thou saidst to them that they should go in, and possess the land, upon which thou hadst lifted up thy hand to give it them. ¹⁶ But they and our fathers dealt proudly, and hardened their necks and hearkened not to thy commandments. ¹⁷ And they would not hear, and they remembered not thy wonders which thou hadst done for them. And they hardened their necks, and gave the head to return to their bondage, as it were by contention. But thou, a forgiving God, gracious, and merciful, longsuffering, and full of compassion, didst not forsake them. ¹⁸ Yea when they had

made also to themselves a molten calf, and had said: This is thy God, that brought thee out of Egypt: and had committed great blasphemies: ¹⁹ Yet thou, in thy many mercies, didst not leave them in the desert: the pillar of the cloud departed not from them by day to lead them in the way, and the pillar of fire by night to shew them the way by which they should go. ²⁰ And thou gavest them thy good Spirit to teach them, and thy manna thou didst not withhold from their mouth, and thou gavest them water for their thirst. ²¹ Forty years didst thou feed them in the desert, and nothing was wanting to them: their garments did not grow old, and their feet were not worn. ²² And thou gavest them kingdoms, and nations, and didst divide lots for them: and they possessed the land of Sehon, and the land of the king of Hesebon, and the land of Og king of Basan. ²³ And thou didst multiply their children as the stars of heaven, and broughtest them to the land concerning which thou hadst said to their fathers, that they should go in and possess it. ²⁴ And the children came and possessed the land, and thou didst humble before them the inhabitants of the land, the Chanaanites, and gavest them into their hands, with their kings, and the people of the land, that they might do with them as it pleased them. ²⁵ And they took strong cities and a fat land, and possessed houses full of all goods: cisterns made by others, vineyards, and oliveyards, and fruit trees in abundance: and they ate, and were filled, and became fat, and abounded with delight in thy great goodness. ²⁶ But they provoked thee to wrath, and departed from thee, and threw thy law behind their backs: and they killed thy prophets, who admonished them earnestly to return to thee: and they were guilty of great blasphemies. ²⁷ And thou gavest them into the hands of their enemies, and they afflicted them. And in the time of their tribulation they cried to thee, and thou heardest from heaven, and according to the multitude of thy tender mercies thou gavest them saviours, to save them from the hands of their enemies. ²⁸ But after they had rest, they returned to do evil in thy sight: and thou leftest them in the hand of their enemies, and they had dominion over them. Then they returned, and cried to thee: and thou heardest from heaven, and deliveredst them many times in thy mercies. ²⁹ And thou didst admonish them to return to thy law. But they dealt proudly, and hearkened not to thy commandments, but sinned against thy judgments, which if a man do, he shall live in them: and they withdrew the shoulder, and hardened their neck, and would not hear. ³⁰ And thou didst forbear with them for many years, and didst testify against them by thy spirit by the hand of thy prophets: and they heard not, and thou didst deliver them into the hand of the people of the lands. ³¹ Yet in thy very many mercies thou didst not utterly consume them, nor forsake them: because thou art a merciful and gracious God. ³² Now therefore our God, great, strong, and terrible, who keepest covenant and mercy, turn not away from thy face all the labour which hath come upon us, upon our kings, and our princes, and our priests, and our prophets, and our fathers, and all the people from the days of the king of Assur, until this day. ³³ And thou art just in all things that have come upon us: because thou hast done truth, but we have done wickedly. ³⁴ Our kings, our princes, our priests, and our fathers have not kept thy law, and have not minded thy commandments, and thy testimonies which thou hast testified

among them. ³⁵ And they have not served thee in their kingdoms, and in thy manifold goodness, which thou gavest them, and in the large and fat land, which thou deliveredst before them, nor did they return from their most wicked devices. ³⁶ Behold we ourselves this day are bondmen: and the land, which thou gavest our fathers, to eat the bread thereof, and the good things thereof, and we ourselves are servants in it. ³⁷ And the fruits thereof grow up for the kings, whom thou hast set over us for our sins, and they have dominion over our bodies, and over our beasts, according to their will, and we are in great tribulation. ³⁸ And because of all this we ourselves make a covenant, and write it, and our princes, our Levites, and our priests sign it.

MACCABEAN REVOLT

1 Machabees entire, with the two martyr chapters of 2 Machabees. Both books are deuterocanonical and belong to the 73-book canon; an abridgement built on a 66-book canon has no period here at all, and the centuries before Christ go silent.

263. *The desolation of the sanctuary*

1 Machabees 1:1-67

The Greek kingdoms, and the abomination set upon the altar. Deuterocanonical.

1 ¹ Now it came to pass, after that Alexander the son of Philip the Macedonian, who first reigned in Greece, coming out of the land of Cethim, had overthrown Darius, king of the Persians and Medes: ² He fought many battles, and took the strong holds of all, and slew the kings of the earth: ³ And he went through even to the ends of the earth: and took the spoils of many nations: and the earth was quiet before him. ⁴ And he gathered a power, and a very strong army: and his heart was exalted and lifted up: ⁵ And he subdued countries of nations, and princes; and they became tributaries to him. ⁶ And after these things, he fell down upon his bed, and knew that he should die. ⁷ And he called his servants, the nobles that were brought up with him from his youth: and he divided his kingdom among them, while he was yet alive. ⁸ And Alexander reigned twelve years, and he died. ⁹ And his servants made themselves kings, every one in his place: ¹⁰ And they all put crowns upon themselves after his death, and their sons after them, many years; and evils were multiplied in the earth. ¹¹ And there came out of them a wicked root, Antiochus the Illustrious, the son of king Antiochus, who had been a hostage at Rome: and he reigned in the hundred and thirty-seventh year of the kingdom of the Greeks. ¹² In those days there went out of Israel wicked men, and they persuaded many, saying: Let us go and make a covenant with the heathens that are round about us: for since we departed from them, many evils have befallen us. ¹³ And the word seemed good in their eyes. ¹⁴ And some of the people determined to do this, and went to the king: and he gave them license to do after the ordinances of the heathens. ¹⁵ And they built a place of exercise in Jerusalem, according to the laws of the nations: ¹⁶ And they made themselves prepuces, and departed from the holy covenant, and joined themselves to the heathens, and were sold to do evil: ¹⁷ And the kingdom was established before Antiochus, and he had a mind to reign over the land of Egypt, that he might reign over two kingdoms. ¹⁸ And he entered into Egypt with a great multitude, with chariots, and elephants,

and horsemen, and a great number of ships: ¹⁹ And he made war against Ptolemee king of Egypt; but Ptolemee was afraid at his presence and fled, and many were wounded unto death. ²⁰ And he took the strong cities in the land of Egypt: and he took the spoils of the land of Egypt. ²¹ And after Antiochus had ravaged Egypt, in the hundred and forty-third year, he returned and went up against Israel. ²² And he went up to Jerusalem, with a great multitude. ²³ And he proudly entered into the sanctuary, and took away the golden altar, and the candlestick of light, and all the vessels thereof, and the table of proposition, and the pouring vessels, and the vials, and the little mortars of gold, and the veil, and the crowns, and the golden ornament that was before the temple: and he broke them all in pieces. ²⁴ And he took the silver and gold, and the precious vessels: and he took the hidden treasures, which he found: and when he had taken all away, he departed into his own country. ²⁵ And he made a great slaughter of men, and spoke very proudly. ²⁶ And there was great mourning in Israel, and in every place where they were: ²⁷ And the princes, and the ancients mourned, and the virgins and the young men were made feeble, and the beauty of the women was changed. ²⁸ Every bridegroom took up lamentation: and the bride that sat in the marriage bed, mourned: ²⁹ And the land was moved for the inhabitants thereof, and all the house of Jacob was covered with confusion. ³⁰ And after two full years, the king sent the chief collector of his tributes to the cities of Juda, and he came to Jerusalem with a great multitude. ³¹ And he spoke to them peaceable words in deceit; and they believed him. ³² And he fell upon the city suddenly, and struck it with a great slaughter, and destroyed much people in Israel. ³³ And he took the spoils of the city, and burnt it with fire, and threw down the houses thereof, and the walls thereof round about: ³⁴ And they took the women captive, and the children, and the cattle they possessed. ³⁵ And they built the city of David with a great and strong wall, and with strong towers, and made it a fortress for them: ³⁶ And they placed there a sinful nation, wicked men, and they fortified themselves therein: and they stored up armour and victuals, and gathered together the spoils of Jerusalem; ³⁷ And laid them up there: and they became a great snare. ³⁸ And this was a place to lie in wait against the sanctuary, and an evil devil in Israel. ³⁹ And they shed innocent blood round about the sanctuary, and defiled the holy place. ⁴⁰ And the inhabitants of Jerusalem fled away by reason of them and the city was made the habitation of strangers, and she became a stranger to her own seed, and her children forsook her. ⁴¹ Her sanctuary was desolate like a wilderness, her festival days were turned into mourning, her sabbaths into reproach, her honours were brought to nothing. ⁴² Her dishonour was increased according to her glory, and her excellency was turned into mourning. ⁴³ And king Antiochus wrote to all his kingdom, that all the people should be one: and every one should leave his own law. ⁴⁴ And all nations consented, according to the word of king Antiochus. ⁴⁵ And many of Israel consented to his service, and they sacrificed to idols, and profaned the sabbath. ⁴⁶ And the king sent letters by the hands of messengers to Jerusalem, and to all the cities of Juda; that they should follow the law of the nations of the earth. ⁴⁷ And should forbid holocausts and sacrifices, and atonements to be made in the temple of God. ⁴⁸ And should prohibit the sabbath,

and the festival days to be celebrated. ⁴⁹ And he commanded the holy places to be profaned, and the holy people of Israel. ⁵⁰ And he commanded altars to be built, and temples, and idols, and swine's flesh to be immolated, and unclean beasts, ⁵¹ And that they should leave their children uncircumcised, and let their souls be defiled with all uncleannesses, and abominations, to the end that they should forget the law, and should change all the justifications of God. ⁵² And that whosoever would not do according to the word of king Antiochus, should be put to death. ⁵³ According to all these words he wrote to his whole kingdom: and he appointed rulers over the people that should force them to do these things. ⁵⁴ And they commanded the cities of Juda to sacrifice. ⁵⁵ Then many of the people were gathered to them that had forsaken the law of the Lord: and they committed evils in the land: ⁵⁶ And they drove away the people of Israel into lurking holes, and into the secret places of fugitives. ⁵⁷ On the fifteenth day of the month, Casleu, in the hundred and forty-fifth year, king Antiochus set up the abominable idol of desolation upon the altar of God, and they built altars throughout all the cities of Juda round about: ⁵⁸ And they burnt incense, and sacrificed at the doors of the houses and in the streets. ⁵⁹ And they cut in pieces, and burnt with fire the books of the law of God: ⁶⁰ And every one with whom the books of the testament of the Lord were found, and whosoever observed the law of the Lord, they put to death, according to the edict of the king. ⁶¹ Thus by their power did they deal with the people of Israel, that were found in the cities month after month. ⁶² And on the five and twentieth day of the month they sacrificed upon the altar of the idol that was over against the altar of God. ⁶³ Now the women that circumcised their children were slain according to the commandment of king Antiochus, ⁶⁴ And they hanged the children about their necks in all their houses: and those that had circumcised them, they put to death. ⁶⁵ And many of the people of Israel determined with themselves, that they would not eat unclean things: and they chose rather to die, than to be defiled with unclean meats: ⁶⁶ And they would not break the holy law of God and they were put to death: ⁶⁷ And there was very great wrath upon the people.

264. *Mathathias, and the beginning of the revolt*

1 Maccabees 2:1-70

2 ¹ In those days arose Mathathias, the son of John, the son of Simeon, a priest of the sons of Joarib, from Jerusalem, and he abode in the mountain of Modin: ² And he had five sons: John, who was surnamed Gaddis: ³ And Simon, who was surnamed Thasi; ⁴ And Judas, who was called Machabeus; ⁵ And Eleazar, who was surnamed Abaron; and Jonathan, who was surnamed Apphus. ⁶ These saw the evils that were done in the people of Juda, and in Jerusalem. ⁷ And Mathathias said: Woe is me, wherefore was I born to see the ruin of my people, and the ruin of the holy city, and to dwell there, when it is given into the hands of the enemies? ⁸ The holy places are come into the hands of strangers her temple is become as a man without honour. ⁹ The vessels of her glory are carried away captive; her old men are murdered in the streets, and her young men are fallen by the sword of the enemies. ¹⁰ What nation hath not inherited her kingdom, and gotten of her spoils? ¹¹ All her ornaments are taken away. She that was free is made a slave. ¹² And behold our sanctuary, and our beauty, and our glory is laid waste, and the Gentiles have

defiled them. ¹³ To what end then should we live any longer? ¹⁴ And Mathathias and his sons rent their garments, and they covered themselves with haircloth, and made great lamentation. ¹⁵ And they that were sent from king Antiochus, came thither, to compel them that were fled into the city of Modin, to sacrifice, and to burn incense, and to depart from the law of God. ¹⁶ And many of the people of Israel consented and came to them: but Mathathias and his sons stood firm. ¹⁷ And they that were sent from Antiochus, answering, said to Mathathias: Thou art a ruler, and an honourable, and great man in this city, and adorned with sons, and brethren. ¹⁸ Therefore, come thou first, and obey the king's commandment, as all nations have done, and the men of Juda, and they that remain in Jerusalem: and thou, and thy sons shall be in the number of the king's friends, and enriched with gold, and silver, and many presents. ¹⁹ Then Mathathias answered, and said with a loud voice: Although all nations obey king Antiochus, so as to depart every man from the service of the law of his fathers, and consent to his commandments: ²⁰ I and my sons, and my brethren will obey the law of our fathers. ²¹ God be merciful unto us: it is not profitable for us to forsake the law, and the justices of God: ²² We will not hearken to the words of king Antiochus, neither will we sacrifice and transgress the commandments of our law, to go another way. ²³ Now as he left off speaking these words, there came a certain Jew in the sight of all to sacrifice to the idols upon the altar in the city of Modin, according to the king's commandment. ²⁴ And Mathathias saw, and was grieved, and his reins trembled, and his wrath was kindled according to the judgment of the law, and running upon him he slew him upon the altar: ²⁵ Moreover the man whom king Antiochus had sent, who compelled them to sacrifice, he slew at the same time, and pulled down the altar, ²⁶ And shewed zeal for the law, as Phinees did by Zamri, the son of Salomi. ²⁷ And Mathathias cried out in the city with a loud voice, saying: Every one that hath zeal for the law, and maintaineth the testament, let him follow me. ²⁸ So he and his sons fled into the mountains, and left all that they had in the city. ²⁹ Then many that sought after judgment, and justice, went down into the desert: ³⁰ And they abode there, they and their children, and their wives, and their cattle: because afflictions increased upon them. ³¹ And it was told to the king's men, and to the army that was in Jerusalem, in the city of David, that certain men, who had broken the king's commandment, were gone away into the secret places in the wilderness, and that many were gone after them. ³² And forthwith they went out towards them, and made war against them on the sabbath day. ³³ And they said to them: Do you still resist? come forth, and do according to the edict of king Antiochus, and you shall live. ³⁴ And they said: We will not come forth, neither will we obey the king's edict, to profane the sabbath day. ³⁵ And they made haste to give them battle. ³⁶ But they answered them not, neither did they cast a stone at them, nor stopped up the secret places, ³⁷ Saying: Let us all die in our innocency: and heaven and earth shall be witnesses for us, that you put us to death wrongfully. ³⁸ So they gave them battle on the sabbath: and they were slain, with their wives, and their children, and their cattle, to the number of a thousand persons. ³⁹ And Mathathias and his friends heard of it, and they mourned for them exceedingly. ⁴⁰ And every man said

to his neighbour: If we shall all do as our brethren have done, and not fight against the heathens for our lives, and our justifications, they will now quickly root us out of the earth. ⁴¹ And they determined in that day, saying: Whosoever shall come up against us to fight on the sabbath day, we will fight against him: and we will not all die, as our brethren that were slain in the secret places. ⁴² Then was assembled to them the congregation of the Assideans, the stoutest of Israel, every one that had a good will for the law. ⁴³ And all they that fled from the evils, joined themselves to them, and were a support to them. ⁴⁴ And they gathered an army, and slew the sinners in their wrath, and the wicked men in their indignation: and the rest fled to the nations for safety. ⁴⁵ And Mathathias and his friends went round about, and they threw down the altars: ⁴⁶ And they circumcised all the children whom they found in the confines of Israel that were uncircumcised: and they did valiantly. ⁴⁷ And they pursued after the children of pride, and the work prospered in their hands: ⁴⁸ And they recovered the law out of the hands of the nations, and out of the hands of the kings: and they yielded not the horn to the sinner. ⁴⁹ Now the days drew near that Mathathias should die, and he said to his sons: Now hath pride and chastisement gotten strength, and the time of destruction, and the wrath of indignation: ⁵⁰ Now, therefore, O my sons, be ye zealous for the law, and give your lives for the covenant of your fathers. ⁵¹ And call to remembrance the works of the fathers, which they have done in their generations: and you shall receive great glory, and an everlasting name. ⁵² Was not Abraham found faithful in temptation, and it was reputed to him unto justice? ⁵³ Joseph, in the time of his distress, kept the commandment, and he was made lord of Egypt. ⁵⁴ Phinees, our father, by being fervent in the zeal of God, received the covenant of an everlasting priesthood. ⁵⁵ Jesus, whilst he fulfilled the word, was made ruler in Israel. ⁵⁶ Caleb, for bearing witness before the congregation, received an inheritance. ⁵⁷ David, by his mercy, obtained the throne of an everlasting kingdom. ⁵⁸ Elias, while he is full of zeal for the law, was taken up into heaven. ⁵⁹ Ananias and Azarias and Misael, by believing, were delivered out of the flame. ⁶⁰ Daniel, in his innocency, was delivered out of the mouth of the lions. ⁶¹ And thus consider, through all generations: that none that trust in him, fail in strength. ⁶² And fear not the words of a sinful man, for his glory is dung and worms: ⁶³ Today he is lifted up, and tomorrow he shall not be found, because he is returned into his earth and his thought is come to nothing. ⁶⁴ You, therefore, my sons, take courage, and behave manfully in the law: for by it you shall be glorious. ⁶⁵ And behold, I know that your brother Simon is a man of counsel: give ear to him always, and he shall be a father to you. ⁶⁶ And Judas Machabeus, who is valiant and strong from his youth up, let him be the leader of your army, and he shall manage the war of the people. ⁶⁷ And you shall take to you all that observe the law: and revenge ye the wrong of your people. ⁶⁸ Render to the Gentiles their reward, and take heed to the precepts of the law. ⁶⁹ And he blessed them, and was joined to his fathers. ⁷⁰ And he died in the hundred and forty-sixth year: and he was buried by his sons in the sepulchres of his fathers, in Modin, and all Israel mourned for him with great mourning.

265. Judas Machabeus takes the lead*1 Maccabees 3:1-60*

3 ¹ Then his son Judas, called Machabeus, rose up in his stead. ² And all his brethren helped him, and all they that had joined themselves to his father, and they fought with cheerfulness the battle of Israel. ³ And he got his people great honour, and put on a breastplate as a giant, and girt his warlike armour about him in battles, and protected the camp with his sword. ⁴ In his acts he was like a lion, and like a lion's whelp roaring for his prey. ⁵ And he pursued the wicked and sought them out, and them that troubled his people he burnt with fire: ⁶ And his enemies were driven away for fear of him, and all the workers of iniquity were troubled: and salvation prospered in his hand. ⁷ And he grieved many kings, and made Jacob glad with his works, and his memory is blessed for ever. ⁸ And he went through the cities of Juda, and destroyed the wicked out of them, and turned away wrath from Israel. ⁹ And he was renowned even to the utmost part of the earth, and he gathered them that were perishing. ¹⁰ And Apollonius gathered together the Gentiles, and a numerous and great army from Samaria, to make war against Israel. ¹¹ And Judas understood it, and went forth to meet him: and he overthrew him, and killed him: and many fell down slain, and the rest fled away. ¹² And he took their spoils, and Judas took the sword of Apollonius, and fought with it all his lifetime. ¹³ And Seron, captain of the army of Syria, heard that Judas had assembled a company of the faithful, and a congregation with him, ¹⁴ And he said I will get me a name, and will be glorified in the kingdom, and will overthrow Judas, and those that are with him, that have despised the edict of the king. ¹⁵ And he made himself ready; and the host of the wicked went up with him, strong succours, to be revenged of the children of Israel. ¹⁶ And they approached even as far as Bethoron: and Judas went forth to meet him, with a small company. ¹⁷ But when they saw the army coming to meet them, they said to Judas: How shall we, being few, be able to fight against so great a multitude, and so strong, and we are ready to faint with fasting today? ¹⁸ And Judas said: It is an easy matter for many to be shut up in the hands of a few: and there is no difference in the sight of the God of heaven to deliver with a great multitude, or with a small company: ¹⁹ For the success of war is not in the multitude of the army, but strength cometh from heaven. ²⁰ They come against us with an insolent multitude, and with pride, to destroy us, and our wives, and our children, and to take our spoils. ²¹ But we will fight for our lives, and our laws: ²² And the Lord himself will overthrow them before our face, but as for you, fear them not. ²³ And as soon as he had made an end of speaking, he rushed suddenly upon them: and Seron, and his host were overthrown before him: ²⁴ And he pursued him by the descent of Bethoron, even to the plain, and there fell of them eight hundred men, and the rest fled into the land of the Philistines. ²⁵ And the fear of Judas, and of his brethren, and the dread of them, fell upon all the nations round about them. ²⁶ And his fame came to the king, and all nations told of the battles of Judas. ²⁷ Now when king Antiochus heard these words, he was angry in his mind: and he sent, and gathered the forces of all his kingdom, an exceeding strong army. ²⁸ And he opened his treasury, and gave out pay to the army for a year: and he commanded them, that they should

be ready for all things. ²⁹ And he perceived that the money of his treasures failed, and that the tributes of the country were small, because of the dissension, and the evil that he had brought upon the land, that he might take away the laws of old times: ³⁰ And he feared that he should not have as formerly enough for charges and gifts, which he had given before with a liberal hand: for he had abounded more than the kings that had been before him. ³¹ And he was greatly perplexed in mind, and purposed to go into Persia, and to take tributes of the countries, and to gather much money. ³² And he left Lysias, a nobleman of the blood royal to oversee the affairs of the kingdom from the river Euphrates even to the river of Egypt: ³³ And to bring up his son, Antiochus, till he came again. ³⁴ And he delivered to him half the army, and the elephants: and he gave him charge concerning all that he would have done, and concerning the inhabitants of Judea, and Jerusalem. ³⁵ And that he should send an army against them to destroy and root out the strength of Israel, and the remnant of Jerusalem, and to take away the memory of them from that place. ³⁶ And that he should settle strangers, to dwell in all their coasts, and divide their land by lot. ³⁷ So the king took the half of the army that remained, and went forth from Antioch, the chief city of his kingdom, in the hundred and forty-seventh year: and he passed over the river Euphrates, and went through the higher countries. ³⁸ Then Lysias chose Ptolemee, the son of Dorymenus, and Nicanor, and Gorgias, mighty men of the king's friends. ³⁹ And he sent with them forty thousand men, and seven thousand horsemen: to go into the land of Juda, and to destroy it, according to the king's orders. ⁴⁰ So they went forth with all their power, and came, and pitched near Emmaus, in the plain country. ⁴¹ And the merchants of the countries heard the fame of them: and they took silver and gold in abundance, and servants: and they came into the camp, to buy the children of Israel for slaves: and there were joined to them the forces of Syria, and of the land of the strangers. ⁴² And Judas, and his brethren, saw that evils were multiplied, and that the armies approached to their borders: and they knew the orders the king had given to destroy the people, and utterly abolish them. ⁴³ And they said, every man to his neighbour: Let us raise up the low condition of our people, and let us fight for our people, and our sanctuary. ⁴⁴ And the assembly was gathered, that they might be ready for battle, and that they might pray, and ask mercy and compassion. ⁴⁵ Now Jerusalem was not inhabited, but was like a desert: there was none of her children that went in or out: and the sanctuary was trodden down: and the children of strangers were in the castle, there was the habitation of the Gentiles: and joy was taken away from Jacob, and the pipe and harp ceased there. ⁴⁶ And they assembled together, and came to Maspha, over against Jerusalem: for in Maspha was a place of prayer heretofore in Israel. ⁴⁷ And they fasted that day, and put on haircloth, and put ashes upon their heads: and they rent their garments: ⁴⁸ And they laid open the books of the law, in which the Gentiles searched for the likeness of their idols: ⁴⁹ And they brought the priestly ornaments, and the first fruits and tithes, and stirred up the Nazarites that had fulfilled their days: ⁵⁰ And they cried with a loud voice toward heaven, saying: What shall we do with these, and whither shall we carry them? ⁵¹ For thy holies are trodden down, and are profaned, and thy priests are

in mourning, and are brought low. ⁵² And behold the nations are come together against us, to destroy us: thou knowest what they intend against us. ⁵³ How shall we be able to stand before their face, unless thou, O God, help us? ⁵⁴ Then they sounded with trumpets, and cried out with a loud voice. ⁵⁵ And after this, Judas appointed captains over the people, over thousands, and over hundreds, and over fifties, and over tens. ⁵⁶ And he said to them that were building houses, or had betrothed wives, or were planting vineyards, or were fearful, that they should return every man to his house, according to the law. ⁵⁷ So they removed the camp, and pitched on the south side of Emmaus. ⁵⁸ And Judas said: Gird yourselves, and be valiant men, and be ready against the morning, that you may fight with these nations that are assembled against us to destroy us and our sanctuary. ⁵⁹ For it is better for us to die in battle, than to see the evils of our nation, and of the holies: ⁶⁰ Nevertheless, as it shall be the will of God in heaven, so be it done.

267. The sanctuary cleansed

1 Maccabees 4:36-61

The dedication kept afterwards as a feast, and named in St. John 10:22, which this plan reads.

4 ³⁶ Then Judas, and his brethren said: Behold our enemies are discomfited: let us go up now to cleanse the holy places, and to repair them. ³⁷ And all the army assembled together, and they went up into Mount Sion. ³⁸ And they saw the sanctuary desolate, and the altar profaned, and the gates burnt, and shrubs growing up in the courts as in a forest, or on the mountains, and the chambers joining to the temple thrown down. ³⁹ And they rent their garments, and made great lamentation, and put ashes on their heads: ⁴⁰ And they fell down to the ground on their faces, and they sounded with the trumpets of alarm, and they cried towards heaven. ⁴¹ Then Judas appointed men to fight against them that were in the castle, till they had cleansed the holy places, ⁴² And he chose priests without blemish, whose will was set upon the law of God. ⁴³ And they cleansed the holy places, and took away the stones that had been defiled into an unclean place. ⁴⁴ And he considered about the altar of holocausts that had been profaned, what he should do with it. ⁴⁵ And a good counsel came into their minds, to pull it down: lest it should be a reproach to them, because the Gentiles had defiled it; so they threw it down. ⁴⁶ And they laid up the stones in the mountain of the temple, in a convenient place, till there should come a prophet, and give answer concerning them. ⁴⁷ Then they took whole stones, according to the law and built a new altar, according to the former: ⁴⁸ And they built up the holy places, and the things that were within the temple: and they sanctified the temple and the courts. ⁴⁹ And they made new holy vessels, and brought in the candlestick, and the altar of incense, and the table, into the temple. ⁵⁰ And they put incense upon the altar, and lighted up the lamps that were upon the candlestick, and they gave light in the temple. ⁵¹ And they set the loaves upon the table, and hung up the veils, and finished all the works that they had begun to make. ⁵² And they arose before the morning on the five and twentieth day of the ninth month, (which is the month of Casleu) in the hundred and forty-eighth year. ⁵³ And they offered sacrifice, according to the law, upon the new altar

of holocausts which they had made. ⁵⁴ According to the time, and according to the day wherein the heathens had defiled it, in the same was it dedicated anew with canticles, and harps, and lutes, and cymbals. ⁵⁵ And all the people fell upon their faces, and adored, and blessed up to heaven, him that had prospered them. ⁵⁶ And they kept the dedication of the altar eight days, and they offered holocausts with joy, and sacrifices of salvation, and of praise. ⁵⁷ And they adorned the front of the temple with crowns of gold, and escutcheons, and they renewed the gates, and the chambers, and hanged doors upon them. ⁵⁸ And there was exceeding great joy among the people, and the reproach of the Gentiles was turned away. ⁵⁹ And Judas, and his brethren, and all the church of Israel decreed, that the day of the dedication of the altar should be kept in its season from year to year for eight days, from the five and twentieth day of the month of Casleu, with joy and gladness. ⁶⁰ They built up also at that time Mount Sion, with high walls, and strong towers round about, lest the Gentiles should at any time come, and tread it down, as they did before. ⁶¹ And he placed a garrison there, to keep it, and he fortified it, to secure Bethsura, that the people might have a defence against Idumea.

272. The death of Judas; Jonathan succeeds

1 Maccabees 9:1-73

9 ¹ In the mean time, when Demetrius heard that Nicanor and his army were fallen in battle, he sent again Bacchides and Alcimus into Judea; and the right wing of his army with them. ² And they took the road that leadeth to Galgal, and they camped in Masaloth, which is in Arabella: and they made themselves masters of it, and slew many people. ³ In the first month of the hundred and fifty-second year they brought the army to Jerusalem: ⁴ And they arose and went to Berea, with twenty thousand men, and two thousand horsemen. ⁵ Now Judas had pitched his tents in Laiza, and three thousand chosen men with him: ⁶ And they saw the multitude of the army that they were many, and they were seized with great fear: and many withdrew themselves out of the camp, and there remained of them no more than eight hundred men. ⁷ And Judas saw that his army slipped away, and the battle pressed upon him, and his heart was cast down: because he had not time to gather them together, and he was discouraged. ⁸ Then he said to them that remained: Let us arise, and go against our enemies, if we may be able to fight against them. ⁹ But they dissuaded him, saying: We shall not be able, but let us save our lives now, and return to our brethren, and then we will fight against them: for we are but few. ¹⁰ Then Judas said: God forbid we should do this thing, and flee away from them: but if our time be come, let us die manfully for our brethren, and let us not stain our glory. ¹¹ And the army removed out of the camp, and they stood over against them: and the horsemen were divided into two troops, and the slingers, and the archers, went before the army, and they that were in the front were all men of valour. ¹² And Bacchides was in the right wing, and the legion drew near on two sides, and they sounded the trumpets: ¹³ And they also that were on Judas's side, even they also cried out, and the earth shook at the noise of the armies: and the battle was fought from morning even unto the evening. ¹⁴ And Judas perceived that the stronger part of the army of Bacchides was on the right side, and all the stout

of heart came together with him: ¹⁵ And the right wing was discomfited by them, and he pursued them even to the mount Azotus. ¹⁶ And they that were in the left wing saw that the right wing was discomfited, and they followed after Judas, and them that were with him, at their back: ¹⁷ And the battle was hard fought, and there fell many wounded of the one side and of the other. ¹⁸ And Judas was slain, and the rest fled away. ¹⁹ And Jonathan and Simon took Judas, their brother, and buried him in the sepulchre of their fathers, in the city of Modin. ²⁰ And all the people of Israel bewailed him with great lamentation, and they mourned for him many days. ²¹ And said: How is the mighty man fallen, that saved the people of Israel! ²² But the rest of the words of the wars of Judas, and of the noble acts that he did, and of his greatness, are not written: for they were very many. ²³ And it came to pass, after the death of Judas, that the wicked began to put forth their heads in all the confines of Israel, and all the workers of iniquity rose up. ²⁴ In those days there was a very great famine, and they and all their country yielded to Bacchides. ²⁵ And Bacchides chose the wicked men, and made them lords of the country: ²⁶ And they sought out, and made diligent search after the friends of Judas, and brought them to Bacchides, and he took vengeance of them, and abused them. ²⁷ And there was a great tribulation in Israel, such as was not since the day, that there was no prophet seen in Israel. ²⁸ And all the friends of Judas came together, and said to Jonathan: ²⁹ Since thy brother Judas died there is not a man like him to go forth against our enemies, Bacchides, and them that are the enemies of our nation. ³⁰ Now, therefore, we have chosen thee this day to be our prince, and captain, in his stead, to fight our battles. ³¹ So Jonathan took upon him the government at that time, and rose up in the place of Judas, his brother. ³² And Bacchides had knowledge of it, and sought to kill him. ³³ And Jonathan, and Simon, his brother, knew it, and all that were with them: and they fled into the desert of Thecua, and they pitched by the water of the lake Asphar. ³⁴ And Bacchides understood it, and he came himself, with all his army, over the Jordan, on the sabbath day. ³⁵ And Jonathan sent his brother, a captain of the people, to desire the Nabutheans his friends, that they would lend them their equipage, which was copious. ³⁶ And the children of Jambri came forth out of Madaba, and took John, and all that he had, and went away with them. ³⁷ After this it was told Jonathan, and Simon, his brother, that the children of Jambri made a great marriage, and were bringing the bride out of Madaba, the daughter of one of the great princes of Chanaan, with great pomp. ³⁸ And they remembered the blood of John, their brother: and they went up, and hid themselves under the covert of the mountain. ³⁹ And they lifted up their eyes, and saw: and behold a tumult, and great preparation: and the bridegroom came forth, and his friends, and his brethren to meet them with timbrels, and musical instruments and many weapons. ⁴⁰ And they rose up against them from the place where they lay in ambush, and slew them, and there fell many wounded, and the rest fled into the mountains, and they took all their spoils: ⁴¹ And the marriage was turned into mourning, and the noise of their musical instruments into lamentation. ⁴² And they took revenge for the blood of their brother: and they returned to the bank of the Jordan. ⁴³ And Bacchides heard it, and he came on the sabbath day even to the bank of the Jordan, with a great

power. ⁴⁴ And Jonathan said to his company: Let us arise, and fight against our enemies: for it is not now as yesterday, and the day before. ⁴⁵ For behold the battle is before us, and the water of the Jordan on this side and on that side, and banks, and marshes, and woods: and there is no place for us to turn aside. ⁴⁶ Now, therefore, cry ye to heaven, that ye may be delivered from the hand of your enemies. And they joined battle. ⁴⁷ And Jonathan stretched forth his hand to strike Bacchides, but he turned away from him backwards. ⁴⁸ And Jonathan, and they that were with him, leapt into the Jordan, and swam over the Jordan to them. ⁴⁹ And there fell of Bacchides' side that day a thousand men: and they returned to Jerusalem. ⁵⁰ And they built strong cities in Judea, the fortress that was in Jericho, and in Ammaus, and in Bethoron, and in Bethel, and Thamnata, and Phara, and Thopo, with high walls, and gates, and bars. ⁵¹ And he placed garrisons in them, that they might wage war against Israel: ⁵² And he fortified the city of Bethsura, and Gazara, and the castle, and set garrisons in them, and provisions of victuals: ⁵³ And he took the sons of the chief men of the country for hostages, and put them in the castle in Jerusalem in custody. ⁵⁴ Now in the year one hundred and fifty-three, the second month, Alcimus commanded the walls of the inner court of the sanctuary to be thrown down, and the works of the prophets to be destroyed: and he began to destroy. ⁵⁵ At that time Alcimus was struck: and his works were hindered, and his mouth was stopped, and he was taken with a palsy, so that he could no more speak a word, nor give order concerning his house. ⁵⁶ And Alcimus died at that time in great torment. ⁵⁷ And Bacchides saw that Alcimus was dead: and he returned to the king, and the land was quiet for two years. ⁵⁸ And all the wicked held a council, saying: Behold Jonathan, and they that are with him, dwell at ease and without fear: now, therefore, let us bring Bacchides hither, and he shall take them all in one night. ⁵⁹ So they went, and gave him counsel. ⁶⁰ And he arose to come with a great army: and he sent secretly letters to his adherents that were in Judea to seize upon Jonathan, and them that were with him: but they could not, for their design was known to them. ⁶¹ And he apprehended of the men of the country, that were the principal authors of the mischief, fifty men, and he slew them. ⁶² And Jonathan, and Simon, and they that were with him, retired into Bethbessen, which is in the desert: and he repaired the breaches thereof, and they fortified it. ⁶³ And when Bacchides knew it, he gathered together all his multitude: and sent word to them that were of Judea. ⁶⁴ And he came, and camped above Bethbessen, and fought against it many days, and made engines. ⁶⁵ But Jonathan left his brother, Simon, in the city and went forth into the country, and came with a number of men, ⁶⁶ And struck Odares, and his brethren, and the children of Phaseron, in their tents, and he began to slay, and to increase in forces. ⁶⁷ But Simon, and they that were with him, sallied out of the city, and burnt the engines, ⁶⁸ And they fought against Bacchides, and he was discomfited by them: and they afflicted him exceedingly, for his counsel, and his enterprise was in vain. ⁶⁹ And he was angry with the wicked men that had given him counsel to come into their country, and he slew many of them: and he purposed to return with the rest into their country. ⁷⁰ And Jonathan had knowledge of it, and he sent ambassadors to him to make peace with him, and to

restore to him the prisoners.⁷¹ And he accepted it willingly, and did according to his words, and swore that he would do him no harm all the days of his life.⁷² And he restored to him the prisoners which he before had taken out of the land of Juda: and he returned, and went away into his own country, and he came no more into their borders.⁷³ So the sword ceased from Israel: and Jonathan dwelt in Machmas, and Jonathan began there to judge the people, and he destroyed the wicked out of Israel.

276. Simon, and the freedom of Israel

1 Maccabees 13:1-54

13 ¹ Now Simon heard that Tryphon was gathering together a very great army to invade the land of Juda, and to destroy it.² And seeing that the people was in dread and in fear, he went up to Jerusalem, and assembled the people,³ And exhorted them, saying: You know what great battles I and my brethren, and the house of my father, have fought for the laws, and the sanctuary, and the distresses that we have seen:⁴ By reason whereof all my brethren have lost their lives for Israel's sake, and I am left alone.⁵ And now far be it from me to spare my life in any time of trouble: for I am not better than my brethren.⁶ I will avenge then my nation and the sanctuary, and our children, and wives: for all the heathens are gathered together to destroy us out of mere malice.⁷ And the spirit of the people was enkindled as soon as they heard these words:⁸ And they answered with a loud voice, saying: Thou art our leader in the place of Judas, and Jonathan, thy brother:⁹ Fight thou our battles, and we will do whatsoever thou shalt say to us.¹⁰ So gathering together all the men of war, he made haste to finish all the walls of Jerusalem, and he fortified it round about.¹¹ And he sent Jonathan, the son of Absalom, and with him a new army, into Joppe, and he cast out them that were in it, and himself remained there.¹² And Tryphon removed from Ptolemais with a great army, to invade the land of Juda, and Jonathan was with him in custody.¹³ But Simon pitched in Addus, over against the plain.¹⁴ And when Tryphon understood that Simon was risen up in the place of his brother, Jonathan, and that he meant to join battle with him, he sent messengers to him,¹⁵ Saying: We have detained thy brother, Jonathan, for the money that he owed in the king's account, by reason of the affairs which he had the management of.¹⁶ But now send a hundred talents of silver, and his two sons for hostages, that when he is set at liberty he may not revolt from us, and we will release him.¹⁷ Now Simon knew that he spoke deceitfully to him; nevertheless, he ordered the money and the children to be sent, lest he should bring upon himself a great hatred of the people of Israel, who might have said:¹⁸ Because he sent not the money and the children therefore is he lost.¹⁹ So he sent the children and the hundred talents and he lied, and did not let Jonathan go.²⁰ And after this, Tryphon entered within the country, to destroy it: and they went about by the way that leadeth to Ador: and Simon and his army marched to every place whithersoever they went.²¹ And they that were in the castle, sent messengers to Tryphon, that he should make haste to come through the desert, and send them victuals.²² And Tryphon made ready all his horsemen to come that night; but there fell a very great snow, and he came not into the country of Galaad.²³ And when he approached to Bascama, he slew Jonathan and his sons there.²⁴ And Tryphon returned, and went

into his own country.²⁵ And Simon sent, and took the bones of Jonathan, his brother, and buried them in Modin, the city of his fathers.²⁶ And all Israel bewailed him with great lamentation: and they mourned for him many days.²⁷ And Simon built over the sepulchre of his father and of his brethren, a building lofty to the sight, of polished stone, behind and before:²⁸ And he set up seven pyramids, one against another, for his father, and his mother, and his four brethren:²⁹ And round about these he set great pillars; and upon the pillars, arms, for a perpetual memory; and by the arms, ships carved, which might be seen by all that sailed on the sea.³⁰ This is the sepulchre that he made in Modin, even unto this day.³¹ But Tryphon, when he was upon a journey with the young king, Antiochus, treacherously slew him.³² And he reigned in his place, and put on the crown of Asia: and brought great evils upon the land.³³ And Simon built up the strong holds of Judea, fortifying them with high towers, and great walls, and gates and bars: and he stored up victuals in the fortresses.³⁴ And Simon chose men, and sent to king Demetrius, to the end that he should grant an immunity to the land; for all that Tryphon did, was to spoil.³⁵ And king Demetrius, in answer to this request, wrote a letter in this manner:³⁶ King Demetrius to Simon, the high priest, and friend of kings, and to the ancients, and to the nation of the Jews, greeting:³⁷ The golden crown, and the palm, which you sent, we have received: and we are ready to make a firm peace with you, and to write to the king's chief officers to release you the things that we have released.³⁸ For all that we have decreed in your favour shall stand in force. The strong holds that you have built, shall be your own.³⁹ And as for any oversight or fault committed unto this day, we forgive it: and the crown which you owed: and if any other thing were taxed in Jerusalem, now let it not be taxed.⁴⁰ And if any of you be fit to be enrolled among ours, let them be enrolled, and let there be peace between us.⁴¹ In the year one hundred and seventy, the yoke of the Gentiles was taken off from Israel.⁴² And the people of Israel began to write in the instruments, and public records, The first year under Simon, the high priest, the great captain, and prince of the Jews.⁴³ In those days Simon besieged Gaza, and camped round about it, and he made engines, and set them to the city, and he struck one tower, and took it.⁴⁴ And they that were within the engine leapt into the city: and there was a great uproar in the city.⁴⁵ And they that were in the city went up, with their wives and children, upon the wall, with their garments rent, and they cried with a loud voice, beseeching Simon to grant them peace.⁴⁶ And they said: Deal not with us according to our evil deeds, but according to thy mercy.⁴⁷ And Simon being moved, did not destroy them but yet he cast them out of the city, and cleansed the houses wherein there had been idols, and then he entered into it with hymns, blessing the Lord:⁴⁸ And having cast out of it all uncleanness, he placed in it men that should observe the law: and he fortified it, and made it his habitation.⁴⁹ But they that were in the castle of Jerusalem were hindered from going out and coming into the country, and from buying and selling: and they were straitened with hunger, and many of them perished through famine.⁵⁰ And they cried to Simon for peace, and he granted it to them: and he cast them out from thence and cleansed the castle from uncleannesses.⁵¹ And they entered into it the three and twentieth day of the second month, in the year one hundred

and seventy-one, with thanksgiving, and branches of palm trees, and harps, and cymbals, and psalteries, and hymns, and canticles, because the great enemy was destroyed out of Israel. ⁵² And he ordained that these days should be kept every year with gladness. ⁵³ And he fortified the mountain of the temple that was near the castle, and he dwelt there himself, and they that were with him. ⁵⁴ And Simon saw that John, his son, was a valiant man for war: and he made him captain of all the forces: and he dwelt in Gazara.

THE LIFE OF CHRIST

St. Luke entire is the spine of this period: it is the gospel written as a continuous narrative, and it carries the infancy, the journey to Jerusalem, and the resurrection appearances. St. Matthew, St. Mark and St. John enter at the year tier only, and only where they give what St. Luke does not.

282. The Annunciation and the Nativity

Luke 1:26-38; 2:1-20 — here Luke 1:26-2:20

Read as one sitting from two places in St. Luke. The angel's promise of a throne and a kingdom without end answers 2 Samuel 7, read earlier in this plan.

1 ²⁶ And in the sixth month, the angel Gabriel was sent from God into a city of Galilee, called Nazareth, ²⁷ To a virgin espoused to a man whose name was Joseph, of the house of David: and the virgin's name was Mary. ²⁸ And the angel being come in, said unto her: Hail, full of grace, the Lord is with thee: blessed art thou among women. ²⁹ Who having heard, was troubled at his saying and thought with herself what manner of salutation this should be. ³⁰ And the angel said to her: Fear not, Mary, for thou hast found grace with God. ³¹ Behold thou shalt conceive in thy womb and shalt bring forth a son: and thou shalt call his name Jesus. ³² He shall be great and shall be called the Son of the Most High. And the Lord God shall give unto him the throne of David his father: and he shall reign in the house of Jacob for ever. ³³ And of his kingdom there shall be no end. ³⁴ And Mary said to the angel: How shall this be done, because I know not man? ³⁵ And the angel answering, said to her: The Holy Ghost shall come upon thee and the power of the Most High shall overshadow thee. And therefore also the Holy which shall be born of thee shall be called the Son of God. ³⁶ And behold thy cousin Elizabeth, she also hath conceived a son in her old age: and this is the sixth month with her that is called barren. ³⁷ Because no word shall be impossible with God. ³⁸ And Mary said: Behold the handmaid of the Lord: be it done to me according to thy word. And the angel departed from her.

2 ¹ And it came to pass that in those days there went out a decree from Caesar Augustus that the whole world should be enrolled.

² This enrolling was first made by Cyrenus, the governor of Syria.

³ And all went to be enrolled, every one into his own city. ⁴ And Joseph also went up from Galilee, out of the city of Nazareth, into Judea, to the city of David, which is called Bethlehem: because he was of the house and family of David. ⁵ To be enrolled with Mary his espoused wife, who was with child. ⁶ And it came to pass that when they were there, her days were accomplished that she should be delivered. ⁷ And she brought forth her first born son and wrapped him up in swaddling clothes and laid him in a

manger: because there was no room for them in the inn. ⁸ And there were in the same country shepherds watching and keeping the night watches over their flock. ⁹ And behold an angel of the Lord stood by them and the brightness of God shone round about them: and they feared with a great fear. ¹⁰ And the angel said to them: Fear not; for, behold, I bring you good tidings of great joy that shall be to all the people: ¹¹ For, this day is born to you a Saviour, who is Christ the Lord, in the city of David. ¹² And this shall be a sign unto you. You shall find the infant wrapped in swaddling clothes and laid in a manger. ¹³ And suddenly there was with the angel a multitude of the heavenly army, praising God and saying: ¹⁴ Glory to God in the highest: and on earth peace to men of good will. ¹⁵ And it came to pass, after the angels departed from them into heaven, the shepherds said one to another: Let us go over to Bethlehem and let us see this word that is come to pass, which the Lord hath shewed to us. ¹⁶ And they came with haste: and they found Mary and Joseph, and the infant lying in the manger. ¹⁷ And seeing, they understood of the word that had been spoken to them concerning this child. ¹⁸ And all that heard wondered: and at those things that were told them by the shepherds. ¹⁹ But Mary kept all these words, pondering them in her heart. ²⁰ And the shepherds returned, glorifying and praising God for all the things they had heard and seen, as it was told unto them.

283. The Visitation, and the Magnificat

Luke 1:39-56

The canticle answers Anna's in 1 Samuel 2.

1 ³⁹ And Mary rising up in those days, went into the hill country with haste into a city of Juda. ⁴⁰ And she entered into the house of Zachary and saluted Elizabeth. ⁴¹ And it came to pass that when Elizabeth heard the salutation of Mary, the infant leaped in her womb. And Elizabeth was filled with the Holy Ghost. ⁴² And she cried out with a loud voice and said: Blessed art thou among women and blessed is the fruit of thy womb. ⁴³ And whence is this to me that the mother of my Lord should come to me? ⁴⁴ For behold as soon as the voice of thy salutation sounded in my ears, the infant in my womb leaped for joy. ⁴⁵ And blessed art thou that hast believed, because those things shall be accomplished that were spoken to thee by the Lord. ⁴⁶ And Mary said: My soul doth magnify the Lord. ⁴⁷ And my spirit hath rejoiced in God my Saviour. ⁴⁸ Because he hath regarded the humility of his handmaid: for behold from henceforth all generations shall call me blessed. ⁴⁹ Because he that is mighty hath done great things to me: and holy is his name. ⁵⁰ And his mercy is from generation unto generations, to them that fear him. ⁵¹ He hath shewed might in his arm: he hath scattered the proud in the conceit of their heart. ⁵² He hath put down the mighty from their seat and hath exalted the humble. ⁵³ He hath filled the hungry with good things: and the rich he hath sent empty away. ⁵⁴ He hath received Israel his servant, being mindful of his mercy. ⁵⁵ As he spoke to our fathers: to Abraham and to his seed for ever. ⁵⁶ And Mary abode with her about three months. And she returned to her own house.

285. The presentation, and the finding in the temple*Luke 2:21-52*

2 ²¹ And after eight days were accomplished, that the child should be circumcised, his name was called JESUS, which was called by the angel before he was conceived in the womb. ²² And after the days of her purification, according to the law of Moses, were accomplished, they carried him to Jerusalem, to present him to the Lord: ²³ As it is written in the law of the Lord: Every male opening the womb shall be called holy to the Lord: ²⁴ And to offer a sacrifice, according as it is written in the law of the Lord, a pair of turtledoves or two young pigeons: ²⁵ And behold there was a man in Jerusalem named Simeon: and this man was just and devout, waiting for the consolation of Israel. And the Holy Ghost was in him. ²⁶ And he had received an answer from the Holy Ghost, that he should not see death before he had seen the Christ of the Lord. ²⁷ And he came by the Spirit into the temple. And when his parents brought in the child Jesus, to do for him according to the custom of the law, ²⁸ He also took him into his arms and blessed God and said ²⁹ Now thou dost dismiss thy servant, O Lord, according to thy word in peace: ³⁰ Because my eyes have seen thy salvation, ³¹ Which thou hast prepared before the face of all peoples: ³² A light to the revelation of the Gentiles and the glory of thy people Israel. ³³ And his father and mother were wondering at those things which were spoken concerning him. ³⁴ And Simeon blessed them and said to Mary his mother: Behold this child is set for the fall and for the resurrection of many in Israel and for a sign which shall be contradicted. ³⁵ And thy own soul a sword shall pierce, that, out of many hearts thoughts may be revealed. ³⁶ And there was one Anna, a prophetess, the daughter of Phanuel, of the tribe of Aser. She was far advanced in years and had lived with her husband seven years from her virginity. ³⁷ And she was a widow until fourscore and four years: who departed not from the temple, by fastings and prayers serving night and day. ³⁸ Now she, at the same hour, coming in, confessed to the Lord: and spoke of him to all that looked for the redemption of Israel. ³⁹ And after they had performed all things according to the law of the Lord, they returned into Galilee, to their city Nazareth. ⁴⁰ And the child grew and waxed strong, full of wisdom: and the grace of God was in him. ⁴¹ And his parents went every year to Jerusalem, at the solemn day of the pasch. ⁴² And when he was twelve years old, they going up into Jerusalem, according to the custom of the feast, ⁴³ And having fulfilled the days, when they returned, the child Jesus remained in Jerusalem. And his parents knew it not. ⁴⁴ And thinking that he was in the company, they came a day's journey and sought him among their kinsfolks and acquaintance. ⁴⁵ And not finding him, they returned into Jerusalem, seeking him. ⁴⁶ And it came to pass, that, after three days, they found him in the temple, sitting in the midst of the doctors, hearing them and asking them questions. ⁴⁷ And all that heard him were astonished at his wisdom and his answers. ⁴⁸ And seeing him, they wondered. And his mother said to him: Son, why hast thou done so to us? Behold thy father and I have sought thee sorrowing. ⁴⁹ And he said to them: How is it that you sought me? Did you not know that I must be about my father's business? ⁵⁰ And they understood not the word that he spoke unto them. ⁵¹ And he went down with them and came to Nazareth and was

subject to them. And his mother kept all these words in her heart. ⁵² And Jesus advanced in wisdom and age and grace with God and men.

288. John the Baptist, and the baptism of Christ*Luke 3:1-38*

3 ¹ Now in the fifteenth year of the reign of Tiberius Caesar, Pontius Pilate being governor of Judea, and Herod being tetrarch of Galilee, and Philip his brother tetrarch of Iturea and the country of Trachonitis, and Lysanias tetrarch of Abilina: ² Under the high priests Annas and Caiphas: the word of the Lord was made unto John, the son of Zachary, in the desert. ³ And he came into all the country about the Jordan, preaching the baptism of penance for the remission of sins. ⁴ As it was written in the book of the sayings of Isaias the prophet: A voice of one crying in the wilderness: Prepare ye the way of the Lord, make straight his paths. ⁵ Every valley shall be filled and every mountain and hill shall be brought low: and the crooked shall be made straight, and the rough ways plain. ⁶ And all flesh shall see the salvation of God. ⁷ He said therefore to the multitudes that went forth to be baptized by him: Ye offspring of vipers, who hath shewed you to flee from the wrath to come? ⁸ Bring forth therefore fruits worthy of penance: and do not begin to say, We have Abraham for our father. For I say unto you that God is able of these stones, to raise up children to Abraham. ⁹ For now the axe is laid to the root of the trees. Every tree therefore that bringeth not forth good fruit shall be cut down and cast into the fire. ¹⁰ And the people asked him, saying: What then shall we do? ¹¹ And he answering, said to them: He that hath two coats, let him give to him that hath none; and he that hath meat, let him do in like manner. ¹² And the publicans also came to be baptized and said to him: Master, what shall we do? ¹³ But he said to them: Do nothing more than that which is appointed you. ¹⁴ And the soldiers also asked him, saying: And what shall we do? And he said to them: Do violence to no man, neither calumniate any man; and be content with your pay. ¹⁵ And as the people were of opinion, and all were thinking in their hearts of John, that perhaps he might be the Christ: ¹⁶ John answered, saying unto all: I indeed baptize you with water: but there shall come one mightier than I, the latchet of whose shoes I am not worthy to loose. He shall baptize you with the Holy Ghost and with fire; ¹⁷ Whose fan is in his hand: and he will purge his floor and will gather the wheat into his barn: but the chaff he will burn with unquenchable fire. ¹⁸ And many other things exhorting did he preach to the people. ¹⁹ But Herod the tetrarch, when he was reproved by him for Herodias, his brother's wife, and for all the evils which Herod had done: ²⁰ He added this also above all and shut up John in prison. ²¹ Now it came to pass, when all the people were baptized, that Jesus also being baptized and praying, heaven was opened. ²² And the Holy Ghost descended in a bodily shape, as a dove, upon him. And a voice came from heaven: Thou art my beloved Son. In thee I am well pleased. ²³ And Jesus himself was beginning about the age of thirty years: being (as it was supposed) the son of Joseph, who was of Heli, who was of Mathat, ²⁴ Who was of Levi, who was of Melchi, who was of Janne, who was of Joseph, ²⁵ Who was of Mathathias, who was of Amos, who was of Nahum, who was of Hesli, who was of Nagge, ²⁶ Who was of Mahath, who was of Mathathias, who

was of Semei, who was of Joseph, who was of Juda,²⁷ Who was of Joanna, who was of Reza, who was of Zorobabel, who was of Salathiel, who was of Neri,²⁸ Who was of Melchi, who was of Addi, who was of Cosan, who was of Helmadan, who was of Her,²⁹ Who was of Jesus, who was of Eliezer, who was of Jorim, who was of Mathat, who was of Levi,³⁰ Who was of Simeon, who was of Judas, who was of Joseph, who was of Jona, who was of Eliakim,³¹ Who was of Melea, who was of Menna, who was of Mathatha, who was of Nathan, who was of David,³² Who was of Jesse, who was of Obed, who was of Booz, who was of Salmon, who was of Naasson,³³ Who was of Aminadab, who was of Aram, who was of Esron, who was of Phares, who was of Judas,³⁴ Who was of Jacob, who was of Isaac, who was of Abraham, who was of Thare, who was of Nachor,³⁵ Who was of Sarug, who was of Ragau, who was of Phaleg, who was of Heber, who was of Sale,³⁶ Who was of Cainan, who was of Arphaxad, who was of Sem, who was of Noe, who was of Lamech,³⁷ Who was of Mathusale, who was of Henoah, who was of Jared, who was of Malaleel, who was of Cainan,³⁸ Who was of Henos, who was of Seth, who was of Adam, who was of God.

289. The temptation

Luke 4:1-13

Christ answers out of Deuteronomy 6 and 8, both read in this plan.

4 ¹ And Jesus being full of the Holy Ghost, returned from the Jordan and was led by the spirit into the desert, ² For the space of forty days, and was tempted by the devil. And he ate nothing in those days. And when they were ended, he was hungry. ³ And the devil said to him: If thou be the Son of God, say to this stone that it be made bread. ⁴ And Jesus answered him: It is written that Man liveth not by bread alone, but by every word of God. ⁵ And the devil led him into a high mountain and shewed him all the kingdoms of the world in a moment of time. ⁶ And he said to him: To thee will I give all this power and the glory of them. For to me they are delivered: and to whom I will, I give them. ⁷ If thou therefore wilt adore before me, all shall be thine. ⁸ And Jesus answering said to him. It is written: Thou shalt adore the Lord thy God, and him only shalt thou serve. ⁹ And he brought him to Jerusalem and set him on a pinnacle of the temple and said to him: If thou be the Son of God, cast thyself from hence. ¹⁰ For it is written that He hath given his angels charge over thee that they keep thee. ¹¹ And that in their hands they shall bear thee up, lest perhaps thou dash thy foot against a stone. ¹² And Jesus answering, said to him: It is said: Thou shalt not tempt the Lord thy God. ¹³ And all the temptation being ended, the devil departed from him for a time.

290. "This day is fulfilled this scripture"

Luke 4:14-44

Nazareth. The widow of Sarephta and Naaman, cited here, were read in the Divided Kingdom.

4 ¹⁴ And Jesus returned in the power of the spirit, into Galilee: and the fame of him went out through the whole country. ¹⁵ And he taught in their synagogues and was magnified by all.

¹⁶ And he came to Nazareth, where he was brought up: and he went into the synagogue, according to his custom, on the

sabbath day: and he rose up to read. ¹⁷ And the book of Isaias the prophet was delivered unto him. And as he unfolded the book, he found the place where it was written: ¹⁸ The spirit of the Lord is upon me. Wherefore he hath anointed me to preach the gospel to the poor, he hath sent me to heal the contrite of heart, ¹⁹ To preach deliverance to the captives and sight to the blind, to set at liberty them that are bruised, to preach the acceptable year of the Lord and the day of reward. ²⁰ And when he had folded the book, he restored it to the minister and sat down. And the eyes of all in the synagogue were fixed on him. ²¹ And he began to say to them: This day is fulfilled this scripture in your ears. ²² And all gave testimony to him. And they wondered at the words of grace that proceeded from his mouth. And they said: Is not this the son of Joseph? ²³ And he said to them: Doubtless you will say to me this similitude: Physician, heal thyself. As great things as we have heard done in Capharnaum, do also here in thy own country. ²⁴ And he said: Amen I say to you that no prophet is accepted in his own country. ²⁵ In truth I say to you, there were many widows in the days of Elias in Israel, when heaven was shut up three years and six months, when there was a great famine throughout all the earth. ²⁶ And to none of them was Elias sent, but to Sarepta of Sidon, to a widow woman. ²⁷ And there were many lepers in Israel in the time of Eliseus the prophet: and none of them was cleansed but Naaman the Syrian. ²⁸ And all they in the synagogue, hearing these things, were filled with anger. ²⁹ And they rose up and thrust him out of the city: and they brought him to the brow of the hill whereon their city was built, that they might cast him down headlong. ³⁰ But he passing through the midst of them, went his way. ³¹ And he went down into Capharnaum, a city of Galilee: and there he taught them on the sabbath days. ³² And they were astonished at his doctrine: for his speech was with power. ³³ And in the synagogue there was a man who had an unclean devil: and he cried out with a loud voice, ³⁴ Saying: Let us alone. What have we to do with thee, Jesus of Nazareth? Art thou come to destroy us? I know thee who thou art, the holy one of God. ³⁵ And Jesus rebuked him, saying: Hold thy peace and go out of him. And when the devil had thrown him into the midst, he went out of him and hurt him not at all. ³⁶ And there came fear upon all; and they talked among themselves, saying: What word is this, for with authority and power he commandeth the unclean spirits, and they go out? ³⁷ And the fame of him was published into every place of the country.

³⁸ And Jesus rising up out of the synagogue, went into Simon's house. And Simon's wife's mother was taken with a great fever: and they besought him for her. ³⁹ And standing over her, he commanded the fever: and it left her. And immediately rising, she ministered to them. ⁴⁰ And when the sun was down, all they that had any sick with divers diseases brought them to him. But he, laying his hands on every one of them, healed them. ⁴¹ And devils went out from many, crying out and saying: Thou art the son of God. And rebuking them he suffered them not to speak; for they knew that he was Christ. ⁴² And when it was day, going out he went into a desert place: and the multitudes sought him, and came unto him. And they stayed him that he should not depart from them. ⁴³ To whom he said: To other cities also I

must preach the kingdom of God: for therefore am I sent. ⁴⁴ And he was preaching in the synagogues of Galilee.

304. The confession of Peter, and the Transfiguration

Luke 9:18-36

Moses and Elias, read in this plan at Sinai and at Carmel, stand with him.

9 ¹⁸ And it came to pass, as he was alone praying, his disciples also were with him: and he asked them, saying: Whom do the people say that I am? ¹⁹ But they answered and said: John the Baptist; but some say Elias: and others say that one of the former prophets is risen again. ²⁰ And he said to them: But whom do you say that I am? Simon Peter answering, said: The Christ of God. ²¹ But he strictly charging them, commanded they should tell this to no man. ²² Saying: The Son of man must suffer many things and be rejected by the ancients and chief priests and scribes and be killed and the third day rise again.

²³ And he said to all: If any man will come after me, let him deny himself and take up his cross daily and follow me. ²⁴ For whosoever will save his life shall lose it: for he that shall lose his life for my sake shall save it. ²⁵ For what is a man advantaged, if he gain the whole world and lose himself and cast away himself? ²⁶ For he that shall be ashamed of me and of my words, of him the Son of man shall be ashamed, when he shall come in his majesty and that of his Father and of the holy angels. ²⁷ But I tell you of a truth: There are some standing here that shall not taste death till they see the kingdom of God.

²⁸ And it came to pass, about eight days after these words, that he took Peter and James and John and went up into a mountain to pray. ²⁹ And whilst he prayed, the shape of his countenance was altered and his raiment became white and glittering. ³⁰ And behold two men were talking with him. And they were Moses and Elias, ³¹ Appearing in majesty. And they spoke of his decease that he should accomplish in Jerusalem. ³² But Peter and they that were with him were heavy with sleep. And waking, they saw his glory and the two men that stood with him. ³³ And it came to pass that, as they were departing from him, Peter saith to Jesus: Master, it is good for us to be here: and let us make three tabernacles, one for thee, and one for Moses; and one for Elias: not knowing what he said. ³⁴ And as he spoke these things, there came a cloud and overshadowed them. And they were afraid when they entered into the cloud. ³⁵ And a voice came out of the cloud; saying: This is my beloved son. Hear him. ³⁶ And whilst the voice was uttered Jesus was found alone. And they held their peace and told no man in those days any of these things which they had seen.

308. The seventy-two, the good Samaritan, Martha and Mary

Luke 10:1-42

10 ¹ And after these things, the Lord appointed also other seventy-two. And he sent them two and two before his face into every city and place whither he himself was to come. ² And he said to them: The harvest indeed is great, but the labourers are few. Pray ye therefore the Lord of the harvest that he send labourers into his harvest. ³ Go: Behold I send you as lambs among wolves. ⁴ Carry neither purse, nor scrip, nor shoes: and

salute no man by the way. ⁵ Into whatever house you enter, first say: Peace be to this house. ⁶ And if the son of peace be there, your peace shall rest upon him: but if not, it shall return to you. ⁷ And in the same house, remain, eating and drinking such things as they have: for the labourer is worthy of his hire. Remove not from house to house. ⁸ And into what city soever you enter, and they receive you, eat such things as are set before you. ⁹ And heal the sick that are therein and say to them: The kingdom of God is come nigh unto you. ¹⁰ But into whatsoever city you enter, and they receive you not, going forth into the streets thereof, say: ¹¹ Even the very dust of your city that cleaveth to us, we wipe off against you. Yet know this, that the kingdom of God is at hand. ¹² I say to you, it shall be more tolerable at that day for Sodom than for that city. ¹³ Woe to thee, Corozain! Woe to thee, Bethsaida! For if in Tyre and Sidon had been wrought the mighty works that have been wrought in you, they would have done penance long ago, sitting in sackcloth and ashes. ¹⁴ But it shall be more tolerable for Tyre and Sidon at the judgment than for you. ¹⁵ And thou, Capharnaum, which art exalted unto heaven, thou shalt be thrust down to hell. ¹⁶ He that heareth you heareth me: and he that despiseth you despiseth me: and he that despiseth me despiseth him that sent me.

¹⁷ And the seventy-two returned with joy, saying: Lord, the devils also are subject to us in thy name. ¹⁸ And he said to them: I saw Satan like lightning falling from heaven. ¹⁹ Behold, I have given you power to tread upon serpents and scorpions and upon all the power of the enemy: and nothing shall hurt you. ²⁰ But yet rejoice not in this, that spirits are subject unto you: but rejoice in this, that your names are written in heaven.

²¹ In that same hour, he rejoiced in the Holy Ghost and said: I confess to thee, O Father, Lord of heaven and earth, because thou hast hidden these things from the wise and prudent and hast revealed them to little ones. Yea, Father, for so it hath seemed good in thy sight. ²² All things are delivered to me by my Father. And no one knoweth who the Son is, but the Father: and who the Father is, but the Son and to whom the Son will reveal him.

²³ And turning to his disciples, he said: Blessed are the eyes that see the things which you see. ²⁴ For I say to you that many prophets and kings have desired to see the things that you see and have not seen them; and to hear the things that you hear and have not heard them.

²⁵ And behold a certain lawyer stood up, tempting him and saying, Master, what must I do to possess eternal life? ²⁶ But he said to him: What is written in the law? How readest thou? ²⁷ He answering, said: Thou shalt love the Lord thy God with thy whole heart and with thy whole soul and with all thy strength and with all thy mind: and thy neighbour as thyself. ²⁸ And he said to him: Thou hast answered right. This do: and thou shalt live. ²⁹ But he willing to justify himself, said to Jesus: And who is my neighbour? ³⁰ And Jesus answering, said: A certain man went down from Jerusalem to Jericho and fell among robbers, who also stripped him and having wounded him went away, leaving him half dead. ³¹ And it chanced, that a certain priest went down the same way: and seeing him, passed by. ³² In like manner also a Levite, when he was near the place and saw him, passed by. ³³ But a certain Samaritan, being on his journey, came near him: and seeing him, was moved with compassion: ³⁴ And

going up to him, bound up his wounds, pouring in oil and wine: and setting him upon his own beast, brought him to an inn and took care of him. ³⁵ And the next day he took out two pence and gave to the host and said: Take care of him; and whatsoever thou shalt spend over and above, I, at my return, will repay thee. ³⁶ Which of these three, in thy opinion, was neighbour to him that fell among the robbers? ³⁷ But he said: He that shewed mercy to him. And Jesus said to him: Go, and do thou in like manner.

³⁸ Now it came to pass, as they went, that he entered into a certain town: and a certain woman named Martha received him into her house. ³⁹ And she had a sister called Mary, who, sitting also at the Lord's feet, heard his word. ⁴⁰ But Martha was busy about much serving. Who stood and said: Lord, hast thou no care that my sister hath left me alone to serve? Speak to her therefore, that she help me. ⁴¹ And the Lord answering, said to her: Martha, Martha, thou art careful and art troubled about many things: ⁴² But one thing is necessary. Mary hath chosen the best part, which shall not be taken away from her.

311. The lost sheep, the lost groat, the prodigal son

Luke 15:1-32

15 ¹ Now the publicans and sinners drew near unto him to hear him. ² And the Pharisees and the scribes murmured, saying: This man receiveth sinners and eateth with them.

³ And he spoke to them this parable, saying: ⁴ What man of you that hath an hundred sheep, and if he shall lose one of them, doth he not leave the ninety-nine in the desert and go after that which was lost, until he find it? ⁵ And when he hath found it, lay it upon his shoulders, rejoicing? ⁶ And coming home, call together his friends and neighbours, saying to them: Rejoice with me, because I have found my sheep that was lost? ⁷ I say to you that even so there shall be joy in heaven upon one sinner that doth penance, more than upon ninety-nine just who need not penance.

⁸ Or what woman having ten groats, if she lose one groat, doth not light a candle and sweep the house and seek diligently until she find it? ⁹ And when she hath found it, call together her friends and neighbours, saying: Rejoice with me, because I have found the groat which I had lost. ¹⁰ So I say to you, there shall be joy before the angels of God upon one sinner doing penance.

¹¹ And he said: A certain man had two sons. ¹² And the younger of them said to his father: Father, give me the portion of substance that falleth to me. And he divided unto them his substance. ¹³ And not many days after, the younger son, gathering all together, went abroad into a far country: and there wasted his substance, living riotously. ¹⁴ And after he had spent all, there came a mighty famine in that country: and he began to be in want. ¹⁵ And he went and cleaved to one of the citizens of that country. And he sent him into his farm to feed swine. ¹⁶ And he would fain have filled his belly with the husks the swine did eat: and no man gave unto him. ¹⁷ And returning to himself, he said: How many hired servants in my father's house abound with bread, and I here perish with hunger! ¹⁸ I will arise and will go to my father and say to him: Father, I have sinned against heaven and before thee. ¹⁹ I am not worthy to be called thy son: make me as one of thy hired servants. ²⁰ And rising up, he came to his father. And when he was yet a great way off, his father

saw him and was moved with compassion and running to him fell upon his neck and kissed him. ²¹ And the son said to him: Father: I have sinned against heaven and before thee I am not now worthy to be called thy son. ²² And the father said to his servants: Bring forth quickly the first robe and put it on him: and put a ring on his hand and shoes on his feet. ²³ And bring hither the fatted calf, and kill it: and let us eat and make merry: ²⁴ Because this my son was dead and is come to life again, was lost and is found. And they began to be merry. ²⁵ Now his elder son was in the field and when he came and drew nigh to the house, he heard music and dancing. ²⁶ And he called one of the servants, and asked what these things meant. ²⁷ And he said to him: Thy brother is come and thy father hath killed the fatted calf, because he hath received him safe. ²⁸ And he was angry and would not go in. His father therefore coming out began to entreat him. ²⁹ And he answering, said to his father: Behold, for so many years do I serve thee and I have never transgressed thy commandment: and yet thou hast never given me a kid to make merry with my friends. ³⁰ But as soon as this thy son is come, who hath devoured his substance with harlots, thou hast killed for him the fatted calf. ³¹ But he said to him: Son, thou art always with me; and all I have is thine. ³² But it was fit that we should make merry and be glad: for this thy brother was dead and is come to life again; he was lost, and is found.

319. Zacheus, and the entry into Jerusalem

Luke 19:1-48

19 ¹ And entering he walked through Jericho. ² And behold, there was a man named Zacheus, who was the chief of the publicans: and he was rich. ³ And he sought to see Jesus who he was: and he could not for the crowd, because he was low of stature. ⁴ And running before, he climbed up into a sycamore tree, that he might see him: for he was to pass that way. ⁵ And when Jesus was come to the place, looking up, he saw him and said to him: Zacheus, make haste and come down: for this day I must abide in thy house. ⁶ And he made haste and came down and received him with joy. ⁷ And when all saw it, they murmured, saying, that he was gone to be a guest with a man that was a sinner. ⁸ But Zacheus standing, said to the Lord: Behold, Lord, the half of my goods I give to the poor; and if I have wronged any man of any thing, I restore him fourfold. ⁹ Jesus said to him: This day is salvation come to this house, because he also is a son of Abraham. ¹⁰ For the Son of man is come to seek and to save that which was lost. ¹¹ As they were hearing these things, he added and spoke a parable, because he was nigh to Jerusalem and because they thought that the kingdom of God should immediately be manifested. ¹² He said therefore: a certain nobleman went into a far country, to receive for himself a kingdom and to return. ¹³ And calling his ten servants, he gave them ten pounds and said to them: Trade till I come. ¹⁴ But his citizens hated him and they sent an embassy after him, saying: We will not have this man to reign over us. ¹⁵ And it came to pass that he returned, having received the kingdom: and he commanded his servants to be called, to whom he had given the money, that he might know how much every man had gained by trading, ¹⁶ And the first came saying: Lord, thy pound hath gained ten pounds. ¹⁷ And he said to him: Well done, thou good servant, because thou hast been faithful in a little, thou shalt have power

over ten cities.¹⁸ And the second came, saying: Lord, thy pound hath gained five pounds.¹⁹ And he said to him: Be thou also over five cities.²⁰ And another came, saying: Lord, behold here is thy pound, which I have kept laid up in a napkin.²¹ For I feared thee, because thou art an austere man: thou takest up what thou didst not lay down: and thou reapest that which thou didst not sow.²² He saith to him: Out of thy own mouth I judge thee, thou wicked servant. Thou knewest that I was an austere man, taking up what I laid not down and reaping that which I did not sow.²³ And why then didst thou not give my money into the bank, that at my coming I might have exacted it with usury?²⁴ And he said to them that stood by: Take the pound away from him and give it to him that hath ten pounds.²⁵ And they said to him: Lord, he hath ten pounds.²⁶ But I say to you that to every one that hath shall be given, and he shall abound: and from him that hath not, even that which he hath shall be taken from him.²⁷ But as for those my enemies, who would not have me reign over them, bring them hither and kill them before me.²⁸ And having said these things, he went before, going up to Jerusalem.²⁹ And it came to pass, when he was come nigh to Bethphage and Bethania, unto the mount called Olivet, he sent two of his disciples,³⁰ Saying: Go into the town which is over against you, at your entering into which you shall find the colt of an ass tied, on which no man ever hath sitten: loose him and bring him hither.³¹ And if any man shall ask you: Why do you loose him? You shall say thus unto him: Because the Lord hath need of his service.³² And they that were sent went their way and found the colt standing, as he had said unto them.³³ And as they were loosing the colt, the owners thereof said to them: Why loose you the colt?³⁴ But they said: Because the Lord hath need of him.³⁵ And they brought him to Jesus. And casting their garments on the colt, they set Jesus thereon.³⁶ And as he went, they spread their clothes underneath in the way.³⁷ And when he was now coming near the descent of Mount Olivet, the whole multitude of his disciples began with joy to praise God with a loud voice, for all the mighty works they had seen,³⁸ Saying: Blessed be the king who cometh in the name of the Lord! Peace in heaven and glory on high!³⁹ And some of the Pharisees, from amongst the multitude, said to him: Master, rebuke thy disciples.⁴⁰ To whom he said: I say to you that if these shall hold their peace, the stones will cry out.

⁴¹ And when he drew near, seeing the city, he wept over it, saying: ⁴² If thou also hadst known, and that in this thy day, the things that are to thy peace: but now they are hidden from thy eyes.⁴³ For the days shall come upon thee: and thy enemies shall cast a trench about thee and compass thee round and straiten thee on every side,⁴⁴ And beat thee flat to the ground, and thy children who are in thee. And they shall not leave in thee a stone upon a stone: because thou hast not known the time of thy visitation.⁴⁵ And entering into the temple, he began to cast out them that sold therein and them that bought.⁴⁶ Saying to them: It is written: My house is the house of prayer. But you have made it a den of thieves.⁴⁷ And he was teaching daily in the temple. And the chief priests and the scribes and the rulers of the people sought to destroy him.⁴⁸ And they found not what to do to him: for all the people were very attentive to hear him.

324. The supper, Gethsemani, and the arrest

Luke 22:1-71

22 ¹ Now the feast of unleavened bread, which is called the pasch, was at hand.² And the chief priests and the scribes sought how they might put Jesus to death: but they feared the people.

³ And Satan entered into Judas, who was surnamed Iscariot, one of the twelve.⁴ And he went and discoursed with the chief priests and the magistrates, how he might betray him to them.⁵ And they were glad and covenanted to give him money.⁶ And he promised. And he sought opportunity to betray him in the absence of the multitude.

⁷ And the day of the unleavened bread came, on which it was necessary that the pasch should be killed.⁸ And he sent Peter and John, saying: Go, and prepare for us the pasch, that we may eat.⁹ But they said: Where wilt thou that we prepare?¹⁰ And he said to them: Behold, as you go into the city, there shall meet you a man carrying a pitcher of water: follow him into the house where he entereth in.¹¹ And you shall say to the goodman of the house: The master saith to thee: Where is the guest chamber, where I may eat the pasch with my disciples?¹² And he will shew you a large dining room, furnished. And there prepare.¹³ And they going, found as he had said to them and made ready the pasch.¹⁴ And when the hour was come, he sat down: and the twelve apostles with him.¹⁵ And he said to them: With desire I have desired to eat this pasch with you, before I suffer.¹⁶ For I say to you that from this time I will not eat it, till it be fulfilled in the kingdom of God.¹⁷ And having taken the chalice, he gave thanks and said: Take and divide it among you.¹⁸ For I say to you that I will not drink of the fruit of the vine, till the kingdom of God come.

¹⁹ And taking bread, he gave thanks and brake and gave to them, saying: This is my body, which is given for you. Do this for a commemoration of me.²⁰ In like manner, the chalice also, after he had supped, saying: This is the chalice, the new testament in my blood, which shall be shed for you.²¹ But yet behold: the hand of him that betrayeth me is with me on the table.²² And the Son of man indeed goeth, according to that which is determined: but yet, woe to that man by whom he shall be betrayed.²³ And they began to inquire among themselves, which of them it was that should do this thing.

²⁴ And there was also a strife amongst them, which of them should seem to be the greater.²⁵ And he said to them: The kings of the Gentiles lord it over them; and they that have power over them are called beneficent.²⁶ But you not so: but he that is the greater among you, let him become as the younger: and he that is the leader, as he that serveth.²⁷ For which is greater, he that sitteth at table or he that serveth? Is not he that sitteth at table? But I am in the midst of you, as he that serveth.²⁸ And you are they who have continued with me in my temptations:²⁹ And I dispose to you, as my Father hath disposed to me, a kingdom;³⁰ That you may eat and drink at my table, in my kingdom: and may sit upon thrones, judging the twelve tribes of Israel.

³¹ And the Lord said: Simon, Simon, behold Satan hath desired to have you, that he may sift you as wheat.³² But I have prayed for thee, that thy faith fail not: and thou, being once converted, confirm thy brethren.³³ Who said to him: Lord, I am ready to go with thee, both into prison and to death.³⁴ And he said: I say

to thee, Peter, the cock shall not crow this day, till thou thrice deniest that thou knowest me. And he said to them: ³⁵ When I sent you without purse and scrip and shoes, did you want anything? ³⁶ But they said: Nothing. Then said he unto them: But now he that hath a purse, let him take it, and likewise a scrip: and he that hath not, let him sell his coat and buy a sword. ³⁷ For I say to you that this that is written must yet be fulfilled in me. And with the wicked was he reckoned. For the things concerning me have an end. ³⁸ But they said: Lord, behold, here are two swords. And he said to them: It is enough.

³⁹ And going out, he went, according to his custom, to the Mount of Olives. And his disciples also followed him. ⁴⁰ And when he was come to the place, he said to them: Pray, lest ye enter into temptation. ⁴¹ And he was withdrawn away from them a stone's cast. And kneeling down, he prayed. ⁴² Saying: Father, if thou wilt, remove this chalice from me: but yet not my will, but thine be done. ⁴³ And there appeared to him an angel from heaven, strengthening him. And being in an agony, he prayed the longer. ⁴⁴ And his sweat became as drops of blood, trickling down upon the ground. ⁴⁵ And when he rose up from prayer and was come to the disciples, he found them sleeping for sorrow. ⁴⁶ And he said to them: Why sleep you? Arise: pray: lest you enter into temptation.

⁴⁷ As he was yet speaking, behold a multitude; and he that was called Judas, one of the twelve, went before them and drew near to Jesus, for to kiss him. ⁴⁸ And Jesus said to him: Judas, dost thou betray the Son of man with a kiss? ⁴⁹ And they that were about him, seeing what would follow, said to him: Lord, shall we strike with the sword? ⁵⁰ And one of them struck the servant of the high priest and cut off his right ear. ⁵¹ But Jesus answering, said: Suffer ye thus far. And when he had touched his ear, he healed him. ⁵² And Jesus said to the chief priests and magistrates of the temple and the ancients, that were come unto him: Are ye come out, as it were against a thief, with swords and clubs? ⁵³ When I was daily with you in the temple, you did not stretch forth your hands against me: but this is your hour and the power of darkness.

⁵⁴ And apprehending him, they led him to the high priest's house. But Peter followed afar off. ⁵⁵ And when they had kindled a fire in the midst of the hall and were sitting about it, Peter was in the midst of them. ⁵⁶ Whom when a certain servant maid had seen sitting at the light and had earnestly beheld him, she said: This man also was with him. ⁵⁷ But he denied him, saying: Woman, I know him not. ⁵⁸ And after a little while, another seeing him, said: Thou also art one of them. But Peter said: O man, I am not. ⁵⁹ And after the space, as it were of one hour, another certain man affirmed, saying: Of a truth, this man was also with him: for he is also a Galilean. ⁶⁰ And Peter said: Man, I know not what thou sayest. And immediately, as he was yet speaking, the cock crew. ⁶¹ And the Lord turning looked on Peter. And Peter remembered the word of the Lord, as he had said: Before the cock crow, thou shalt deny me thrice. ⁶² And Peter going out, wept bitterly.

⁶³ And the men that held him mocked him and struck him. ⁶⁴ And they blindfolded him and smote his face. And they asked him saying: Prophesy: Who is it that struck thee? ⁶⁵ And blaspheming, many other things they said against him.

⁶⁶ And as soon as it was day, the ancients of the people and the chief priests and scribes came together. And they brought him into their council saying: If thou be the Christ, tell us. ⁶⁷ And he saith to them: If I shall tell you, you will not believe me. ⁶⁸ And if I shall also ask you, you will not answer me, nor let me go. ⁶⁹ But hereafter the Son of man shall be sitting on the right hand of the power of God. ⁷⁰ Then said they all: Art thou then the Son of God? Who said: You say that I am. ⁷¹ And they said: What need we any further testimony? For we ourselves have heard it from his own mouth.

325. *The Passion*

Luke 23:1-56

23 ¹ And the whole multitude of them, rising up, led him to Pilate. ² And they began to accuse him, saying: We have found this man perverting our nation and forbidding to give tribute to Caesar and saying that he is Christ the king. ³ And Pilate asked him, saying: Art thou the king of the Jews? But he answering, said: Thou sayest it. ⁴ And Pilate said to the chief priests and to the multitudes: I find no cause in this man. ⁵ But they were more earnest, saying: He stirreth up the people, teaching throughout all Judea, beginning from Galilee to this place. ⁶ But Pilate hearing Galilee, asked if the man were of Galilee? ⁷ And when he understood that he was of Herod's jurisdiction, he sent him away to Herod, who was also himself at Jerusalem in those days.

⁸ And Herod seeing Jesus, was very glad: for he was desirous of a long time to see him, because he had heard many things of him; and he hoped to see some sign wrought by him. ⁹ And he questioned him in many words. But he answered him nothing. ¹⁰ And the chief priests and the scribes stood by, earnestly accusing him. ¹¹ And Herod with his army set him at nought and mocked him, putting on him a white garment: and sent him back to Pilate. ¹² And Herod and Pilate were made friends, that same day: for before they were enemies one to another.

¹³ And Pilate, calling together the chief priests and the magistrates and the people, ¹⁴ Said to them: You have presented unto me this man as one that perverteth the people. And behold I, having examined him before you, find no cause in this man, in those things wherein you accuse him. ¹⁵ No, nor Herod neither. For, I sent you to him: and behold, nothing worthy of death is done to him. ¹⁶ I will chastise him therefore and release him. ¹⁷ Now of necessity he was to release unto them one upon the feast day. ¹⁸ But the whole multitude together cried out, saying: Away with this man, and release unto us Barabbas: ¹⁹ Who, for a certain sedition made in the city and for a murder, was cast into prison. ²⁰ And Pilate again spoke to them, desiring to release Jesus. ²¹ But they cried again, saying: Crucify him, Crucify him. ²² And he said to them the third time: Why, what evil hath this man done? I find no cause of death in him. I will chastise him therefore and let him go. ²³ But they were instant with loud voices, requiring that he might be crucified. And their voices prevailed. ²⁴ And Pilate gave sentence that it should be as they required. ²⁵ And he released unto them him who for murder and sedition had been cast into prison, whom they had desired. But Jesus he delivered up to their will. ²⁶ And as they led him away, they laid hold of one Simon of Cyrene, coming from the country; and they laid the cross on him to carry after Jesus. ²⁷ And there followed him a great multitude of people and of

women, who bewailed and lamented him. ²⁸ But Jesus turning to them, said: Daughters of Jerusalem, weep not over me; but weep for yourselves and for your children. ²⁹ For behold, the days shall come, wherein they will say: Blessed are the barren and the wombs that have not borne and the paps that have not given suck. ³⁰ Then shall they begin to say to the mountains: Fall upon us. And to the hills: Cover us. ³¹ For if in the green wood they do these things, what shall be done in the dry? ³² And there were also two other malefactors led with him to be put to death. ³³ And when they were come to the place which is called Calvary, they crucified him there: and the robbers, one on the right hand, and the other on the left.

³⁴ And Jesus said: Father, forgive them, for they know not what they do. But they, dividing his garments, cast lots. ³⁵ And the people stood beholding. And the rulers with them derided him, saying: He saved others: let him save himself, if he be Christ, the elect of God. ³⁶ And the soldiers also mocked him, coming to him and offering him vinegar. ³⁷ And saying: If thou be the king of the Jews, save thyself. ³⁸ And there was also a superscription written over him in letters of Greek and Latin and Hebrew THIS IS THE KING OF THE JEWS.

³⁹ And one of those robbers who were hanged blasphemed him, saying: If thou be Christ, save thyself and us. ⁴⁰ But the other answering, rebuked him, saying: Neither dost thou fear God, seeing; thou art under the same condemnation? ⁴¹ And we indeed justly: for we receive the due reward of our deeds. But this man hath done no evil. ⁴² And he said to Jesus: Lord, remember me when thou shalt come into thy kingdom. ⁴³ And Jesus said to him: Amen I say to thee: This day thou shalt be with me in paradise. ⁴⁴ And it was almost the sixth hour: and there was darkness over all the earth until the ninth hour. ⁴⁵ And the sun was darkened, and the veil of the temple was rent in the midst. ⁴⁶ And Jesus crying with a loud voice, said: Father, into thy hands I commend my spirit. And saying this, he gave up the ghost. ⁴⁷ Now, the centurion, seeing what was done, glorified God, saying: Indeed this was a just man. ⁴⁸ And all the multitude of them that were come together to that sight and saw the things that were done returned, striking their breasts. ⁴⁹ And all his acquaintance and the women that had followed him from Galilee stood afar off, beholding these things.

⁵⁰ And behold there was a man named Joseph who was a counsellor, a good and a just man, ⁵¹ (The same had not consented to their counsel and doings) of Arimathea, a city of Judea: who also himself looked for the kingdom of God. ⁵² This man went to Pilate and begged the body of Jesus. ⁵³ And taking him down, he wrapped him in fine linen and laid him in a sepulchre that was hewed in stone, wherein never yet any man had been laid. ⁵⁴ And it was the day of the Parasceve: and the sabbath drew on. ⁵⁵ And the women that were come with him from Galilee, following after, saw the sepulchre and how his body was laid. ⁵⁶ And returning, they prepared spices and ointments: and on the sabbath day they rested, according to the commandment.

328. The resurrection, and the road to Emmaus

Luke 24:1-53

24 ¹ And on the first day of the week, very early in the morning, they came to the sepulchre, bringing the spices which they had prepared. ² And they found the stone rolled back from the sepul-

chre. ³ And going in, they found not the body of the Lord Jesus. ⁴ And it came to pass, as they were astonished in their mind at this, behold, two men stood by them, in shining apparel. ⁵ And as they were afraid and bowed down their countenance towards the ground, they said unto them: Why seek you the living with the dead? ⁶ He is not here, but is risen. Remember how he spoke unto you, when he was yet in Galilee, ⁷ Saying: The Son of man must be delivered into the hands of sinful men and be crucified and the third day rise again. ⁸ And they remembered his words. ⁹ And going back from the sepulchre, they told all these things to the eleven and to all the rest. ¹⁰ And it was Mary Magdalen and Joanna and Mary of James and the other women that were with them, who told these things to the apostles. ¹¹ And these words seemed to them as idle tales: and they did not believe them. ¹² But Peter rising up, ran to the sepulchre and, stooping down, he saw the linen cloths laid by themselves: and went away wondering in himself at that which was come to pass.

¹³ And behold, two of them went, the same day, to a town which was sixty furlongs from Jerusalem, named Emmaus. ¹⁴ And they talked together of all these things which had happened. ¹⁵ And it came to pass that while they talked and reasoned with themselves, Jesus himself also, drawing near, went with them. ¹⁶ But their eyes were held, that they should not know him. ¹⁷ And he said to them: What are these discourses that you hold one with another as you walk and are sad? ¹⁸ And the one of them, whose name was Cleophas, answering, said to him: Art thou only a stranger in Jerusalem, and hast not known the things that have been done there in these days? ¹⁹ To whom he said: What things? And they said: Concerning Jesus of Nazareth, who was a prophet, mighty in work and word before God and all the people. ²⁰ And how our chief priests and princes delivered him to be condemned to death and crucified him. ²¹ But we hoped that it was he that should have redeemed Israel. And now besides all this, to-day is the third day since these things were done. ²² Yea and certain women also of our company affrighted us who, before it was light, were at the sepulchre, ²³ And not finding his body, came, saying that they had also seen a vision of angels, who say that he is alive. ²⁴ And some of our people went to the sepulchre and found it so as the women had said: but him they found not. ²⁵ Then he said to them: O foolish and slow of heart to believe in all things, Which the prophets have spoken. ²⁶ Ought not Christ to have suffered these things and so, to enter into his glory? ²⁷ And beginning at Moses and all the prophets, he expounded to them in all the scriptures the things that were concerning him. ²⁸ And they drew nigh to the town whither they were going: and he made as though he would go farther. ²⁹ But they constrained him, saying: Stay with us, because it is towards evening and the day is now far spent. And he went in with them. ³⁰ And it came to pass, whilst he was at table with them, he took bread and blessed and brake and gave to them. ³¹ And their eyes were opened: and they knew him. And he vanished out of their sight. ³² And they said one to the other: Was not our heart burning within us, whilst he spoke in the way and opened to us the scriptures? ³³ And rising up, the same hour, they went back to Jerusalem: and they found the eleven gathered together, and those that were with them, ³⁴ Saying: The Lord is risen indeed and hath appeared to Simon.

³⁵ And they told what things were done in the way: and how they knew him in the breaking of bread.

³⁶ Now, whilst they were speaking these things, Jesus stood in the midst of them and saith to them: Peace be to you. It is I: Fear not. ³⁷ But they being troubled and frightened, supposed that they saw a spirit. ³⁸ And he said to them: Why are you troubled, and why do thoughts arise in your hearts? ³⁹ See my hands and feet, that it is I myself. Handle, and see: for a spirit hath not flesh and bones, as you see me to have. ⁴⁰ And when he had said this, he shewed them his hands and feet. ⁴¹ But while they yet believed not and wondered for joy, he said: Have you here any thing to eat? ⁴² And they offered him a piece of a broiled fish and a honeycomb. ⁴³ And when he had eaten before them, taking the remains, he gave to them. ⁴⁴ And he said to them: These are the words which I spoke to you while I was yet with you, that all things must needs be fulfilled which are written in the law of Moses and in the prophets and in the psalms, concerning me. ⁴⁵ Then he opened their understanding, that they might understand the scriptures. ⁴⁶ And he said to them: Thus it is written, and thus it behoved Christ to suffer and to rise again from the dead, the third day: ⁴⁷ And that penance and remission of sins should be preached in his name, unto all nations, beginning at Jerusalem. ⁴⁸ And you are witnesses of these things. ⁴⁹ And I send the promise of my Father upon you: but stay you in the city till you be endued with power from on high.

⁵⁰ And he led them out as far as Bethania: and lifting up his hands, he blessed them. ⁵¹ And it came to pass, whilst he blessed them, he departed from them and was carried up to heaven. ⁵² And they adoring went back into Jerusalem with great joy. ⁵³ And they were always in the temple, praising and blessing God. Amen.

THE APOSTOLIC CHURCH

The Acts of the Apostles entire, from the Ascension to Rome, with three psalms the apostles preach from, and one passage of the Apocalypse to close the arc opened in Genesis 1. The epistles are not read; see the omissions.

333. The Ascension, and the choosing of Matthias

Acts 1:1-26

1 ¹ The former treatise I made, O Theophilus, of all things which Jesus began to do and to teach, ² Until the day on which, giving commandments by the Holy Ghost to the apostles whom he had chosen, he was taken up. ³ To whom also he shewed himself alive after his passion, by many proofs, for forty days appearing to them, and speaking of the kingdom of God. ⁴ And eating together with them, he commanded them, that they should not depart from Jerusalem, but should wait for the promise of the Father, which you have heard (saith he) by my mouth. ⁵ For John indeed baptized with water: but you shall be baptized with the Holy Ghost, not many days hence. ⁶ They therefore who were come together, asked him, saying: Lord, wilt thou at this time restore again the kingdom of Israel? ⁷ But he said to them: It is not for you to know the times or moments, which the Father hath put in his own power: ⁸ But you shall receive the power of the Holy Ghost coming upon you, and you shall be witnesses unto

me in Jerusalem, and in all Judea, and Samaria, and even to the uttermost part of the earth. ⁹ And when he had said these things, while they looked on, he was raised up: and a cloud received him out of their sight. ¹⁰ And while they were beholding him going up to heaven, behold two men stood by them in white garments. ¹¹ Who also said: Ye men of Galilee, why stand you looking up to heaven? This Jesus who is taken up from you into heaven, shall so come as you have seen him going into heaven. ¹² Then they returned to Jerusalem from the mount that is called Olivet, which is nigh Jerusalem, within a sabbath day's journey. ¹³ And when they were come in, they went up into an upper room, where abode Peter and John, James and Andrew, Philip and Thomas, Bartholomew and Matthew, James of Alpheus and Simon Zelotes and Jude the brother of James. ¹⁴ All these were persevering with one mind in prayer with the women, and Mary the mother of Jesus, and with his brethren.

¹⁵ In those days Peter rising up in the midst of the brethren, said (now the number of persons together was about an hundred and twenty): ¹⁶ Men, brethren, the scripture must needs be fulfilled, which the Holy Ghost spoke before by the mouth of David concerning Judas, who was the leader of them that apprehended Jesus: ¹⁷ Who was numbered with us, and had obtained part of this ministry. ¹⁸ And he indeed hath possessed a field of the reward of iniquity, and being hanged, burst asunder in the midst: and all his bowels gushed out. ¹⁹ And it became known to all the inhabitants of Jerusalem: so that the same field was called in their tongue, Haceldama, that is to say, The field of blood. ²⁰ For it is written in the book of Psalms: Let their habitation become desolate, and let there be none to dwell therein. And his bishopric let another take. ²¹ Wherefore of these men who have companied with us, all the time that the Lord Jesus came in and went out among us, ²² Beginning from the baptism of John, until the day wherein he was taken up from us, one of these must be made a witness with us of his resurrection. ²³ And they appointed two, Joseph, called Barsabas, who was surnamed Justus, and Matthias. ²⁴ And praying, they said: Thou, Lord, who knowest the heart of all men, shew whether of these two thou hast chosen, ²⁵ To take the place of this ministry and apostleship, from which Judas hath by transgression fallen, that he might go to his own place. ²⁶ And they gave them lots, and the lot fell upon Matthias, and he was numbered with the eleven apostles.

334. Pentecost

Acts 2:1-47

Babel, read in the Early World, is answered here. St. Peter preaches from Joel and from Psalms 15 and 109.

2 ¹ And when the days of the Pentecost were accomplished, they were all together in one place: ² And suddenly there came a sound from heaven, as of a mighty wind coming: and it filled the whole house where they were sitting. ³ And there appeared to them parted tongues, as it were of fire: and it sat upon every one of them. ⁴ And they were all filled with the Holy Ghost: and they began to speak with divers tongues, according as the Holy Ghost gave them to speak. ⁵ Now there were dwelling at Jerusalem, Jews, devout men, out of every nation under heaven. ⁶ And when this was noised abroad, the multitude came together, and were confounded in mind, because that every man heard

them speak in his own tongue. ⁷ And they were all amazed, and wondered, saying: Behold, are not all these that speak Galileans? ⁸ And how have we heard, every man our own tongue wherein we were born? ⁹ Parthians and Medes and Elamites and inhabitants of Mesopotamia, Judea, and Cappadocia, Pontus and Asia, ¹⁰ Phrygia and Pamphylia, Egypt and the parts of Libya about Cyrene, and strangers of Rome, ¹¹ Jews also, and proselytes, Cretes, and Arabians: we have heard them speak in our own tongues the wonderful works of God. ¹² And they were all astonished, and wondered, saying one to another: What meaneth this? ¹³ But others mocking, said: These men are full of new wine.

¹⁴ But Peter standing up with the eleven, lifted up his voice, and spoke to them: Ye men of Judea, and all you that dwell in Jerusalem, be this known to you and with your ears receive my words. ¹⁵ For these are not drunk, as you suppose, seeing it is but the third hour of the day: ¹⁶ But this is that which was spoken of by the prophet Joel: ¹⁷ And it shall come to pass, in the last days, (saith the Lord), I will pour out of my Spirit upon all flesh: and your sons and your daughters shall prophesy: and your young men shall see visions, and your old men shall dream dreams. ¹⁸ And upon my servants indeed and upon my handmaids will I pour out in those days of my spirit: and they shall prophesy. ¹⁹ And I will shew wonders in the heaven above, and signs on the earth beneath: blood and fire, and vapour of smoke. ²⁰ The sun shall be turned into darkness and the moon into blood, before the great and manifest day of the Lord shall come. ²¹ And it shall come to pass, that whosoever shall call upon the name of the Lord shall be saved. ²² Ye men of Israel, hear these words: Jesus of Nazareth, a man approved of God among you by miracles and wonders and signs, which God did by him, in the midst of you, as you also know: ²³ This same being delivered up, by the determinate counsel and foreknowledge of God, you by the hands of wicked men have crucified and slain. ²⁴ Whom God hath raised up, having loosed the sorrows of hell, as it was impossible that he should be holden by it. ²⁵ For David saith concerning him: I foresaw the Lord before my face: because he is at my right hand, that I may not be moved. ²⁶ For this my heart hath been glad, and my tongue hath rejoiced: moreover my flesh also shall rest in hope. ²⁷ Because thou wilt not leave my soul in hell: nor suffer thy Holy One to see corruption. ²⁸ Thou hast made known to me the ways of life: thou shalt make me full of joy with thy countenance. ²⁹ Ye men, brethren, let me freely speak to you of the patriarch David: that he died and was buried; and his sepulchre is with us to this present day. ³⁰ Whereas therefore he was a prophet and knew that God hath sworn to him with an oath, that of the fruit of his loins one should sit upon his throne. ³¹ Foreseeing this, he spoke of the resurrection of Christ. For neither was he left in hell: neither did his flesh see corruption. ³² This Jesus hath God raised again, whereof all we are witnesses. ³³ Being exalted therefore by the right hand of God and having received of the Father the promise of the Holy Ghost, he hath poured forth this which you see and hear. ³⁴ For David ascended not into heaven; but he himself said: The Lord said to my Lord: Sit thou on my right hand, ³⁵ Until I make thy enemies thy footstool. ³⁶ Therefore let all the house of Israel know most

certainly that God hath made both Lord and Christ, this same Jesus, whom you have crucified.

³⁷ Now when they had heard these things, they had compunction in their heart and said to Peter and to the rest of the apostles: What shall we do, men and brethren? ³⁸ But Peter said to them: Do penance: and be baptized every one of you in the name of Jesus Christ, for the remission of your sins. And you shall receive the gift of the Holy Ghost. ³⁹ For the promise is to you and to your children and to all that are far off, whomsoever the Lord our God shall call. ⁴⁰ And with very many other words did he testify and exhort them, saying: Save yourselves from this perverse generation.

⁴¹ They therefore that received his word were baptized: and there were added in that day about three thousand souls. ⁴² And they were persevering in the doctrine of the apostles and in the communication of the breaking of bread and in prayers. ⁴³ And fear came upon every soul. Many wonders also and signs were done by the apostles in Jerusalem: and there was great fear in all. ⁴⁴ And all they that believed were together and had all things common. ⁴⁵ Their possessions and goods they sold and divided them to all, according as every one had need. ⁴⁶ And continuing daily with one accord in the temple and breaking bread from house to house, they took their meat with gladness and simplicity of heart: ⁴⁷ Praising God and having favour with all the people. And the Lord increased daily together such as should be saved.

337. Peter and John before the council

Acts 4:1-37

4 ¹ And as they were speaking to the people the priests and the officer of the temple and the Sadducees came upon them, ² Being grieved that they taught the people and preached in Jesus the resurrection from the dead: ³ And they laid hands upon them and put them in hold till the next day: for it was now evening. ⁴ But many of them who had heard the word believed: and the number of the men was made five thousand.

⁵ And it came to pass on the morrow, that their princes and ancients and scribes were gathered together in Jerusalem. ⁶ And Annas the high priest and Caiphas and John and Alexander: and as many as were of the kindred of the high priest. ⁷ And setting them in the midst, they asked: By what power or by what name, have you done this? ⁸ Then Peter, filled with the Holy Ghost, said to them: Ye princes of the people and ancients, hear. ⁹ If we this day are examined concerning the good deed done to the infirm man, by what means he hath been made whole: ¹⁰ Be it known to you all and to all the people of Israel, that by the name of our Lord Jesus Christ of Nazareth, whom you crucified, whom God hath raised from the dead, even by him, this man standeth here before you, whole. ¹¹ This is the stone which was rejected by you the builders, which is become the head of the corner. ¹² Neither is there salvation in any other. For there is no other name under heaven given to men, whereby we must be saved.

¹³ Now seeing the constancy of Peter and of John, understanding that they were illiterate and ignorant men, they wondered: and they knew them that they had been with Jesus. ¹⁴ Seeing the man also who had been healed, standing with them, they could say nothing against it. ¹⁵ But they commanded them to

go aside out of the council: and they conferred among themselves, ¹⁶ Saying: What shall we do to these men? For indeed a miracle hath been done by them, known to all the inhabitants of Jerusalem. It is manifest: and we cannot deny it. ¹⁷ But that it may be no farther spread among the people, let us threaten them that they speak no more in this name to any man. ¹⁸ And calling them, they charged them not to speak at all, nor teach in the name of Jesus. ¹⁹ But Peter and John answering, said to them: If it be just, in the sight of God, to hear you rather than God, judge ye. ²⁰ For we cannot but speak the things which we have seen and heard. ²¹ But they, threatening, sent them away, not finding how they might punish them, because of the people: for all men glorified what had been done, in that which had come to pass. ²² For the man was above forty years old, in whom that miraculous cure had been wrought.

²³ And being let go, they came to their own company and related all that the chief priests and ancients had said to them. ²⁴ Who having heard it, with one accord lifted up their voice to God and said: Lord, thou art he that didst make heaven and earth, the sea and all things that are in them. ²⁵ Who, by the Holy Ghost, by the mouth of our father David, thy servant, hast said: Why did the Gentiles rage: and the people meditate vain things? ²⁶ The kings of the earth stood up: and the princes assembled together against the Lord and his Christ. ²⁷ For of a truth there assembled together in this city against thy holy child Jesus, whom thou hast anointed, Herod, and Pontius Pilate, with the Gentiles and the people of Israel, ²⁸ To do what thy hand and thy counsel decreed to be done. ²⁹ And now, Lord, behold their threatenings: and grant unto thy servants that with all confidence they may speak thy word, ³⁰ By stretching forth thy hand to cures and signs and wonders, to be done by the name of thy holy Son, Jesus.

³¹ And when they had prayed, the place was moved wherein they were assembled: and they were all filled with the Holy Ghost: and they spoke the word of God with confidence. ³² And the multitude of believers had but one heart and one soul. Neither did any one say that aught of the things which he possessed was his own: but all things were common unto them. ³³ And with great power did the Apostles give testimony of the resurrection of Jesus Christ our Lord: and great grace was in them all. ³⁴ For neither was there any one needy among them. For as many as were owners of lands or houses sold them and brought the price of the things they sold, ³⁵ And laid it down before the feet of the apostles. And distribution was made to every one, according as he had need. ³⁶ And Joseph, who, by the apostles, was surnamed Barnabas (which is, by interpretation, The son of consolation), a Levite, a Cyprian born, ³⁷ Having land, sold it and brought the price and laid it at the feet of the Apostles.

340. Stephen

Acts 6:1-7:59

Stephen's speech is the salvation history of this plan, told in one breath before his death.

6 ¹ And in those days, the number of the disciples increasing, there arose a murmuring of the Greeks against the Hebrews, for that their widows were neglected in the daily ministration.

² Then the twelve, calling together the multitude of the disciples,

said: It is not reason that we should leave the word of God and serve tables. ³ Wherefore, brethren, look ye out among you seven men of good reputation, full of the Holy Ghost and wisdom, whom we may appoint over this business. ⁴ But we will give ourselves continually to prayer and to the ministry of the word.

⁵ And the saying was liked by all the multitude. And they chose Stephen, a man full of faith and of the Holy Ghost, and Philip and Prochorus and Nicanor, and Timon and Parmenas and Nicolas, a proselyte of Antioch. ⁶ These they set before the apostles: and they praying, imposed hands upon them. ⁷ And the word of the Lord increased: and the number of the disciples was multiplied in Jerusalem exceedingly. A great multitude also of the priests obeyed the faith. ⁸ And Stephen, full of grace and fortitude, did great wonders and signs among the people. ⁹ Now there arose some, of that which is called the synagogue of the Libertines and of the Cyrenians and of the Alexandrians and of them that were of Cilicia and Asia, disputing with Stephen. ¹⁰ And they were not able to resist the wisdom and the spirit that spoke. ¹¹ Then they suborned men to say they had heard him speak words of blasphemy against Moses and against God. ¹² And they stirred up the people and the ancients and the scribes. And running together, they took him and brought him to the council. ¹³ And they set up false witnesses, who said: This man ceaseth not to speak words against the holy place and the law. ¹⁴ For we have heard him say that this Jesus of Nazareth shall destroy this place and shall change the traditions which Moses delivered unto us. ¹⁵ And all that sat in the council, looking on him, saw his face as if it had been the face of an angel.

7 ¹ Then the high priest said: Are these things so? ² Who said: Ye men, brethren and fathers, hear. The God of glory appeared to our father Abraham, when he was in Mesopotamia, before he dwelt in Charan. ³ And said to him: Go forth out of thy country and from thy kindred: and come into the land which I shall shew thee. ⁴ Then he went out of the land of the Chaldeans and dwelt in Charan. And from thence, after his father was dead, he removed him into this land, wherein you now dwell. ⁵ And he gave him no inheritance in it: no, not the pace of a foot. But he promised to give it him in possession, and to his seed after him, when as yet he had no child. ⁶ And God said to him: That his seed should sojourn in a strange country, and that they should bring them under bondage and treat them evil four hundred years. ⁷ And the nation which they shall serve will I judge (said the Lord): and after these things they shall go out and shall serve me in this place. ⁸ And he gave him the covenant of circumcision. And so he begot Isaac and circumcised him the eighth day: and Isaac begot Jacob: and Jacob, the twelve patriarchs. ⁹ And the patriarchs, through envy, sold Joseph into Egypt. And God was with him, ¹⁰ And delivered him out of all his tribulations: and he gave him favour and wisdom in the sight of Pharaoh, the king of Egypt. And he appointed him governor over Egypt and over all his house. ¹¹ Now there came a famine upon all Egypt and Chanaan, and great tribulation: and our fathers found no food. ¹² But when Jacob had heard that there was corn in Egypt, he sent our fathers first. ¹³ And at the second time, Joseph was known by his brethren: and his kindred was made known to Pharaoh. ¹⁴ And Joseph sending, called thither Jacob, his father, and all his kindred, seventy-five souls. ¹⁵ So Jacob went down into Egypt. And he

died, and our fathers. ¹⁶ And they were translated into Sichem and were laid in the sepulchre that Abraham bought for a sum of money of the sons of Hemor, the son of Sichem. ¹⁷ And when the time of the promise drew near, which God had promised to Abraham, the people increased and were multiplied in Egypt. ¹⁸ Till another king arose in Egypt, who knew not Joseph. ¹⁹ This same, dealing craftily with our race, afflicted our fathers, that they should expose their children, to the end they might not be kept alive. ²⁰ At the same time was Moses born: and he was acceptable to God. Who was nourished three months in his father's house. ²¹ And when he was exposed, Pharaoh's daughter took him up and nourished him for her own son. ²² And Moses was instructed in all the wisdom of the Egyptians: and he was mighty in his words and in his deeds. ²³ And when he was full forty years old, it came into his heart to visit his brethren, the children of Israel. ²⁴ And when he had seen one of them suffer wrong, he defended him: and striking the Egyptian, he avenged him who suffered the injury. ²⁵ And he thought that his brethren understood that God by his hand would save them. But they understood it not. ²⁶ And the day following, he shewed himself to them when they were at strife and would have reconciled them in peace, saying: Men, ye are brethren. Why hurt you one another? ²⁷ But he that did the injury to his neighbour thrust him away, saying: Who hath appointed thee prince and judge over us? ²⁸ What! Wilt thou kill me, as thou didst yesterday kill the Egyptian? ²⁹ And Moses fled upon this word: and was a stranger in the land of Madian, where he begot two sons. ³⁰ And when forty years were expired, there appeared to him, in the desert of mount Sina, an angel in a flame of fire in a bush. ³¹ And Moses seeing it wondered at the sight. And as he drew near to view it, the voice of the Lord came unto him, saying: ³² I am the God of thy fathers: the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac and the God of Jacob. And Moses being terrified durst not behold. ³³ And the Lord said to him: Loose the shoes from thy feet: for the place wherein thou standest is holy ground. ³⁴ Seeing, I have seen the affliction of my people which is in Egypt: and I have heard their groaning and am come down to deliver them. And now come: and I will send thee into Egypt. ³⁵ This Moses, whom they refused, saying: Who hath appointed thee prince and judge? Him God sent to be prince and redeemer, by the hand of the angel who appeared to him in the bush. ³⁶ He brought them out, doing wonders and signs in the land of Egypt and in the Red Sea and in the desert, forty years. ³⁷ This is that Moses who said to the children of Israel: A prophet shall God raise up to you of your own brethren, as myself. Him shall you hear. ³⁸ This is he that was in the church in the wilderness, with the angel who spoke to him on Mount Sina and with our fathers. Who received the words of life to give unto us. ³⁹ Whom our fathers would not obey: but thrust him away and in their hearts turned back into Egypt, ⁴⁰ Saying to Aaron: Make us gods to go before us. For as for this Moses, who brought us out of the land of Egypt, we know not what is become of him. ⁴¹ And they made a calf in those days and offered sacrifices to the idol and rejoiced in the works of their own hands. ⁴² And God turned and gave them up to serve the host of heaven, as it is written in the books of the prophets: Did you offer victims and sacrifices to me for forty years, in the desert, O house of Israel? ⁴³ And you took unto you

the tabernacle of Moloch and the star of your god Rempham, figures which you made to adore them. And I will carry you away beyond Babylon. ⁴⁴ The tabernacle of the testimony was with our fathers in the desert, as God ordained for them, speaking to Moses, that he should make it according to the form which he had seen. ⁴⁵ Which also our fathers receiving, brought in with Jesus, into the possession of the Gentiles: whom God drove out before the face of our fathers, unto the days of David, ⁴⁶ Who found grace before God and desired to find a tabernacle for the God of Jacob. ⁴⁷ But Solomon built him a house, ⁴⁸ Yet the most High dwelleth not in houses made by hands, as the prophet saith: ⁴⁹ Heaven is my throne and the earth my footstool. What house will you build me (saith the Lord)? Or what is the place of my resting? ⁵⁰ Hath not my hand made all these things?

⁵¹ You stiffnecked and uncircumcised in heart and ears, you always resist the Holy Ghost. As your fathers did, so do you also. ⁵² Which of the prophets have not your fathers persecuted? And they have slain them who foretold of the coming of the Just One: of whom you have been now the betrayers and murderers. ⁵³ Who have received the law by the disposition of angels and have not kept it.

⁵⁴ Now hearing these things, they were cut to the heart: and they gnashed with their teeth at him. ⁵⁵ But he, being full of the Holy Ghost, looking up steadfastly to heaven, saw the glory of God and Jesus standing on the right hand of God. And he said: Behold, I see the heavens opened and the Son of man standing on the right hand of God. ⁵⁶ And they, crying out with a loud voice, stopped their ears and with one accord ran violently upon him. ⁵⁷ And casting him forth without the city, they stoned him. And the witnesses laid down their garments at the feet of a young man, whose name was Saul. ⁵⁸ And they stoned Stephen, invoking and saying: Lord Jesus, receive my spirit. ⁵⁹ And falling on his knees, he cried with a loud voice, saying: Lord, lay not this sin to their charge. And when he had said this, he fell asleep in the Lord. And Saul was consenting to his death.

342. *The conversion of Saul*

Acts 9:1-31

9 ¹ And Saul, as yet breathing out threatenings and slaughter against the disciples of the Lord, went to the high priest ² And asked of him letters to Damascus, to the synagogues: that if he found any men and women of this way, he might bring them bound to Jerusalem. ³ And as he went on his journey, it came to pass that he drew nigh to Damascus. And suddenly a light from heaven shined round about him. ⁴ And falling on the ground, he heard a voice saying to him: Saul, Saul, why persecutest thou me? ⁵ Who said: Who art thou, Lord? And he: I am Jesus whom thou persecutest. It is hard for thee to kick against the goad. ⁶ And he, trembling and astonished, said: Lord, what wilt thou have me to do? ⁷ And the Lord said to him: Arise and go into the city; and there it shall be told thee what thou must do. Now the men who went in company with him stood amazed, hearing indeed a voice but seeing no man. ⁸ And Saul arose from the ground: and when his eyes were opened, he saw nothing. But they, leading him by the hands, brought him to Damascus. ⁹ And he was there three days without sight: and he did neither eat nor drink.

¹⁰ Now there was a certain disciple at Damascus, named Ananias. And the Lord said to him in a vision: Ananias, And he said: Behold I am here, Lord. ¹¹ And the Lord said to him: Arise and go into the street that is called Strait and seek in the house of Judas, one named Saul of Tarsus. For behold he prayeth. ¹² (And he saw a man named Ananias coming in and putting his hands upon him, that he might receive his sight.) ¹³ But Ananias answered: Lord, I have heard by many of this man, how much evil he hath done to thy saints in Jerusalem. ¹⁴ And here he hath authority from the chief priests to bind all that invoke thy name. ¹⁵ And the Lord said to him: Go thy way: for this man is to me a vessel of election, to carry my name before the Gentiles and kings and the children of Israel. ¹⁶ For I will shew him how great things he must suffer for my name's sake. ¹⁷ And Ananias went his way and entered into the house. And laying his hands upon him, he said: Brother Saul, the Lord Jesus hath sent me, he that appeared to thee in the way as thou camest, that thou mayest receive thy sight and be filled with the Holy Ghost. ¹⁸ And immediately there fell from his eyes as it were scales: and he received his sight. And rising up, he was baptized. ¹⁹ And when he had taken meat, he was strengthened. And he was with the disciples that were at Damascus, for some days. ²⁰ And immediately he preached Jesus in the synagogues, that he is the son of God. ²¹ And all that heard him were astonished and said: Is not this he who persecuted in Jerusalem those that called upon this name and came hither for that intent, that he might carry them bound to the chief priests? ²² But Saul increased much more in strength and confounded the Jews who dwelt at Damascus, affirming that this is the Christ. ²³ And when many days were passed, the Jews consulted together to kill him. ²⁴ But their lying in wait was made known to Saul. And they watched the gates also day and night, that they might kill him. ²⁵ But the disciples, taking him in the night, conveyed him away by the wall, letting him down in a basket. ²⁶ And when he was come into Jerusalem, he essayed to join himself to the disciples: and they all were afraid of him, not believing that he was a disciple. ²⁷ But Barnabas took him and brought him to the apostles and told them how he had seen the Lord, and that he had spoken to him: and how in Damascus he had dealt confidently in the name of Jesus. ²⁸ And he was with them, coming in and going out in Jerusalem and dealing confidently in the name of the Lord. ²⁹ He spoke also to the Gentiles and disputed with the Greeks. But they sought to kill him. ³⁰ Which when the brethren had known, they brought him down to Cæsarea and sent him away to Tarsus. ³¹ Now, the church had peace throughout all Judea and Galilee and Samaria: and was edified, walking in the fear of the Lord: and was filled with the consolation of the Holy Ghost.

343. *Cornelius, and the door opened to the Gentiles*

Acts 9:32-11:18

⁹ ³² And it came to pass that Peter, as he passed through, visiting all, came to the saints who dwelt at Lydda. ³³ And he found there a certain man named Eneas, who had kept his bed for eight years, who was ill of the palsy. ³⁴ And Peter said to him: Eneas, the Lord Jesus Christ healeth thee. Arise and make thy bed. And immediately he arose. ³⁵ And all that dwelt at Lydda and Saron saw him: who were converted to the Lord.

³⁶ And in Joppe there was a certain disciple named Tabitha, which by interpretation is called Dorcas. This woman was full of good works and almsdeeds which she did. ³⁷ And it came to pass in those days that she was sick and died. Whom when they had washed, they laid her in an upper chamber. ³⁸ And forasmuch as Lydda was nigh to Joppe, the disciples, hearing that Peter was there, sent unto him two men, desiring him that he would not be slack to come unto them. ³⁹ And Peter rising up went with them. And when he was come, they brought him into the upper chamber. And all the widows stood about him, weeping and shewing him the coats and garments which Dorcas made them. ⁴⁰ And they all being put forth, Peter, kneeling down, prayed. And turning to the body, he said: Tabitha, arise. And she opened her eyes and, seeing Peter, sat up. ⁴¹ And giving her his hand, he lifted her up. And when he had called the saints and the widows, he presented her alive. ⁴² And it was made known throughout all Joppe. And many believed in the Lord. ⁴³ And it came to pass that he abode many days in Joppe, with one Simon a tanner.

10 ¹ And there was a certain man in Cæsarea, named Cornelius, a centurion of that which is called the Italian band: ² A religious man, and fearing God with all his house, giving much alms to the people and always praying to God. ³ This man saw in a vision manifestly, about the ninth hour of the day, an angel of God coming in unto him and saying to him: Cornelius. ⁴ And he, beholding him, being seized with fear, said: What is it, Lord? And he said to him: Thy prayers and thy alms are ascended for a memorial in the sight of God. ⁵ And now send men to Joppe: and call hither one Simon, who is surnamed Peter. ⁶ He lodgeth with one Simon a tanner, whose house is by the sea side. He will tell thee what thou must do. ⁷ And when the angel who spoke to him was departed, he called two of his household servants and a soldier who feared the Lord, of them that were under him. ⁸ To whom when he had related all, he sent them to Joppe.

⁹ And on the next day, whilst they were going on their journey and drawing nigh to the city, Peter went up to the higher parts of the house to pray, about the sixth hour. ¹⁰ And being hungry, he was desirous to taste somewhat. And as they were preparing, there came upon him an ecstasy of mind. ¹¹ And he saw the heaven opened and a certain vessel descending, as it were a great linen sheet let down by the four corners from heaven to the earth: ¹² Wherein were all manner of four-footed beasts and creeping things of the earth and fowls of the air. ¹³ And there came a voice to him: Arise, Peter. Kill and eat. ¹⁴ But Peter said: Far be it from me. For I never did eat any thing that is common and unclean. ¹⁵ And the voice spoke to him again the second time: That which God hath cleansed, do not thou call common. ¹⁶ And this was done thrice. And presently the vessel was taken up into heaven. ¹⁷ Now, whilst Peter was doubting within himself what the vision that he had seen should mean, behold the men who were sent from Cornelius, inquiring for Simon's house, stood at the gate. ¹⁸ And when they had called, they asked if Simon, who is surnamed Peter, were lodged there. ¹⁹ And as Peter was thinking of the vision, the Spirit said to him: Behold three men seek thee. ²⁰ Arise, therefore: get thee down and go with them, doubting nothing: for I have sent them. ²¹ Then Peter, going down to the men, said: Behold, I am he whom you seek. What is the cause for which you are come? ²² Who said: Cornelius, a

centurion, a just man and one that feareth God, and having good testimony from all the nation of the Jews, received an answer of an holy angel, to send for thee into his house And to hear words of thee. ²³ Then bringing them in, he lodged them. And the day following, he arose and went with them: and some of the brethren from Joppe accompanied him. ²⁴ And the morrow after, he entered into Cæsarea. And Cornelius waited for them, having called together his kinsmen and special friends. ²⁵ And it came to pass that when Peter was come in, Cornelius came to meet him and falling at his feet adored. ²⁶ But Peter lifted him up, saying: Arise: I myself also am a man. ²⁷ And talking with him, he went in and found many that were come together. ²⁸ And he said to them: you know how abominable it is for a man that is a Jew to keep company or to come unto one of another nation: but God hath shewed to me, to call no man common or unclean. ²⁹ For which cause, making no doubt, I came when I was sent for. I ask, therefore, for what cause you have sent for me? ³⁰ And Cornelius said: Four days ago, unto this hour, I was praying in my house, at the ninth hour and behold a man stood before me in white apparel and said: ³¹ Cornelius, thy prayer is heard and thy alms are had in remembrance in the sight of God. ³² Send therefore to Joppe: and call hither Simon, who is surnamed Peter. He lodgeth in the house of Simon a tanner, by the sea side. ³³ Immediately therefore I sent to thee: and thou hast done well in coming. Now, therefore, all we are present in thy sight to hear all things whatsoever are commanded thee by the Lord.

³⁴ And Peter opening his mouth, said: in very deed I perceive that God is not a respecter of persons. ³⁵ But in every nation, he that feareth him and worketh justice is acceptable to him. ³⁶ God sent the word to the children of Israel, preaching peace by Jesus Christ (He is Lord of all). ³⁷ You know the word which hath been published through all Judea: for it began from Galilee, after the baptism which John preached. ³⁸ Jesus of Nazareth: how God anointed him with the Holy Ghost and with power, who went about doing good and healing all that were oppressed by the devil, for God was with him. ³⁹ And we are witnesses of all things that he did in the land of the Jews and in Jerusalem: whom they killed, hanging him upon a tree. ⁴⁰ Him God raised up the third day and gave him to be made manifest, ⁴¹ Not to all the people, but to witnesses preordained by God, even to us, who did eat and drink with him, after he arose again from the dead. ⁴² And he commanded us to preach to the people and to testify that it is he who was appointed by God to be judge of the living and of the dead. ⁴³ To him all the prophets give testimony, that by his name all receive remission of sins, who believe in him.

⁴⁴ While Peter was yet speaking these words, the Holy Ghost fell on all them that heard the word. ⁴⁵ And the faithful of the circumcision, who came with Peter, were astonished for that the grace of the Holy Ghost was poured out upon the Gentiles also. ⁴⁶ For they heard them speaking with tongues and magnifying God. ⁴⁷ Then Peter answered: Can any man forbid water, that these should not be baptized, who have received the Holy Ghost, as well as we? ⁴⁸ And he commanded them to be baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus Christ. Then they desired him to tarry with them some days.

11 ¹ And the apostles and brethren, who were in Judea, heard that the Gentiles also had received the word of God. ² And when Peter was come up to Jerusalem, they that were of the circumcision contended with him, ³ Saying: Why didst thou go in to men uncircumcised and didst eat with them? ⁴ But Peter began and declared to them the matter in order, saying: ⁵ I was in the city of Joppe praying: and I saw in an ecstasy of mind a vision, a certain vessel descending, as it were a great sheet let down from heaven by four corners. And it came even unto me. ⁶ Into which looking, I considered and saw fourfooted creatures of the earth and beasts and creeping things and fowls of the air. ⁷ And I heard also a voice saying to me: Arise, Peter. Kill and eat. ⁸ And I said: Not so, Lord: for nothing common or unclean hath ever entered into my mouth. ⁹ And the voice answered again from heaven: What God hath made clean, do not thou call common. ¹⁰ And this was done three times. And all were taken up again into heaven. ¹¹ And behold, immediately there were three men come to the house wherein I was, sent to me from Cæsarea. ¹² And the Spirit said to me that I should go with them, nothing doubting. And these six brethren went with me also: and we entered into the man's house. ¹³ And he told us how he had seen an angel in his house, standing and saying to him: Send to Joppe and call hither Simon, who is surnamed Peter, ¹⁴ Who shall speak to thee words whereby thou shalt be saved, and all thy house. ¹⁵ And when I had begun to speak, the Holy Ghost fell upon them, as upon us also in the beginning. ¹⁶ And I remembered the word of the Lord, how that he said: John indeed baptized with water but you shall be baptized with the Holy Ghost. ¹⁷ If then God gave them the same grace as to us also who believed in the Lord Jesus Christ: who was I, that could withstand God? ¹⁸ Having heard these things, they held their peace and glorified God, saying: God then hath also to the Gentiles given repentance, unto life.

345. The first mission

Acts 13:1-52

13 ¹ Now there were in the church which was at Antioch prophets and doctors, among whom was Barnabas and Simon who was called Niger, and Lucius of Cyrene and Manahen who was the foster brother of Herod the tetrarch, and Saul. ² And as they were ministering to the Lord and fasting, the Holy Ghost said to them: Separate me Saul and Barnabas, for the work whereunto I have taken them. ³ Then they fasting and praying and imposing their hands upon them, sent them away. ⁴ So they, being sent by the Holy Ghost, went to Seleucia: and from thence they sailed to Cyprus. ⁵ And when they were come to Salamina, they preached the word of God in the synagogues of the Jews. And they had John also in the ministry. ⁶ And when they had gone through the whole island, as far as Paphos, they found a certain man, a magician, a false prophet, a Jew, whose name was Bar-Jesu: ⁷ Who was with the proconsul Sergius Paulus, a prudent man. He, sending for Barnabas and Saul, desired to hear the word of God. ⁸ But Elymas the magician (for so his name is interpreted) withstood them, seeking to turn away the proconsul from the faith. ⁹ Then Saul, otherwise Paul, filled with the Holy Ghost, looking upon him, ¹⁰ Said: O full of all guile and of all deceit, child of the devil, enemy of all justice, thou ceasest not to pervert the right ways of the Lord. ¹¹ And now behold, the hand of the Lord is upon thee: and thou shalt be

blind, not seeing the sun for a time. And immediately there fell a mist and darkness upon him: and going about, he sought some one to lead him by the hand. ¹² Then the proconsul, when he had seen what was done, believed, admiring at the doctrine of the Lord. ¹³ Now when Paul and they that were with him had sailed from Paphos, they came to Perge in Pamphylia. And John departing from them, returned to Jerusalem. ¹⁴ But they, passing through Perge, came to Antioch in Pisidia: and, entering into the Synagogue on the sabbath day, they sat down. ¹⁵ And after the reading of the law and the prophets, the rulers of the synagogue sent to them, saying: Ye men, brethren, if you have any word of exhortation to make to the people, speak. ¹⁶ Then Paul rising up and with his hand bespeaking silence, said: Ye men of Israel and you that fear God, give ear. ¹⁷ The God of the people of Israel chose our fathers and exalted the people when they were sojourners in the land of Egypt: And with an high arm brought them out from thence: ¹⁸ And for the space of forty years endured their manners in the desert: ¹⁹ And, destroying seven nations in the land of Chanaan, divided their land among them by lot. ²⁰ As it were, after four hundred and fifty years. And after these things, he gave unto them judges, until Samuel the prophet. ²¹ And after that they desired a king: and God gave them Saul the son of Cis, a man of the tribe of Benjamin, forty years. ²² And when he had removed him, he raised them up David to be king: to whom giving testimony, he said: I have found David, the son of Jesse, a man according to my own heart, who shall do all my wills. ²³ Of this man's seed, God, according to his promise, hath raised up to Israel a Saviour Jesus: ²⁴ John first preaching, before his coming, the baptism of penance to all the people of Israel. ²⁵ And when John was fulfilling his course, he said: I am not he whom you think me to be. But behold, there cometh one after me, whose shoes of his feet I am not worthy to loose. ²⁶ Men, brethren, children of the stock of Abraham, and whosoever among you fear God: to you the word of this salvation is sent. ²⁷ For they that inhabited Jerusalem and the rulers thereof, not knowing him, nor the voices of the prophets which are read every sabbath, judging him, have fulfilled them. ²⁸ And finding no cause of death in him, they desired of Pilate that they might kill him. ²⁹ And when they had fulfilled all things that were written of him, taking him down from the tree, they laid him in a sepulchre. ³⁰ But God raised him up from the dead the third day. ³¹ Who was seen for many days by them who came up with him from Galilee to Jerusalem, who to this present are his witnesses to the people. ³² And we declare unto you that the promise which was made to our fathers, ³³ This same God hath fulfilled to our children, raising up Jesus, as in the second psalm also is written: Thou art my Son: this day have I begotten thee. ³⁴ And to shew that he raised him up from the dead, not to return now any more to corruption, he said thus: I will give you the holy things of David, faithful. ³⁵ And therefore, in another place also, he saith: Thou shalt not suffer thy holy one to see corruption. ³⁶ For David, when he had served in his generation, according to the will of God, slept: and was laid unto his fathers and saw corruption. ³⁷ But he whom God hath raised from the dead saw no corruption. ³⁸ Be it known therefore to you, men, brethren, that through him forgiveness of sins is preached to you: and from all the things from which you could not be justi-

fied by the law of Moses. ³⁹ In him every one that believeth is justified. ⁴⁰ Beware, therefore, lest that come upon you which is spoken in the prophets: ⁴¹ Behold, ye despisers, and wonder and perish: for I work a work in your days, a work which you will not believe, if any man shall tell it you. ⁴² And as they went out, they desired them that on the next sabbath they would speak unto them these words. ⁴³ And when the synagogue was broken up, many of the Jews and of the strangers who served God followed Paul and Barnabas: who, speaking to them, persuaded them to continue in the grace of God.

⁴⁴ But the next sabbath day, the whole city almost came together, to hear the word of God. ⁴⁵ And the Jews, seeing the multitudes, were filled with envy and contradicted those things which were said by Paul, blaspheming. ⁴⁶ Then Paul and Barnabas said boldly: To you it behoved us first to speak the word of God: but because you reject it and judge yourselves unworthy of eternal life, behold we turn to the Gentiles. ⁴⁷ For so the Lord hath commanded us: I have set thee to be the light of the Gentiles: that thou mayest be for salvation unto the utmost part of the earth. ⁴⁸ And the Gentiles hearing it were glad and glorified the word of the Lord: and as many as were ordained to life everlasting believed. ⁴⁹ And the word of the Lord was published throughout the whole country. ⁵⁰ But the Jews stirred up religious and honourable women and the chief men of the city: and raised persecution against Paul and Barnabas: and cast them out of their coasts. ⁵¹ But they, shaking off the dust of their feet against them, came to Iconium. ⁵² And the disciples were filled with joy and with the Holy Ghost.

347. The council of Jerusalem

Acts 15:1-41

15 ¹ And some, coming down from Judea, taught the brethren: That, except you be circumcised after the manner of Moses, you cannot be saved. ² And when Paul and Barnabas had no small contest with them, they determined that Paul and Barnabas and certain others of the other side should go up to the apostles and priests to Jerusalem, about this question. ³ They therefore, being brought on their way by the church, passed through Phenice and Samaria, relating the conversion of the Gentiles. And they caused great joy to all the brethren. ⁴ And when they were come to Jerusalem, they were received by the church and by the apostles and ancients, declaring how great things God had done with them. ⁵ But there arose of the sect of the Pharisees some that believed, saying: They must be circumcised and be commanded to observe the law of Moses.

⁶ And the apostles and ancients assembled to consider of this matter. ⁷ And when there had been much disputing, Peter, rising up, said to them: Men, brethren, you know that in former days God made choice among us, that by my mouth the Gentiles should hear the word of the gospel and believe. ⁸ And God, who knoweth the hearts, gave testimony, giving unto them the Holy Ghost, as well as to us: ⁹ And put no difference between us and them, purifying their hearts by faith. ¹⁰ Now therefore, why tempt you God to put a yoke upon the necks of the disciples which neither our fathers nor we have been able to bear? ¹¹ But by the grace of the Lord Jesus Christ, we believe to be saved, in like manner as they also.

¹² And all the multitude held their peace: and they heard Barnabas and Paul telling what great signs and wonders God had wrought among the Gentiles by them. ¹³ And after they had held their peace, James answered, saying: Men, brethren, hear me. ¹⁴ Simon hath related how God first visited to take of the Gentiles, a people to his name. ¹⁵ And to this agree the words of the prophets, as it is written: ¹⁶ After these things I will return and will rebuild the tabernacle of David, which is fallen down: and the ruins thereof I will rebuild. And I will set it up: ¹⁷ That the residue of men may seek after the Lord, and all nations upon whom my name is invoked, saith the Lord, who doth these things. ¹⁸ To the Lord was his own work known from the beginning of the world. ¹⁹ For which cause I judge that they who from among the Gentiles are converted to God are not to be disquieted: ²⁰ But that we write unto them, that they refrain themselves from the pollutions of idols and from fornication and from things strangled and from blood. ²¹ For Moses of old time hath in every city them that preach him in the synagogues, where he is read every sabbath. ²² Then it pleased the apostles and ancients, with the whole church, to choose men of their own company and to send to Antioch with Paul and Barnabas, namely, Judas, who was surnamed Barsabas, and Silas, chief men among the brethren. ²³ Writing by their hands: The apostles and ancients, brethren, to the brethren of the Gentiles that are at Antioch and in Syria and Cilicia, greeting. ²⁴ Forasmuch as we have heard that some going out from us have troubled you with words, subverting your souls, to whom we gave no commandment: ²⁵ It hath seemed good to us, being assembled together, to choose out men and to send them unto you, with our well beloved Barnabas and Paul: ²⁶ Men that have given their lives for the name of our Lord Jesus Christ. ²⁷ We have sent therefore Judas and Silas, who themselves also will, by word of mouth, tell you the same things. ²⁸ For it hath seemed good to the Holy Ghost and to us to lay no further burden upon you than these necessary things: ²⁹ That you abstain from things sacrificed to idols and from blood and from things strangled and from fornication: from which things keeping yourselves, you shall do well. Fare ye well. ³⁰ They therefore, being dismissed, went down to Antioch and, gathering together the multitude, delivered the epistle. ³¹ Which when they had read, they rejoiced for the consolation. ³² But Judas and Silas, being prophets also themselves, with many words comforted the brethren and confirmed them. ³³ And after they had spent some time there, they were let go with peace by the brethren unto them that had sent them. ³⁴ But it seemed good unto Silas to remain there: and Judas alone departed to Jerusalem. ³⁵ And Paul and Barnabas continued at Antioch, teaching and preaching, with many others, the word of the Lord.

³⁶ And after some days, Paul said to Barnabas: Let us return and visit our brethren in all the cities wherein we have preached the word of the Lord, to see how they do. ³⁷ And Barnabas would have taken with them John also, that was surnamed Mark. ³⁸ But Paul desired that he (as having departed from them out of Pamphylia and not gone with them to the work) might not be received. ³⁹ And there arose a dissension so that they departed one from another. And Barnabas indeed, taking Mark, sailed to Cyprus. ⁴⁰ But Paul, choosing Silas, departed, being delivered

by the brethren to the grace of God. ⁴¹ And he went through Syria and Cilicia, confirming the churches, commanding them to keep the precepts of the apostles and the ancients.

348. Macedonia: Lydia, and the jailer

Acts 16:1-40

16 ¹ And he came to Derbe and Lystra. And behold, there was a certain disciple there named Timothy, the son of a Jewish woman that believed: but his father was a Gentile. ² To this man the brethren that were in Lystra and Iconium gave a good testimony. ³ Him Paul would have to go along with him: and taking him, he circumcised him, because of the Jews who were in those places. For they all knew that his father was a Gentile. ⁴ And as they passed through the cities, they delivered unto them the decrees for to keep, that were decreed by the apostles and ancients who were at Jerusalem. ⁵ And the churches were confirmed in faith and increased in number daily. ⁶ And when they had passed through Phrygia and the country of Galatia, they were forbidden by the Holy Ghost to preach the word in Asia. ⁷ And when they were come into Mysia, they attempted to go into Bithynia: and the Spirit of Jesus suffered them not. ⁸ And when they had passed through Mysia, they went down to Troas. ⁹ And a vision was shewed to Paul in the night, which was a man of Macedonia standing and beseeching him and saying: Pass over into Macedonia and help us. ¹⁰ And as soon as he had seen the vision, immediately we sought to go into Macedonia: being assured that God had called us to preach the gospel to them. ¹¹ And sailing from Troas, we came with a straight course to Samothracia, and the day following to Neapolis. ¹² And from thence to Philippi, which is the chief city of part of Macedonia, a colony. And we were in this city some days conferring together. ¹³ And upon the Sabbath day, we went forth without the gate by a river side, where it seemed that there was prayer: and sitting down, we spoke to the women that were assembled. ¹⁴ And a certain woman named Lydia, a seller of purple, of the city of Thyatira, one that worshipped God, did hear: whose heart the Lord opened to attend to those things which were said by Paul. ¹⁵ And when she was baptized, and her household, she besought us, saying: If you have judged me to be faithful to the Lord, come into my house and abide there. And she constrained us.

¹⁶ And it came to pass, as we went to prayer, a certain girl having a pythonical spirit met us, who brought to her masters much gain by divining. ¹⁷ This same following Paul and us, cried out, saying: These men are the servants of the Most High God, who preach unto you the way of salvation. ¹⁸ And this she did many days. But Paul being grieved, turned and said to the spirit: I command thee, in the name of Jesus Christ, to go out from her. And he went out the same hour.

¹⁹ But her masters, seeing that the hope of their gain was gone, apprehending Paul and Silas, brought them into the market place to the rulers. ²⁰ And presenting them to the magistrates, they said: These men disturb our city, being Jews: ²¹ And preach a fashion which it is not lawful for us to receive nor observe, being Romans. ²² And the people ran together against them: and the magistrates, rending off their clothes, commanded them to be beaten with rods. ²³ And when they had laid many stripes upon them, they cast them into prison, charging the gaoler to keep

them diligently. ²⁴ Who having received such a charge, thrust them into the inner prison and made their feet fast in the stocks.

²⁵ And at midnight, Paul and Silas, praying, praised God. And they that were in prison heard them. ²⁶ And suddenly there was a great earthquake, so that the foundations of the prison were shaken. And immediately all the doors were opened and the bands of all were loosed. ²⁷ And the keeper of the prison, awakening out of his sleep and seeing the doors of the prison open, drawing his sword, would have killed himself, supposing that the prisoners had been fled. ²⁸ But Paul cried with a loud voice, saying: Do thyself no harm, for we all are here. ²⁹ Then calling for a light, he went in: and trembling, fell down at the feet of Paul and Silas. ³⁰ And bringing them out, he said: Masters, what must I do, that I may be saved? ³¹ But they said: believe in the Lord Jesus: and thou shalt be saved, and thy house. ³² And they preached the word of the Lord to him and to all that were in his house. ³³ And he, taking them the same hour of the night, washed their stripes: and himself was baptized, and all his house immediately. ³⁴ And when he had brought them into his own house, he laid the table for them: and rejoiced with all his house, believing God. ³⁵ And when the day was come, the magistrates sent the serjeants, saying: Let those men go. ³⁶ And the keeper of the prison told these words to Paul: The magistrates have sent to let you go. Now therefore depart. And go in peace. ³⁷ But Paul said to them: They have beaten us publicly, uncondemned, men that are Romans, and have cast us into prison. And now do they thrust us out privately? Not so: but let them come. ³⁸ And let us out ourselves. And the serjeants told these words to the magistrates. And they were afraid: hearing that they were Romans. ³⁹ And coming, they besought them: and bringing them out, they desired them to depart out of the city. ⁴⁰ And they went out of the prison and entered into the house of Lydia: and having seen the brethren, they comforted them and departed.

355. Rome

Acts 28:1-31

"Preaching the kingdom of God... without prohibition." The book stops rather than ends, and so does the period.

28 ¹ And when we had escaped, then we knew that the island was called Melita. But the barbarians shewed us no small courtesy. ² For kindling a fire, they refreshed us all, because of the present rain and of the cold. ³ And when Paul had gathered together a bundle of sticks and had laid them on the fire, a viper, coming out of the heat, fastened on his hand. ⁴ And when the barbarians saw the beast hanging on his hand, they said one to another: Undoubtedly this man is a murderer, who, though he hath escaped the sea, yet vengeance doth not suffer him to live. ⁵ And he indeed, shaking off the beast into the fire, suffered no harm. ⁶ But they supposed that he would begin to swell up and that he would suddenly fall down and die. But expecting long and seeing that there came no harm to him, changing their minds, they said that he was a god.

⁷ Now in these places were possessions of the chief man of the island, named Publius: who, receiving us for three days, entertained us courteously. ⁸ And it happened that the father of Publius lay sick of a fever and of a bloody flux. To whom Paul entered in. And when he had prayed and laid his hands on him,

he healed him. ⁹ Which being done, all that had diseases in the island came and were healed. ¹⁰ Who also honoured us with many honours: and when we were to set sail, they laded us with such things as were necessary.

¹¹ And after three months, we sailed in a ship of Alexandria, that had wintered in the island, whose sign was the Castors. ¹² And when we were come to Syracuse, we tarried there three days. ¹³ From thence, compassing by the shore, we came to Rhegium: and after one day, the south wind blowing, we came the second day to Puteoli: ¹⁴ Where, finding brethren, we were desired to tarry with them seven days. And so we went to Rome. ¹⁵ And from thence, when the brethren had heard of us, they came to meet us as far as Appii Forum and the Three Taverns. Whom when Paul saw, he gave thanks to God and took courage. ¹⁶ And when we were come to Rome, Paul was suffered to dwell by himself, with a soldier that kept him.

¹⁷ And after the third day, he called together the chief of the Jews. And when they were assembled, he said to them: Men, brethren, I, having done nothing against the people or the custom of our fathers, was delivered prisoner from Jerusalem into the hands of the Romans. ¹⁸ Who, when they had examined me, would have released me, for that there was no cause of death in me. ¹⁹ But the Jews contradicting it, I was constrained to appeal unto Caesar: not that I had anything to accuse my nation of. ²⁰ For this cause therefore I desired to see you and to speak to you. Because that for the hope of Israel, I am bound with this chain. ²¹ But they said to him: We neither received letters concerning thee from Judea: neither did any of the brethren that came hither relate or speak any evil of thee. ²² But we desire to hear of thee what thou thinkest: for as concerning this sect, we know that it is every where contradicted. ²³ And when they had appointed him a day, there came very many to him unto his lodgings. To whom he expounded, testifying the kingdom of God and persuading them concerning Jesus, out of the law of Moses and the prophets, from morning until evening. ²⁴ And some believed the things that were said: but some believed not. ²⁵ And when they agreed not among themselves, they departed, Paul speaking this one word: Well did the Holy Ghost speak to our fathers by Isaiahs the prophet, ²⁶ Saying: Go to this people and say to them: With the ear you shall hear and shall not understand: and seeing you shall see and shall not perceive. ²⁷ For the heart of this people is grown gross, and with their ears have they heard heavily and their eyes they have shut, lest perhaps they should see with their eyes and hear with their ears and understand with their heart and should be converted: and I should heal them. ²⁸ Be it known therefore to you that this salvation of God is sent to the Gentiles: and they will hear it. ²⁹ And when he had said these things, the Jews went out from him, having much reasoning among themselves.

³⁰ And he remained two whole years in his own hired lodging: and he received all that came in to him, ³¹ Preaching the kingdom of God and teaching the things which concern the Lord Jesus Christ, with all confidence, without prohibition.

Appendices

The apparatus of this volume. It stands at the back so that the readings can stand at the front; nothing has been shortened to put it here.

A. This edition

Registered as. douay-rheims

Source record. edition.english-college-of-douay.douay-rheims-bible.challoner-gutenberg-1581

Publication. Project Gutenberg eBook 1581, released 1 December 1998, most recently updated 23 September 2023; produced by Dennis McCarthy and Tad Book from a text originally published by Catholic Software

Date. 1749

Language. en

Chapter and verse numbering. vulgate

Psalter. gallican

Psalms inscriptions. numbered

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Status. public-domain

Jurisdiction. United States

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Numbering. The plan cites in vulgate numbering and this edition prints vulgate. Where the two differ a reading is converted through the tracked verse-level psalm concordance, and the reference this edition carries is printed beside the one the plan cites. Where no correspondence is recorded the reading is refused and says so, because a psalm reference that resolves to a real verse of the wrong psalm cannot be told from a correct one.

Paragraphs. 301 paragraph breaks are set in this volume, and not one of them was chosen while typesetting. The tracked verse files of every edition in this library are one verse per row and carry no paragraph structure at all; the markers their sources carried were dropped when the text was derived. Where a break is printed here it comes from one of two places, and both are tracked tables that can be read, counted and regenerated.

301 projected. No paragraph mark survives for this edition there, so the break is projected from witnesses that have one, under a rule rather than by hand: it is set only where every witness able to carry that verse opens a paragraph at it, and at least two do. The witnesses are king-james-version and world-english-bible-catholic. Where they disagree nothing is printed — and they disagree often, concurring at 2239 of the 8661 places where any of them breaks, which is 25.9%. That refusal is deliberate. A break resting on one witness alone would read as this edition's own paragraphing, and it would not be.

Set `--no-paragraphs` to remove every break and set the text exactly as the stored verse files hold it, each chapter running on as one paragraph. A mechanical review of this edition should use it: with the projection on, what is under review is partly this projection. It removes the paragraphing and nothing else: the verses set, their order and their wording are identical either way. The pilcrows go with the breaks, being paragraph marks themselves.

Digest. Of the verse rows set, in the order set (SHA-256): 3eeaa4ccf56a7981070b7adbb459c218b5eab0e0996933b1cf273a28e02b8eb2

D. What this edition cannot carry

Every reading of this track resolves in this edition.

E. Colophon

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